Anguttara Nikāya

The Numerical Discourses

- Book Three -



A New Translation

by

Bhikkhu Candana



Anguttara Nikāya
The Numerical Discourses

A New Translation

BOOK THREE

by

Bhikkhu Candana

Sabbadānaṃ Dhammadānaṃ Jināti

'The gift of Dhamma surpasses all other gifts.'

<u>This book is *not* for sale.</u>

Its distribution is **free of charge**.

The Dhamma is <u>NOT</u> to be sold!

<u>Dear Reader,</u>

<u>This is a gift of The Dhamma to You.</u>

All translations of the Suttas/Discourses contained in this book are copyrighted material.

You may copy, reprint, republish and redistribute this work in any medium, provided that you only make such copies available <u>free of charge</u> and <u>do not alter its contents</u>.

Being a Buddhist monk, living without the security of a monastery or a local Buddhist community, Bhikkhu Candana lives and works through the financial assistance of students and individual supporters who value his work and life mission.

If you would like to make a donation to help him in his daily needs, you can do so through:

https://gofund.me/9d161e0e

Copyright © Bhikkhu Candana, 2020, 2026

<u>www.mindreleased.com</u>

Table of Contents

Dedication 12

INTRODUCTION 13

a brief note 18

Bāla Vagga 20

“The Section on Fools” 20

1. Bhaya Sutta (Fear Causing Perils) 20

2. Lakkhaṇa Sutta (Characteristic Feature) 21

3. Cintī Sutta (On Thinking) 22

4. Accaya Sutta (Wrongdoing) 23

5. Ayoni Sutta (Without Consideration) 23

6. Akusala Sutta (Unhealthy & Damaging) 24

7. Sāvajja Sutta (Blameworthy) 25

8. Sabyābajjha Sutta (Harmful) 25

9. Khata Sutta (Destroyed) 26

10. Mala Sutta (Smudges) 27

Rathakāra Vagga 28

“The Section on the Chariot Builder” 28

11. Ñāta Sutta (Known Through Behavior) 28

12. Sāraṇīya Sutta (Special Locations to Recall) 29

13. Āsaṁsa Sutta (Expectations) 29

14. Cakkavatti Sutta (The Universal Wheel-turning Monarch) 32

15. Pacetana Sutta (King Pacetana) 33

16. Apaṇṇaka Sutta (Unmistakable) 35

17. Attabyābādha Sutta (Misfortune to Oneself & Others) 37

18. Devaloka Sutta (Realms of the Devas) 38

19. Paṭhama Pāpaṇika Sutta (The Business Owner – Part 1) 38

20. Dutiya Pāpaṇika Sutta (The Business Owner – Part 2) 39
Puggala Vagga 42
"The Section on People" 42
21. Samiddha Sutta (The Venerable Saviṭṭha) 42
22. Gilāna Sutta (Suffering from Illness) 44
23. Saṅkhāra Sutta (Habitual Drives) 45
24. Bahukāra Sutta (Very Helpful) 46
25. Vajirūpama Sutta (Like Diamond) 47
26. Sevitabba Sutta (One to Associate With) 48
27. Jigcchitabba Sutta (Offensive) 50
28. Gūthabhāṇī Sutta (Speech that Resembles Freshly Dropped Excrement) 52
29. Andha Sutta (The Blind) 53
30. Avakujja Sutta (The Inverted Water Pot) 55
Devadūta Vagga 58
"The Section on the Divine Messengers" 58
31. Brahmā Sutta (With Brahmā) 58
32. Ānanda Sutta (The Venerable Ānanda) 59
33. Sāriputta Sutta (The Venerable Sāriputta) 60
34. Nidāna Sutta (Causes) 61
35. Hatthaka Sutta (Discourse to Hatthaka) 63
36. Devadūta Sutta (Divine Messengers) 65
37. Paṭhama Catumahārāja Sutta (The Four Great Celestial Guardian Kings – Part 1) 69
38. Dutiya Catumahārāja Sutta (The Four Great Celestial Guardian Kings – Part 2) 71
39. Sukhamāla Sutta (Garlanded by Happiness and Comfort) 72
40. Ādhipateyya Sutta (Authorities) 74
Cūḷa Vagga 79
"The Shorter Section" 79
41. Sammukhībhāva Sutta (The Presence) 79
42. Tiṭhāna Sutta (Three Traits) 79

43. Atthavasa Sutta (Distinguishing Qualities) 80
44. Kathāpavatti Sutta (Elements of Coherence) 80
45. Paṇḍita Sutta (Advised by the Wise) 81
46. Sīlavanta Sutta (The Virtuous) 81
47. Saṅkhata Lakkhaṇa Sutta & Asaṅkhata Lakkhaṇa Sutta (The Marks of the Prepared & The Marks of the Non-prepared) 82
48. Pabbata Rāja Sutta (The Great Himalayas) 82
49. Ātappakaraṇīya Sutta (Ardent Energy) 83
50. Mahācora Sutta (The Highway Robber) 84
Brāhmaṇa Vagga 86
"The Section on Brahmins" 86
51. Paṭhama Dvebrāhmaṇa Sutta (The Two Brahmins – Part 1) 86
52. Dutiya Dvebrāhmaṇa Sutta (The Two Brahmins – Part 2) 87
53. Aññatara Brāhmaṇa Sutta (A Certain Brahmin) 88
54. Paribbājaka Sutta (A Wandering Ascetic) 89
55. Nibbuta Sutta (Extinction) 92
56. Paloka Sutta (Dwindled) 94
57. Vacchagotta Sutta (Discourse to Vacchagotta) 95
58. Tikaṇṇa Sutta (Discourse to Tikaṇṇa) 98
59. Jāṇussoṇi Sutta (Discourse to Jāṇussoṇi) 102
60. Saṅgārava Sutta (Discourse to Saṅgārava) 106
Mahā Vagga 116
"The Greater Section" 116
61. Titthāyatanadi Sutta (Beliefs of Sectarians) 116
62. Bhaya Sutta (Terrifying Danger) 123
63. Venāgapura Sutta (At Venāgapura) 126
64. Sarabha Sutta (Discourse to Sarabha) 130
65. Kesaputtiya (Kālāma) Sutta (Discourse to the Kālamas) 133
66. Sāḷha Sutta (Discourse to Sāḷha) 141
67. Kathāvatthu Sutta (Topics of Conversation) 146

68. Aññatitthiya (Titthiya) Sutta (Those holding other views) 148
69. Akusalamūla Sutta (Damaging & Harmful Roots) 151
70. Uposatha Sutta (The Fortnightly Observances) 155
Ānanda Vagga 166
"The Section on the Venerable Ānanda" 166
71. Channa Sutta (The Wandering Ascetic Channa) 166
72. Ājīvaka Sutta (The Naked Ascetics) 168
73. Mahānāmasakka Sutta (Mahānāma, the Sakyan) 170
74. Niganṭha Sutta (The Niganṭha – Jain Naked Ascetics) 172
75. Nivesaka Sutta (Encouragement) 175
76. Paṭhama Bhava Sutta (On Becoming – Part 1) 177
77. Dutiya Bhava Sutta (On Becoming – Part 2) 178
78. Sīlabbata Sutta (Rites & Observances of Religious Practice) 179
79. Gandhajāta Sutta (The Fragrances) 180
80. Cūḷanikā (Abhibhu) Sutta (Minor World Systems) 182
Samaṇa Vagga 186
"The Section on Recluses" 186
81a. Samaṇa Sutta (Recluses) 186
81b. Gadrabha Sutta (A Donkey) 186
82. Kassaka Sutta (A Farmer) 187
83. Vajjiputta Sutta (Son of the Vajjis) 188
84. Sekha Sutta (The Disciple in Higher Training) 189
85. Paṭhama Sikkhā Sutta (Mastering the Trainings – Part 1) 190
86. Dutiya Sikkhā Sutta (Mastering the Trainings – Part 2) 192
87. Tatiya Sikkhā Sutta (Mastering the Trainings – Part 3) 194
88. Paṭhama Sikkhā Sutta (The Higher Trainings – Part 1) 196
89. Dutiya Sikkhā Sutta (The Higher Trainings – Part 2) 197
90. Paṅkadhā Sutta (Acknowledging a Mistake) 199
Loṇakapalla Vagga 203

"The Section on the Salt Crystal" 203
91. Accāyika Sutta (Urgent Tasks) 203
92a. Paviveka Sutta (Seclusion) 204
92b. Sarada Sutta (In Autumn) 206
93. Parissa Sutta (Gatherings) 206
94. Paṭhama Ājānīya Sutta (The Thoroughbred – Part 1) 208
95. Dutiya Ājānīya Sutta (The Thoroughbred – Part 2) 209
96. Tatiya Ājānīya Sutta (The Thoroughbred – Part 3) 210
97. Potthaka Sutta (A Rough Burlap Cloth) 211
98. Kāsikam Vattha Sutta (A Fine Varanasi (Kāsi) Fabric) 213
99. Loṇakapalla Sutta (A Salt Crystal) 214
100. Paṁsudhovaka Sutta (The Refining of Gold) 219
101. Nimitta Sutta (Hallmark) 222
Sambodhi Vagga 227
"The Section on Awakening" 227
102. Pubbeva Sambodha Sutta (Before Awakening) 227
103. Paṭhama Assada Sutta (Seeking Satisfaction – Part 1) 228
104. Dutiya Assada Sutta (Seeking Satisfaction – Part 2) 229
105. Samaṇa Brahmana Sutta (Recluses & Brahmins) 229
106. Ruṇṇa Sutta (Lamentation) 230
107. Atitti Sutta (Non-Satiation) 230
108. Paṭhama Kūṭāgāre Sutta (The Peaked Roof – Part 1) 231
109. Dutiya Kūṭāgāre (Byāpanna) Sutta (Peaked Roof – Part 2) 232
110. Paṭhama Nidāna Sutta (Origination of Actions – Part 1) 233
111. Dutiya Nidāna Sutta (Origination of Actions – Part 2) 234
Āpāyika Vagga 237
"The Section on the Miserable Realms" 237
112. Āpāyika Sutta (Miserable Realms) 237
113. Dullabha Sutta (Rare) 237

114. Appameyya (Immeasurable) 238
115. Āneñja Sutta (Immovable States) 238
116. Vipatti Sampadā Sutta (Failures and Successes) 240
117. Apaṇṇaka Sutta (With Certainty) 242
118. Kammanta Sutta (Activity) 245
119. Paṭhama Soceyya Sutta (On Purity – Part 1) 247
120. Dutiya Soceyya Sutta (On Purity – Part 2) 248
121. Moneyya Sutta (Wise Perfection) 249
Kusinārā Vagga 251
"The Section on Kusinārā" 251
122. Kusinārā Sutta (At Kusinārā) 251
123. Bhaṇḍana Sutta (Quarrelling) 252
124. Gotamaka Cetiya Sutta (At the Gotamaka Shrine) 254
125. Bharaṇḍu Kālāma Sutta (The Kālāma Bharaṇḍu) 255
126. Hatthaka Sutta (Hatthaka the Young Deva) 257
127. Kaṭuviya Sutta (On Defiling) 259
128. Paṭhama Anuruddha Sutta (The Venerable Anuruddha – Part 1) 260
129. Dutiya Anuruddha Sutta (The Venerable Anuruddha – Part 2) 261
130. Paṭicchanna Sutta (Covered & Exposed) 263
131. Lekha Sutta (Carved in Stone) 264
Yodhājīva Vagga 265
"The Section on the Warrior" 265
132. Yodhājīva Sutta (The Warrior) 265
133. Parisā Sutta (Gatherings) 267
134. Mittā Sutta (The Friend) 267
135. Uppādā Sutta (Arising) 267
136. Kesakambala Sutta (The Blanket of Head-hair) 268
137. Sampadā Sutta (Attainments) 269
138. Vuddhi Sutta (Development) 269

139. Assakhaḷuṅka Sutta (Wild Colts) 269
140. Assaparassa Sutta (Stallions) 271
141. Assājānīya Sutta (Thoroughbreds) 273
142. Paṭhama Moranivāpa Sutta (The Peacock Sanctuary – Part 1) 276
143. Dutiya Moranivāpa Sutta (The Peacock Sanctuary – Part 2) 276
144. Tatiya Moranivāpa Sutta (The Peacock Sanctuary – Part 3) 277
Maṅgala Vagga 278
"The Section on the Great Fortune" 278
145. Akusala Sutta (Damaging & Harmful) 278
146. Sāvajja Sutta (Blamable) 278
147. Visama Sutta (Disharmonious) 279
148. Asuci Sutta (Impure) 279
149. Paṭhama Khata Sutta (Dug Up & Undone – Part 1) 280
150. Dutiya Khata Sutta (Dug Up & Undone – Part 2) 280
151. Tatiya Khata Sutta (Dug Up & Undone – Part 3) 281
152. Catuttha Khata Sutta (Dug Up & Undone – Part 4) 282
153. Vandanā Sutta (Homage) 282
154. Pubbaṇha Sutta (At the Crack of Dawn) 283
Paṭipadā Vagga 284
"The Section on The Path of Practice" 284
155. Paṭhama Paṭipadā Sutta (Modes of Practice – Part 1) 284
156. Dutiya Paṭipadā Sutta (Modes of Practice – Part 2) 286
Kammapatha Peyyāla 289
"Abbreviated Section on the Courses of Action" 289
157. Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta (Deposited into Hell – Part 1) 289
158. Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta (Deposited into Hell – Part 2) 289
159. Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta (Deposited into Hell – Part 3) 290
160. Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta (Deposited into Hell – Part 4) 291
161. Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta (Deposited into Hell – Part 5) 291

162. Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta (Deposited into Hell – Part 6)..... 291
163. Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta (Deposited into Hell – Part 7)..... 292
164. Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta (Deposited into Hell – Part 8)..... 292
165. Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta (Deposited into Hell – Part 9)..... 293
166. Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta (Deposited into Hell – Part 10)..... 293
Rāga Peyyāla Vagga..... 295
“The Section on Abbreviated Repetitions, Starting with Passion”..... 295
167 - 352. 295
a final note..... 300

Dedication

This work is reverently and lovingly dedicated to the late Venerable Bhikkhu Kaṭukurunde Ñāṇananda, a true Noble Son of The Blessed One, whose fearless clarity, meditative depth of understanding, and unwavering fidelity to the early word of The Buddha rekindled the living flame of The Dhamma in our time. Therefore, with a heart overflowing with profound gratitude and deep admiration, I bow in veneration to my late teacher, acknowledging him as the greatest inspiration behind this undertaking. May the merits arisen here be shared in his honor, and may his example continue to guide sincere seekers back to the luminous simplicity of The Teaching, revealed to existence by The Perfectly Self-Awakened Buddha.

Also, this work could not have been possible without the care and attention of my late parents and teachers, as well as students and all those supporters, whose hearts resonate to the same tune, that is the unmistakable love for The Dhamma.

With profound gratitude and a heart full of devotion, I humbly dedicate this work to The Triple Gem and The Truly Holy Noble Disciples, who have crossed the flood. Their wisdom and compassion have shaped my understanding, and it is with deep reverence that I offer this translation of the Anguttara Nikāya, a cornerstone of the Buddhist Pāli Canon, to posterity.

As a practitioner, psychotherapist, and teacher, I embarked on this solitary journey, weaving together years of academic study and meditative practice. The result is a comprehensive and nuanced translation that seeks to capture the essence of the *suttas* (discourses) in their entirety.

In the spirit of preserving the authenticity of Lord Buddha's Teachings, i.e. The Dhamma, this translation endeavors to include all sections almost always omitted by others for the sake of brevity. Every discourse, every verse, and every lesson within these sacred texts have been meticulously examined and presented, sparing neither time nor energy to ensure a faithful rendering.

As the world grapples with uncertainty and strife, may this humble offering serve as a beacon of light, a gift of Dhamma to those in need.

Whatever countless merits have been gained by supporters of this project and of my life and work, as a Bhikkhu in this changing world, may their rewards perpetually increase, exponentially, protecting The Sāsana and the genuine Teachings of Lord Buddha, which are being polluted daily and driven to extinction, as predicted By Lord Buddha Himself.

May the Blessings of the Triple Gem be with you, in your hearts, always…

Mettācittenā,
Bhikkhu Candana
Buddhist Era 2569 (2026)

INTRODUCTION

A New Translation of Anguttara Nikāya: The Numerical Discourses

The **Anguttara Nikāya**, the "Collection of Discourses Arranged by Number," is one of the most elegantly practical repositories of The Buddha's Teachings. Its structure reflects a natural law of learning: that profound understanding arises from the gradual accumulation and integration of simple principles. By organizing The Dhamma into numerical sets – ones, twos, threes, and so forth – the collection offers a path that is both systematic and organic, resonating equally with the newly interested reader and the dedicated practitioner.

Unlike texts shaped by philosophical argument or doctrinal exposition, the Anguttara Nikāya thrives on **direct encounters**: The Buddha addressing a monk struggling with his duties, a layperson navigating ethical challenges, a king pondering governance, or a wanderer seeking clarity. These dialogues reveal something essential about The Dhamma: that it was *never* meant to float in abstraction, but to be met within the "living laboratory" of human experience.

The very structure of the collection highlights the **relatability** and *contextual intimacy* of the Teaching, where each sutta emerges from specific people in specific circumstances – moments of confusion, insight, conflict, or breakthrough. The Dhamma is shown as it actually operated in the world: clear, compassionate, precise, and always geared toward Release.

This translation is part of a larger undertaking that has been developing over the course of more than seven years. The project began as an effort to **narrate** large sections of the Pāli Canon, driven by a simple but sincere aspiration to make the suttas directly accessible to anyone, anywhere, without cost or barriers. Narration gradually revealed textual inconsistencies, missing repetitions, and interpretive issues that required urgent attention. What began as narration, therefore, expanded into a full-scale, line-by-line **retranslation** of the Nikāyas.

Throughout this work, I have adhered to a few essential principles.

The first is **faithfulness to the Pāli**, including a devoted restoration of the many repetitions that have been removed by editors over the centuries. These repetitions are *not* ornamental flourishes. They are the heartbeat of an oral tradition that preserved The Dhamma for centuries before a single word was written. Their rhythm reinforces memory, emphasis, and practice. They enable the teachings to sink deeply into one's understanding. Modern tendencies to remove or abbreviate them often create an impression of terseness that simply does not reflect the original mode of transmission.

In this translation, the repetitions are restored and preserved in full – even when doing so demanded long days, and sometimes weeks, of translation, narration, and transcription, in a dedicated effort to re-link these dismembered and scattered sections of the discourses. In addition, key Pāli terms are retained where necessary, allowing readers to trace meanings accurately, while English renderings convey accessibility and readability.

Here, I feel it is necessary to say a few words about the very rich and ultra-nuanced terms used by The Buddha in His dissemination of The Dhamma.

Although many such terms were used by His contemporaries, such as *dhamma*, *tathāgata*, *vimutti*, *kamma*, *brahmin*, etc., the Great Teacher reintroduced these terms by rendering a thoroughly new and different meaning for each. One such organically and highly contextual Pāli term that The Blessed One used was "*saṅkhāra.*" Here, I have used several definitions for "saṅkhāra" throughout this retranslated work of the Numerical Discourses (as well as in the other collections or Nikāyas), rather than being rigidly bound to a single definition. To this end, readers will discover "*saṅkhāra*" presented as "*habitual drive(s),*" "*generative cause(s),*" "*winding,*" "*preparing*" or "*loading up,*" or "*conditioned.*" Often, however (as with other terms like *Citta* or *Samādhi)*, I have found it essential to simply leave it in its Pāli form, as purely "saṅkhāra." This, because readers are highly encouraged to become familiar with the original Pāli forms of these extremely important terms, given their unique role within The Buddhist Training, instead of using the current familiar and rather limited English definitions for it, i.e. "*formation,*" "*fermentation,*" "*choices,*" etc.

The second principle to which I have adhered in this work is **directness**. The Dhamma of the Nikāyas speaks for itself. It does not require elaborate conceptual scaffolding, philosophical preambles, or densely packed pages of academic framing for its meaning to become evident. Therefore, this Introduction – while providing necessary orientation – deliberately avoids to become another scholarly essay that stands between the reader and The Buddha's words. In recent decades, we have grown accustomed to multi-layered commentary, footnotes, digressions, doctrinal charts, and interpretive debates. Such materials may hold value in certain contexts, yet they risk turning the living Dhamma into an object of intellectual fascination rather than a Path of Practice and True Liberation.

My intention is to gently encourage the reader to step beyond the habit of meeting the Nikāyas through an academic lens alone.

The Buddha did not care to speak to scholars.

He spoke to human beings – farmers, kings, merchants, recluses, artisans, wanderers – people with fears, hopes, questions, and obstacles not unlike our own.

The Dhamma is timeless because it speaks directly, clearly, and compassionately to the very structure of human experience. It is not my place to obscure this directness with layers of theoretical framing. Rather, I strive to allow the suttas to shine through **uninterrupted**, so the reader may meet them as the early Saṅgha did: openly, attentively, and without preconception. This because, the teachings are not bound by time or place; they remain as potent and

transformative today as they were when first spoken, offering a path to liberation for all who engage with them sincerely. So, approach them reflectively, with care and attention, and allow The Dhamma to unfold naturally in your own experience.

Another central dimension of this project has been the recognition, that such an undertaking requires not only scholarly training and linguistic skill, but the **full commitment of monastic life**. Some years ago, I closed my psychotherapy practice as a clinician, and embraced homelessness as a Bhikkhu to devote myself entirely to the preservation and translation of The Buddha's discourses. This was not a romantic or symbolic gesture, but a necessary step. The depth of attention demanded by this work – its precision, continuity, and meditative integrity – could not coexist with professional responsibilities.

This translation exists only because of the generosity of supporters whose faith and kindness have sustained me with the four requisites of a Bhikkhu: food, clothing, shelter, and medicine. Without their help, this task – spanning thousands of pages, countless hours, and multiple continents across the world – would not have been possible. To these individuals, I express my deepest gratitude. And the **merit of preserving The Dhamma** is shared fully and freely with all who have supported and encouraged this effort, and continue to do so.

The Anguttara Nikāya is especially suitable for modern readers. Its structure allows The Dhamma to be entered *at any point* – one may read a single short sutta and carry its teaching through the day, or delve into thematic clusters that illuminate The Path from multiple angles. Its emphasis on gradual cultivation mirrors the lived reality of practice: step by step, quality by quality, choice by choice, moment by moment.

It is my sincere wish that this translation bring the reader into direct contact with the liberating clarity of The Buddha's words. May these teachings be approached with mindfulness and humility, without haste or presumption. And may they serve as a steady light in a world that, like ancient India, is marked by both beauty and confusion, both aspiration and suffering.

Offered freely, without condition, and with a heart dedicated to the continuation of The Buddha's Dispensation, this work is for the benefit of all beings.

Bhikkhu Candana,
Buddhist Era 2569 (2026)

Tikanipāta

–

Book of the Threes

a brief note

The Book of Threes

Tikanipāta

In the *Book of Threes*, The Buddha organizes His guidance into triads – threefold patterns that reflect the structure of experience and the Path.

These teachings touch on The Three Refuges, the three kinds of misconduct, the Three Trainings, and countless other triadic formulations that illuminate the nature of the Buddhist Practice proper. The *suttas* in this collection, therefore, offer a balanced view of *Sīla* (virtuous behavior), *Samādhi* (mental cultivation), and *Paññā* (wisdom).

It is here, in this Book of Threes, where we find the famous and often underestimated *Kālāma (Kesaputtiya) Sutta* (AN 3.65) and The Buddha's encouragement of honest and free inquiry to the people of Kālāma. Also, within the *Devaduta Sutta* (AN 3.36), we are shown the "Divine Messengers" whom all of us encounter throughout life, prior to death, in order to develop our sense of Urgency (*saṃvega*). Here too is where we encounter the highly impactful and revealing teaching given to the Venerable Anuruddha by the Venerable Sāriputta, as seen in the *Dutiya Anuruddha Sutta* (AN 3.130).

The *Threes* help the reader see The Dhamma as an interlocking whole, with each triad revealing a stable framework for self-transformation, leading one straight to Release. We are shown throughout these discourses how The Dhamma is *not* an abstraction, but a *practical system* where understanding, effort, and realization *must* harmonize, and thus become demonstrably life changing both for oneself, as well as society at large.

Anguttara Nikāya

The Numerical Discourses

A New Translation

Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Sammasambuddhassa
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Sammasambuddhassa
Namo Tassa Bhagavato Arahato Sammasambuddhassa

Tikanipāta

Book of the Threes

Suttas 1 – 352

AN III

Suttas 1-10

Bāla Vagga

"The Section on Fools"

1. ***Bhaya Sutta*** *(Fear Causing Perils)*

This is what I personally heard.

Once, while The Blessed One was living in the monastery donated by the householder Anāthapiṇḍika, in Sāvatthī's Jeta's Park, He addressed the Bhikkhus by saying:

"Bhikkhus!"

"Yes, Blessed Lord!" those Bhikkhus replied.

And The Blessed One continued by instructing:

"Bhikkhus, all dangerous and fear causing situations result from the behavior and actions of fools, never from the actions of those who are wise.

"Similarly, all perilous and disastrous circumstances take place due to the behavior and actions of fools, never from the actions of those who are wise.

"Similarly, all troubles and catastrophes come from the behavior and actions of fools, never from the actions of those who are wise.

"Imagine, Bhikkhus, a fire that starts spreading from a burning hut made of reeds and dry grass, proliferating and expanding as it engulfs bigger structures such as houses, villas, and luxurious mansions that are well-insulated, and even if they have all their doors and windows sealed shut, or every wall covered with plaster, both internally and externally, nevertheless, they will all burn due to that fire from the burning hut.

"In just the same way, Bhikkhus, all dangerous and fear causing situations result from the behavior and actions of fools, never from the actions of those who are wise.
"Similarly, all perilous and disastrous circumstances take place due to the behavior and actions of fools, never from the actions of those who are wise.

“Similarly, all troubles and catastrophes come from the behavior and actions of fools, never from the actions of those who are wise.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, know that due to his behavior, the very presence of the fool indicates the presence of danger and fear-causing perils. But the opposite is true with the presence of the wise, in whose presence there is safety and no danger.

“So, whereas the fool causes perilous and disastrous circumstances to occur, in the presence of the wise, however, there is none.

“And similarly, while the fool brings with him troubles and catastrophes for both himself and others, the wise, on the other hand, does not cause any such things to occur.

“For, truly, there can be no danger paused by the presence of the wise, no terrors or troublesome events, nor any fear-causing perils at all, due to the behavior or actions of those who are wise.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must train yourselves, by reflecting:

‘We will fully relinquish and abandon all those qualities that designate one as a fool, those qualities with which a fool is identified. And instead, we will continuously develop and cultivate within us those qualities that transform us into wise individuals, chiseling for ourselves those bright characteristics and features that make one be recognized as truly skillful and wise!’

“It is in this manner, O Bhikkhus, that you must all train yourselves!”

2. ***Lakkhaṇa Sutta*** *(Characteristic Feature)*

Bhikkhus, the fool is identified through the characteristic features of his actions, just as the wise person is identified through the characteristic features of his actions. Therefore, wisdom itself is demonstrably clear in the feature of one’s very behavior, manifested through the actions one commits.

In this manner, the fool is to be recognized in the presence of three things.

What are these three?

The evil actions one commits through the body. The evil deed one commits through one’s speech. And the evil thoughts one keeps pondering and conjuring up in one’s mind.

These are the three qualities that expose the fool, making him thus easily identifiable.
On the other hand, Bhikkhus, the wise person is to be recognized in the presence of three things.

What are these three?

The good and skillful actions one commits through the body. The good and skillful ways of using one's speech while communicating, along with the good and skillful thoughts one reflects upon and ponders in one's mind.

These are the three qualities that manifest the person who is wise, making him thus easily identifiable.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must train yourselves, by reflecting:

'We will fully relinquish and abandon all those qualities that designate one as a fool, those qualities with which a fool is identified. And instead, we will continuously develop and cultivate within us those qualities that transform us into wise individuals, chiseling for ourselves those bright characteristic features that make one be recognized as truly skillful and wise!'

It is in this manner, O Bhikkhus, that you must all train yourselves!

3. ***Cintī Sutta*** *(On Thinking)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three traits, the three behaviors of a fool. Which three?

Here, a fool behaves unskillfully in body, unskillfully in his speech, and unskillfully in his thoughts. If a fool were to behave skillfully in body, skillfully in speech, and skillfully in his thoughts, then wise individuals would not be able to see him for who he is.

However, it is because a fool is one who behaves unskillfully with his body, unskillfully in his speech, and unskillfully in his thoughts, that wise individuals are able to identify him as an unskillful person, as a fool.

Bhikkhus, these are the three traits, the three behaviors of a wise person. Which three?

Here, a wise person behaves skillfully in body, skillfully in his speech and skillfully in his thoughts. If a wise person were to behave unskillfully in body, unskillfully in speech, and unskillfully in his thoughts, then wise individuals would not be able to see him for who he is.

However, it is because a wise person is one who behaves skillfully with his body, skillfully in his speech, and skillfully in his thoughts, that wise individuals are able to identify him as a skillful person, as a truly wise person.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must train yourselves, by reflecting:

'We will fully relinquish and abandon all those qualities that designate one as a fool, those qualities with which a fool is identified. And instead, we will continuously develop and cultivate

within us those qualities that transform us into wise individuals, chiseling for ourselves those bright characteristic features that make one be recognized as truly skillful and wise!'

It is in this manner, O Bhikkhus, that you must all train yourselves!

4. ***Accaya Sutta*** *(Wrongdoing)*

Bhikkhus, the one who possesses three traits should be known as a fool. Which three?

He does not look at his wrongdoing as a wrongdoing. When he finally sees his wrongdoing as a wrongdoing, he still does not try to fix it in accordance with The Dhamma. And when someone else confesses to him their wrongdoing, he rejects it by not welcoming it, in order to mend the situation according to The Dhamma.

The person with these three traits should be identified as a fool.

But, Bhikkhus, the one who possesses these other three traits should be known as wise. Which three?

He sees a wrongdoing as a wrongdoing. When he sees a wrongdoing as a wrongdoing, he quickly tries to fix it in accordance with The Dhamma. And when someone else confesses to him their wrongdoing, he welcomes it, in order to mend the situation according to The Dhamma.

Thus, the person possessing these three traits should be identified as wise.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must train yourselves, by reflecting:

'We will fully relinquish and abandon all those qualities that designate one as a fool, those qualities with which a fool is identified. And instead, we will continuously develop and cultivate within us those qualities that transform us into wise individuals, chiseling for ourselves those bright characteristic features that make one be recognized as truly skillful and wise!'

It is in this manner, O Bhikkhus, that you must all train yourselves!

5. ***Ayoni Sutta*** *(Without Consideration)*

Bhikkhus, the one who possesses three traits should be known as a fool. What are these three?

He poses a question without proper consideration. In responding to a question, he does so without consideration. When someone else responds to a question with proper consideration and in a meaningful way, he quickly rejects it disapprovingly.

The person with these three traits should be identified as a fool.

However, Bhikkhus, the one who possesses these other three traits should be known as wise. What are these three?

He poses a question with proper consideration. In responding to a question, he does so with consideration. When someone else responds to a question with proper consideration and in a meaningful way, he welcomes it approvingly.

The person with these three traits should be identified as wise.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must train yourselves, by reflecting:

'We will fully relinquish and abandon all those qualities that designate one as a fool, those qualities with which a fool is identified. And instead, we will continuously develop and cultivate within us those qualities that transform us into wise individuals, chiseling for ourselves those bright characteristic features that make one be recognized as truly skillful and wise!'

It is in this manner, O Bhikkhus, that you must all train yourselves!

*6. **Akusala Sutta** (Unhealthy & Damaging)*

Bhikkhus, the one who possesses three traits should be known as a fool. Which three?

He lives through unhealthy and damaging bodily actions, unhealthy and damaging verbal actions, and unhealthy and damaging mental actions.

A person possessing these three traits should be identified as a fool.

On the other hand, Bhikkhus, the one who possesses these other three traits should be known as a wise person. Which three?

He lives through healthy and constructive bodily actions, healthy and constructive verbal actions, and healthy and constructive mental actions.
A person possessing these three traits should be identified as a wise person.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must train yourselves, by reflecting:

'We will fully relinquish and abandon all those qualities that designate one as a fool, those qualities with which a fool is identified. And instead, we will continuously develop and cultivate within us those qualities that transform us into wise individuals, chiseling for ourselves those bright characteristic features that make one be recognized as truly skillful and wise!'

It is in this manner, O Bhikkhus, that you must all train yourselves!

7. ***Sāvajja Sutta*** *(Blameworthy)*

Bhikkhus, the one who possesses three traits should be known as a fool. Which three?

He engages in blameworthy bodily actions, engages in blameworthy verbal actions, and engages in blameworthy mental actions.

Thus, the person possessing these three traits should be identified as a fool.

However, Bhikkhus, the one who possesses these other three traits should be known as a wise person. Which three?

He is one who engages in blameless bodily actions, engages in blameless verbal actions, and engages in blameless mental actions.

A person possessing these three traits should be identified as a wise person.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must train yourselves, by reflecting:

'We will fully relinquish and abandon all those qualities that designate one as a fool, those qualities with which a fool is identified. And instead, we will continuously develop and cultivate within us those qualities that transform us into wise individuals, chiseling for ourselves those bright characteristic features that make one be recognized as truly skillful and wise!'

It is in this manner, O Bhikkhus, that you must all train yourselves!

8. ***Sabyābajjha Sutta*** *(Harmful)*

Bhikkhus, the one who possesses three traits should be known as a fool. Which three?

He engages in harmful bodily actions, engages in harmful verbal actions, and engages in harmful mental actions.

Thus, the person possessing these three traits should be identified as a fool.

Meanwhile, the one who possesses these other three traits should be known as a wise person. Which three?

He engages in non-harmful bodily actions, engages in non-harmful verbal actions, and engages in non-harmful mental actions.

So, the person possessing these three traits should be identified as a wise person.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must train yourselves, by reflecting:

'We will fully relinquish and abandon all those qualities that designate one as a fool, those qualities with which a fool is identified. And instead, we will continuously develop and cultivate within us those qualities that transform us into wise individuals, chiseling for ourselves those bright characteristic features that make one be recognized as truly skillful and wise!'

It is in this manner, O Bhikkhus, that you must all train yourselves!

9. ***Khata Sutta*** *(Destroyed)*

Bhikkhus, it is through acquiring and holding onto three traits that the inefficient, unfit, and untrained person keeps himself in a decrepit, crippled, destroyed and a flimsy state, placing himself in a position where he is rebuked and reprimanded by the wise, and thus he produces heaps of bad merits.

What are these three?

Physical wrongdoing, verbal wrongdoing, and mental wrongdoing.

By possessing these three traits, the inefficient, unfit, and untrained person keeps himself in a decrepit, crippled, destroyed and a flimsy state, placing himself in a position where he is rebuked and reprimanded by the wise, and thus he produces heaps of bad merits.

However, Bhikkhus, it is through acquiring and holding onto these other three traits that the effective, healthy, and well-trained person keeps himself in a capable, efficient, healthy and dexterous state, placing himself in a position where he stands blameless and commended by the wise, and thus he produces heaps of good merits.

And what are these three?

Physical good deeds, verbal good deeds, and mental good deeds.

By possessing these three traits, the effective, healthy, and well-trained person keeps himself in a capable, efficient, healthy and dexterous state, placing himself in a position whereby he stands blameless and commended by the wise, and thus he produces heaps of good merits.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must train yourselves, by reflecting:

'We will fully relinquish and abandon all those qualities that designate one as a fool, those qualities with which a fool is identified. And instead, we will continuously develop and cultivate within us those qualities that transform us into wise individuals, chiseling for ourselves those bright characteristic features that make one be recognized as truly skillful and wise!'

It is in this manner, O Bhikkhus, that you must all train yourselves!

*10. **Mala Sutta** (Smudges)*

Bhikkhus, it is through the possession of three traits, and by not giving up their three smudges, that after death, one opens his eyes and finds himself landed in hell, as if escorted there.

And what are these three?

A person lives unethically, without giving up the smudge of unethical living. A person lives enviously and jealousy in his heart, without giving up the smudge of envy or jealousy. A person is stingy, and lives without giving up the smudge of stinginess.

It is therefore through the possession of these three traits, and by not giving up their three smudges, that after death, one opens his eyes and finds himself landed in hell, as if escorted there.

But, Bhikkhus, it is through the possession of these other three traits, and by giving up their three smudges, that after death, one opens his eyes and finds himself landed in heaven, as if escorted there.

What are these three?

The person lives an ethical life behaving virtuously, having given up the smudge of unethical and non-virtuous living. The person lives without envy or jealousy in his heart, having given up the smudge of envy and jealousy. The person lives generously, having given up the smudge of stinginess.

It is through the possession of these three traits and by giving up their three smudges, that after death, one opens his eyes and finds himself landed in heaven, as if escorted there.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must train yourselves, by reflecting:

'We will fully relinquish and abandon all those qualities that designate one as a fool, those qualities with which a fool is identified. And instead, we will continuously develop and cultivate within us those qualities that transform us into wise individuals, chiseling for ourselves those bright characteristic features that make one be recognized as truly skillful and wise!'

It is in this manner, O Bhikkhus, that you must all train yourselves!

AN III

Suttas 11-20

Rathakāra Vagga

"The Section on the Chariot Builder"

*11. **Ñāta Sutta** (Known Through Behavior)*

Bhikkhus, it is through the possession of these three traits in his behavior, that a Bhikkhu is known for who and what he is, given his behavior that is harmful to others, ultimately working for the detriment and misery of the multitude, for the suffering of the many, for the failure and ruin of both Devas and humans.

Which three?

Such a Bhikkhu is one who instigates others to commit physical actions that result in conflict, verbal actions that result in conflict, and mental actions that result in conflict.

It is through the possession of these three traits in his behavior, that a Bhikkhu is known for who and what he is, given his behavior that is harmful to others, ultimately working for the detriment and misery of the multitude, for the suffering of the many, for the failure and ruin of both Devas and humans.

Meanwhile, Bhikkhus, it is through possessing these other three traits in his behavior, that a Bhikkhu is known for who and what he is, given his behavior that is beneficial, one that promotes happiness in people, working for the ultimate comfort of the multitude, for the safety of the many, for the wellbeing and success of both Devas and humans.

Which three?

Such a Bhikkhu is one who inspires others to commit physical actions that result in harmony, verbal actions that result in harmony, and mental actions that result in harmony.

It is through the possession of these three traits in his behavior, that a Bhikkhu is known for who and what he is, given his behavior that is beneficial, one that promotes happiness in people, working for the ultimate comfort of the multitude, for the safety of the many, for the wellbeing and success of both Devas and humans.

*12. **Sāraṇīya Sutta** (Special Locations to Recall)*

Bhikkhus, there are three special locations that a noble head-anointed Khattiya warrior king recalls throughout his entire life. Which three?

His birthplace; the place where he was anointed as a Khattiya warrior king; and the site where, after a triumphant battle, he arose as the victor on the battlefield.

These are the three special locations that a noble head-anointed Khattiya warrior king remembers throughout his life.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, there are these three special locations that a Bhikkhu recalls throughout his entire life. Which three?

First is the place where he shaved off his head and beard, put on the saffron robes, and went forth from the home life into homelessness.

The second is the place where he first grasped the meaning of the Four Noble Truths, i.e. *'This is suffering; this is the origin of suffering; this is its cessation; this is The Path to the cessation of suffering.'*

Lastly, the third is the site where through the destruction of the contaminants, in this very life, he realized for himself, with direct knowledge, the Unshakeable Freedom of heart, Liberation through wisdom, which he abides and dwells in.

These are the three special locations that a Bhikkhu recalls throughout his entire life.

*13. **Āsaṁsa Sutta** (Expectations)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three types of individuals found in existence. What three?

The first is a person without any expectations about the world. Another is a person who is gripped with expectation. And finally, the third is a person who has moved beyond all expectations.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the person without any expectations about the world?

Here, a person is born in a poor family, a family of untouchables, cart builders, flower collectors, basket weavers, bamboo workers, and hunters, without much resources or food, surviving on very little, eking out a living with much difficulty. This person, who being physically unattractive, unappealing, unseemly, suffering from illness, lame, disabled, blind, and incapacitated, is unable to gain food, drink, or lodging, scents, garlands, unguents, and oil lamps.

Being in that state, when such a person hears that a certain Khattiya warrior king has been anointed, he does not fret thinking to himself:

"O, when will I be next to be anointed as king?"

Such is a person who lives without any expectations.

And who, Bhikkhus is the person gripped with expectation?

Here, the crown-prince, the son of a head-anointed Khattiya warrior king, the next in line to become anointed as the next ruler, is assured of his future. In hearing that the Khattiyas have anointed a certain warrior king in a neighboring kingdom, he frets as he thinks to himself:

"O, when will I be next in becoming head-anointed myself, as a Khattiya warrior king?"

Such is a person gripped with expectation.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the person who has moved beyond all expectations?

Here, a head-anointed Khattiya warrior king, while hearing that a certain Khattiya has been anointed as a king somewhere, he does not worry or consider:

"O, when will the Khattiyas anoint me as a warrior king too?"

And why is that?

It is because his past expectation for becoming anointed has disappeared the moment he became a head-anointed Khattiya warrior king.

Such is a person who has moved beyond all expectations.

Bhikkhus, these are therefore the three types of individuals found in existence.

In the same manner, Bhikkhus, there are these three types of Bhikkhus found existing within the Saṅgha. What three?

The Bhikkhu without expectations, the one gripped with expectation, and finally the one who has moved beyond all expectations.

And who, Bhikkhus, is that Bhikkhu without any expectations?

Here, a bhikkhu is impure in his heart, non-virtuous and suspect in behavior, immoral and therefore not a true recluse, though pretending to be one; secretive in his actions, dishonest,

unscrupulous, inwardly perverted, engaging in non-celibate acts, although claiming to be celibate, hence being corrupt.

Now, this bhikkhu, on hearing that through the destruction of his contaminants, a certain Bhikkhu, in this very life, with his own direct knowledge, has attained the Unshakeable Freedom of the heart, having realized Liberation through Wisdom, which he now abides and dwells in, does not reflect to himself:

"O, when will it be my turn to attain the destruction of the contaminants, in this very life, through my own direct knowledge! When will I also attain the Unshakeable Freedom of the heart, by realizing Liberation through Wisdom, which I will then abide and dwell in?"

And why is that?

Because such is a bhikkhu without any expectations.

And who, Bhikkhus, is that Bhikkhu who is gripped with expectation?

Here, a Bhikkhu lives a pure and virtuous life, and is of wholesome conduct.

Then, on hearing that a certain Bhikkhu, through the destruction of his contaminants, in this very life, and through his own direct knowledge, has attained the Unshakeable Freedom of the heart, having realized Liberation through Wisdom, which he abides and dwells in, he reflects to himself:

"O, when will it be my turn to attain the destruction of the contaminants, in this very life, through my own direct knowledge! When will I also attain the Unshakeable Freedom of the heart, by realizing Liberation through Wisdom, which I will then abide and dwell in?"

Such is a Bhikkhu gripped with expectation.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the Bhikkhu who has moved beyond all expectations?

Here, a Bhikkhu is an Arahant, one with contaminants utterly destroyed.

In hearing that a certain Bhikkhu, with the destruction of his contaminants, in this very life, and through his own direct knowledge has attained the Unshakeable Freedom of heart, by realizing Liberation through Wisdom, which he now abides and dwells in, it does not occur to him:

"O, when will it be my turn to attain the destruction of the contaminants, in this very life, through my own direct knowledge! When will I also attain the Unshakeable Freedom of the heart, by realizing Liberation through Wisdom, which I will then abide and dwell in?"
And why is that?

It is because his past expectation of liberation has disappeared the very moment he experienced Liberation.

Such is a Bhikkhu who has moved beyond all expectations.

These, Bhikkhus, are the three types of Bhikkhus found existing within the Saṅgha.

14. ***Cakkavatti Sutta*** *(The Universal Wheel-turning Monarch)*

"Bhikkhus, a Cakkavattin, who righteously rules his kingdom by The Dhamma, still cannot turn the Wheel despite being a Universal Wheel-turning head-anointed Khattiya Monarch himself, *without* first having a King presiding over him."

In hearing this, one of the Bhikkhus inquired:

"But, Blessed Lord, who is it that presides over the rulership of a head-anointed Cakkavattin, a Universal Wheel-turning head-anointed Khattiya Warrior King, who righteously rules by The Dhamma?"

"It is The Dhamma itself, Bhikkhu!" responded The Blessed One, as He continued:

"A Cakkavattin, a Universal Wheel-turning head-anointed Monarch, being a Khattiya king, righteously rules by The Dhamma, while wholeheartedly respecting and venerating The Dhamma. Thus, by honoring and relying on The Dhamma, he makes it his crest, his banner, and guiding authority, as he guards and caters to the needs of his subjects at his royal court, providing them shelter and protection.

"Further, a Cakkavattin, a Universal Wheel-turning head-anointed Monarch, righteously rules while wholeheartedly respecting, venerating, and taking refuge in The Dhamma. Thus, by honoring and relying on The Dhamma, he makes it his crest, his banner, and guiding authority, as he caters to the needs of his Khattiya warrior subjects, his armies, householders, and the people throughout his domain, including recluses, brahmins, and animals of all kinds, providing them shelter and protection.

"Thus, by providing them with righteous protection and shelter, he guards all his subjects as a Cakkavattin, a Universal Wheel-turning head-anointed Monarch, who gains his power through ruling righteously by The Dhamma Itself! This, he does while overseeing and governing his entire dominion through The Dhamma, thereby maintaining the turn of the Wheel that cannot be reversed by any hostile human aggressors.

"Similarly, Bhikkhu, The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Awakened Buddha, The King of The Dhamma righteously rules by The Dhamma, while wholeheartedly respecting and venerating The Dhamma. Thus, by honoring and relying on The Dhamma, He makes it His crest,

His banner, and guiding authority, as He guards and caters to the true needs, shelter, and protection of beings by means of showing them proper conduct in relation to bodily actions and behaviors, as He teaches:

'One must cultivate certain bodily actions and behaviors, while abstaining from other bodily actions and behaviors.'

"Further, Bhikkhu, The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Awakened Buddha, The King of The Dhamma righteously rules by The Dhamma, while wholeheartedly respecting and venerating The Dhamma. Thus, by honoring and relying on The Dhamma, He makes it His crest, His banner, and guiding authority, as He guards and caters to the needs, shelter, and protection of beings by means of showing them proper conduct in relation to verbal actions and behaviors, as He teaches:

'One must cultivate certain verbal actions and behaviors, while abstaining from other verbal actions and behaviors.'

"Further, Bhikkhu, The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Awakened Buddha, The King of The Dhamma righteously rules by The Dhamma, while wholeheartedly respecting and venerating The Dhamma. Thus, by honoring and relying on The Dhamma, He makes it His crest, His banner, and guiding authority, as He guards and caters to the needs, shelter, and protection of beings by means of showing them proper conduct in relation to mental actions and behaviors, as He teaches:

'One must cultivate certain mental actions and behaviors, while abstaining from other mental actions and behaviors.'

"It is through guarding and providing such shelter and protection in relation to bodily, verbal, and mental actions and behaviors that The Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Awakened Buddha, The King of The Dhamma righteously rules by The Dhamma, while setting in motion The Wheel that cannot be reversed or turned back by any recluse, brahmin, Māra, or Brahmā, Devas or humans, or any hostile aggressor, throughout existence."

15. ***Pacetana Sutta*** *(King Pacetana)*

At one time, The Blessed One was staying within the Deer Park at Isipatana, in Varanasi. While there, the Teacher addressed the Bhikkhus by saying:

"Bhikkhus!"

"Yes, Blessed Lord!" The Bhikkhus replied.

And The Blessed One continued instructing:

“Bhikkhus, there used to be a royal monarch by the name of Pacetana who lived many years ago. One day, while addressing his chariot maker, King Pacetana spoke these words:

‘Friend, in six months’ time, a battle will take place, and I need you to make a new set of wheels, ready and prepared especially for my chariot.’

‘Yes, Lord!’ the chariot maker replied.

“However, short of six days before the six months’ deadline, the chariot maker was able to finish the work but while having ready only a single wheel made for the King’s chariot.

“On being made aware of this, King Pacetana addressed the chariot maker and said:

‘In six days’ time, the battle will commence. Will you have the other wheel ready?’

“In response, the chariot maker addressed the king:

‘My Lord, it took me six months minus six days, to finish just a single wheel!’

‘But, chariot maker, can you finish the second wheel in six days?’

“To which the man replied: *“Yes, I can finish the second wheel, my Lord.’*

“Then, the chariot maker worked on the second wheel day and night, and on having finished his work on the second wheel, he brought it along with the first wheel to King Pacetana and stated:

‘My Lord, your commissioned wheels are ready.’

‘Well, what is the difference between the one that took you six months minus six days, and the one that you finished in less than six days? I cannot tell them apart!’ exclaimed the King.

“In answer, the chariot maker stated:

‘But there is indeed a big difference, my Lord!’

“And taking the wheel which took him less than a week to complete, the chariot maker pushed it by rolling forward. When the momentum of the push ran out, the wheel fell over to one side, after wobbling for a bit. Next, the man took the wheel that took him six months minus six days to complete and rolled it forward until finally it came to a stop. But, when the momentum of the push ran out, this time the wheel stood in place, fixed on its axle.

“In seeing this, the King remarked:

‘Chariot maker, why is it that one wheel fell on its side after wobbling first, while the other on coming to a full stop, simply stands unmoved in its place?’

'My Lord, it is because the wheel that took me six days to complete, has a warped rim, it is asymmetrical, defective, and imperfect, with spokes that are not fully straight, being defective and imperfect. It is due to this, my Lord, that when its forward momentum stopped, it fell to its side after wobbling.

However, the wheel that took me six months minus six days to complete, has a rim that is not warped; it is symmetrical and not defective, with spokes that are fully straight and therefore perfect. It is due to this, my Lord, that when its forward momentum stopped, this wheel stood in place, fixed on its axle.'

"Bhikkhus, you may be wondering that this chariot maker was someone else, but you should not think so, for the chariot maker was none other than Myself, in that distant lifetime.

"For, at the time, I was skilled and a master at fixing warped defects and imperfections in wood. Now, I am the Tathāgata, The Arahant, The Perfectly Awakened Buddha, skilled and a master at fixing the imperfections, warped, and defective behaviors of bodily conduct; skilled and a master at fixing the imperfections, warped, and defective behaviors in speech and verbal conduct; skilled and a master at fixing the imperfections, warped, and defective behaviors of mental conduct.

"Similarly, that Bhikkhu or Bhikkhuni who has not relinquished the imperfections, warped, and defective behaviors of body, speech, and mind, is one who has fallen off This Dhamma and Discipline (Vinaya), much like the wheel that was made in six days, falling to the ground after wobbling for a bit.

"Meanwhile, the Bhikkhu or Bhikkhuni who has relinquished the imperfections, warped, and defective behaviors of body, speech, and mind, is firmly established in This Dhamma and Discipline (Vinaya), much like the wheel that was made in six months minus six days, that remained standing in place and unmoved, after coming to a full stop.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, you must strive and train yourselves in this way:

'We shall give up the imperfections, all those warped and defective behaviors of bodily conduct; we shall give up all the imperfections, all those warped and defective behaviors of verbal conduct; we shall give up the imperfections, all those warped and defective behaviors of mental conduct. Such will be our striving. Such will be our training.""

*16. **Apaṇṇaka Sutta** (Unmistakable)*

Bhikkhus, it is through possessing three traits that a Bhikkhu would be practicing the unmistakable Holy Life, having established himself on the Path toward the total destruction and elimination of the contaminants (*āsavas*). Which three?

Here, by protecting and observing his sense faculties, a Bhikkhu lives moderately while consuming his alms food, and is dedicated to striving through heedfulness.

And how is it, Bhikkhus, that a Bhikkhu protects his sense faculties?

Here, when seeing a visible object with the eye, the Bhikkhu does not become identified with its signs and individual features or details. Otherwise, if he were to leave the eye faculty unprotected, wrong and unwholesome states of covetousness or resentment might overtake and control him. Thus, he constantly maintains control over the eye faculty, restraining and keeping it in check.

On hearing a sound with the ear, the Bhikkhu does not become identified with its signs and individual features or details. Otherwise, if he were to leave the ear faculty unprotected, wrong and unwholesome states of covetousness or resentment might overtake and control him. Thus, he constantly maintains control over the ear faculty, restraining and keeping it in check.

On smelling an odor with the nose, the Bhikkhu does not become identified with its signs and individual features or details. Otherwise, if he were to leave the nose faculty unprotected, wrong and unwholesome states of covetousness or resentment might overtake and control him. Thus, he constantly maintains control over the nose faculty, restraining and keeping it in check.

On tasting a flavor with the tongue, the Bhikkhu does not become identified with its signs and individual features or details. Otherwise, if he were to leave the tongue faculty unprotected, wrong and unwholesome states of covetousness or resentment might overtake and control him. Thus, he constantly maintains control over the tongue faculty, restraining and keeping it in check.

On touching a tangible object with the body, the Bhikkhu does not become identified with its signs and individual features or details. Otherwise, if he were to leave the body faculty unprotected, wrong and unwholesome states of covetousness or resentment might overtake and control him. Thus, he constantly maintains control over the body faculty, restraining and keeping it in check.

On knowing and cognizing a thought with the mind, the Bhikkhu does not become identified with its signs and individual features or details. Otherwise, if he were to leave the mind faculty unprotected, wrong and unwholesome states of covetousness or resentment might overtake and control him. Thus, he constantly maintains control over the mind faculty, restraining and keeping it in check.

This, therefore, is how a Bhikkhu protects and observes his sense faculties.

And how is it Bhikkhus, that the Bhikkhu lives moderately while consuming his alms food?

Here, by paying close and wise attention, the Bhikkhu knows while consuming his food that he does so neither for amusement nor for intoxication, nor for the sake of physical attractiveness or

appeal, but to simply sustain his body and nourish it, in order to protect it from sickness, so that he may continue on his noble striving. Thus, he ponders:

"I shall end my attachment to old feelings of habit and not leave the door open for new feelings of habit to invade or overwhelm me."

This is how the Bhikkhu lives moderately while consuming his alms food.

And how is it, Bhikkhus, that the Bhikkhu is dedicated to striving through heedfulness?

Here, on walking forward or backward, whether standing or sitting, or lying down, the Bhikkhu is always engaged in the task of purifying his mind from obstructive thoughts by maintaining his ongoing mindfulness, while staying diligently and fully aware.

Thus, in the first watch of the night, whether he is walking forward or backward, whether he is standing or sitting, the Bhikkhu is always engaged in the task of purifying his mind from obstructive thoughts by maintaining his ongoing mindfulness, while staying diligently and fully aware.

Similarly, in the middle watch of the night, the Bhikkhu lies down on his right side, in the lion's posture, with one foot bent overlapping the other, observing it all with wise attention as he is mindful and clearly comprehending, having already determined the time for rising up.

And after waking, in the final watch of the night, whether he is walking forward or backward, whether he is standing or sitting, the Bhikkhu engages in the task of purifying his mind from obstructive thoughts by maintaining his ongoing mindfulness, while staying diligently and fully aware.

This is how the Bhikkhu is dedicated to striving through heedfulness.

Bhikkhus, it is through possessing these three traits that a Bhikkhu practices the unmistakable Holy Life, having established himself on the Path toward the total destruction and elimination of the contaminants.

17. ***Attabyābādha Sutta*** *(Misfortune to Oneself & Others)*

Bhikkhus, these three traits are responsible for bringing harm and misfortune to oneself, harm and misfortune to others, and harm and misfortune to both oneself and others.

What are these three?

Evil and damaging bodily actions; evil and damaging verbal actions (*communication and speech*); evil and damaging mental actions (*thoughts and contemplations*).

These are the three traits responsible for bringing misfortune to oneself, misfortune to others, and misfortune to both oneself and others.

But Bhikkhus, these other three traits are responsible for bringing benefits and good fortune to oneself, benefits and good fortune to others, and benefits and good fortune to both oneself and others.

What are these three?

Good and constructive bodily actions; good and constructive verbal actions (*communication and speech*); and good and constructive mental actions (*thoughts and contemplations*).

These are the three traits responsible for bringing benefits and good fortune to oneself, benefits and good fortune to others, and benefits and good fortune to both oneself and others.

18. ***Devaloka Sutta*** *(Realms of the Devas)*

"Bhikkhus, if those from other sects were to ask you the following question:

'Friends, are you practicing The Holy Life under the recluse Gautama so that you attain a higher rebirth in some heavenly Deva realms?'

"Would you then not find such a posited question distasteful, repulsive, and revolting?"

"Yes, Blessed Lord!" The Bhikkhus responded.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, seeing that rebirth even in the higher or Deva realms, where you would enjoy a long lifespan, celestial glory, beauty, happiness, and power, is still quite distasteful, repulsive, and revolting to you, then, the very possibility of engaging in bodily wrongdoing, in verbal wrongdoing, and in mental wrongdoing should be equally distasteful, repulsive, and revolting to you."

19. ***Paṭhama Pāpaṇika Sutta*** *(The Business Owner – Part 1)*

Bhikkhus, it is through the possession of these three traits that a business owner is unable to acquire wealth that has thus far been un-acquired, nor is he able to increase what he has already acquired.

What are these three?

Here, a business owner is not motivated to diligently work hard from early on in the day, at noon, or in the evening. Possessing these three traits, a business owner is unable to acquire wealth that has thus far been un-acquired, nor is he able to increase what he has already acquired.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, it is through the possession of these three traits that the Bhikkhu is unable to realize wholesome states that have thus far been un-realized, nor is he able to develop to completion what he has already acquired.

And what are these three?

Here, the Bhikkhu is not motivated to diligently stay with his object of meditation from early on in the day, at noon, or in the evening. Possessing these three traits, the Bhikkhu is unable to realize wholesome states that have thus far been un-realized, nor is he able to develop to completion what he has already acquired.

However, Bhikkhus, it is through the possession of these other three traits that a business owner is able to acquire wealth that has thus far been un-acquired, and thereby also able to increase what he has already acquired.

What are these three?

Here, a business owner is motivated to diligently work hard from early on in the day, at noon, and in the evening. Possessing these three traits, a business owner is able to acquire wealth that has thus far been un-acquired, and thereby is also able to increase what he has already acquired.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, it is through the possession of these other three traits that a Bhikkhu is able to realize wholesome states that have thus far been un-realized, and thereby also able to increase those wholesome states he has already realized.

Now what are these three?

Here, the Bhikkhu is motivated to diligently stay with his object of meditation from early on in the day, at noon, and in the evening. Possessing these three traits, the Bhikkhu is able to realize wholesome states that have thus far been un-realized, and thereby also able to increase those wholesome states he has already realized.

20. ***Dutiya Pāpaṇika Sutta*** *(The Business Owner – Part 2)*

Bhikkhus, it is through the possession of these three traits that a business owner is able to quickly gain abundant wealth.

Now what are these three?

Here, a business owner has sharp eyes, is in charge, and has supportive individuals around him.

And how, Bhikkhus, would a business owner have sharp eyes?

Here, such a business owner knows full-well that if a certain product is purchased at a certain price and then sold at such a price, then this much capital is first needed to purchase it, in order to generate a certain amount of profit.

This is what is meant by a business owner having sharp eyes.

And how, Bhikkhus, would a business owner be in charge?

Here, such a business owner is in charge of purchasing and selling the products of his business and with skill.

This is what is meant by having a business owner who is in charge.

And how, Bhikkhus, would a business owner have supportive individuals around him?

Here, affluent, wealthy, and financially well-off householders and their sons come to know this business owner as someone they could trust, evidenced by his sharp eyes and the fact that he is in charge of his business, in addition to witnessing that he is able to support his wife and family, therefore being a reliable person, who is able to pay them back. So, they invest in his business, while telling him:

'O friend business owner, once you have earned and acquired your wealth with this money we are lending you, first support your wife and family, and then pay us back on our investments afterwards.'

This is what is meant by having supportive individuals around him.

It is through the possession of these three traits that a business owner is able to quickly gain abundant wealth.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, it is through the possession of three traits that the Bhikkhu is able to quickly gain abundant wealth of wholesome and skillful traits that are truly beneficial. Which three?

Here, the Bhikkhu has sharp eyes, is in charge, and has supportive individuals around him.

And how, Bhikkhus, would the Bhikkhu have sharp eyes?

Here, the Bhikkhu knows full-well and understands, as it truly is:

'This is suffering; this is the origin of suffering; this is its cessation; this is The Path that leads to the cessation of suffering.'

This is what is meant by the Bhikkhu having sharp eyes.

And how, Bhikkhus, could the Bhikkhu be in charge?

Here, the Bhikkhu stirs up energy and motivation in himself, in order to relinquish unwholesome traits and develop in himself the wholesome ones. This way, he exercises his firm resolve by taking charge and not slacking off as he develops more and more wholesome traits in himself.

This is what is meant by having the Bhikkhu be in charge.

And how, Bhikkhus, would the Bhikkhu have supportive individuals around him?

Here, the Bhikkhu frequents those more learned Bhikkhus in the Saṅgha, who are experts in The Dhamma and The Vinaya, as he works diligently to strengthen his understanding of The Dhamma, by inquiring sincerely with the eagerness to learn, while asking them:

"How is this, Venerable Sir?"

"Bhante, could you please explain to me what is meant by this?"

And those Venerable Ones then explain by providing him with helpful answers, clarifying for him what had thus far been obscure, while dissolving his doubts and perplexities about various issues he had, and therefore helping him to gain a better understanding of The Dhamma.

This is what is meant by having supportive individuals around him.

It is through the possession of these three traits that the Bhikkhu is able to quickly gain the abundant wealth of wholesome and skillful traits that are truly beneficial.



AN III

Suttas 21-31

Puggala Vagga

"The Section on People"

21. ***Samiddha Sutta*** *(The Venerable Saviṭṭha)*

This is what I personally heard.

At one time, The Blessed One was staying at Anāthapiṇḍika's Monastery in Jeta's Grove, near the city of Sāvatthī, when both the Venerable Saviṭṭha and the Venerable Mahākoṭṭhita, in approaching the Venerable Sāriputta, exchanged courteous greetings and sat down to one side. Then, the Venerable Sāriputta spoke these words, while addressing the Venerable Saviṭṭha:

"Friend Saviṭṭha, there are these three types of beings found in existence. What three?

"Here, there is the body-witness; the one attained to view; and the one liberated through faith.

These are the three types of beings found in existence.

"Now, out of these three, which one do you consider to be the one that stands out as the most excellent?"

"Friend Sāriputta, out of those three types of beings, I consider the one liberated through faith to be the most excellent. And for what reason?

"It is because this person's faculty of faith is supreme."

At this point, the Venerable Sāriputta turned to the Venerable Mahākoṭṭhita, and said:

"Friend Koṭṭhita, there are these three types of beings found in existence. What three?

"Here, there is the body-witness; the one attained to view; and the one liberated through faith.

These are the three types of beings found in existence.

"Now, out of these three, which one do *you* consider to be the one that stands out as the most excellent?"

“Friend Sāriputta, out of those three types of beings, I consider the body-witness to be the most excellent. And for what reason?

“It is because this person’s faculty of collected stability of mind (*samādhi*) is supreme.”

Then, turning to the Venerable Sāriputta, the Venerable Mahākoṭṭhita said:

“Friend Sāriputta, there are these three types of beings found in existence. What three?

“Here, there is the body-witness; the one attained to view; and the one liberated through faith.

These are the three types of beings found in existence.

“Now Friend, out of these three, which one would *you* consider to be the one that stands out as the most excellent?”

“Friend Koṭṭhita, out of those three types of beings, I consider the one attained to View to be the most excellent. And for what reason?

“It is because this person’s faculty of wisdom is supreme.”

At this, turning to the Venerable Saviṭṭha and the Venerable Mahākoṭṭhita, the Venerable Sāriputta said to them:

“Friends, we each have given our ideal choice and also explained the reason behind it. Let us go and approach The Blessed Lord and report this matter to Him. This way, as He explains it to us, so should we remember and apply it in our practice.”

“Yes, friend,” replied the Venerable Saviṭṭha and the Venerable Mahākoṭṭhita, and together with Venerable Sāriputta, all three of them went and approached The Blessed One and after paying homage to Him, they sat to one side.

Then, the Venerable Sāriputta related to The Blessed One the entire conversation held earlier between himself and his two fellow Bhikkhus.

After this, The Blessed One said:

“Sāriputta, it is not easy to make a clear distinction in regards to this matter, whereby one may make the conclusion that out of these three, only *this* type of person is the most excellent.

“And why is this the case?

"It is because a person who is liberated through faith can be practicing in a way that will surely lead him to Arahanthood, while another person who is a body-witness, and someone else who has attained to View are merely once-returners or non-returners, without advancing any further.

"Therefore, Sāriputta, it is not easy to make a clear distinction in regards to this matter, whereby one may make the conclusion that out of these three, only *this* type of person is the most excellent.

"Because, similarly, some person who is a body-witness can be practicing in a way that will surely lead him to Arahanthood, while another person who is liberated through faith and someone else who has attained to View are merely once-returners or non-returners, without advancing any further.

"Therefore, Sāriputta, it is not easy to make a clear distinction in regards to this matter, whereby one may make the conclusion that out of these three, only *this* type of person is the most excellent.

"Because, similarly, yet another person who has attained to View can be practicing in a way that will surely lead him to Arahanthood, while some other person who is liberated through faith and another who is a body-witness are merely once-returners or non-returners, without advancing any further.

"Therefore, Sāriputta, it is not easy to make a clear distinction in regards to this matter, whereby one may make the conclusion that out of these three, only *this* type of person is the most excellent."

22. ***Gilāna Sutta*** *(Suffering from Illness)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three types of people suffering from illness found in existence. What three?

Here, someone suffering will not be able to recover from his illness, whether he does or does not get suitable nourishment, suitable medicine, and a caring and competent caretaker to look after him.

Another ailing person is one who recovers from his illness, whether he does or does not get suitable nourishment, suitable medicine, and a caring and competent caretaker to look after him.

Finally, there is the suffering person who will recover from his illness *only* if he gets suitable nourishment, suitable medicine, and a caring and competent caretaker, but not if he is deprived of them.

Suitable nourishment, suitable medicine, and a caring and competent caretaker are intended to be used and administered especially for the one who will recover from his illness if and when he is

provided with the suitable nourishment, suitable medicine, and a caring and competent caretaker, but he will deteriorate if he is deprived of them.

However, given the benefit these factors have on this type of a person, the other suffering individuals must not be deprived of these resources of suitable nourishment, suitable medicine, and a caring and competent caretaker, for they too must be provided with these benefits.

These, therefore, are the three types of people suffering from illness found in existence.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, there are these three types of beings, much like those people suffering from illness that are found in existence. What three?

Here, someone will not be dedicated to a wholesome way of life, whether he does or does not come in contact with The Tathāgata, or whether he does or does not hear The Dhamma and The Discipline, taught and proclaimed by The Tathāgata.

Meanwhile, someone else will be dedicated to a wholesome way of life, whether he does or does not come in contact with The Tathāgata, or whether he does or does not hear The Dhamma and The Discipline, taught and proclaimed by the Tathāgata.

Finally, yet another person will be dedicated to a wholesome way of life, but *only* because he comes in contact with The Tathāgata and *only* because he is able to hear The Dhamma and The Discipline, taught and proclaimed by The Tathāgata.

Thus, providing the teachings of The Dhamma are intended especially for the person who will be dedicated to a wholesome way of life, but only if he comes in contact with The Tathāgata, and only if he is able to hear The Dhamma and The Discipline, taught and proclaimed by The Tathāgata, and not without the presence or teaching of The Tathāgata.

However, given the benefit that these factors have on this type of being, the other people too must be taught The Dhamma and The Discipline, taught and proclaimed by The Tathāgata, and not be deprived of them.

Bhikkhus, these are the three types of beings that are similar to those suffering from an illness, found in existence.

23. ***Saṅkhāra Sutta*** *(Habitual Drives)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three types of beings found in existence. What three?

Here, Bhikkhus, a person engages in bodily acts impelled by habitual drives that produce suffering; he engages in ways of communicating and speech that produce suffering; and he engages in thinking thoughts and mental actions that produce suffering.

As a result, this person is reborn in a world full of suffering. Once reborn into such a world of affliction and suffering, he is constantly surrounded and rubbed by affliction and suffering. Being thus rubbed by pain and suffering from all sides, he experiences torture and affliction, feeling agonizing pain, as do all those who are reborn in hell.

Here, another person engages in bodily acts impelled by habitual drives that do not produce suffering; he engages in ways of communicating and speech while impelled by habitual drives that do not produce suffering; and he engages in thinking thoughts and mental actions while impelled by habitual drives that do not produce suffering.

As a result, this person is reborn in a world devoid of suffering. Once reborn into such a world devoid of suffering, he is constantly surrounded and touched by pleasure. Being thus touched by pleasure from all sides, he experiences joy and relief, feeling the bliss of comfort and ease, as do all those who are reborn in heaven.

Still another person engages in bodily acts impelled by habitual drives that produce both suffering and those that do not produce suffering; he engages in ways of communicating and speech impelled by habitual drives that produce both suffering and those that do not produce suffering; and he engages in thinking thoughts and mental actions impelled by habitual drives that produce both suffering and those that do not produce suffering.

As a result, this person is reborn into such a world that includes suffering and at times its absence. Once reborn into such a world that includes suffering and at times pleasure and happiness, he is surrounded and touched by both pleasure and pain. Being thus rubbed by both suffering and pleasure, he sometimes experiences agonizing pain and at times feels the relief and bliss of comfort, just like some human beings or Devas do, as well as others who are born in some of the lower realms.

These, Bhikkhus, are the three types of beings found in existence.

24. ***Bahukāra Sutta*** *(Very Helpful)*

Bhikkhus, these three types of beings are found to be helpful to others. What three?
The person who becomes the conduit for someone to take Refuge in The Buddha, The Dhamma, and The Saṅgha.

Such a person is surely one who is helpful to another.

Furthermore, it is the person who becomes the conduit for someone to understand and directly know and see, as it actually is:

"This is suffering; this is the origin of suffering; this is the cessation and ending of suffering; this is the Path that leads to the ending of suffering."

Now, such a person is truly helpful to another.

Yet another person becomes the conduit for someone to realize for himself, with his own direct knowledge and through the destruction of the contaminants, the spotless and Unshakeable Freedom of the Heart, realizing for himself Liberation through Wisdom, whereby he enters upon and dwells in it.

This, indeed, is truly a helpful person to another.

These three types of beings are found to be helpful to another.

Bhikkhus, I declare to you that there is no one *more* helpful to another than these three types of beings.

Also, it is not easy to repay these three beings by paying homage to them, by rising up from your seat for them and standing in reverential salutation to them, by relating to them with one's proper conduct, by offering them robes, alms food, lodging, and medicine, and all conceivable medical attention, whenever necessary.

25. ***Vajirūpama Sutta*** *(Like Diamond)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three types of beings found in existence. What three?

Someone who has a mind that is similar to an open wound; another whose mind is like that of lightning; and yet another whose mind is like that of a diamond.

And who, Bhikkhus, is that person who has a mind that is similar to an open wound?

Here, being irritable, a person is prone to easily getting enraged. Even if he were to receive a minor criticism, he quickly becomes infuriated, resentful, angry, and bitter. In addition, much like an open wound, he stays inflamed and easily provoked at the slightest contact, whereby more pus and nasty stuff would ooze out from such a wound when touched, just like for such a person who, with his underlying hatred and rage, forces others around him to 'walk on egg-shells,' simply to avoid accidentally provoking another outburst from him.

This is a person who has a mind that is similar to an open wound.

And who, Bhikkhus, is that person whose mind is like that of lightning?

Here, a person understands as it actually is:

"This is suffering; this is the origin of suffering; this is the cessation and ending of suffering; this is the Path that leads to the ending of suffering."

Much like in the darkest part of the night when a lightning strikes, a man with good eyesight would be able to see its bright flash and everything it lights up, clearly and in all their detail, so too does this person who understands, as it actually is:

"This is suffering; this is the origin of suffering; this is the cessation and ending of suffering; this is the Path that leads to the ending of suffering."

This is the person whose mind is like that of lightning.

And who, Bhikkhus, is that person whose mind is like diamond?

Here, through the destruction of the contaminants (*āsavas*), a person realizes in this life, for himself and with direct knowledge, the unshakeable serenity Heart, its Liberation through Wisdom, which he abides and dwells in from that point onward.

Similar to the diamond that can cut anything, whether a gem, a rock, or a metal, while itself staying intact, so too, on cutting and penetrating through delusion and thus destroying the contaminants, such a person realizes in this life, for himself and with direct knowledge, the unshakeable serenity of the Heart, its Liberation through Wisdom, which he abides and dwells in from that point onward.

This, therefore, is the person whose mind is like that of a diamond.

These, Bhikkhus, are the three types of beings found in existence.

26. ***Sevitabba Sutta*** *(One to Associate With)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three types of beings found in existence. What three?

The one who is not to be engaged or associated with, nor attended to; the one who is to be engaged or associated with, and attended to; and finally, the one to be engaged or associated with and attended to with much honor and reverence.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the person who is not to be engaged or associated with, nor attended to?

Here, someone is found to be inferior to oneself in conduct, having an immoral character, lacking in virtue (*sīla*), mental cultivation (*samādhi*), and wisdom (*paññā*).

This person is one not to be engaged or associated with, but only attended to as a result of one's loving-kindness, Universal Compassion, and common courtesy.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the person who is to be engaged or associated with, as well as attended to?

Here, someone is found to be of similar or equal conduct to oneself and with a moral character, supported by a genuinely virtuous behavior (*sīla*), mental cultivation (*samādhi*), and wisdom (*paññā*).

This person, therefore, is one to be engaged or associated with, as well as attended to. And why is that?

It is because one considers the following in relation to such a person:

"This person is of a similar conduct to mine and with a moral character, supported by a genuinely virtuous behavior, and as a result, this interaction will have a beneficial effect on both of us by making us feel congruently happy, as we discuss virtue. Also, our mutual dedication to mental cultivation will have a beneficial effect on both of us by making us feel congruently happy, as we discuss mental cultivation (samādhi). Also, our mutual appreciation and application of wisdom will have a beneficial effect on both of us, while making us feel congruently happy, as we discuss wisdom!"

To this end, such a person is to be engaged or associated with, as well as attended to.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the person to be engaged or associated with, as well as attended to, with much honor and reverence?

Here, someone is found to be of superior conduct to oneself and with a solid moral character, supported by a genuinely virtuous behavior (*sīla*), mental cultivation (*samādhi*), and wisdom (*paññā*).

This person, therefore, is one to be engaged or associated with, as well as attended to with much honor and reverence. And why is that?

It is because one considers the following in relation to such a person:

"Through my interaction with this person, whatever aggregate associated with virtue in me that is unfulfilled, will become fulfilled, whereby through wisely interacting with this person, the aggregate of virtuous conduct will come to complete fruition in me.
Further, through my interaction with this person, whatever aggregate associated with mental cultivation in me that is unfulfilled, will become fulfilled, whereby through wisely interacting with this person, the aggregate of mental cultivation will come to complete fruition in me.
Further, through my interaction with this person, whatever aggregate associated with wisdom in me that is unfulfilled, will become fulfilled, hence through wisely interacting with this person, the aggregate of wisdom will come to complete fruition in me!"

To this end, such a person is to be engaged or associated with, as well as attended to with much honor and reverence.

Bhikkhus, these are the three types of beings found in existence.

'By associating with the inferior person, you regress;
By associating with an equal person, you don't regress;
But it is by attending to a superior person, that you advance quickly.
So, follow the one superior to you,
And never look back!'

27. ***Jigcchitabba Sutta*** *(Offensive)*

Bhikkhus, there are three types of beings found in existence. What three?

The one who is disgusting to look at, not worthy to be associated with, nor attended to or followed; the one who is looked upon with equanimity, yet not worthy to be associated with or attended to, nor followed; and finally, the one who is associated with, attended to, and followed.

a. And who, Bhikkhus, is that person who is disgusting to look at, not worthy to be associated with, nor attended to or followed?

Here, someone is impure, non-virtuous, immoral, with suspect behavior, who is not a true recluse at all, but simply is pretending to be one; secretive in his actions, dishonest, unscrupulous, depraved and inwardly perverted, engaging in non-celibate acts, although claiming to be celibate.

It is such a person who is disgusting to look at, not worthy to be associated with, nor attended to or followed. And why do we say this?

It is because even if one were to not follow the example of such a person, there would still be a bad report spreading about oneself, as a result of associating with such a character, that states:

"So and so has such bad companions and associates, which means that he too must be like them. Otherwise, why would he be around or associating with such people?"

It is just like a snake that slithers its way through a pile of wet feces. Now, even if the snake were to not attack or bite anyone, it would still carry on the smell and the residue of the feces its body came in contact with, which it passes onto whatever and whomever it touches.

Similarly, even if one were to not follow the example of such a person, there would still be a bad report spreading about oneself, as a result of associating with such characters, that states:

"So and so has such bad companions and associates, which means that he too must be like them. Otherwise, why would he be around or associating with such people?"

It is for this reason that such a person is disgusting to look at, not worthy to be associated with, nor attended to or followed.

b. And who, Bhikkhus, is that person who is looked upon with equanimity, yet not worthy to be associated with, nor attended to or followed?

Here, someone is irritable and easily prone to getting enraged. Even if he were to receive a minor criticism, he quickly becomes infuriated, resentful, angry, and bitter. In addition, much like an open wound, he stays inflamed and easily provoked at the slightest contact, whereby more pus and nasty stuff would ooze out from such a wound when touched, just like for such a person who, with his underlying hatred and rage, forces others around him to 'walk on egg-shells,' simply to avoid accidentally provoking another outburst from him.

Just like the incendiary timber of the *Tinduka* tree, which begins to crackle even if barely touched, so too is such a person, irritable and prone to easily getting enraged. Even if he were to receive a minor criticism, he quickly becomes infuriated, resentful, angry, and bitter. In addition, much like an open wound, he stays inflamed and easily provoked at the slightest contact, whereby more pus and nasty stuff would ooze out from such a wound when touched.

Just like a pile of wet feces that if struck or accidentally stepped into, releases its foul smell, so too is such an irritable person, who is prone to easily getting enraged, much like an open wound. Even if he were to receive a minor criticism, he quickly becomes infuriated, resentful, angry, and bitter. In addition, much like an open wound, he stays inflamed and easily provoked at the slightest contact, whereby more pus and nasty stuff would ooze out from such a wound when touched.

Therefore, such a person happens to be the one who is to be looked upon with equanimity, yet not worthy to be associated with, nor attended to or followed. And why do we say this?

It is because, sooner or later, one will consider:

"If I were to associate with, attend to or even follow such a bitter person, then at the slightest opportunity, he might insult and abuse me, or even do harm to me."

It is for this reason that such a person is to be looked upon with equanimity, yet not worthy to be associated with, nor attended or followed, at all.

c. And who, Bhikkhus, is that person who is to be associated with, attended to, and followed?

Here, someone is found to be of a virtuous behavior and pure conduct.

It is such a person who is to be associated with, attended to, and followed. And why do we say this?

It is because even if one were to not follow the example of such a person, there would still be a good report spreading about oneself, due to associating with him, that states:

"So and so has such good companions and associates, who must also be like him. Otherwise, why would they be around him?"

It is for this reason that such a person is to be associated with, attended to, and followed.

These, therefore, Bhikkhus are the three types of beings found in existence.

'By associating with the inferior person, you regress;
By associating with an equal person, you don't regress;
But it is by attending to a superior person, that you advance quickly;
So, follow the one superior to you,
And never look back!'

28. ***Gūthabhāṇī Sutta*** *(Speech that Resembles Freshly Dropped Excrement)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three types of beings found in existence. What three?

The one whose speech is like that of freshly dropped excrement; the other whose speech resembles flowers; and lastly, the one whose speech is like that of pure honey.

a. And who, Bhikkhus, is that person whose speech is like that of freshly dropped excrement?

Here, when someone is asked to show up at an assembly, to his relatives' gathering, or to a gathering of his colleagues, or to stand in council, or to appear at the royal court and report on a matter as a witness thus: *"Tell us, sir, what you have witnessed,"* at which he states that he has witnessed what, in fact, he has not witnessed; or he denies having witnessed at all that which he has, in fact, witnessed. Thus, while not having seen, he exclaims by lying: *"I have seen,"* and when having actually seen, he instead claims: *"I have not seen."*

Such a person lies knowingly and speaks falsehood to secure his own ends, or those of others, or some worldly goal that he has in mind.

Such is a person whose speech is like that of freshly dropped excrement.

b. And who, Bhikkhus, is that person whose speech resembles flowers?

Here, when someone is asked to show up at an assembly, to his relatives' gathering, or to a gathering of his colleagues, or to stand in council, or to appear at the royal court and report on a matter as a witness thus: *"Tell us, sir, what you have witnessed,"* at which he states that he has witnessed what indeed, he has witnessed. Or when having not witnessed, he denies having witnessed it. Thus, when not having seen, he says *"I have not seen,"* and when having seen, he says *"Yes, I have seen."*

Such a person does not lie knowingly but speaks the truth, which he does not to secure his own ends, nor those of others, or for some worldly goal that he has in mind.

Therefore, such is the person whose speech is like that of flowers.

c. And who, Bhikkhus, is that person whose speech is like that of pure honey?

Here, someone has relinquished the use of abusive, hurtful, or mean speech, and consciously refrains from the use of abusive, hurtful or mean speech.

His speech is therefore kindly, encouraging, and lovely to the ear, and goes straight to the heart, remaining respectful and considerate, thereby welcomed and enjoyable by the many who get to hear it.

Such is the person whose speech is like that of pure honey.

These are, Bhikkhus, the three types of beings found in existence.

29. ***Andha Sutta*** *(The Blind)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three types of beings found in existence. What three?

The blind; the one with a single eye; and the one with two eyes.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the blind individual?

Here, someone does not possess the eye through which one may obtain riches that have otherwise been un-obtained, and cannot increase his wealth that has already been accumulated.

In addition, such an individual does not possess the eye with which to see and distinguish the unwholesome qualities from those that are wholesome; the blameworthy qualities from those that are blameless; the inferior qualities from those that are superior; as well as to tell apart the differences that exist between dark and bright traits in regards to one's actions and choices. Such is the blind.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the one with a single eye?

Here, someone possesses the eye through which one may obtain riches that have otherwise been un-obtained, and to increase his already accumulated wealth.

Such an individual, however, does not possess the eye with which to see and distinguish the unwholesome qualities from those that are wholesome; the blameworthy qualities from those that are blameless; the inferior qualities from those that are superior; as well as to tell apart the differences that exist between dark and bright traits in regards to one's actions and choices.

Such is the one with a single eye.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the one with two eyes?

Here, someone possesses the eye through which one may obtain riches that have otherwise been un-obtained, and to increase his wealth that has already been accumulated.

Such an individual also possesses the eye with which to see and distinguish the unwholesome qualities from those that are wholesome; the blameworthy qualities from those that are blameless; the inferior qualities from those that are superior; as well as to tell apart the differences that exist between dark and bright traits in regards to one's actions and choices.

Such is the one with two eyes.

Bhikkhus, these are the three types of beings found in existence.

'Not possessing material wealth,
And similarly, running empty in his store of good merits,
He finds himself unlucky in both throws of the dice.
That man is truly born blind, is ruined, having depriving himself of the opportunity to see.

Cheating and stealing, the one who keeps lying,
Although may be adding more wealth, while indulging in sense pleasures,
Yet, unbeknownst to him, he is rushing on his way from here to hell.
This is the one with a single working eye.

Better than both of those two, is the one with eyes that number in two,
With riches acquired through his own efforts,
And with the righteously earned wealth, he opens up his stores of riches,
Sharing all that he has, not only with open hands,
But especially, with his heart that opens even wider.

Thus, when it is time, he leaves behind this human birth,
To be reborn in heavenly realms,
Where he will remain a stranger to sorrow.

So, stay away from the first two, avoiding them altogether:
Both the blind and the single-eyed,
For truly, it is best to associate with the third,
As you go on calling the two-eyed your true friend.'

30. ***Avakujja Sutta*** *(The Inverted Water Pot)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three types of beings found in existence. What three? The one with blocked wisdom; the one with scattered wisdom; and the one with vast wisdom.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the one with blocked wisdom?

Here, someone often goes to the monastery to listen to The Dhamma taught by the Bhikkhus. The Bhikkhus generously teach him The Dhamma that is beautiful in the beginning, beautiful in the middle, and beautiful in the end, along with its correct meaning and phrasing.
But despite having thus revealed to him The Holy Life that is perfect and complete, while sitting there, this person does not pay attention to The Dhamma being taught, whether in its beginning, its middle, or end.
Also, after having left his seat and moving about, he still does not pay attention to what was shared with him, for he does not contemplate the beginning, the middle, or the end of The Dhamma taught to him earlier.

It is just as if a water pot had been inverted and thus turned upside down, as a result of which the water poured down on it would simply flow over and run off, leaving the water pot's cavity entirely empty, dry, and untouched.

In the same way, someone often goes to the monastery to listen to The Dhamma taught by the Bhikkhus. The Bhikkhus generously teach him The Dhamma that is beautiful in the beginning, beautiful in the middle, and beautiful in the end, along with its correct meaning and phrasing.
But despite having thus revealed to him The Holy Life that is perfect and complete, while sitting there, this person does not pay attention to The Dhamma being taught, whether in its beginning, its middle, or end.
Also, after having left his seat and moving about, he still does not pay attention to what was shared with him, for he does not contemplate the beginning, the middle, or the end of The Dhamma taught to him earlier.

Such is the one with blocked wisdom.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the one with scattered wisdom?

Here, someone often goes to the monastery to listen to The Dhamma taught by the Bhikkhus. The Bhikkhus generously teach him The Dhamma that is beautiful in the beginning, beautiful in the middle, and beautiful in the end, along with its correct meaning and phrasing.
Then, on having thus revealed to him The Holy Life that is perfect and complete, while sitting there, this person attends carefully as he pays attention to The Dhamma being taught, whether in its beginning, its middle, or its end.
However, after having left his seat and moving about, he does not pay attention to what was shared with him, for he does not contemplate the beginning, the middle, or the end of The Dhamma taught to him earlier.

It is just as if a person with a variety of grains tossed into his lap, such as rice grains, sesame seeds, and jujubes, were to move suddenly and without care, scattering them all about him as a result, and thus wasting away those precious grains he had received.

In the same way, someone often goes to the monastery to listen to The Dhamma taught by the Bhikkhus. The Bhikkhus generously teach him The Dhamma that is beautiful in the beginning, beautiful in the middle, and beautiful in the end, along with its correct meaning and phrasing.
Then, on having thus revealed to him The Holy Life that is perfect and complete, while sitting there, this person attends carefully as he pays attention to The Dhamma being taught, whether in its beginning, its middle, or end.
However, after having left his seat and moving about, he does not pay attention to what was shared with him, for he does not contemplate the beginning, the middle, or the end of The Dhamma taught to him earlier.

Such is the one with scattered wisdom.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the one with vast wisdom?

Here, someone often goes to the monastery to listen to The Dhamma taught by the Bhikkhus. The Bhikkhus generously teach him The Dhamma that is beautiful in the beginning, beautiful in the middle, and beautiful in the end, along with its correct meaning and phrasing.
Then, on having thus revealed to him The Holy Life that is perfect and complete, while sitting there, this person attends carefully as he pays attention to The Dhamma being taught, whether in its beginning, its middle, or end.
Later, after having left his seat and moving about, he again pays attention to what was shared with him, as he keeps contemplating the beginning, the middle, or the end of The Dhamma taught to him earlier.

It is just as if a water pot had been placed upright, and water is poured down into it, filling it up, and drenching the water pot without letting any of it run off or go to waste.

In the same way, someone often goes to the monastery to listen to The Dhamma taught by the Bhikkhus. The Bhikkhus generously teach him The Dhamma that is beautiful in the beginning, beautiful in the middle, and beautiful in the end, along with its correct meaning and phrasing.

Then, on having thus revealed to him The Holy Life that is perfect and complete, while sitting there, this person attends carefully as he pays attention to The Dhamma being taught, whether in its beginning, its middle, or end.
Later, after having left his seat and moving about, he again pays attention to what was shared with him, as he keeps contemplating the beginning, the middle, or the end of The Dhamma taught to him earlier.

Such is the one with vast wisdom.

Bhikkhus, these are the three types of beings found in existence.

'The one with blocked wisdom, stupid and undiscerning,
Is often found visiting the Bhikkhus and hearing them teach The Dhamma to him.
But, from such a talk, this person misses out in grasping the meaning
Whether from its beginning, its middle, or even its end.

'Being better than the former, the one with scattered wisdom
Also goes visiting the Bhikkhus and hearing them teach The Dhamma.
While sitting during such a talk, he grasps the meaning from its beginning, middle, or end.
But, after leaving his seat, the wisdom grasped
Leaves him as well, as he forgets what was learned.

'Being the best of the three, the one with vast wisdom
Also goes visiting the Bhikkhus to hear them teach The Dhamma.
While sitting during such a talk, he grasps the meaning from its beginning, middle, and end.
And on leaving his seat, his mind remains undivided,
Retaining what was heard, as he practices what he learned,
In accordance with The Dhamma, putting an end to all suffering.'



AN III

Suttas 31-40

Devadūta Vagga

"The Section on the Divine Messengers"

31. ***Brahmā Sutta*** *(With Brahmā)*

Bhikkhus, wherever you see a home where the mother and father are respected and venerated by their children, there you find a family residing in the company of Brahmā.

Wherever you see a home where the mother and father are respected and venerated by their children, there you find a family residing in the company of their primary teachers.

Wherever you see a home where the mother and father are respected and venerated by their children, there you find a family residing in the company of those who are worthy of gifts and offerings.

After all, the term "Brahmā" is a title for one's own mother and father.

"Primary teachers" is a title for one's mother and father, and finally, "worthy of gifts and offerings," is a title for one's mother and father as well. But for what reason?

It is because both mother and father are crucial in raising their children, nurturing them, protecting them, showing and teaching them about the world.

'Mother and father are given the name Brahmā,
As well as of Primary Teachers.
They are worthy of gifts and offerings by their children,
As their compassion towards their offspring knows no measure.
Thus, a wise person needs to venerate and show reverence,
With due honor, to one's parents, by offering them food and drink,
Clothes and proper lodging, along with caring for them
By massaging their bodies, cleaning them and washing their feet.
Because of this, the wise always praise the loving service
Done to one's mother and father, as a result of which
One rejoices after death, having been reborn into the heavenly realms.'

*32. **Ānanda Sutta** (The Venerable Ānanda)*

At one time, while approaching The Blessed One, the Venerable Ānanda paid homage to Him and once having sat down to one side, he asked the following question:

"Blessed Lord, is it possible for a Bhikkhu to attain such a state of collectedness of mind (*samādhi*), whereby he would no longer have any tendency for 'I-making,' or 'mine-making,' as well as the underlying tendency for conceit, as it relates to the body being experienced?

"Similarly, is it possible for him to no longer have any tendency for 'I-making,' or 'mine-making,' as well as the underlying tendency for conceit, as it relates to external objects being cognized and known?

"And similarly, is it possible for him to enter upon and dwell in the state of Freedom of the Heart, realizing personally and with direct understanding, The Liberation through Wisdom, whereby he would no longer have any tendency left in him for 'I-making,' or 'mine-making,' as well as the underlying tendency for conceit?"

"It is possible, Ānanda."

"How is this so, Bhante, that he could attain such a state of collectedness of mind (*samādhi*)?"

"Here, Ānanda, a Bhikkhu considers thus:

'This is peaceful, this is excellent, namely, the stilling of all habitual drives (saṅkhārā); the relinquishment of all assets (upadhi); the destruction of craving; detachment or dispassion (virāga), cessation (nirodha), Nibbāna!'

"It is in this way, Ānanda, that a Bhikkhu could attain such a state of collectedness of mind, whereby he would no longer have any tendency for 'I-making,' or 'mine-making,' as well as the underlying tendency for conceit as it relates to this body being experienced; and he would no longer have any tendency for 'I-making,' or 'mine-making,' as well as the underlying tendency for conceit as it relates to external objects being cognized and known; and he would enter upon and dwell in the state of The Freedom of Heart, by realizing personally and with direct understanding, The Liberation through Wisdom, whereby there would no longer be any tendency left in him for 'I-making,' or 'mine-making,' as well as the underlying tendency for conceit.

"After all, it was in reference to this, Ānanda, that it was mentioned in the Pārāyana, to The Questions of Puṇṇaka:

'*He no longer finds himself perturbed in this world,*
Having seen and understood the highs and the lows in it.
Being at peace, having exhausted the passions,
He remains sorrow-less and without any wishes or desires.
It is he, I declare, who has crossed entirely, once and for all,
The flood of birth and death.'"

33. ***Sāriputta Sutta*** *(The Venerable Sāriputta)*

At one time, after having approached The Blessed One and paying homage to Him, the Venerable Sāriputta sat down to one side. Then, The Blessed One said to him:

"Sāriputta, I teach The Dhamma in brief; I teach The Dhamma at length; I teach The Dhamma both in brief and at length. It is the listeners' own capacity to carefully attend to and understand what I teach that is rare."

Then, the Venerable Sāriputta exclaimed respectfully:

"Blessed Lord, *now* is the time! *Now* is the time, Tathāgata!

"The Blessed Lord should teach The Dhamma in brief; He should teach It at length; The Blessed Lord should teach The Dhamma both in brief and at length. For truly, there are those here who do have the capacity to understand what The Blessed One teaches!"

"In that case, Sāriputta, you must train yourselves in this manner:

'There will no longer be in us any tendency for 'I-making,' or 'mine-making,' as well as the underlying tendency for conceit, as it relates to this body being experienced. There will no longer be in us any tendency for 'I-making,' or 'mine-making,' as well as the underlying tendency for conceit, as it relates to external objects being cognized and known. And we will enter upon and dwell in that state of The Freedom of Heart, by realizing personally and with direct understanding, The Liberation through Wisdom, whereby there will no longer be any tendency left in us for 'I-making,' or 'mine-making,' as well as the underlying tendency for conceit.'

"Therefore, Sāriputta, you must train yourselves in this manner."

"And when, Sāriputta, a Bhikkhu no longer has any tendency for 'I-making,' or 'mine-making,' as well as the underlying tendency for conceit, as it relates to this body being experienced; when he no longer has the tendency for 'I-making,' or 'mine-making,' as well as the underlying tendency for conceit, as it relates to external objects being cognized and known; and when he enters upon and dwells in that state of The Freedom of Heart, by realizing personally and with direct understanding, The Liberation through Wisdom, whereby there will no longer be any tendency left in him for 'I-making,' or 'mine-making,' as well as the underlying tendency for conceit, then he is to be called a Bhikkhu who has cut off craving at the root, who has eradicated the fetters, and by completely destroying the underlying conceit, he has truly ended suffering.

"After all, it was in reference to this, Sāriputta, that it was mentioned in the Pārāyana, to The Questions of Udaya:

'*The relinquishing of both craving for sense perceptions and sadness for losing them,*
The banishing of boredom and the shunning of remorse;

Work on purifying the practice with mindfulness and equanimity,
Continuously applying wholesome examination of the various states you encounter.
This, I declare, is how you will come to personally taste Release,
By way of Directly Knowing, which is what obliterates ignorance, indeed.'"

34. ***Nidāna Sutta*** *(Causes)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three causes that are instigating factors, which develop into intentional actions (*Kammā*). What three?

Greed, as the basis, is a cause for kamma; anger, as the basis, is a cause for kamma; and delusion, as the basis, is a cause for kamma.

Bhikkhus, any greedy action caused by and born of greed, originating and arising from greed, ripens at the moment the person is reborn. When it thus ripens, the results of these past intentional actions are then consequently manifested either here and now, in the next birth, or in a subsequent birth.

Bhikkhus, any angry action caused by and born of anger, originating and arising from anger, ripens at the moment the person is reborn. When it thus ripens, the results of these past intentional actions are then consequently manifested either here and now, in the next birth, or in a subsequent birth.

Bhikkhus, any deluded action caused by and born of delusion, originating and arising from delusion, ripens at the moment the person is reborn. When it thus ripens, the results of these past intentional actions are then consequently manifested either here and now, or in the next birth, or in a subsequent birth.

Bhikkhus, imagine unspoiled and healthy seeds, that are not damaged or destroyed by either heat or the sun, and when planted at the right time, in a well-prepared field and with the rain also falling to nourish them, they would then germinate, grow, and fully develop.

In the same manner, Bhikkhus, any greedy action caused by and born of greed, originating and arising from greed, ripens at the moment the person is reborn. When it thus ripens, the results of these past intentional actions are then consequently manifested either here and now, in the next birth, or in a subsequent birth.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, any angry action caused by and born of anger, originating and arising from anger, ripens at the moment the person is reborn. When it thus ripens, the results of these past intentional actions are then consequently manifested either here and now, in the next birth, or in a subsequent birth.

And, Bhikkhus, any deluded action caused by and born of delusion, originating and arising from delusion, ripens at the moment the person is reborn. When it thus ripens, the results of these past

intentional actions are then consequently manifested either here and now, in the next birth, or in a subsequent birth.

Bhikkhus, these are the three causes that are instigating factors, which develop into intentional actions (*Kammā*).

On the other hand, Bhikkhus, there are these other three causes that are instigating factors, which develop into intentional actions (*Kammā*), as well. What three?

Non-greed as the basis for action; non-anger as the basis for action; and non-delusion as the basis for action.

Bhikkhus, any non-greedy and equanimous action caused by and born of non-greed, originating and arising from non-greed, due to the absence of greed, fades and disperses the energy and magnitude of that very action, thereby uprooting it, and making it like a dead palm stump, never to rise again.

Bhikkhus, any non-angry and calmly considerate action caused by and born of non-anger, originating and arising from non-anger, due to the absence of anger, fades and disperses the energy and magnitude of that very action, thereby uprooting it, and making it like a dead palm stump, never to rise again.

Bhikkhus, any non-deluded and carefully reflected action, caused by and born of non-delusion, originating and arising from non-delusion, due to the absence of delusion, fades and disperses the energy and magnitude of that very action, thereby uprooting it, and making it like a dead palm stump, never to rise again.

Bhikkhus, imagine some unbroken, unspoiled and healthy seeds, that are not damaged or destroyed by either heat or the sun, ready to be planted in a well-prepared field. But a man comes along, burns all those seeds, turns them to ashes and blows them into the air, or disposes of them by putting them into a fast-flowing river.

In the same manner, Bhikkhus, any non-greedy and equanimous action caused by and born of non-greed, originating and arising from non-greed, due to the absence of greed, fades and disperses the energy and magnitude of that very action, thereby uprooting it, and making it like a dead palm stump, never to rise again.

Bhikkhus, any non-angry and calmly considerate action caused by and born of non-anger, originating and arising from non-anger, due to the absence of anger, fades and disperses the energy and magnitude of that very action, thereby uprooting it, and making it like a dead palm stump, never to rise again.

Bhikkhus, any non-deluded and carefully reflected action, caused by and born of non-delusion, originating and arising from non-delusion, due to the absence of delusion, fades and disperses the

energy and magnitude of that very action, thereby uprooting it, and making it like a dead palm stump, never to rise again.

Bhikkhus, these are therefore the other three causes that are the instigating factors, which develop into intentional actions (*Kammā*), as well.

'*Whether born through greed, anger, or delusion,*
The ignorant one faces the effects of these,
By tasting their fruits sooner or later,
Whether they would be heavy or light,
While still in this conscious body he is now reborn into.
But the wise and calmly considerate Bhikkhu,
Engaging in all that he does, with careful reflection,
Equanimously abandons right here, any and all such Kammā,
By cutting the very link that would have connected him to all miserable states.'

35. ***Hatthaka Sutta*** *(Discourse to Hatthaka)*

This is what I personally heard.

At one time, The Blessed One was in Āḷavī, seated on a spread of leaves in the Siṁsapā forest, by a cattle track.

It was then that Hatthaka of Āḷavaka was walking and wandering for exercise, when he saw The Blessed One seated on a spread of leaves in the Siṁsapā forest, and decided to go and approach Him. Once there, he paid homage to The Blessed One, and then sat to one side and said:

"Bhante, did The Blessed One sleep well?"

"Yes, Prince, I slept well. I am one of those in this world who sleeps well."

"But Bhante, these winter nights are very cold, the snow has already begun falling, the ground and the cattle-made ruts in the fields are rough to travel through, and here, the spread of leaves is very thin, while snow is falling even through the trees, which are already barren from their leaves, and although the cold wind blows through the saffron robe clinging to the body, yet The Blessed One says:

'Yes Prince, I slept well, I am one of those in this world who sleeps well.'

"In that case, Prince, I will question you on this and you may answer as it pleases you.
Now, consider this:

"There is a mansion belonging to a householder or a householder's son, that is well painted, with closed windows and doors. In that mansion, there are cushions made of deer skin with coverings

of wool, with all the walls being properly plastered and insulated. Overhead too, there is a covering of a peaked roof that is well insulated, inside out, while the ceiling is covered, wall to wall, with antelope, deer hide and red coverings. Also, inside the house there are oil lamps, and so each room is well lit up, making the place very comfortable while the householder's four wives attend to him, catering to all his needs and likes.

"Now, tell me, Prince, would he sleep well in such a place, or not? What do you think?"

"Bhante, he would truly sleep well! If anyone would be sleeping well in the world, then he would certainly be the one!"

"Then Prince, what do you think? Could it be possible that because of some bodily or mental affliction caused by greed that invades and keeps burning this householder or this householder's son, he loses that sense of comfort and instead ends up sleeping badly, or is not able to sleep at all?"

"Oh yes, that could be very possible, Bhante!"

"Therefore, Prince, the afflictions caused by greed, on account of which this householder or this householder's son would keep burning and thus sleep badly, are fully dispelled in The Tathāgata, entirely uprooted, and made like a dead palm tree stump, never to grow back again. That itself is a reason for Me to sleep well.

"Further, Prince, what do you think? Could it be possible that because of some bodily or mental affliction caused by anger or irritability that invades and keeps burning this householder or this householder's son, he loses that sense of comfort and instead ends up sleeping badly, or is not able to sleep at all?"

"Oh yes, that could be very possible, Bhante!"

"Therefore, Prince, the afflictions caused by anger or irritability, on account of which this householder or this householder's son would keep burning and thus sleep badly, are fully dispelled in The Tathāgata, entirely uprooted, and made like a dead palm tree stump, never to grow back again. That itself is a reason for Me to sleep well.

"Also, Prince, what do you think? Could it be possible that because of some bodily or mental affliction caused by delusion that invades and keeps burning this householder or this householder's son, he loses that sense of comfort and instead ends up sleeping badly, or is not able to sleep at all?"

"Oh yes, that could be very possible, Bhante!"

"Therefore, Prince, the afflictions caused by delusion, on account of which this householder or this householder's son would keep burning and thus sleep badly, are fully dispelled in The

Tathāgata, entirely uprooted, and made like a dead palm tree stump, never to grow back again. That itself is a reason for me to sleep well.

'*That Brahmin, who is no longer burning by passions for sense pleasures,*
Having relinquished all assets, attains to Nibbāna.
Thus, he sleeps well, having cut off all attachments,
'No longer plagued by sorrow in his heart,
He truly is the one who sleeps peacefully,
Having attained to the sublime peace of the heart.'

36. ***Devadūta Sutta*** *(Divine Messengers)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three Divine messengers. What three?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone who commits evil bodily actions, who commits evil actions through his speech and verbal communication, and who commits evil actions through his thoughts and ruminations, with the breakup of the body, after death, is reborn into a place of misery, within the lower realms, in hell.

Once there, the wardens of hell drag him by his limbs and show him to their king, Lord Yāma, and tell him:

"Lord, this one did not care for his mother or his father, nor for recluses that lead the Holy Life, nor for his elders. May your highness grant him the punishment he deserves."

Then, King Yāma of the underworld cross questions him, asking about the reasons for his misbehavior in life:

"Good man, did you not see the first divine messenger appearing in your life among humans?"

"Lord, I did not see."

Then, King Yāma of the underworld interrogates him further:

"Good man, did you not see a woman or a man among humans, eighty, ninety or a hundred years old, bent like the framework of an old roof, frail and weak, being supported on a stick and shivering, sick, with youthfulness gone, teeth broken and hair turned grey and most of it gone, and covered with wrinkles all over their body?"

Then he says, "That I did see, Lord."

Then, King Yāma of the underworld asks him:

“Good man, you being intelligent, having already grown mature and even become old, did it not occur to you at any point –

‘I too am subject to ageing and decay; therefore, while there is still time and I have the ability, I should do good by body, speech, and mind?’”

Then he says, “Lord, I could not. I was simply carelessly negligent, and did not pay any attention.”

Then, King Yāma of the underworld says to him:

“On account of your careless negligence, you did not do what was right, by body, speech or mind. That demerit was not done by your mother, father, brother, sister, friends, associates, blood relations, by Devas, recluses or brahmins. No! It was done by *you*, and now you will have to experience the results and face their outcome!”

King Yāma of the underworld then cross questions him further, this time making queries about the second messenger:

“Good man, did you not see the second divine messenger appearing in your life among humans?”

“Lord, I did not see.”

Then, King Yāma of the underworld asks him:

“Good man, did you not see a woman or a man among humans, being gravely ill, afflicted and feeling pain, drowning in his own urine and feces; a sick and an ailing person, who could no longer take care of himself, where he needed the help and care of others to be raised and placed onto his bed?”

Then he says: “I did see, Lord.”

At that, King Yāma of the underworld asks him:

“Good man, you being intelligent, having already grown and become old, did it not occur to you at any point –

‘I too am subject to illness and afflictions; therefore, while there is still time and I have the ability, I should do good by body, speech, and mind?’

Then he says: “Lord, I could not. I was simply carelessly negligent.”

Then, King Yāma of the underworld says to him:

“On account of your careless negligence, you did not do what was right, by body, speech or mind. That demerit was not done by your mother, father, brother, sister, friends, associates, blood relations, by Devas, recluses or brahmins. It was done by *you*, and now you will have to experience the results and face their outcome!”

King Yāma of the underworld then cross questions him further, this time making queries about the third messenger:

“Good man, did you not see the third divine messenger appearing in your life among humans?”

“Lord, I did not see.”

Then, King Yāma of the underworld asks him:

“Good man, did you not see a woman or a man among humans who was dead, having been deceased for one day, two days, three days, or even having turned blue, bloated and festering?”

Then he says: “I did see, Lord.”

Then, King Yāma of the underworld asks him:

“Good man, you being intelligent, having already grown and become old, did it not occur to you at any point –

‘I too am subject to death and will eventually drop this broken body; therefore, while there is still time and I have the ability, I should do good by body, speech, and mind?’

Then he says: “Lord, I could not. I was simply carelessly negligent.”

Then, King Yāma of the underworld says to him:

“On account of your careless negligence, you did not do what was right, by body, speech or mind. That demerit was not done by your mother, father, brother, sister, friends, associates, blood relations, by Devas, recluses or brahmins. It was done by *you*, and now you will have to experience the results and face their outcome.”

Then, after cross-questioning him about the third messenger, King Yāma of the underworld falls silent and does not speak anymore.

Next, the wardens of hell grab that man and give him the fivefold punishment, whereby they fix a burning iron peg to each of his hands, and two others to each of his feet, and another that pierces his chest. On account of it, he feels terribly sharp and excruciatingly painful feelings, but he does not die, until the heavy results of the evil actions he had committed are exhausted.

Then, the wardens of hell drag him back and forth, and throw him down repeatedly, and proceed to cut him with knives as he feels sharp, excruciatingly painful feelings, but he still does not die, until the heavy weight of the evil actions he had committed are exhausted.

Then, the wardens of hell hang him head down and slash him open with hatchets, as he feels sharp, excruciatingly painful feelings, yet no matter the intensity of the torture he is exposed to, he does not die, until the heavy weight of the evil actions he had committed are exhausted.

Then, the wardens of hell tie him down to a carriage and make him pull it after himself, while running on a ground that is ablaze with fire, where he feels sharp, excruciatingly painful feelings, but does not die, until the heavy weight of the evil actions he had committed are exhausted.

Then, the wardens of hell make him climb up and come down a giant and slippery rock which is blazing with fire, and there too, he feels sharp and excruciating pain, but does not die until the heavy results of the evil actions he had committed are exhausted.

The wardens of hell then take him by the feet and throw him to a very large boiling molten pot, where he cooks in its bubbling foam, experiencing the excruciating pain of being boiled, as he sometimes dives deep into it and then comes out of it, by swimming across it. As a result, he feels sharp, unimaginably excruciating pain but still does not die, until the heavy weight of the evil actions he had committed are exhausted.

Next, the wardens of hell put him in the Great Hell, which is known to be thus:

"It has four doors in the four cornered squares,
Which are divided and then further subdivided.
A place that is surrounded fully by an iron wall and an iron roof on top,
And with iron floor that keeps burning, all the time.
The Great Hell spreads for seven hundred miles and stands there, all the time."

Bhikkhus, at one time it occurred to King Yāma of the underworld:

"While those born in the human realm do so many evil actions and then are subjected to these various punishments, I, on the other hand, wish to gain the opportunity to be reborn into the human realm at a time when a Tathāgata appears, an Arahant, a Perfectly Awakened Buddha, whereby I could gain the opportunity to attend to Him and listen, as He would teach me The Dhamma, so that I could learn and understand The Dhamma from Him!"

Bhikkhus, I am not repeating these words for you here as things that I heard from another recluse's or brahmin's lips!

I am describing for you what I personally have known, seen, and experienced myself.

Then, The Blessed spoke these words in verse:

'Although, even while young, people meet the Divine Messengers face to face,
They still remain negligent, and as a result, experience sorrow for a very long time,
Once on their way to the lower realms of hell.
But those good people still living here,
When warned by the Divine messengers,
Do not stay negligent but really practice The Noble Dhamma.
And on having seen and understood that
The dangers of having desire and grasping
Are the very cause for birth and death,
And by no longer clinging or grabbing onto anything,
They become liberated, as their fires become extinguished, even while still living.
Thus, fully contented, overcoming animosity and all dangers too,
They are the ones who have attained, indeed,
True freedom that is Nibbāna Supreme.'

37. ***Paṭhama Catumahārāja Sutta*** *(The Four Great Celestial Guardian Kings – Part 1)*

Bhikkhus, on the eighth day of the waxing moon, the ministers and members of the gathering of the Four Great Celestial Guardian Kings wander about to see, whether many humans care for mother, father, recluses, brahmins, elders in the family, or observe the eight precepts on the full moon day, while keeping awake, to engage in meritorious actions.

Bhikkhus, on the fourteenth day of the waxing moon, the sons of the Four Great Celestial Guardian Kings wander about to see, whether many humans care for mother, father, recluses, brahmins, elders in the family, or observe the eight precepts on the full moon day, while keeping awake, in order to engage in meritorious actions.

Bhikkhus, on the full moon Uposatha day that occurs on the fifteenth day of the waxing moon, the Four Great Celestial Guardian Kings themselves wander about to see whether many humans care for mother, father, recluses, brahmins, elders in the family or observe the eight precepts on the full moon day, while keeping awake, to engage in meritorious actions.

Bhikkhus, if they observe that very few humans care for mother, father, recluses, brahmins, and elders in the family or observe the eight precepts on the full moon day, at the assembly of Thirty-Three Devas of Tāvatiṁsā in their Sudhamma Hall, the Four Great Celestial Guardian Kings inform Sakka, the King of the Devas, while reporting to him:

"Lord, nowadays only a few care for mother, father, recluses, brahmins, and elders in the family and a few observe the eight precepts on the full moon day, while keeping awake to engage in meritorious actions."

Now, Bhikkhus, on hearing this, the Thirty-Three Devas of Tāvatiṁsā become distressed and worried, considering how the number of Divine and Celestial hosts is now diminishing and in decline, whereas the number of the *asuras* and demons keeps increasing and growing.

However, Bhikkhus, if it so happens that many humans begin caring for mother, father, recluses, brahmins, and elders in the family, or observe the eight precepts on the full moon day, at the assembly of Thirty-Three Devas of Tāvatiṁsā in their Sudhamma Hall, the Four Great Celestial Guardian Kings inform Sakka, the King of the Devas, while reporting to him:

"Lord, nowadays many care for mother, father, recluses, brahmins, and elders in the family and many observe the eight precepts on the full moon, while keeping awake to engage in meritorious actions."

Now, Bhikkhus, on hearing this, the Thirty-Three Devas of Tāvatiṁsā become delighted and rejoice, considering how the number of Divine and Celestial hosts is now on the rise, whereas the number of the *asura*s and demons keeps decreasing and diminishing.

Bhikkhus, you must learn that once upon a time, The King of Devas, Lord Sakka, while instructing his retinue of Thirty-Three Devas of The Tāvatiṁsā Heaven, began reciting the following verse:

"Anyone who desires to be like me,
May they commit themselves to living with purity,
By observing the fortnightly Uposatha to perfection, and in all its eight factors,
Whether on the eighth, the fourteenth, or the fifteenth,
Or on any of the especially significant days."

But Bhikkhus, you must know that this verse was not spoken appropriately, nor in the best possible way that it could have been spoken.

And why do I say this?

It is because even the King of Devas, Sakka himself, possesses a heart and a mind that are not free from lust, hatred, and delusion.

After all, it is *only* in the case of an Arahant, who has completely destroyed all the contaminants that corrupt the heart, who has fully lived The Holy Life by attaining its ultimate Goal and thereby has done what had to be done, having laid down the heavy burden and fully obliterated and torn into shreds the fetter for renewed existence, and thus accomplished the Task, by liberating himself through Release with direct understanding; it is *such* a person indeed, who truly can speak this verse appropriately, when he says:

"Anyone who desires to be like me,
May they commit themselves to living with purity,
By observing the fortnightly Uposatha to perfection, and in all its eight factors,
Whether on the eighth, the fourteenth, or the fifteenth,
Or on any of the especially significant days."

And why do I say this?

It is because that Bhikkhu has truly and fully released himself from greed, hatred, and delusion, indeed.

38. ***Dutiya Catumahārāja Sutta*** *(The Four Great Celestial Guardian Kings – Part 2)*

Bhikkhus, once Lord Sakka, The King of Devas, began reciting the following verse while instructing his retinue of Thirty-Three Devas of The Tāvatiṁsā Heaven:

"Anyone who desires to be like me,
May they commit themselves to living with purity,
By observing the fortnightly Uposatha to perfection, and in all its eight factors,
Whether on the eighth, the fourteenth, or the fifteenth,
Or on any of the especially significant days."

But Bhikkhus, you must know that this verse was not spoken appropriately, nor in the best possible way that it could have been spoken.

And why do I say this?

It is because even the King of Devas, Sakka himself, is still susceptible to rebirth, having to undergo and endure old age, sickness, and death, for he still has to face much sorrow, pain, wailing and tears, along with depression and anguish. Therefore, he is still not free from these things, hence not immune to suffering.

On the other, an Arahant, who has completely destroyed all the contaminants that corrupt the heart, and fully lived The Holy Life, by attaining its ultimate Goal, and thereby has done what had to be done, having already laid down the heavy burden and fully obliterated and torn into shreds the fetter for renewed existence, and thus accomplished the Task by liberating himself through Release, with direct understanding; it is *such* a person indeed, who truly can speak the verse appropriately and in its best possible way, when he says:

"Anyone who desires to be like me,
May they commit themselves to living with purity,
By observing the fortnightly Uposatha to perfection, and in all its eight factors,
Whether on the eighth, the fourteenth, or the fifteenth,
Or on any of the especially significant days."

And why do I say this?

It is because that Bhikkhu has rightly unshackled himself from rebirth, and is no longer subject to the cycles of birth, old age, sickness, and death. Thus, he has fully released himself from all the sorrow, pain, wailing and tears, along with depression and anguish which continued existing in *saṁsāra* brings.

I declare, therefore, that it is he, the Arahant, who is utterly free from, and thus totally immune to suffering.

39. ***Sukhamāla Sutta*** *(Garlanded by Happiness and Comfort)*

Bhikkhus, I was very delicately raised and pampered in my upbringing, being garlanded with happiness and comfort throughout my lay life.

In my father's home there was a pond just for blue lotuses, another for only red lotuses, and yet another for white lotuses, all of them built just for me and for my own enjoyment. I never used sandalwood other than the very best, which meant they had to come from Varaṇasi. My head dress, ornately embroidered close-fitting jacket, my garment and outer robe were all made of Varaṇasi's finest silk.

Wherever I went, a white parasol was held over me, both day and night, so that I would not be touched by heat or cold, dust, grass or even dew drops. There were three grand palaces built just for me: one for winter, one for summer, and yet another for the rainy, monsoon season.

Bhikkhus, I spent the four months of the rainy season inside the mansion entirely, with no other male in sight other than myself, for I was only surrounded by females to keep me company and entertain me.

Also, whereas in other households the servants and workmen are normally served second-rate meals like gruel, in contrast, in my father's home they were all offered the finest of rice, meat, and various curries.

Nevertheless, Bhikkhus, while being so carefully taken care of and delicately nurtured, the thought occurred to me:

'An uninstructed ordinary person, although himself being subject to decay and old age and thus not at all immune to decay and old age, on seeing another who is decayed and aging, becomes repulsed and feels disgust, especially because he neglects to consider the simple fact of his own similar predicament, while he forgets to consider:

"I too am subject to becoming old, ageing and decaying, because I am not immune to old age. Therefore, to become repulsed or feel disgusted whenever I see someone who is already old and decaying, is truly improper of me and quite foolish."

As I pondered thus, the intoxication and vanity I felt towards my youth, suddenly lost its grip on me, and I became disenchanted.

Furthermore, Bhikkhus, I pondered how an uninstructed ordinary person, although himself being subject to illness and not immune to illness, on seeing another who is suffering from an illness becomes repulsed and feels disgusted by what he witnesses, but without considering his own similar predicament, as in:

"I too am subject to becoming ill, for I am not immune to getting sick. Therefore, if I am now repulsed and feel disgusted in seeing someone who is already suffering from illness, this is truly improper of me and quite foolish."

As I pondered thus, the intoxication and vanity I felt towards my health and vigor, suddenly lost its grip on me, and I became disenchanted.

Furthermore, Bhikkhus, I reflected on how an uninstructed ordinary person, although himself being subject to death and not immune to the inevitability of death, on seeing another who is dead or about to die, becomes repulsed and feels disgusted by what he witnesses, but without considering his own similar predicament, as in:

"I too am subject to death, as I am not immune to death. Therefore, if I am now repulsed and feel disgusted in seeing someone who is already dead or about to die, this is truly improper of me and definitely unwise!"

As I pondered thus, the intoxication I felt towards my life suddenly lost its grip on me, and I became disenchanted.

As such, Bhikkhus, there are these three intoxications. What three?

Being intoxicated by youth; intoxicated with health; and intoxicated with life itself.

Here, Bhikkhus, an uninstructed ordinary person (*puthujjana*), being intoxicated by youth and its vanity, misbehaves through body, speech and mind, and on account of that misbehavior, at the breakup of the body, after death, he is reborn in a realm of misery, in a lower state, in hell.

Similarly, an uninstructed ordinary person, being intoxicated with health and lost in its vanity, misbehaves through body, speech, and mind, and on account of that misbehavior, at the breakup of the body, after death, he is reborn in a realm of misery, in a lower state, in hell.

Also, an uninstructed ordinary person, being intoxicated with life and lost in its vanity, misbehaves through body, speech and mind, and on account of that misbehavior, at the breakup of the body, after death, he is reborn in a realm of misery, in a lower state, in hell.

After all, it is through intoxication with youthfulness that a Bhikkhu relinquishes his training and reverts back to the lower life of a layperson. Also, it is through intoxication with health and vigor that a Bhikkhu relinquishes his training and reverts back to living the lower life of a layperson. And it is through intoxication with life that a Bhikkhu relinquishes his training and reverts back to living the lower life of a layperson.

'Ordinary and average beings,
Who themselves are subject and not immune
To decay, old age, sickness and death,
Become repulsed and disgusted by the sight of others
Who are decaying, old, suffering from illness, dead, or dying.
But, seeing and knowing that I too am subject to these unavoidable factors,
It is improper for me to become repulsed or disgusted by others,
Who are decaying, old, suffering from illness, dead, or about to die.

'While dwelling thus, having experienced the state beyond all assets,
Seeing the security that comes from renouncing,
No longer was I intoxicated with youth, with health or vigor, or even with life.
Thus, through diligent resolve, I clearly saw Nibbāna.
No longer can I indulge in sense pleasure,
For it is only by relying on the sublime Holy Life,
That there is no more coming to any state of being.'

*40. **Ādhipateyya Sutta** (Authorities)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three authorities. What three?

Authority over oneself; taking the world as one's authority; and taking The Dhamma as one's authority.

a. And what, Bhikkhus, is authority over oneself?

Here, Bhikkhus, a Bhikkhu goes to the forest, to the root of a tree, or an empty hut, and reflects thus:

"I did not go forth by taking on the robes, going from household life into homelessness, for the sake of robes, alms food, lodging, or for wanting this or that! Rather, it was due to the fervent consideration that:

'I am subject to birth, aging, death, grief, lamentation, pain, depression, and anguish. And seeing that I am subject to suffering, being afflicted by suffering, perhaps an ending to this whole mass of suffering could still be reached, where I may break free from rebecoming altogether.'

Therefore, he goes on reflecting –

"As one who has gone forth from household life into homelessness, I gave up sense pleasures. So, it would be improper, if not far worse, if I were to now go chasing after sense pleasures after having already given them all up."

To this end, the Bhikkhu resolves:

"I will be unshaken in my efforts; I will rouse the energy and not become negligent, as I establish mindfulness before me without perplexity, establishing my body in tranquility and keeping it soft, without creating agitation in my heart, while I develop a deeply collected state of mind."

By making himself his own authority thus, the Bhikkhu relinquishes the unwholesome and develops the wholesome, and by maintaining his growing purity, he abandons blameworthy behaviors as he develops and cultivates for himself a transformed character, one that is truly blameless in all his behavior.

This, Bhikkhus, is what is meant by 'developing authority over oneself.'

b. And what, Bhikkhus, is meant by taking the world as one's authority?

Here, a Bhikkhu goes to the forest, to the root of a tree, or an empty hut, and reflects thus:

"I did not go forth by taking on the robes, going from household life into homelessness, for the sake of robes, alms food, lodging, or for wanting this or that! Rather, it was due to the fervent consideration that:

'I am subject to birth, aging, death, grief, lamentation, pain, depression, and anguish. I am subject to suffering, being afflicted by suffering. So, perhaps an ending to this whole mass of suffering could still be reached.'

Therefore, he goes on reflecting –

"As one who has gone forth from household life into homelessness, I might engage in thinking thoughts about sense pleasures, or entertain thoughts of ill-will, or thoughts of harming others. But in this vast world, there may be very powerful recluses and brahmins, who have the Divine

Eye, and therefore they would be able to know the minds of others. So, while those secret thoughts or mental behaviors could be well-hidden in me from all those that are nearby, they would be clearly visible to them, however, even if they are far away and at considerable distance from me! Thus, in being fully aware of my thoughts, they will come to know me thus:

'Look at this clansman's son who, having gone forth out of faith from household life into homelessness, still continues to have such evil, unwholesome, and harmful thoughts!'

"Also, there exist powerful Devas who have the Divine Eye as well and could clearly know the minds and thoughts of others, whether from a far distance or while in proximity to me. Even though I would not be able to see them, yet they too will most certainly know and look straight into my heart and mind, while exclaiming this about me:

'O, look at this clansman's son! Although having gone forth out of faith from household life into homelessness, he still lives while thinking such evil, unwholesome, and harmful thoughts!'

To this end, the Bhikkhu resolves:

"I will be unshaken in my effort; I will rouse the energy and not become negligent, as I establish mindfulness before me without perplexity, establishing my body in tranquility and keeping it soft, without creating agitation in my heart, while I develop a deeply collected state of mind."

By taking the world as one's authority thus, the Bhikkhu relinquishes the unwholesome and develops the wholesome, and by maintaining his growing purity, he abandons blameworthy behaviors as he develops and cultivates for himself a transformed character, one that is truly blameless in all his behavior.

This, Bhikkhus, is what is meant by 'taking the world as one's authority.'

c. And what, Bhikkhus, is meant by taking The Dhamma as one's authority?

Here, Bhikkhus, a Bhikkhu goes to the forest, to the root of a tree, or an empty hut, and reflects thus:

"I did not go forth by taking on the robes, going from household life into homelessness, for the sake of robes, alms food, lodging, or for wanting this and that! Rather, it was due to the fervent consideration that:

'I am subject to birth, aging, death, grief, lamentation, pain, depression, and anguish. I am subject to suffering, being afflicted by suffering. But, perhaps an ending to this whole mass of suffering could still be reached.'

"After all, The Dhamma is well expounded by The Blessed One; it is directly visible; immediately effective; leading onwards; inviting rigorous testing and inspection; for it is truly applicable and personally realizable by the wise, each for oneself.

"And on top of that, I also have my fellow companions in The Holy Life, who both know and see. Therefore, as one who has gone forth from household life into homelessness, in this well-taught Dispensation of The Dhamma by The Blessed One, if I were to be negligent, lazy and heedless, that would be highly inconsiderate, improper, and foolishly disrespectful of me."

To this end, the Bhikkhu resolves:

"I will be unshaken in my effort; I will rouse the energy and not become negligent, as I establish mindfulness before me without perplexity; establishing my body in tranquility and keeping it soft, without creating agitation in my heart, as I develop a deeply collected state of mind."

By taking The Dhamma as one's authority thus, the Bhikkhu relinquishes the unwholesome and develops the wholesome, and by maintaining his growing purity, he abandons blameworthy behaviors as he develops and cultivates for himself a transformed character, one that is truly blameless in all his behavior.

This, Bhikkhus, is what is meant by 'taking The Dhamma as one's authority.'

Bhikkhus, these are therefore the three authorities.

'There is no hiding in the world for the one who engages in evil,
After all, the person will be unable to hide even from himself
What, in fact, is the truth from all that is false.

But, the eyewitness to it all,
Is the benevolent and trustworthy wholesome that is in you,
The one you continuously despise, nonetheless,
For, it is the one who knows and sees what's really kept hidden,
And all that is unwholesome, which you desperately try to conceal within.

Meanwhile, however, The Tathāgata and the Devas,
Through their unobstructed vision,
Can clearly see that fool,
As he goes on engaging in misconduct, thinking he is well-hidden.

So, one should become one's own authority by becoming mindful;
Taking the world as one's authority, one should exercise wise consideration and be alert;
And through taking The Dhamma as his genuine authority,
The Bhikkhu should truly exert himself by going past the point of no return.

By conquering Māra, the end-maker,
One realizes for himself the destruction of birth and re-becoming altogether.

So, it is such a wise one, truly,
The one who is rightfully declared as the knower of existence,
Who, no longer identifying with anything at all,
Cannot make or consider anything his own, anymore.'



AN III

Suttas 41-50

Cūḷa Vagga

"The Shorter Section"

41. ***Sammukhībhāva Sutta*** *(The Presence)*

Bhikkhus, the son of a clansman who has faith in his heart, accrues much merit in the presence of three things. What three?

When faith is present, then the clansman with faith accrues much merit.

When the clansman with faith is in the presence of something to be offered as a gift, he accrues much merit.

When the clansman with faith is in the presence of someone who is truly worthy of gifts, and who accepts the offering being made, then that clansman again accrues much merit.

Bhikkhus, the son of a clansman who has faith accrues much merit in the presence of these three things.

42. ***Tiṭhāna Sutta*** *(Three Traits)*

Bhikkhus, there are three things that distinguish a person as someone who has confidence in The Dhamma and thereby has faith. What are these three?

He desires to see the virtuous ones.

His heart always desires to hear The Dhamma.

And he remains generous while living the household life, without the blemishes of stinginess affecting his heart. He delights in relinquishing, with a mind released and benevolent, as he open-handedly keeps giving to all those in need, truly enjoying the very giving of gifts.

Bhikkhus, it is by having these three traits that one is known to have confidence and faith.

'The one who desires to see the virtuous beings,
Who looks for opportunities to hear The Dhamma,
And has overcome the blemishes of stinginess,
Is said to indeed possess faith.'

43. ***Atthavasa Sutta*** *(Distinguishing Qualities)*

Bhikkhus, someone who sees these three distinguishing qualities in himself, should undoubtedly teach others. What three?

He who teaches The Dhamma should experience both The Dhamma and its meaning.

He who listens to The Dhamma should experience both The Dhamma and its meaning.

And thirdly, the one teaching, as well as the one being taught, should both experience The Dhamma and its meaning.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three distinguishing qualities, one should undoubtedly teach The Dhamma.

44. ***Kathāpavatti Sutta*** *(Elements of Coherence)*

Bhikkhus, someone who sees these three elements of coherence in himself, should undoubtedly teach others. What three?

He who teaches The Dhamma should experience both The Dhamma and its meaning.

He who listens to The Dhamma should experience both The Dhamma and its meaning.

And thirdly, the one teaching, as well as the one being taught, should both experience The Dhamma and its meaning.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three elements of coherence, one should undoubtedly teach The Dhamma.

45. ***Paṇḍita Sutta*** *(Advised by the Wise)*

Bhikkhus, these three are advised by the wise. What three?

Bhikkhus, giving gifts is advised by the wise.

Bhikkhus, going forth and becoming homeless is advised by the wise.

Bhikkhus, attending on one's mother and father is advised by the wise.

These three are advised by the wise.

'The good encourage being open-handedly generous and harmless,
Along with being self-disciplined and of service to one's parents,
And to those who are genuinely practicing The Holy Life.

Having thus been advised,
The wise person who possesses Right View
Should live his life while practicing The Training
In accordance with these principles,
As he moves on to experience even higher states.'

46. ***Sīlavanta Sutta*** *(The Virtuous)*

Bhikkhus, when the virtuous Bhikkhu lives while being supported by the community of supporters or by a village, as a result of this, all those supporting him in turn gain wonderful merits in three ways.

And what are these three?

They gain through their behavior done with the body, by their speech and communication, and by thoughts they have in their mind.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, when the virtuous Bhikkhu lives while being supported by the community of supporters or a by a village, as a result of this, all those supporting him in turn gain wonderful merits in these three ways.

47. ***Saṅkhata Lakkhaṇa Sutta & Asaṅkhata Lakkhaṇa Sutta*** *(The Marks of the Prepared & The Marks of the Non-prepared)*

Bhikkhus, these three are the marks of the "prepared."

Now, what are these three?

a. The fact that there is a *saṅkhārā* (a "loading up" or "winding-up," a prepared or "primed" state) that has arisen in the mind, which is clearly evident to the observer.

b. The decay and disappearance of that prepared or primed state in the mind becomes clear and evident.

c. And, the unfolding or transformation that takes place whenever the internally prepared and primed state of the mind is followed through and acted upon, also becomes clearly evident.

Bhikkhus, these three are the marks of the prepared.

Furthermore, Bhikkhus, there are these three marks of the non-prepared.

And what are these three?

a. The fact that there is nothing being "prepared" or primed in the mind is itself clear and evident.

b. It is clear and evident that no decaying or disappearance takes place of any state that may have been prepared or primed within the mind.

c. And, it is clear and evident that there is no unfolding or transformation taking place of any internally prepared or primed state, where no primed, "loaded" or "wound up" prepared state is somehow unfolding, whether by being followed through or acted upon, as before.

Bhikkhus, these are therefore the three marks of the non-prepared.

48. ***Pabbata Rāja Sutta*** *(The Great Himalayas)*

Bhikkhus, the large Sāla trees grow around the Great Himalayas in three ways. What three?

Their branches, leaves, and foliage grow depending on and affected by the Himalayas.
Their bark and shoots grow depending on and affected by the Himalayas.
And they grow with both their softwood and inner heartwood, while closely depending upon and affected by the Himalayas.

Thus, the large Sāla trees grow around the Great Himalayan Mountains in these three ways.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, the head of a family of householders, who possesses faith in his heart, has his family members that surround and depend upon him, also growing in three ways. What three?

They grow in their faith.
They grow in their virtuous behavior.
And they grow in their wisdom, by becoming more discerning.

Thus, Bhikkhus, the head of a family of householders, who possesses faith in his heart, has his family members that surround and depend upon him, also growing in these three ways.

'In the deep forest, trees grow and become mighty
While relying and depending upon a great rocky mountain.
In the same manner, by relying on the head of a household who lives with faith and virtue,
His wife, children, relations, friends, associates and those living under him,
All grow and become mighty like him too, while witnessing
His virtues, benevolence, generosity, and good conduct;
All echoing and serving as their example.

By living and behaving according to The Dhamma,
All those who delight in the enjoyment of sense pleasures
Soon find themselves in a good destination once this life is over,
Where they will rejoice in the heavenly realms,
Partaking of more sensual pleasures.'

49. ***Ātappakaraṇīya Sutta*** *(Ardent Energy)*

Bhikkhus, ardent energy should be roused in the following three instances. What three?

In order to stop the arising of un-arisen unwholesome, evil, and damaging behavior through the body, speech, and mind.

To bring forth the arising of the yet un-arisen wholesome, good, and constructive behaviors through the body, speech, and mind.

And to be able to endure sharp, painful, rough, troublesome, and excruciating feelings experienced in the body, that may even cause one to seek the ending of one's life.

In these three instances, Bhikkhus, ardent energy should especially be roused.

And when, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu rouses ardent energy in order to stop the arising of un-arisen unwholesome, evil, and damaging behavior through the body, speech, and mind; when he rouses within him the ardent energy to bring forth the arising of un-arisen wholesome, good, and constructive behavior through the body, speech, and mind; and when he rouses ardent energy that is certainly needed to endure sharp, painful, rough, troublesome, and excruciating feelings experienced in the body that may even cause one to seek the ending of one's life, then, he is certainly called a Bhikkhu who is ardently energetic, persevering, dedicated, and established in mindfulness firmly enough, to completely end all suffering.

*50. **Mahācora Sutta** (The Highway Robber)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three things, the highway robber breaks into houses, cuts limbs, plunders wealth, robs people, and goes into hiding while setting his ambush.

What are these three?

Here, Bhikkhus, the highway robber takes cover in uneven terrains; he hides under a covering; and he hides in the shadow of powerful people.

And how, Bhikkhus, does the highway robber take cover in uneven terrains?

Here, he hides in uneven and rough terrains of deep river valleys and mountain slopes. In this way, he takes cover in uneven terrains.

And how, Bhikkhus, does the highway robber hide under a covering?

Here, he hides among heavily grown and tall grass, in a place crowded with trees, in a cave, or in the great forest. In this way, he hides under a covering.

And how, Bhikkhus, does the highway robber hide in the shadow of powerful people?

Here, he takes cover under the king or the king's ministers, whereby he goes on reflecting while scheming:

'If anyone were to accuse me of anything, the king or his ministers will defend me by dismissing their accusations.'

Thus, if anyone were to accuse him of anything, the king or his ministers will defend him by dismissing the accusations. In this way, he hides in the shadow of powerful people.

Bhikkhus, by possessing these three things, the highway robber takes cover in uneven terrains; he hides under a covering; and he hides in the shadow of powerful people.

In a similar manner, Bhikkhus, by possessing three qualities, the evil bhikkhu injures and even destroys himself; he is blameworthy, as he falls to an offense and is reproached and questioned by the wise, thus accruing much evil and damaging demerit for himself, and for a long time.

What are these three?

Here, Bhikkhus, such a bhikkhu also takes cover in uneven terrains; he hides under a covering; and he hides in the shadow of powerful people.

And how, Bhikkhus, does the bhikkhu take cover in uneven terrains?

Here, the evil bhikkhu is endowed with uneven bodily behavior; uneven communication, speech or verbal action; as well as uneven thinking or mental behavior. In this way, the evil bhikkhu takes cover in uneven terrains.

And how, Bhikkhus, does the bhikkhu hide under a covering?

Here, not being dedicated at all to The Dhamma taught by The Tathāgata, the evil bhikkhu holds to wrong and extremist views that go contrary to The Dhamma, while he goes hiding like a coward, concealing himself under and within his wrong views. In this way, the bhikkhu hides under a covering.

And how, Bhikkhus, does the evil bhikkhu hide in the shadow of powerful people?

Here, he takes cover under the king or his ministers, whereby he goes on reflecting while scheming:

'If anyone were to accuse me of anything, the king or his ministers will defend me by dismissing their accusations.'

Thus, if anyone were to accuse him of anything, the king or his ministers will defend him by dismissing the accusations. In this way, he hides in the shadow of powerful people.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three qualities, the evil bhikkhu injures and even destroys himself; he is blameworthy, as he falls to an offense and is reproached and questioned by the wise, thus accruing much evil and damaging demerit for himself, and for a long time.



AN III

Suttas 51-60

Brāhmaṇa Vagga

"The Section on Brahmins"

51. ***Paṭhama Dvebrāhmaṇa Sutta*** *(The Two Brahmins – Part 1)*

At one time, two elderly brahmins, burdened by years, who had lived up to a hundred and twenty years, went and approached The Blessed One. Once the friendly greetings were exchanged, they sat down to one side and addressed The Blessed One by saying:

"Master Gotama, we are two elderly brahmins, burdened by years, who have lived up to a hundred and twenty years. However, we have not done anything wholesome, good, nor worthy of merits, and in addition, we have not established for ourselves any worthwhile shelter against the terrors of uncertainty.

"Please, let Master Gautama advise us for our good, welfare, and happiness for a long time."

"Indeed brahmins, you are burdened by years, having lived up to a hundred and twenty years, but you have not done anything wholesome, good, nor worthy merits, and in addition, you have not established for yourselves any worthwhile shelter against the terrors of uncertainty.

"Truly, brahmins, this world is led on by decay, old age, illness, and death. But, despite the fact of being susceptible to and led on by decay, old age, illness, and death, one *can* still have and maintain protection through the shelter of restraint, built and developed through his bodily actions, his speech or communication, and his thoughts.

"These, therefore, are one's own island, one's own shelter and support, giving you the protection and safety you are looking for."

'Life sweeps by, making one's lifespan short despite its seeming length,
For, here is no shelter for the one growing old.
Thus, on witnessing this inevitable danger in death,
Quickly engage in doing actions, the merits of which
Bring you and others much happiness.

Because, for the one going beyond as life comes to an end,
It is the self-discipline in behavior,

Through restraint of his own bodily actions, his speech or communication,
And especially the thoughts he entertains in his mind,
Along with the merits done while still living,
That truly become one's own shelter,
Leading him to the happiness beyond.'

52. ***Dutiya Dvebrāhmaṇa Sutta*** *(The Two Brahmins – Part 2)*

At one time, two elderly brahmins, burdened by years, who had lived up to a hundred and twenty years approached The Blessed One. Then, once the friendly greetings were exchanged, they went and sat down to one side, and addressed The Blessed One by saying:

"Master Gotama, we are two elderly brahmins, burdened by years, who have lived up to a hundred and twenty years. However, we have not done anything wholesome, good, nor worthy of merits, and in addition, we have not established for ourselves any worthwhile shelter against the terrors of uncertainty.

"Please, let Master Gautama advise us for our good, welfare and happiness for a long time."

"Indeed brahmins, you are truly burdened by years, having lived up to a hundred and twenty years, but you have not done anything wholesome, good, nor worthy of merits, and in addition, you have not established for yourselves any worthwhile shelter against the terrors of uncertainty.

"Truly, brahmins, this world is burning and in the flames of what are called decay, old age, afflictions, and death.

"But, despite being susceptible to the inevitable ravages of decay, old age, afflictions, and death, one *can* still have and maintain protection through the shelter of restraint, built and developed through his bodily actions, his speech or communication, and his thoughts.

"These, therefore, are one's own island, one's own shelter and support.

'When the house is on fire, whatever is taken out of it and saved,
Includes those items that are the most useful and valuable to you,
Not the ones that are left behind,
To go up in smoke, while burning in the blaze.

Since we all are being burned by decay, old age, afflictions, and death,
What is left behind are the merits gained through actions
That you have committed through the body, speech, and mind,
Which no burning blaze could really touch,
For, these will truly lead you to happiness, into the beyond.'

*53. **Aññatara Brāhmaṇa Sutta** (A Certain Brahmin)*

Once, a certain brahmin approached The Blessed One, and after exchanging greetings with Him, sat down to one side and said:

"Master Gautama, we have often heard the statement:

'The Dhamma is immediate and directly visible, and not a wait-and-see Discipline.'

"But how is it, Venerable Sir, that The Dhamma is thus: *'immediate, directly visible, not a wait-and-see Discipline, encouraging of personal examination and inspection, always leading one forward, and to be realized by the wise, each one for themselves?'*"

And The Blessed One replied, by saying:

"Brahmin, a greedy person, overcome by greed, consumed by greed, ends up harming himself, harming others, and harming both, while also feeling mental anguish, which leads him to experience even more suffering. But, if and when he relinquishes greed, he then no longer harms himself, nor harms others, nor harms both, thereby he does not feel mental anguish, and this itself saves him from experiencing much suffering.

"It is in this manner, brahmin, that one can understand the meaning of the statement:

'The Dhamma is experienced here and now, for it is immediate and directly visible; not a wait-and-see Discipline; it encourages personal examination and inspection; always leading one forward, hence it is to be realized by the wise, each one for themselves!'

"Similarly, brahmin, an angry person, overcome and consumed by anger and hatred, ends up harming himself, harming others, and harming both, while also feeling mental anguish, which leads him to experience even more suffering. But, if and when he relinquishes anger and hatred, then he no longer harms himself, nor harms others, nor harms both; thereby he does not feel mental anguish, and this itself saves him from experiencing much suffering.

"It is in this manner, brahmin, that one can understand the meaning of the statement:

'The Dhamma is experienced here and now, for it is immediate and directly visible; not a wait-and-see Discipline; it encourages personal examination and inspection; always leading one forward, hence it is to be realized by the wise, each one for themselves!'

"Also, brahmin, a deluded person, overcome by willful ignoring and consumed by deluded thinking, ends up harming himself, harming others, and harming both, while also feeling mental anguish, which leads him to experience even more suffering. But, if and when he relinquishes delusion and his willful ignoring, then he no longer harms himself, nor others, nor both himself and others; thereby he does not feel mental anguish, and this itself saves him from experiencing much suffering.

"It is in this manner, brahmin, that one can understand the meaning of the statement:

'The Dhamma is experienced here and now, for it is immediate and directly visible; not a wait-and-see Discipline; it encourages personal examination and inspection; always leading one forward, hence it is to be realized by the wise, each one for themselves!'

Then, with his hands in reverential salutation, the brahmin respectfully exclaimed:

"Magnificent, Venerable sir! Magnificent, Venerable sir!

"The Blessed One has made The Dhamma clear to me in many ways! It is as though He turned upright what had been turned upside-down, revealing what was hidden, showing the way to one who was lost, or holding up a lamp in the dark for those with eyesight to see.

"I go to The Blessed One for refuge, and to The Dhamma, and to The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus!

"From this day forward, may The Blessed One kindly remember me as a lay disciple of His, who has taken refuge in Him, until the end of life."

54. ***Paribbājaka Sutta*** *(A Wandering Ascetic)*

Once, a certain brahmin, who was a wandering ascetic belonging to another sect, approached The Blessed One and after exchanging friendly greetings, sat to one side and said to The Blessed One:

"Master Gautama, we have often heard the statement:

'The Dhamma is immediate and directly visible, and not a wait-and-see Discipline.'

"But in what manner is it, Venerable Sir, that –

'The Dhamma is experienced here and now, for it is immediate and directly visible; not a wait-and-see Discipline; it encourages personal examination and inspection; always leading one forward, hence it is to be realized by the wise, each one for themselves!'

Then, The Blessed One replied, by saying:

a. "Brahmin, a passionate person, overcome and consumed by lust or passion, ends up harming himself, harming others, and harming both, while also feeling mental anguish, which leads him to experience more suffering. But, if he relinquishes the passion or lust in his heart, then he no longer harms himself, nor harms others, nor harms both; thereby he does not feel mental anguish, and this itself saves him from experiencing much suffering.

“After all, brahmin, when a passionate person is burning with passion or lust, consumed and overcome by passion or lust, then he allows himself to engage in behavior that is evil and harmful, whether through his bodily actions, his speech, or his mind. But, when he relinquishes that passion or lust, he then no longer engages in misconduct, whether through his bodily actions, his speech, or his mind.

“Therefore, brahmin, a passionate person who is burning with passion or lust, consumed and overcome by passion or lust, does not know nor stops to consider what is truly beneficial to himself; he does not know nor stops to consider what is truly beneficial to another, and he does not know nor stops to consider what is truly beneficial to both.

“It is only when he relinquishes the passion or lust in him, that he comes to know and see what truly is beneficial to himself. Only then can he know and see what is truly beneficial to others; and thereby also comes to know and see what is truly beneficial to both.

“It is in such a way too, brahmin, that one can understand the meaning of the statement:

‘The Dhamma is experienced here and now, for it is immediate and directly visible; not a wait-and-see Discipline; it encourages personal examination and inspection; always leading one forward, hence it is to be realized by the wise, each one for themselves!’

b. “Brahmin, an angry or irritable person, overcome and consumed by anger or hatred, ends up harming himself, harming others, and harming both, while also feeling mental anguish, which leads him to experience more suffering. But, if he relinquishes the anger or hatred in his heart, he no longer harms himself, nor harms others, nor harms both; thereby he does not feel mental anguish, and this itself saves him from experiencing much suffering.

“After all, brahmin, when an angry or irritable person is burning with anger or hatred, consumed and overcome by anger or hatred, then he allows himself to engage in behavior that is evil and unwholesome, whether through his bodily actions, his speech, or his mind. But, when he relinquishes that anger or hatred, he then no longer engages in misconduct, whether through his bodily actions, his speech, or his mind.

“Therefore, brahmin, an angry person who is burning with anger or hatred, consumed and overcome by anger or hatred, does not know nor stops to consider what is truly beneficial to himself; he does not know nor stops to consider what is truly beneficial to another; and he does not know nor stops to consider what is truly beneficial to both.

“It is only when he relinquishes the anger or hatred in him, that he comes to know and see what is truly beneficial to himself; only then can he know and see what is truly beneficial to others; and therefore, also comes to know and see what is truly beneficial to both.

“It is in such a way too, brahmin, that one can understand the meaning of the statement:

'The Dhamma is experienced here and now, for it is immediate and directly visible; not a wait-and-see Discipline; it encourages personal examination and inspection; always leading one forward, hence it is to be realized by the wise, each one for themselves!'

c. "Brahmin, a deluded person, overcome and consumed by his delusion and willful ignoring, ends up harming himself, harming others, and harming both, while also feeling mental anguish, which leads him to experience more suffering. But, if he relinquishes delusion or the willful ignoring in him, he no longer harms himself, nor harms others, nor harms both; thereby he does not feel mental anguish, and this itself saves him from experiencing much suffering.

"After all, brahmin, when a deluded person is burning with, consumed and overcome by delusion or his willful ignoring, then he allows himself to engage in behavior that is evil and unwholesome, whether through his bodily actions, his speech, or his mind. But, when he relinquishes that delusion or willful ignoring, he then no longer engages in misconduct, whether through his bodily actions, his speech, or his mind.

"Therefore, brahmin, a deluded person who is burning with, consumed and overcome by delusion or his willful ignorance, does not know nor stops to consider what is truly beneficial to himself; he does not know nor stops to consider what is truly beneficial to another; and he does not know nor stops to consider what is truly beneficial to both.

"It is only when he relinquishes the delusion or the willful ignorance in him, that he comes to know and see what is truly beneficial to himself; only then can he know and see what is truly beneficial to others; and therefore, also comes to know and see what is truly beneficial to both.

"It is in such a way too, brahmin, that one can understand the meaning of the statement:

'The Dhamma is experienced here and now, for it is immediate and directly visible; not a wait-and-see Discipline; it encourages personal examination and inspection; always leading one forward, hence it is to be realized by the wise, each one for themselves!'

Then, that wandering ascetic from another sect made the following exclamation, with his hands in reverential salutation:

"Magnificent, Venerable sir! Magnificent, Venerable sir!

"The Blessed One has made The Dhamma clear to me in many ways! It is as though He turned upright what had been turned upside-down, thus revealing what was hidden, showing the way to one who was lost, or holding up a lamp in the dark for those with eyesight to see.

"I go to The Blessed One for refuge, and to The Dhamma, and to The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus!

"From this day forward, may The Blessed One kindly remember me as a lay disciple of His, who has taken refuge in Him, until the end of life."

55. ***Nibbuta Sutta*** *(Extinction)*

At one time, while approaching The Blessed One, the brahmin Jāṇussoṇi exchanged friendly greetings with Him, and then sat down to one side and said:

"Venerable Sir, to what extent is Extinction (*Nibbāna*) experienced here and now, being directly visible, immediate, inviting one to test and see for oneself, leading and taking one forward, and to be realized by the wise, by themselves?"

a. "Brahmin, a lustful or greedy person, overcome, excited, and consumed by greed, ends up harming himself, harming others, and harming both, while also feeling mental anguish, which leads him to experience more suffering. But, if he relinquishes greed, he no longer harms himself, nor harms others, nor harms both; thereby he does not feel mental anguish, nor experiences suffering.

"This because, brahmin, a lustful or greedy person, overcome, excited, and consumed by greed, engages in misconduct of body, speech, and mind. But, when he relinquishes greed, he no longer engages in misconduct through his body, speech, or mind.

"Therefore, brahmin, a lustful or greedy person, overcome, excited, and consumed by greed, does not know nor see what is truly beneficial to himself; he does not know nor see what is truly beneficial to another; and he does not know nor see what is truly beneficial to both.

"It is only when he relinquishes lust or greed, that he knows and sees what is truly beneficial to himself; he knows and sees what is truly beneficial to others, and he knows and sees what is truly beneficial to both.

"It is in such a way too, that Extinction (*Nibbāna*) is experienced here and now, being directly visible, immediate, inviting one to come, test, and see for oneself, leading and taking one forward, and to be realized by the wise, by themselves.

b. "Similarly, brahmin, an angry or irritable person, overcome, excited, and consumed by anger or hatred, ends up harming himself, harming others, and harming both, while also feeling mental anguish, which leads him to experience more suffering. But, if he relinquishes anger, he no longer harms himself, nor harms others, nor harms both; thereby he does not feel mental anguish, nor experiences suffering.

"This because, brahmin, an angry or irritable person, overcome, excited, and consumed by anger and hatred, engages in misconduct of body, speech, and mind. But, when he relinquishes that anger or hatred, he no longer engages in misconduct through his body, speech, or mind.

"Therefore, brahmin, an angry or irritable person, overcome, excited, and consumed by anger and hatred, does not know nor see what is truly beneficial to himself; he does not know nor see what is truly beneficial to another; and he does not know nor see what is truly beneficial to both.

“It is only when he relinquishes that anger or hatred, that he knows and sees what is truly beneficial to himself; he knows and sees what is truly beneficial to others; and he knows and sees what is truly beneficial to both.

“It is in such a way too, that Extinction (*Nibbāna*) is experienced here and now, being directly visible, immediate, inviting one to come, test, and see for oneself, leading and taking one forward, and to be realized by the wise, by themselves.

c. “Also, brahmin, a deluded person, overcome, excited, and consumed by delusion and his willful ignoring, ends up harming himself, harming others, and harming both, while also feeling mental anguish, which leads him to experience more suffering. But, if he relinquishes that delusion and willful ignoring, he no longer harms himself, nor harms others, nor harms both; thereby he does not feel mental anguish, nor experiences suffering.

“This because, brahmin, a deluded person, overcome, excited, and consumed by delusion and his willful ignorance, engages in misconduct of body, speech, and mind. But, when he relinquishes that delusion and willful ignoring, he no longer engages in misconduct through his body, speech, or mind.

“Therefore, brahmin, a deluded person, overcome, excited, and consumed by delusion and his willful ignorance, does not know nor see what is truly beneficial to himself; he does not know nor see what is truly beneficial to another; and he does not know nor see what is truly beneficial to both.

“It is only when he relinquishes that delusion and willful ignoring, that he knows and sees what is truly beneficial to himself; he knows and sees what is truly beneficial to others; and he knows and sees what is truly beneficial to both.

“It is in such a way too, that Extinction (*Nibbāna*) is experienced here and now, being directly visible, immediate, inviting one to come, test, and see for oneself, leading and taking one forward, and to be realized by the wise, by themselves.”

Then, on becoming delighted while listening to the words spoken by The Blessed One, the brahmin Jāṇussoṇi made the following exclamation with his hands in reverential salutation:

“Magnificent, Venerable sir! Magnificent, Venerable Sir!

“The Blessed One has made The Dhamma clear for me in many ways, as though he turned upright what had been turned upside-down, and thus revealing what was hidden, showing the way to one who was lost, or holding up a lamp in the dark for those with eyesight to see.

“I go to The Blessed One for refuge, and to The Dhamma, and to The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus.

From this day forward, may The Blessed One remember me as a lay disciple who has taken refuge in him, until the end of life."

*56. **Paloka Sutta** (Dwindled)*

At one time, a certain brahmin from a well-known clan approached The Blessed One, and after exchanging friendly greetings with Him, sat down to one side and said:

"Venerable Sir, I have heard this from senior brahmins, the forefathers, the teachers of teachers, that a long time ago, the world was densely populated, with no space to spare between people, with countless villages, towns, and districts.

"Venerable Sir, what is the reason for humans to have dwindled and decreased in number today, whereby now only a few seem to be left in comparison, and similarly the reduction in the number of villages, towns and districts that are far less than before?"

And The Blessed One replied, by saying:

"Brahmin, people today live unrighteously, with greed and lust everywhere, for they are bound by covetousness everywhere they turn, and are thus defeated by their wrong views, filled with anger, which is why they take up arms and sharp weapons, attacking, hurting and killing each other.

"This is the reason for the scarcity in the number of people today, brahmin, whereby the number of humans has dwindled, and only a few seem to be left in comparison, and similarly the reduction in the number of villages, towns, and districts that are far less than before.

"Furthermore, brahmin, because people today live unrighteously, with greed and lust everywhere, for they are bound by covetousness everywhere they turn, and are thus defeated by their wrong views, adequate rain does not come at the right time. As a result, there is famine, lack of food, seeds turn white, and people live on rationed food, and on account of that, many people die.

"Brahmin, this is the reason for humans to have dwindled in number, where only a few seem to be left in comparison, and similarly the reduction in the number of villages, towns, and districts that are far less than before.

"Also, brahmin, because people today live without any moral values nor virtue; with greed everywhere, being bound by covetousness and thus defeated by their wrong views, evil yakkhas, demons, and evil non-human beings are everywhere to be found, on account of which many people suffer and die.

“Brahmin, this is the reason for humans to have dwindled in number, where only a few seem to be left in comparison, and similarly the reduction in the number of villages, towns, and districts that are far less than before.”

Then, that brahmin made the following exclamation with his hands in reverential salutation, as he declared:

“Magnificent, Venerable sir! Magnificent, Venerable sir!

“The Blessed One has made The Dhamma clear to me in many ways! It is as though He turned upright what had been turned upside-down, thus revealing to me what was hidden, showing the way to one who was lost, holding up a lamp in the dark for those with eyesight to see.

“I go to The Blessed One for refuge, and to The Dhamma, and to The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus!

“From this day forward, may The Blessed One kindly remember me as a lay disciple of His, who has taken refuge in Him, until the end of life.”

*57. **Vacchagotta Sutta** (Discourse to Vacchagotta)*

On one occasion, the wandering ascetic Vacchagotta went and approached The Blessed One, and after exchanging friendly greetings with The Teacher, he sat down to one side and said:

“Venerable Sir, I heard that the recluse Gautama had said this:

‘Gifts should be given to me, not to others. Gifts should be given to my disciples and not to the disciples of other sects. Gifts given to me are of much benefit; gifts given to others are not so beneficial. Gifts given to my disciples are of benefit and the gifts given to the disciples of other sects are not beneficial, at all.’

“Venerable Sir, do those who say this state that which has been truly spoken by the recluse Gautama, or are they simply misrepresenting and accusing the recluse Gautama wrongly? Do those who say this speak and explain according to The Dhamma, in a way that would not bring onto them criticism and rebuke from wise individuals, or not?

“We are asking this, Venerable Sir, because we do not wish to be misrepresenting the recluse Gautama.”

And The Blessed One spoke by saying:

“Vacchagotta, those who say:

‘Gifts should be given to me, not to others. Gifts should be given to my disciples and not to the disciples of other sects. Gifts given to me are of much benefit; gifts given to others are not so

beneficial. Gifts given to my disciples are of benefit and the gifts given to the disciples of other sects are not beneficial, at all,' are <u>*not*</u> stating what has been truly spoken by Me; hence they are simply misrepresenting Me with what is untrue and contrary to fact.

"After all, Vaccha, whoever obstructs another from giving or receiving a gift or an offering, creates three obstacles. What three?

"He destroys the possibility for the giver to make merit; he destroys the possibility of gaining the offering for the receiver; and thus, he injures and maims himself through this evil act of obstruction.

"Thus, Vaccha, whoever obstructs another from giving or receiving a gift or an offering, creates three obstacles.

"But, Vaccha, I will tell you this as well –

"Whoever throws away even the dirty water used for the washing of his bowl, cup or saucers into a cesspit or a refuse dump, at the entrance of the village, while reflecting with a heart that is flooded with loving-kindness (*mettā*):

'May all those living beings that are to be sustained with this, benefit from this!'

"Now this itself will accrue much merits, so how much more can be said when given to humans!"

"Yet, I tell you Vaccha, that whatever is given to the one with virtuous behavior is *far* more fruitful than those given to non-virtuous and immoral individuals.

"But even more fruitful than these are gifts offered to those, who have given up five factors and now possess the five other factors.

"And what are the five factors that are given up?

"Intoxication with sense pleasures; anger; sloth and torpor; restlessness and worry; and skeptical doubts. These are the five factors they have given up.

"And what are the five factors that are possessed?

"The possession of abundant virtues, by the one gone beyond The Training.
The collected stability of the mind (*samādhi*), of the one gone beyond The Training.
The wisdom, of the one gone beyond The Training.
The attainment of Full Awakening, by the one gone beyond The Training.
The Knowledge and Vision of Release, of the one gone beyond The Training.

“These are the five factors that they possess.

“It is for this reason that I declare, that gifts offered to those who have given up five factors and now possess the five other factors, are truly *the* most fruitful.

‘The cattle may be pure white or black in color, or maybe red or brown,
They might be spotted, solid-colored, beautiful, or dove colored,
But the best to be born among them is the Bull
That is powerful and mighty, yet tamed and restrained,
The one with the highest authority and formidable speed to lead,
Which is why it is to him that the load is given,
Irrespective of the color of his hide.

In the same manner, among warrior kings,
Brahmins, merchants, householders, or outcastes,
Those who are truly tamed are indeed the very best;
Righteous, virtuous, truthful and endowed with wise inner moral shame.
They are, after all, the only ones who come to the end of the holy life,
By having put an end to death itself.
It is they, who have put down the heavy load,
And done what had to be done, and are now desire-less, taintless, and free.

Gone beyond all thoughts, they are fully extinguished without any grabbing or holding.
These are The Holy Ones, the supreme field of merits,
The very best to be offered your heartfelt gifts.

But the majority that is dull-witted,
And all those without true understanding or insight,
Give their gifts to the undeserving and unappeased,
The ones who are genuinely un-holy,
While those givers, in their blindness, keep ignoring
The Holy Ones, sitting close by.

As for those with eyes to see, who revere the appeased and the wise,
Their faith soon becomes established in The Tathāgata.
Which is why they either go to the heavenly realms, or are born into good families here,
While gradually advancing and making their way,
To the state reached only by the wise,
With their attainment of Nibbāna Supreme.’

58. ***Tikaṇṇa Sutta*** *(Discourse to Tikaṇṇa)*

At one time, the brahmin Tikaṇṇa approached The Blessed One, and after exchanging friendly greetings with Him, he sat to one side and began extolling the three Vedas in the presence of The Blessed One, speaking in praise of those brahmins as masters of the Vedas' threefold knowledge.

Then The Blessed One said:

"But brahmin, in what way do the brahmins describe a 'brahmin' as being a master of the Vedas' threefold knowledge?"

The brahmin Tikaṇṇa then said:

"Here, Venerable Sir, the brahmin should be of good birth on both sides, with his maternal and paternal sides being unblemished and pure in their brahmin lineage, as far back as the seventh generation. He should also be a learned preserver and reciter, able to repeat the sequence of words and sounds, the hymns of the three Vedas, together with the rites and rituals, with their vocabularies, etymology, phonology, and histories as the fifth. He should be skilled in their philosophy and grammar too. He should also know how to interpret the marks of a Great Man.

"So, Venerable Sir, it is in this way that the brahmins describe a 'brahmin,' as being a master of the Vedas' threefold knowledge."

And The Blessed One said:

"But, brahmin, to be a master of the Threefold Knowledge in the Noble One's Dhamma and Discipline is understood quite differently than the one described by the brahmins."

"Then, tell me, Venerable Sir, how such a master of the threefold Knowledge in the Noble One's Dhamma and Discipline is understood to be different than the one described by the brahmins. It would be beneficial and good if Master Gautama taught me The Dhamma in such a way, that I may clearly know how one becomes a master of the threefold Knowledge in The Noble One's discipline."

"Then, brahmin, listen carefully to what I shall say."

"Yes, Sir," the brahmin Tikaṇṇa said, and The Blessed One continued speaking:

"Here, brahmin, by secluding his mind from sensual pleasures and unwholesome states, the Bhikkhu enters upon and dwells in the first *jhāna*, which is accompanied by thinking and planning, along with joy and pleasure, which manifest when he is appropriately in seclusion.

"Further, with the stilling of thinking and planning, the Bhikkhu enters upon and dwells in the second *jhāna*, which brings about self-confidence and unification of mind, but in the absence of

thinking and planning, while the joy and pleasure continue in him due to the deepening of his collected stability of mind (*samādhi*).

"Further, with the fading away of joy too, he dwells in equanimity, remaining mindful and fully aware, while still feeling pleasure with the body, as he enters upon and dwells in the third *jhāna*, on account of which the noble ones declare:

'He has indeed a pleasant disposition; the one who has equanimity, while being mindful.'

"Further, by moving beyond both pleasure and pain altogether, and with the previous disappearance of joy and resistance, he enters upon and dwells in the fourth *jhāna*, which has neither pain nor pleasure, but the purity of mindfulness that is pervading, along with continued deepening of equanimity.

a. "In this manner, with his mind collected and purified, bright, unblemished, freed from the contaminants, nimble, malleable, strong, steady, and attained to security, he then directs it to the knowledge of the recollection of his past lives. Soon, he remembers his numerous past lives, that is, one birth, two births, three births, four births, five births, ten births, twenty births, thirty, forty, fifty births, a hundred births, a thousand births, a hundred thousand births, many eons of world-contractions, many eons of world expansions, many eons of world contractions and expansions, recalling thus:

'There, I was so named, of such a family, with such an appearance; such was my food and sustenance; such were my experiences of pleasure and pain; such as my lifespan; and after passing away from there, I was reborn elsewhere, and there too, I was so named, of such a family, with such an appearance; such was my food and sustenance; such were my experiences of pleasure and pain; and such was my life-span; and passing away from there, I was reborn here.'

"This, brahmin, is the first true knowledge attained by such a Bhikkhu, whose ignorance is banished with true knowledge having arisen; where darkness is expelled and light has arisen, as he lives heedful, diligent, committed, and unrelentingly resolute.

b. "Then, as his mind becomes further and further collected, stable, purified, bright, freed from the contaminants and unblemished, nimble, malleable, strong, steady, and attained to security, such a Bhikkhu then directs it to the knowledge of the death and rebirth destinations of beings. Thus, with the Divine Eye, which is superior to those of human beings, he sees beings dying and being reborn into exalted or un-exalted states, becoming beautiful or ugly, fortunate or unfortunate in their new becomings. He sees and knows how beings die and are reborn into different states according to their actions thus:

'These beings who did not live with virtue in body, speech, and mind, being disrespectful of the Noble Ones, wrong in their views, on account of those wrong views in their actions, upon the dissolution of their body, after death, were reborn into a state of deprivation, in a bad

destination, in evil states, even in hell. But these worthy beings who lived with virtue in body, speech, and mind, who were respectful of the Noble Ones, right in their views, on account of those right views in their actions, on the dissolution of the body, after death, are now reborn in a good destination, even in the heavenly world.'

"In this manner, with the Divine Eye, which is superior to those of human beings, he sees beings passing away and being reborn into exalted or un-exalted states, becoming beautiful or ugly, landing into fortunate or miserable situations and surrounding. He thus sees and knows clearly how beings die and are reborn into different states according to their intentional actions (*kammā*)."

"This is the second true knowledge attained by such a Bhikkhu, whose ignorance is banished with true knowledge having arisen; where darkness is expelled and light has arisen, as he lives heedful, diligent, committed, and unrelentingly resolute.

c. "Then, with his collected mind thus purified, bright, freed from the contaminants and unblemished, being so nimble, malleable, strong, steady, and attained to security, the Bhikkhu directs it to the knowledge of the destruction of the contaminants.

"In this manner, he directly knows and sees as it actually is: '*This is suffering*.'
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the origin of suffering.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the cessation of suffering.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the Path leading to the cessation of suffering.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'These are the contaminants (āsavas).'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the origin of the contaminants.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the cessation of the contaminants.'*
He directly sees and knows as it actually is: *'This is the Path leading to the cessation of the contaminants.'*

"And at that moment, when the Bhikkhu knows and sees thus, his mind becomes fully liberated from the contaminant of sensual desire, from the contaminant of becoming, and from the contaminant of ignorance.

"When thus liberated, there arises the knowledge in him: *'It is now finally Released!'*
"And he directly knows:

'Birth is now completely destroyed,
The Holy Life has been lived to its end!
What had to be done, is done and finished!
There is nothing more for me to wish for or do,
Nor any state of becoming waiting for me.'

"And this is the third true knowledge, brahmin, that is attained by such a Bhikkhu, whose ignorance is banished with true knowledge having arisen; where darkness is expelled and light has arisen, as he lives heedful, diligent, committed, and unrelentingly resolute."

'The collected mind of the virtuous meditator, steady, alert and unshakeable,
The Secure and Wise One, dispelling the darkness with The Threefold Knowledges,
Conqueror of death, clinging to nothing,
He now stands benefiting both Devas and humans,
Bearing His very last body, dwelling in wisdom, it is Gautama whom he worships.

Remembering His previous births,
Seeing the whereabouts of beings between the heavens and hells,
This is The True Sage, who having destroyed birth,
Possesses The Threefold knowledges.

It is in this way that one is understood to be a true Brahmin,
A master of The Threefold Knowledges,
According to The Noble One's Dhamma and Discipline,
<u>Not</u> the one described by those who go on chanting or singing hymns.'

"So, it is in this way, brahmin, that one is considered to be a master of The Threefold Knowledges in The Noble One's Dhamma and Discipline, and as you can see, it is quite *different* from the one described by the brahmins."

Then, once this was spoken by The Blessed One, the brahmin Tikaṇṇa exclaimed with delight:

"Indeed Master Gautama, indeed!

"Blessed One, surely, I now see how the brahmin who is looked upon as a master of the three Vedas as described by the brahmins, is quite *different* indeed, from the one considered to be a Master of The Threefold Knowledges within The Noble One's Dhamma and Discipline!

"I also see, Master Gautama, that the brahmins' description of a brahmin as a master of the Vedas' threefold knowledge is *not* even worth one-sixteenth of the one who is considered to be a true Master of The Threefold Knowledges within The Noble One's Dhamma and Discipline.

"It is truly, Magnificent, Venerable sir! Quite remarkable and amazing indeed, Venerable sir!

"The Blessed One has made The Dhamma clear to me in many ways! It is as though He turned upright what had been turned upside-down, and revealed to me what was hidden; showing the way to one who was lost; holding up a lamp in the dark for those with eyesight to see.

"I go to The Blessed One for refuge, and to The Dhamma, and to The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus!

“From this day forward, may The Blessed One kindly remember me as a lay disciple of His, who has taken refuge in Him, until the end of life.”

*59. **Jāṇussoṇi Sutta** (Discourse to Jāṇussoṇi)*

At one time, the brahmin Jāṇussoṇi went and approached The Blessed One, and after exchanging friendly greetings, he sat down to one side and asked:

“Bhante, is it appropriate to consider that those who want to make a sacrifice, offer milk rice, or make a generous gift, should do so by giving such an offering to a brahmin, who is regarded as a master of the Vedas’ threefold knowledge?”

And The Blessed One said:

“First, brahmin, how do you understand what the brahmins describe as a ‘brahmin,’ who is a master of the Vedas’ threefold knowledge?”

“Here, Venerable Sir, the brahmin should be of good birth on both sides, with his maternal and paternal sides being unblemished and pure in their brahmin lineage, as far back as the seventh generation. He should also be a learned preserver and reciter, able to repeat the sequence of words and sounds, the hymns of the three Vedas, together with the rites and rituals, with their vocabularies, etymology, phonology, and histories as the fifth. He should be skilled in the philosophy and grammar too. He should also know how to interpret the marks of a Great Man.

“So, Venerable Sir, it is in this way that the brahmins describe a brahmin, as being a master of the Vedas ’threefold knowledge.”

“But, brahmin, being a master of the Threefold Knowledge in The Noble One’s Dhamma and Discipline, is understood quite differently from the one described by the brahmins.”

And the brahmin Jāṇussoṇi replied, by saying:

“Then, please, could you tell me, Venerable Sir, how such a master of the Threefold Knowledge in the Noble One’s Dhamma and Discipline, differs from the one described by the brahmins. This because, it would be really beneficial and good, if Master Gautama taught me The Dhamma in such a way, that I may clearly know how one becomes a master of the Threefold Knowledge in The Noble One’s Dispensation.”

“Then, brahmin, listen carefully to what I shall say.”

“Yes, Sir,” the brahmin Jāṇussoṇi said, and The Blessed One continued speaking:

“Here, brahmin, by secluding his mind from sensual pleasures and unwholesome states, the Bhikkhu enters upon and dwells in the first *jhāna*, which is accompanied by thinking and planning, along with joy and pleasure, which manifest when he is appropriately in seclusion.

“Further, with the stilling of thinking and planning, the Bhikkhu enters upon and dwells in the second *jhāna*, which brings about self-confidence and unification of mind, but in the absence of thinking and planning, while the joy and pleasure continue in him due to the deepening of his collected stability of mind (*samādhi*).

“Further, with the fading away of joy too, he dwells in equanimity, remaining mindful and fully aware, while still feeling pleasure with the body, as he enters upon and dwells in the third *jhāna*, on account of which the noble ones declare:

‘He has indeed a pleasant disposition; the one who has equanimity, while being mindful.’

“Further, by moving beyond both pleasure and pain altogether, and with the previous disappearance of joy and resistance, he enters upon and dwells in the fourth *jhāna*, which has neither pain nor pleasure, but the purity of mindfulness that is pervading, along with continued deepening of equanimity.

a. “In this manner, with his mind collected and purified, bright, unblemished, freed from the contaminants, nimble, malleable, strong, steady, and attained to security, he then directs it to the knowledge of the recollection of his past lives. Soon, he remembers his numerous past lives, that is, one birth, two births, three births, four births, five births, ten births, twenty births, thirty, forty, fifty births, a hundred births, a thousand births, a hundred thousand births, many eons of world-contractions, many eons of world expansions, many eons of world contractions and expansions, recalling thus:

‘There, I was so named, of such a family, with such an appearance; such was my food and sustenance; such were my experiences of pleasure and pain; such as my lifespan; and after passing away from there, I was reborn elsewhere, and there too, I was so named, of such a family, with such an appearance; such was my food and sustenance; such were my experiences of pleasure and pain; and such was my life-span; and passing away from there, I was reborn here.’

“This, brahmin, is the first true knowledge attained by such a Bhikkhu, whose ignorance is banished with true knowledge having arisen; where darkness is expelled and light has arisen, as he lives heedful, diligent, committed, and unrelentingly resolute.

b. “Then, as his mind becomes further and further collected, stable, purified, bright, freed from the contaminants and unblemished, nimble, malleable, strong, steady, and attained to security, such a Bhikkhu then directs it to the knowledge of the death and rebirth destinations of beings. Thus, with the Divine Eye, which is superior to those of human beings, he sees beings dying and being reborn into exalted or un-exalted states, becoming beautiful or ugly, fortunate or

unfortunate, in their new becomings. He sees and knows how beings die and are reborn into different states according to their actions thus:

'These beings who did not live with virtue in body, speech, and mind, being disrespectful of the Noble Ones, wrong in their views, on account of those wrong views in their actions, upon the dissolution of their body, after death, were reborn into a state of deprivation, in a bad destination, in evil states, even in hell. But these worthy beings who lived with virtue in body, speech, and mind, who were respectful of the Noble Ones, right in their views, on account of those right views in their actions, upon the dissolution of the body, after death, are now reborn in a good destination, even in the heavenly world.'

"In this manner, with the Divine Eye, which is superior to those of human beings, he sees beings passing away and being reborn into exalted or un-exalted states, becoming beautiful or ugly, landing into fortunate or miserable situations and surrounding. He thus sees and knows clearly how beings die and are reborn into different states according to their intentional actions (*kammā*)."

"This is the second true knowledge attained by such a Bhikkhu, whose ignorance is banished with true knowledge having arisen; where darkness is expelled and light has arisen, as he lives heedful, diligent, committed, and unrelentingly resolute.

c. "Then, with his collected mind thus purified, bright, freed from the contaminants and unblemished, being so nimble, malleable, strong, steady, and attained to security, the Bhikkhu directs it to the knowledge of the destruction of the contaminants.

"In this manner, he directly knows and sees as it actually is: '*This is suffering*.'
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the origin of suffering.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the cessation of suffering.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the Path leading to the cessation of suffering.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'These are the contaminants (āsavas).'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the origin of the contaminants.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the cessation of the contaminants.'*
He directly sees and knows as it actually is: *'This is the Path leading to the cessation of the contaminants.'*

"And at that moment, when the Bhikkhu knows and sees thus, his mind becomes fully liberated from the contaminant of sensual desire, from the contaminant of becoming, and from the contaminant of ignorance.

"When thus liberated, there arises the knowledge in him: *'It is now finally Released!'*

"And he directly knows:

'Birth is now completely destroyed,
The Holy Life has been lived to its end!
What had to be done, is done and finished!
There is nothing more for me to wish for or do,
Nor any state of becoming waiting for me.'

"And this is the third true knowledge, brahmin, that is attained by such a Bhikkhu, whose ignorance is banished with true knowledge having arisen; where darkness is expelled and light has arisen, as he lives heedful, diligent, committed, and unrelentingly resolute."

'The One Perfected through His virtue;
Whose mind is so focused and unshakable,
Dwells in contented serenity,
The Master of His mind abides totally untouched by anything.

Remembering His previous births,
Seeing the whereabouts of beings between the heavens and hells,
This is The True Sage, who having destroyed birth,
Possesses The Threefold knowledges.

It is in this way that one is understood to be a true Brahmin,
A master of The Threefold Knowledges,
According to The Noble One's Dhamma and Discipline,
<u>Not</u> the one described by those who go on chanting or singing hymns.'

"So, it is in this way, brahmin, that one is considered to be a master of The Threefold Knowledges in The Noble One's Dhamma and Discipline, and as you can see, it is quite *different* from the one described by the brahmins."

Then, once this was spoken by The Blessed One, the brahmin Jāṇussoṇi exclaimed with delight:

"Indeed Master Gautama, indeed!

"Blessed One, surely, I now see how the brahmin who is looked upon as a master of the three Vedas, as described by the brahmins, is quite *different* indeed, from the one considered to be a Master of The Threefold Knowledges within The Noble One's Dhamma and Discipline!

"I also see, Master Gautama, that the brahmins' description of a brahmin as a master of the Vedas' threefold knowledge is *not* even worth one-sixteenth of the one who is considered to be a true Master of The Threefold Knowledges within The Noble One's Dhamma and Discipline.

"It is truly, Magnificent, Venerable sir! Quite remarkable and amazing indeed, Venerable sir!

"The Blessed One has made The Dhamma clear to me in many ways! It is as though He turned upright what had been turned upside-down, revealing to me what was hidden; showing the way to one who was lost; holding up a lamp in the dark for those with eyesight to see.

"I go to The Blessed One for refuge, and to The Dhamma, and to The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus!

"From this day forward, may The Blessed One kindly remember me as a lay disciple of His, who has taken refuge in Him, until the end of life."

60. ***Saṅgārava Sutta*** *(Discourse to Saṅgārava)*

Once, the young brahmin Saṅgārava approached The Blessed One, and after exchanging friendly greetings with Him, he sat down to one side and said:

"Venerable Sir, I have considered this:

'We brahmins should make sacrifices and make others do sacrifices too. The reason for this, of course, is that it is our conviction that those who do the sacrifices and those who participate in such sacrifices, engage in accruing numerous merits that extend to more individuals than just themselves.

But those who go forth from this or other sect and become thus homeless, they would be merely taming, controlling, and extinguishing their own passions, leading only to their own liberation, at best. Hence, by going forth, they are only seeking wisdom for themselves and therefore making merits for <u>only</u> themselves.'

And The Blessed One replied by saying:

"Well, brahmin, I will now question you on this, and you may reply as you wish.

"Here, brahmin, The Tathāgata arises in the world, an Arahant, Perfectly Awakened, endowed with true knowledge and conduct, The Fortunate One, The Knower of existence, The Matchless Tamer of those to be tamed, The Teacher of both Devas and humans, The Awakened and Blessed One.

"He then declares:

'Come! This is the Path. This is the method. It is by coming to this Path and method that I have understood the noble end of the Holy Life and therein abide, Myself having realized it with direct knowledge.

'Come! And if you also practice diligently as I did, then this Path and method will allow you to reach the noble end of The Holy Life as well, which you too, through <u>your own</u> direct experience and full understanding, will come to know and realize, for yourself!'

“In this manner, The Teacher teaches and others come to that Path and method. Now, with this being the case, is this not then for the benefit of hundreds, for the benefit of thousands, itself? Is it not, therefore, for the benefit of countless other beings?

“And with this being the case, then, would the merits to be gained by the deliberate act of going forth, amount to be only for the benefit of a *single* individual, or for innumerable and countless other beings as well, besides oneself?”

The brahmin Saṅgārava then replied by saying:

“Venerable Sir, given the way you have just explained it, I must admit that the merits to be gained by the deliberate act of going forth are truly for the benefit of innumerable and countless more beings!”

When this was said, the Venerable Ānanda said to the brahmin Saṅgārava:

“Brahmin, of these two methods, which one is less prominent, less troublesome, while the other being more fruitful and more effective?

And the young brahmin Saṅgārava replied to the Venerable Ānanda by saying:

“As I revere and applaud Master Gotama, so also I revere and applaud Venerable Ānanda.”

For the second time, the Venerable Ānanda said:

“Brahmin, I do not ask you which one of us here is revered and applauded. Instead, brahmin, I ask you which of these two methods is less prominent, less troublesome, while the other being more fruitful and more effective?”

And for the second time, the young brahmin Saṅgārava said to Venerable Ānanda:

“As I revere and applaud Master Gotama, so also I revere and applaud Venerable Ānanda.”

And for the third time, the Venerable Ānanda said:

“Brahmin, I do not ask you which one of us here is revered and applauded. Instead, brahmin, I ask you which of these two methods is less prominent, less troublesome, while the other being more fruitful and more effective?”

And for the third time, the brahmin Saṅgārava repeated to Venerable Ānanda:

“As I revere and applaud Master Gotama, so also I revere and applaud Venerable Ānanda.”

At this, the thought occurred to The Blessed One:

'The brahmin Saṅgārava is evading this legitimate question put to him by Ānanda. What if I release him from this tense situation?'

So, The Blessed One asked the young brahmin Saṅgārava another question:

"While attending the meeting at the royal palace in the presence of the Great King today, what was the topic of discussion, brahmin?"

"Venerable Sir, the topic of conversation was this:

'In the past, although there were fewer Bhikkhus, yet more of them displayed superhuman and psychic powers. But today, even though there are many more Bhikkhus, only a few among them are able to display superhuman and psychic powers.'

"This, Venerable Sir, was the topic of discussion as I sat at the meeting held at the royal palace today, in the presence of the Great King."

"Brahmin, there are these three types of miracles. What three?

"The miracle of psychic powers; the miracle of knowing the hearts and minds of others, along with their intentions; and the miracle of instruction.

a. "And what, brahmin, is the miracle of psychic powers?

"Here, brahmin, someone uses various forms of psychic powers such as, while being one, he becomes many, and becoming many he reverts back to being one; he appears and disappears without any obstructions, moving through walls unhindered, through solid embankments and rocks, as though passing through space; he dives into the earth and comes out of it as though it were liquid; he walks on water as though it were solid ground; while sitting cross-legged, he travels in space like a small or a large bird; with his bare hand, he touches the moon and the sun that are so powerful, and goes on exercising and wielding his powers, unobstructed, as far as the Brahmā world.

"This, brahmin, is the miracle of psychic powers.

b. "And what, brahmin, is the miracle of knowing the hearts and minds of others, along with their intentions?

"Here, brahmin, someone through the use of a sign (*nimitta*) as his base, understands and reveals:

'Your mind is in such and such a state, and it is so and not otherwise; these are the thoughts you are having and pondering, and these are your intentions.'

"In this manner, he declares what he sees with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that would be of no use, for his penetrating sight would still remain accurate and true.

"Furthermore, someone else without the use of a sign, but having the capacity and possibility to hear the voices or thoughts of other humans, non-humans, and even *Devas*, similarly makes the declaration:

'Your mind is in such and such a state, and it is so and not otherwise; these are the thoughts you are having and pondering, and these are your intentions.'

"In this manner, he declares what he sees with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that would be of no use, for his knowledge of these facts would still remain accurate and true.

"Further, someone else without the use of a sign, and without having the capacity or possibility to hear the voices of other humans, non-humans, or *Devas*, is one who feels the reverberations of thoughts while another is thinking and pondering them, and as this is going on, he penetrates the other's heart and mind through his concentrated mind and thereby declares:

'Your mind is in such and such a state, and it is so and not otherwise; these are the thoughts you are having and pondering, and these are your intentions.'

"In this manner, he declares what he sees with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that would be of no use, for his seeing would still remain accurate and true.

"Furthermore, someone else without the use of a sign, without having the capacity or possibility to hear the voices of other humans, non-humans, or *Devas*, and without feeling the reverberations of thoughts that another is thinking and pondering, but instead, having himself attained a collected and stable state of heart that does not include thinking and pondering, directs his mind, while encompassing the other's mind. As a result, he comes to know and understand:

'This person is having such and such mental preparations that are priming him in this way, to the point where his next thought will be this or that!'

"In this manner, he declares what he sees with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that would be of no use, for his penetrative sight and knowing would still remain accurate and true.

This, brahmin, is the miracle of knowing the hearts and minds of others, along with their intentions.

c. "And what, brahmin, is the miracle of instruction?

Here, brahmin, someone advises another:

'Think in <u>this</u> manner, do not think in that manner!
Pay attention and attend to <u>these</u> things, and do not pay attention or attend to those things, over there!
Get rid of and abandon <u>these</u> things and develop those other qualities, and then abide in them.'

"This then, brahmin, is the miracle of instruction.

"Now, brahmin, among these three miracles, which one would you say is your favorite?

1. "Well, Venerable Sir, as far as the first miracle of psychic powers, where someone uses various forms of psychic powers such, as while being one, he becomes many, and on becoming many he reverts back to being one; where he can appear and disappear without any obstructions, moving through walls unhindered, through solid embankments and rocks, as though passing through space; where he dives into the earth and comes out of it as though it were liquid; he walks on water as though it were solid ground; while sitting cross-legged, he could travel in space like a small or a large bird; and with his bare hand, he is able to touch even the moon and the sun that are so powerful, and goes on exercising and wielding his powers, unobstructed, as far as the Brahmā world;

"Well, this to me, Master Gautama, seems like it could be a magical trick.

2. "And with the other miracle, Venerable Sir, whereby someone through the use of a sign (*nimitta*) as his base, understands and declares to another:

'Your mind is in such and such a state, and it is so and not otherwise; these are the thoughts you are having and pondering, and these are your intentions.'

"In this way, declaring what he sees with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that would be of no use, for his seeing would still remain accurate and true;

"Well, this too, Master Gautama, seems to me that it could be a magical trick.

3. "As for the other miracle, Venerable Sir, whereby someone else, without the use of a sign, but having the capacity and possibility to hear the voices or thoughts of other humans, non-humans, or even *Devas*, understands and declares to another:

'Your mind is in such and such a state, and it is so and not otherwise; these are the thoughts you are having and pondering, and these are your intentions.'

"In this manner, declaring to others what he sees with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that would be of no use, for his seeing would still remain accurate and true;

"This too, then, Venerable Sir, seems to me that it could be a magical trick.

4. "And with the other miracle, Venerable Sir, whereby someone else who, without using some kind of a sign, and without having the capacity or possibility to hear the voices of other humans, non-humans, or *Devas*, feels the reverberations of thoughts as another is thinking and pondering, while penetrating the other's heart and mind through his concentrated mind, and thereby declares:

'Your mind is in such and such a state, and it is so and not otherwise; these are the thoughts you are having and pondering, and these are your intentions.'

"In this manner, telling others of what he sees with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that would be of no use, for his seeing would still remain accurate and true;

"Here, too, Venerable Sir, I think one could do this by some magical trick as well.

5. "And with the other miracle, Venerable Sir, whereby someone else without the use of a sign, without having the capacity or possibility to hear the voices of other humans, non-humans or *Devas*, and without feeling the reverberations of thoughts as the other is thinking and pondering, but instead, having himself attained a collected and stable state of the heart that does not include thinking and pondering, he directs his mind while encompassing the other's mind. As a result, he comes to know and understand:

'This person is having such and such mental preparations that are priming him in this way, to the point where his next thought will be this or that!'

"In this manner, he goes on declaring what he sees with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that would be of no use, for his seeing would still remain accurate and true;

"Well, this too, Venerable Sir, seems like it could be a magical trick.

6. "However, the third miracle, Venerable Sir, where someone advises another thus:

'Think in <u>this</u> manner, do not think in that manner!
Pay attention and attend to <u>these</u> things, and do not pay attention or attend to those things, over there!
Get rid of and abandon <u>these</u> things, and develop those other qualities, and then abide in them.'

"*This* happens to be it for me, Master Gautama! The miracle of instruction *is* my favorite, among all the three miracles.

“It is wonderful, Master Gotama! How brilliantly these words were expressed by Master Gautama! For, we are confident that Master Gautama is capable of performing each of these three miracles!

“Because, surely, Master Gautama possesses and uses the various forms of psychic powers mentioned, such as being one, He becomes many, and becoming many He reverts to being one; He appears and disappears without any obstructions, moving through walls, embankments and rocks unhindered, as though passing through space; He dives into the earth and comes out of it as though it were water; He walks on water as though it were solid ground; while sitting cross-legged, He travels in space like a small or a large bird; He touches the moon and the sun, that are so powerful, with His bare hand, thus wielding His powers as far as the Brahmā world.

“Also, He is able to apply the miracle of knowing the hearts and minds of others, along with their intentions, through the use of a sign (*nimitta*) as his base, whereby he understands and declares:

‘Your mind is in such and such a state, and it is so and not otherwise; these are the thoughts you are having and pondering, and these are your intentions.’

“In this manner, He declares what he sees with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that would be of no use, for His seeing would still remain accurate and true.

“Furthermore, without the use of a sign, but having the capacity and possibility to hear the voices or thoughts of other humans, non-humans or *Devas*, Master Gautama makes the declaration:

‘Your mind is in such and such a state, and it is so and not otherwise; these are the thoughts you are having and pondering, and these are your intentions.’

“In this manner, Master Gautama declares what He sees with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that would be of no use, for His seeing would still remain accurate and true.

“Furthermore, without the use of a sign, and without having the capacity or possibility to hear the voices of other humans, non-humans, or *Devas*, He feels the reverberations of thoughts as another is thinking and pondering them, while penetrating the other’s heart and mind through His concentrated mind, and thereby Master Gautama can declare:

‘Your mind is in such and such a state, and it is so and not otherwise; these are the thoughts you are having and pondering, and these are your intentions.’

“In this manner, He declares what He sees with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that would be of no use, for His seeing would still remain accurate and true.

“Furthermore, without the use of a sign, and without having the capacity or possibility to hear the voices of other humans, non-humans or *Devas*, and without feeling the reverberations of thoughts as the other is thinking and pondering them, instead, having Himself attained a collected and stable state of the heart that does not include thinking and pondering, He directs His mind while encompassing the other’s mind, and thus Master Gautama knows and understands:

‘This person is having such and such mental preparations that are priming him in this way, to the point where his next thought will be this or that!’

“In this manner, He declares what he sees with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that would be of no use, for His seeing would still remain accurate and true.

“In addition, Master Gautama, while using the third miracle which He obviously possesses, advises his students:

‘Think in <u>this</u> manner, do not think in that manner!
Pay attention and attend to <u>these</u> things, and do not pay attention or attend to those things, over there!
Get rid of and abandon <u>these</u> things, and develop those other qualities, and then abide in them.’

However, The Blessed One replied to the brahmin Saṅgārava’s comments, by saying:

“Brahmin, even though you have spoken words that were not heartfelt or authentic at all, through the means of your flattery, which were therefore intended to be insulting to Me, I will, nevertheless, give you the answer.

“It is indeed a fact, for I *do* possess and *can* use the various forms of psychic powers mentioned, such as while being one, I can become many, and having become many, I can revert back to being one; I appear and disappear without any obstructions, moving through walls unhindered, through solid and impenetrable embankments and rocks, as though passing through space; I dive into the earth and come out of it as though it were liquid water; I walk on water as though it were solid ground; while sitting cross-legged, I can travel in space like a small or a large bird; and with My bare hand, I can touch the moon and the sun that are so powerful, thus wielding My powers unobstructed as far as the Brahmā world itself!

“Also, I am able to apply the miracle of knowing the hearts and minds of others, along with their intentions, through the use of a sign (*nimitta*) as My base, whereby I understand and declare:

‘Your mind is in such and such a state, and it is so and not otherwise; these are the thoughts you are having and pondering, and these are your intentions.’

“In this manner, I declare what I see with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that is of no use, for My seeing would still remain accurate and true.

“Furthermore, without the use of a sign, but having the capacity and possibility to hear the voices or thoughts of other humans, non-humans or *Devas*, I make the declaration:

‘Your mind is in such and such a state, and it is so and not otherwise; these are the thoughts you are having and pondering, and these are your intentions.’

“In this manner, I declare what I see with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that is of no use, for My seeing would still remain accurate and true.

“Furthermore, without the use of a sign, and without having the capacity or possibility to hear the voices of other humans, non-humans, or *Devas*, I feel the reverberations of thoughts as another is thinking and pondering them, while penetrating the other’s heart and mind through My concentrated mind, whereby I can declare:

‘Your mind is in such and such a state, and it is so and not otherwise; these are the thoughts you are having and pondering, and these are your intentions.’

“In this manner, I declare what I see with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that is of no use, for My seeing would still remain accurate and true.

“Furthermore, without the use of a sign, and without having the capacity or possibility to hear the voices of other humans, non-humans or *Devas*, and without feeling the reverberations of thoughts as the other is thinking and pondering them, but instead, having Myself attained a collected and stable state of the heart that does not include thinking and pondering, I direct My mind while encompassing the other’s mind, wherein I know and understand:

‘This person is having such and such mental preparations that are priming him in this way, to the point where his next thought will be this or that!’

“In this manner, I declare what I see with accuracy and certainty, and no matter what others say to deny or conceal these facts, all that is of no use, for My seeing would still remain accurate and true.

“In addition, while using the third miracle, I advise My students:

‘Think in <u>this</u> manner, do not think in that manner!
Pay attention and attend to <u>these</u> things, and do not pay attention or attend to those things, over there!
Get rid of and abandon <u>these</u> things, and develop those other qualities, and then abide in them.’”

And the brahmin Saṅgārava then exclaimed, in astonishment:

“But, Master Gotama, could there be even one other Bhikkhu, who is capable of performing all these three miracles, other than Master Gotama?”

“Brahmin, there is not just one hundred, two hundred, three hundred, four hundred, or five hundred of My disciples who are now capable of preforming these feats, but many *many* more, indeed, who truly possess these miraculous abilities as well.”

“But where are these Bhikkhus currently residing, Master Gautama?”

“Look around you, brahmin, they are *here*, in this same Saṅgha of Bhikkhus!”

Then, on hearing these words spoken to him by The Blessed One Himself, the young brahmin Saṅgārava exclaimed in total delight:

“It is truly magnificent, Venerable sir! Quite remarkable and amazing indeed, Venerable sir!

“The Blessed One has made The Dhamma clear to me in many ways! It is as though He turned upright what had been turned upside-down, and revealed to me what was hidden; showing the way to one who was lost; holding up a lamp in the dark for those with eyesight to see.

“I go to The Blessed One for refuge, and to The Dhamma, and to The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus!

“From this day forward, may The Blessed One kindly remember me as a lay disciple of His, who has taken refuge in Him, until the end of life.”

AN III

Suttas 61-70

Mahā Vagga

"The Greater Section"

61. ***Titthāyatanadi Sutta*** *(Beliefs of Sectarians)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three beliefs held by various sectarians, which when exposed to scrutiny, questioned, and cross-examined by those considered to be wise, quickly collapse, for they get recognized as ways to drive one to give up striving in The Holy Life, encouraging and leading the person to become carelessly negligent.

Now, what are these three?

a. There are some recluses and brahmins who hold the view that says:

'Whatever someone happens to experience, whether pleasant, painful, or neutral, all that is simply the result of actions they have done in the past.'

b. There are some other recluses and brahmins who hold the view that says:

'Whatever someone happens to experience, whether pleasant, painful, or neutral, all that is the result of some 'Almighty', 'Supreme Being' or 'Creator God.'

c. There are some recluses and brahmins who hold the view that says:

'Whatever someone happens to experience, whether pleasant, painful, or neutral, all that is arbitrary, simply taking place randomly and on account of pure chance, with no reason, meaning, or cause behind it, whatsoever.'

aa. Here, Bhikkhus, I went and approached those recluses and brahmins who hold the view, that asserts the belief:

'Whatever someone happens to experience, whether pleasant, painful, or neutral, all that is simply the result of actions they have done in the past,' and I asked them –

"Venerable sirs, is it true that you are of the view, that whatever someone happens to experience, whether pleasant, painful, or neutral, all that is simply the result of actions they have done in the past?'

When asked thus, they admitted and affirmed it.

Then, I challenged them with the rebuke:

"But venerable sirs, do you destroy life, steal or take what is not given, indulge in sex, tell lies, slander, use harsh words, use idle chatter, desire and covet others' possessions, or bear anger and hatred in your hearts, and hold wrong views, all as a result of actions done in the past?"

In hearing this, they all fell silent.

Now, Bhikkhus, you must understand that all those who fall back on the belief and wrong view that what they experience is nothing but the result of the actions done in the past, are themselves negligent, for they do not even have the wish, let alone the interest and effort, for what should and should not be done.

So, because of their confusion and perplexity, being uncertain and not knowing as to what should and should not be done, those recluses and brahmins live while being unguarded in their behavior through body, speech, and mind.

And since these people are thus unable to hold true to the values of improving and developing oneself in The Holy Life, all those recluses and brahmins do not guard their minds, and therefore do not deserve the title of a 'recluse,' at all.

Bhikkhus, this is the first rebuke made to those recluses and brahmins who hold such a doctrine based on wrong views.

bb. Then, Bhikkhus, I went and approached those recluses and brahmins who hold the view, that asserts the belief:

'Whatever someone happens to experience, whether pleasant, painful, or neutral, all that is the result of some 'Almighty', 'Supreme Being', or 'Creator God,' and I asked them –

"Venerable sirs, is it true that you are of the view, that whatever someone happens to experience, whether pleasant, painful, or neutral, all that is the result of some 'Almighty', 'Supreme Being', or 'Creator God'?'

And when asked thus, they admitted and affirmed it.

Then, I challenged them with the rebuke:

"But venerable sirs, do you destroy life, steal and take what is not given, indulge in sex, tell lies, slander, use harsh words, use idle chatter, desire and covet others' possessions, or bear anger and hatred in your hearts, and hold wrong views, all because of such an 'Almighty' , 'Supreme Being', or 'Creator God,' who makes you engage in such behaviors?"

In hearing this, they all fell silent.

Now, Bhikkhus, you must understand that all those who fall back on the belief and wrong view that what they experience is nothing but the will and decision of some 'Almighty', 'Supreme Being', or 'Creator God,' are themselves negligent, for they do not even have the wish, let alone the interest and effort, for what should and should not be done.

So, because of their confusion and perplexity, being uncertain and not knowing as to what should and should not be done, those recluses and brahmins live while being unguarded in their behavior through body, speech, and mind.

And since these people are thus unable to hold true to the values of improving and developing oneself in The Holy Life, all those recluses and brahmins do not guard their minds, and therefore do not deserve the title of a 'recluse,' at all.

Bhikkhus, this then is the second rebuke made to those recluses and brahmins who hold such a doctrine based on wrong views.

cc. Then, Bhikkhus, I went and approached those recluses and brahmins who hold the view, that asserts the belief:

'Whatever someone happens to experience, whether pleasant, painful, or neutral, all that is taking place randomly and on account of pure chance, with no reason and cause behind it.'
and I asked them –

"Venerable sirs, is it true that you are of the view, that whatever someone happens to experience, whether pleasant, painful, or neutral, all that is taking place randomly and on account of pure chance, with no reason and cause behind it?'

And when asked thus, they admitted and affirmed it.

Then, I challenged them with the rebuke:

"But venerable sirs, do you destroy life, steal and take what is not given, indulge in sex, tell lies, slander, use harsh words, use idle chatter, desire and covet others' possessions, or bear anger and hatred in your hearts, and hold wrong views, all for no reason or cause at all? Would all such behavior be the result of pure chance, and simply a random occurrence?"

In hearing this, they all fell silent.

Now, Bhikkhus, you must understand that all those who fall back on the belief and wrong view that what they experience occurs randomly and on account of pure chance and without any reason or cause, are themselves negligent, for they do not even have the wish, let alone the interest and effort, for what should and should not be done.

So, because of their confusion and perplexity, being uncertain and not knowing as to what should and should not be done, those recluses and brahmins live while being unguarded in their behavior through body, speech, and mind.

And since these people are thus unable to hold true to the values of improving and developing oneself in The Holy Life, all those recluses and brahmins do not guard their minds, and therefore do not deserve the title of a 'recluse,' at all.

Bhikkhus, this then is the third rebuke made to those recluses and brahmins who hold such a doctrine based on wrong views.

These are, Bhikkhus, those three beliefs of various sectarians, which when exposed to scrutiny, questioned, and cross-examined by the ones who are truly considered wise, quickly collapse, for they get recognized as ways to drive one to give up striving in The Holy Life, encouraging and leading the person to become carelessly negligent.

On the other hand, Bhikkhus, The Dhamma that I proclaim and teach you is not defiled, at all! It always remains un-refutable, impossible to be rebuked, and is considered faultless by all those who are truly wise.

And how, Bhikkhus, is The Dhamma that I proclaim and teach not defiled, un-refutable, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise?

Here, Bhikkhus, I proclaim and teach the Six Elements, embodying The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise.

I proclaim and teach the Six Bases for Contact, embodying The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise.

I proclaim and teach the Eighteen Mental Examinations, embodying The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise.

I proclaim and teach the Four Noble Truths, embodying The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise.

1. Now, Bhikkhus, when it was said, *'I teach the Six Elements, embodying The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise'* – what was exactly meant by this statement?

Bhikkhus, there are these Six Elements. Which six?
There is the element of earth, the element of water, the element of fire, the element of air, the element of space, and the element of consciousness, all of which embody The Dhamma that I have been proclaiming and teaching you, which is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and is considered blameless by all those who are truly wise.

This is the reason, therefore, why it was just stated:

'I teach the Six Elements, embodying The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise.'

2. Further, Bhikkhus, when it was said, *'I teach the Six Bases for Contact, embodying The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise'* – what was exactly meant by this statement?

Bhikkhus, there are these Six Bases for Contact. Which six?

There is contact made through the eye base; there is contact made through the ear base; there is contact made through the nose base; there is contact made through the tongue base; there is contact made through the body base, and there is contact made through the mind base, all of which embody The Dhamma that I have been proclaiming and teaching you, which is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and is considered blameless by all those who are truly wise.

This is the reason, therefore, why it was just stated:

'I teach the Six Bases for Contact, embodying The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise.'

3. Further, Bhikkhus, when it was said, *'I teach the Eighteen Mental Examinations, embodying The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise'* – what was exactly meant by this statement?

Bhikkhus, there are these Eighteen Mental Examinations. Which eighteen?

Here, Bhikkhus, on seeing a form, one examines the mind experiencing pleasure; one examines the mind experiencing repulsion; one examines the mind experiencing equanimity.

Similarly, on hearing a sound, one examines the mind experiencing pleasure; one examines the mind experiencing repulsion; one examines the mind experiencing equanimity.

On smelling an odor, one examines the mind experiencing pleasure; one examines the mind experiencing repulsion; one examines the mind experiencing equanimity.

On tasting a flavor, one examines the mind experiencing pleasure; one examines the mind experiencing repulsion; one examines the mind experiencing equanimity.

On touching a tangible object, one examines the mind experiencing pleasure; one examines the mind experiencing repulsion; one examines the mind experiencing equanimity.

On knowing a thought, one examines the mind experiencing pleasure; one examines the mind experiencing repulsion; one examines the mind experiencing equanimity.

Therefore, Bhikkhus all these eighteen mental examinations embody The Dhamma that I have been proclaiming and teaching you, which is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and is considered blameless by all those who are truly wise.

This is the reason, therefore, why it was just stated:

'I teach the Eighteen Mental Examinations, embodying The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise.'

4. And when, Bhikkhus, it was said, *'I proclaim and teach the Four Noble Truths, embodying The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise'* – what was exactly meant by this statement?

Bhikkhus, there are these Four Noble Truths. Which Four?

Here, Bhikkhus, on account of the six elements, there is a descent into the embryo. To the one thus entered into the embryo, there is name and form. On account of the presence of name and form, there are the six sense bases. On account of the six sense bases, there is contact. On account of contact being thus possible, there are feelings.

In this way, Bhikkhus, to those who experience feeling, I then teach:

'This is suffering; this is the cause of suffering; this the cessation of suffering; and this is the Path leading to the cessation of suffering.'

And what, Bhikkhus, is the Noble Truth of Suffering?

Here, Bhikkhus, I declare and teach that birth is suffering, getting old is suffering, falling sick is suffering, death is suffering, sorrow, lamentation, pain, depression, and anguish are all suffering; not obtaining what one desires is suffering; in short, the five aggregates that one grips and tenaciously holds onto is itself suffering.

This, Bhikkhus, is called the Noble Truth of Suffering.

And what, Bhikkhus, is the Noble Truth of the Cause of Suffering?

Here, Bhikkhus, on account of willful ignorance in oneself, preparations (*saṅkhārā*) are then allowed to arise, which prime and load up and thus spring forth by manifesting and becoming the generative causes for one's behavior.
On account of these generative causes, consciousness arises.
On account of consciousness, name and form arises.
On account of name and form, the six sense bases arise.
On account of the six sense bases, contact arises.
On account of contact, feelings arise.
On account of feelings, craving arises.
On account of craving, gripping or tenacious grabbing arises.
On account of tenaciously grabbing, the desire for rebecoming arises.
On account of the desire to rebecome, birth takes place.
On account of being born, there naturally follow the facts of ageing and getting old, falling sick, death, sorrow, crying and lamenting, pain, depression, and anguish.

This, therefore, Bhikkhus, is called the Noble Truth of the Cause of Suffering.

And what, Bhikkhus, is the Noble Truth of the Cessation of Suffering?

Here, Bhikkhus, with the complete cessation of willful ignoring, the *saṅkhārā* themselves cease.
With the cessation of the *saṅkhārā*, consciousness then ceases.
With the cessation of consciousness, name and form cease.
With the cessation of name and form, the six sense bases also cease.
With the cessation of the six sense bases, contact ceases to occur.
With the cessation of contact, then feelings cease altogether.
With the cessation of feelings, craving ceases.
With the cessation of craving, gripping or tenaciously grabbing cease.
With the cessation of tenacious grabbing, the desire to rebecome ceases.
With the cessation of the desire to rebecome, birth then ceases altogether.
With the cessation of birth, then ageing and getting old, falling sick, death, sorrow, crying and lamenting, pain, depression, and anguish all cease.

This, Bhikkhus, is called the Noble Truth of the Cessation of Suffering.

And what, Bhikkhus, is the Noble Truth of the Path Leading to the Cessation of Suffering?

Here, Bhikkhus, it is this same Noble Eightfold Path, that is: Right View, Right Intentional Thought, Right Speech, Right Action, Right Effort, Right Lifestyle, Right Mindfulness, and Right *Samādhi* (collected stability of mind).

This, Bhikkhus, is called the Noble Truth of the Path Leading to the Cessation of Suffering.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, these Four Noble Truths indeed embody The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered blameless by all those who are truly wise.

This is the reason, therefore, why it was just stated:

'I proclaim and teach the Four Noble Truths, embodying The Dhamma that is not defiled, un-refuted, impossible to be rebuked, and considered faultless by all those who are truly wise.'

62. ***Bhaya Sutta*** *(Terrifying Danger)*

Bhikkhus, the common, ordinary, untrained and undisciplined person (*puthujjana*) says that there are three terrifying dangers, which are indifferent to and unaffected by the bond between a mother and a child. Thus, these terrors come to separate the mother from her beloved son, and the son from his mother, where neither could find the other.

Now, what are these three?

a. Bhikkhus, there comes a time, when a great fire arises, threatening the lives of sentient beings, as it burns and blazes mercilessly through villages, cities, and towns.
Now, as it ravages on while burning through villages, cities, and towns, the mother does not find her son, and the son does not find his mother.

Therefore, the *puthujjana* calls this the first terrifying danger, as a result of which mother and son become separated, losing each other.

b. Next, Bhikkhus, there is a time when a great storm arises, bringing mighty torrential rains to villages, cities, and towns. When villages, cities, and towns become flooded and submerged in that chaos, the mother does not find her son, and the son loses sight of his mother.

This, the *puthujjana* calls the second terrifying danger, as a result of which mother and son become separated, losing each other.

c. Further, Bhikkhus, there is a time when the marauding tribes mount their chariots as they assault and invade the land, threatening the lives of the natives, pillaging villages, cities, and towns, where citizens flee in all directions. In such chaos, the mother does not find her son, and the son does not find his mother.

The *puthujjana* calls this the third terrifying danger, as a result of which mother and son become separated, losing each other.

These, therefore, Bhikkhus, the common, ordinary, untrained, and undisciplined person calls the three terrifying dangers that do not recognize the bond between a mother and a child. Thus, these terrors come to separate the mother from her beloved son, where neither could find the other.

In contrast, Bhikkhus, the common, ordinary, untrained and undisciplined person (*puthujjana*) also knows of three terrifying dangers, wherein having been separated, mother and son reunite by finding each other.

And what are these three?

aa. Here, Bhikkhus, there comes a time, when a great fire arises, threatening the lives of sentient beings, as it burns and blazes mercilessly through villages, cities, and towns. Now, as it ravages on burning through villages, cities, and towns, the mother finds her son, and the son finds his mother.

Therefore, the *puthujjana* calls this the first terrifying danger, whereby having been separated due to the fire, later however, the mother finds her son, and the son finds his mother.

bb. Next, Bhikkhus, there is a time when a great storm arises, bringing mighty torrential rains to villages, cities, and towns. Although they had been separated as the villages, cities, and towns became flooded and submerged in that chaos, later, the mother does find her son, and the son finds his mother.

This, the *puthujjana* calls the second terrifying danger, wherein the mother finds her son, and the son finds his mother.

cc. And, Bhikkhus, there may come a time, when the marauding tribes mount their chariots as they assault and invade the land, threatening the lives of the natives, pillaging villages, cities, and towns, where citizens flee in all directions, and in such chaos, both mother and her son get separated. But later, the mother does find her son, and the son also finds his mother.

The *puthujjana* calls this the third terrifying danger, as a result of which the mother finds her son, and the son finds his mother.

Thus, Bhikkhus, the common, ordinary, untrained, and undisciplined person (*puthujjana*) calls these three terrifying dangers, wherein having been separated, mother and son reunite by finding each other.

However, Bhikkhus, there are these three other terrors, which truly separate the mother from her son, and the son from his mother; terrors which are indifferent to and unaffected by the bond between a mother and a child.

And what are these three?

They are the terrifying facts of getting old; falling sick; and dying.

1. Thus Bhikkhus, while the son is getting old, no matter how she might try to protect him from ageing, that loving mother cannot save her son from aging, by saying:

"Please, let <u>me</u> get old, instead of my son! May my son not get old."

And similarly, while the mother is getting old, the son cannot save her from ageing, by saying:

"Please, let <u>me</u> get old, in my mother's stead! May my mother not get old."

2. Also, Bhikkhus, while the son has fallen sick, no matter how she might try to protect him from sickness, that loving mother cannot save her son from falling sick, by saying:

"Please, let <u>me</u> get sick, instead of my son! May my son not get sick nor be afflicted with anything."

Similarly, when the mother has fallen sick, the son cannot save her from illness, by saying:

"Please, let <u>me</u> get sick, instead of my mother! May my mother not get sick."

3. And, Bhikkhus, when the son is dying, no matter how much she might try to protect him from death, that loving mother cannot save her son from dying, by saying:

"Please, let <u>me</u> die, instead of my son! May my son not die."

Similarly, when the mother is dying, no matter how much he tries, the son cannot save her from dying, by saying:

"Please, let <u>me</u> die instead of my mother! May my mother not die."

Bhikkhus, these are the three other terrors, which truly separate the mother from her son, and the son from his mother; terrors which are indifferent to and unaffected by the bond between a loving mother and her child.

However, Bhikkhus, there is a Path and a method to dispel and overcome the terrors that separate a loving mother from her son; terrors which are indifferent to and unaffected by the bond between a mother and her child.

And what, Bhikkhus, is the Path, that very method to dispel and overcome these terrors?

Bhikkhus, it is this same Noble Eightfold Path.

That is: Right View, Right Intention, Right Speech, Right Action, Right Lifestyle, Right Effort, Right Mindfulness, and Right Collectedness of Mind.

Bhikkhus, this is The Path and method to dispel and overcome the terrors that separate a loving mother from her son; terrors which are indifferent to and unaffected by the bond between a mother and her child.

*63. **Venāgapura Sutta** (At Venāgapura)*

At one time, while The Blessed One was touring the country of Kosala with a large group of Bhikkhus, he entered the brahmin city of Venāgapura, where soon enough, the brahmin householders of Venāgapura heard the news –

'The good recluse Gotama, son of the Sakyan clan, having gone forth from the home life into homelessness, has now arrived at our city of Venāgapura.'

Further, they came to learn that a great report had been spread about The Blessed Gautama, to the effect that –

'The Blessed One is an Arahant, perfectly Awakened, accomplished and endowed with true knowledge and conduct; well gone, knower of the worlds, the incomparable discipliner of those to be tamed; Teacher of Devas and humans, The Enlightened and Blessed One.

'And having realized by himself and with direct knowledge, in this world together with its Devas and humans, Māras, Brahmās, as well as the community of recluses and brahmins, He now teaches The Dhamma that is beautiful in its beginning, beautiful in its middle, and beautiful in its end; fully presenting it with its right meaning and phrasing, while clearly revealing to all The Holy Life that is utterly perfect and pure.

'Now, it surely is wonderful indeed, to be able to go and see such Arahants.'

Then, the brahmin householders of Venāgapura went and approached The Blessed One, where some of them paid homage to Him and then sat down to one side; others exchanged friendly greetings and sat down to one side; while still others extended their clasped hands towards The Blessed One and sat down to one side; still others sat down after having announced their name and clan, while others silently sat down to one side, without greeting The Teacher, at all.

Then, Vacchagotta of Venāgapura said to The Blessed One:

"It is quite amazing, Master Gautama! It is truly wonderful, Master Gotama! For, your mental faculties are so stunningly tranquil and bright, with your skin color that is so pure and clear, like a yellow jujube fruit in autumn, or just like a palm flower released from the husk, or better yet,

like an ornament made of pure gold that is skillfully prepared and then placed in the middle of an orange brocade by a master goldsmith.

“How good it would be, if there were high and lofty couches such as decked chairs cushioned by wild bull hide, decorated with white woolen cloth, with layers of embroidered woolen blankets, made with a mixture of wool and covered with silken embroidered coverlets; if the floor were covered with woven woolen carpets, having elephant hide as spreads, horse driven luxurious chariot spreads made of antelope and deer hide; with overhead canopies, and red cushions on either side.

“Surely, Master Gautama would be rightfully the one to gain all these and more, and without difficulty!”

And The Blessed replied by saying:

“Brahmin, these high and lofty couches you speak of are rarely gained or obtained by the ones who have gone forth, and even if they were gained, they would still remain unsuitable for the truly homeless recluse.

“But, Brahmin, there are these three high and lofty couches which I gain quickly, at will, instantly and without any difficulty. What three?

“The high and lofty couches of Divinity; the high and lofty couches of Brahmā; and the high and lofty couches of The Noble Ones.

“These, brahmin, are the three high and lofty couches, which I gain quickly, at will, instantly and without any difficulty.”

“But, Master Gautama, what exactly are the high and lofty couches of Divinity which The Blessed One gains quickly, at will, instantly and without any difficulty?

a. “Here, brahmin, in the morning, I put on My robes and by taking the alms bowl and outer robe, I go for alms into the village. After the meal, having already returned from the alms round, I walk into a grove or a wooded area. Finding a heap of grass or leaves, which I collect and then sit on with my folded legs, I keep the body straight as I establish mindfulness by reconnecting with the breath, right under the tip of the nose.

“Then, brahmin, by pulling My mind away from sensual pleasures and unwholesome states, I enter upon and dwell in the first *jhāna*, which is accompanied by thinking and planning, with joy and pleasure that manifest when I am appropriately in seclusion.

“Further, with the stilling of thinking and planning, I enter upon and dwell in the second *jhāna*, which has within it self-confidence and unification of mind, but in the absence of thinking and

planning, with joy and pleasure that continue due to the deepening of My collected stability of mind (*samādhi*).

"Further, with the fading away of joy also, I dwell in equanimity, remaining mindful and fully aware, while still feeling pleasure through the body, as I enter upon and dwell in the third *jhāna*, on account of which the noble ones declare:

'He indeed possesses a lovely demeanor; the one who has equanimity, while being mindful.'

"Furthermore, by moving beyond pleasure and pain altogether, and with the previous disappearance of joy and discontent, I enter upon and dwell in the fourth *jhāna*, which has neither pain nor pleasure in it, but the purity of mindfulness pervading throughout, along with continued deepening of equanimity.

"Now, brahmin, while in that state, whenever I walk back and forth, my walking is Divine. While standing still, my standing is Divine. While sitting, my sitting is Divine. And if I were to lie down, then my lying down too is Divine.

"Brahmin, these are therefore the high and lofty couches of Divinity, which I gain quickly and at will, instantly and without any difficulty."

"It is wonderful, Master Gotama, for who else could quickly and at will, gain such high and lofty couches of Divinity, instantly and without any difficulty, other than Master Gotama!"

"But, Master Gotama, what are the high and lofty couches of Brahmā, which The Blessed One gains quickly and at will, instantly and without any difficulty?"

And The Blessed One continued by saying:

b. "Here, brahmin, in the morning, I put on my robes and by taking the alms bowl and outer robe, I go for alms into the village. After the meal, having already returned from the alms round, I walk into a grove or a wooded area. Finding a heap of grass or leaves, which I collect and then sit on with my folded legs, I keep the body straight while establishing mindfulness before me, observing the breath as it moves in and out over the upper lip.

"Then, in deep and restful tranquility, I direct my mind while pervading one quarter direction with Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness (*mettā*), so too the second quarter, the third quarter, and the fourth quarter; so above, below and across, in every respect while radiating with a heart that is fully drenched in Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness, enveloping and growing in all directions, immeasurably, and without any sense of forcefulness, resentment, compulsion, or the slightest antagonism towards anyone or anything.

"Then, in deep and restful tranquility, I direct my mind while pervading one quarter direction with Universal Compassion (*karunā*), so too the second quarter, the third quarter, and the fourth quarter; so above, below and across, in every respect while radiating with a heart that is fully

drenched in Universal Compassion, enveloping and growing in all directions, immeasurably, and without any sense of forcefulness, resentment, compulsion, or the slightest antagonism towards anyone or anything.

"Then, in deep and restful tranquility, I direct my mind while pervading one quarter direction with Universal Altruistic Joy (*muditā*), so too the second quarter, the third quarter, and the fourth quarter; so above, below and across, in every respect while radiating with a heart that is fully drenched in Universal Altruistic Joy; enveloping and growing in all directions, immeasurably, and without any sense of forcefulness, resentment, compulsion, or the slightest antagonism towards anyone or anything.

"Then, in deep and restful tranquility, I direct my mind while pervading one quarter direction with equanimity (*upekkhā*), so too the second quarter, the third quarter, and the fourth quarter; so above, below and across, in every respect while radiating with a heart that is fully drenched in equanimity; enveloping and growing in all directions, immeasurably, and without any sense of forcefulness, resentment, compulsion, or the slightest antagonism towards anyone or anything.

"Now, brahmin, while in that state, whenever I walk back and forth, my walking is that of Brahmā. While standing still, my standing is that of Brahmā. While sitting, my sitting is that of Brahmā. And if I were to lie down, then my lying down too is that of Brahmā.

"Brahmin, these are therefore the high and lofty couches of Brahmā, which I gain quickly and at will, instantly and without any difficulty."

"It is wonderful, Master Gotama, for who else could quickly and at will, gain such high and lofty couches of Brahmā, instantly and without any difficulty, other than Master Gotama!"

"But, Master Gautama, what are the high and lofty couches of The Noble Ones, which The Blessed One gains quickly and at will, instantly, and without any difficulty?"

c. "Here, brahmin, in the morning, I put on my robes and by taking the alms bowl and outer robe, I go for alms into the village. After the meal, having already returned from the alms round, I walk into a grove or a wooded area. Finding a heap of grass or leaves, which I collect and then sit on with my folded legs, and by keeping the body straight, I anchor myself in mindfulness while fully aware of the breath as it enters and leaves, right over the mouth.

"Then, while reflecting carefully, I know and see clearly that there is no more greed or lust left in Me, having already been pulled out with its roots, made like a dead palm tree's stump that has been cut cleanly in half, never to grow back again.

"Similarly, while reflecting carefully, I know and see clearly that there is no more anger or hatred left in Me; having already been pulled out with its roots, made like a dead palm tree's stump that has been cut cleanly in half, never to grow back again.

“And also, while reflecting carefully, I know and see clearly that there is no more delusion or willful ignoring left in Me; having already been pulled out with its roots, made like a dead palm tree’s stump that has been cut cleanly in half, never to grow back again.

“Now, brahmin, while in that state, whenever I walk back and forth, my walking is that of The Noble Ones. While standing still, my standing is that of The Noble Ones. While sitting, my sitting is that of The Noble Ones. And if I were to lie down, then my lying down too is that of The Noble Ones.

“Brahmin, these therefore are the high and lofty couches of The Noble Ones, which I gain quickly and at will, instantly and without any difficulty.”

“It is wonderful, Master Gotama, for who else could so quickly and at will, gain such high and lofty couches of The Noble Ones, instantly and without any difficulty, other than Master Gotama?”

“Sādhu, Sādhu indeed, Venerable sir! This is Magnificent, Venerable sir!

“The Blessed One has made The Dhamma clear to me in many ways! It is as though He turned upright what had been turned upside-down, and revealed to me what was hidden; showing the way to one who was lost; holding up a lamp in the dark for those with eyesight to see.

“I go to The Blessed One for refuge, and to The Dhamma, and to The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus!

“From this day forward, may The Blessed One kindly remember me as a lay disciple of His, who has taken refuge in Him, until the end of life.”

*64. **Sarabha Sutta** (Discourse to Sarabha)*

At one time, while The Blessed One was staying at the Vultures’ Peak in Rājagaha, a wandering ascetic by the name of Sarabha, who had recently left The Teacher’s Dispensation, was going about in Rājagaha, making the following statement:

‘I know The Dhamma of the Recluse Gautama, the Son of the Sakyans, whose Dhamma and Discipline I left, having already fully mastered it!’

Then, after putting on their robes one morning and taking their alms bowls and outer robes, a group of Bhikkhus entered Rājagaha for their daily alms and heard the ascetic Sarabha saying these words to the people of Rājagaha:

‘I know The Dhamma of the Recluse Gautama, the Son of the Sakyans, whose Dhamma and Discipline I left, having already fully mastered it!’

“Later that day, after having eaten their meal, those Bhikkhus returned to the monastery and approached The Blessed One, and after paying homage to The Teacher, they sat down to one side and said:

“Venerable sir, the wandering ascetic named Sarabha, who had recently left the Teacher’s Dhamma and Discipline, is going about in Rājagaha making these statements:

‘I know The Dhamma of the Recluse Gautama, the Son of the Sakyans, whose Dhamma and Discipline I left, having already fully mastered it!’

“Blessed Lord, it would be good if The Blessed One could go to the monastery of the wandering ascetics on the bank of the River Sappinika and, out of Universal Compassion, perhaps see the wandering ascetic Sarabha.”

And The Blessed One consented with His silence.

Then, in the afternoon, having come out of His seclusion, The Blessed One went and approached the wandering ascetic Sarabha at the monastery of the wandering ascetics, on the bank of the River Sappinika.

The Blessed One then sat down on the prepared seat and said:

“Sarabha, is it true that you have been saying these words:

‘I know The Dhamma of the Recluse Gautama, the Son of the Sakyans, whose Dhamma and Discipline I left, having already fully mastered it!’

When this was said, the wandering ascetic Sarabha became silent.

For the second time, The Blessed addressed the ascetic Sarabha:

“Sarabha, tell us what you have learned and know of The Dhamma of the Recluse Gautama, the Son of the Sakyans. And if you have not learned it completely, then I will help you complete it. But, if you are truly complete in your learning, then I will be content and happy for you.”

Yet for the second time, the wandering ascetic Sarabha became silent.

And for the third time, The Blessed One said to the ascetic Sarabha: “

“Sarabha, tell us what you have learned and know of The Dhamma of the Recluse Gautama, the Son of the Sakyans. And if you have not learned it completely, then I will help you complete it. But, if you are truly complete in your learning, then I will be content and happy for you.”

But for the third time, the wandering ascetic Sarabha became silent.

Then, the wandering ascetics of Rājagaha turned to Sarabha and said:

“Friend, whatever you have to confess to the Recluse Gotama, do it, for He has just informed you that He will help you complete it, in the case that your learning of The Dhamma is not complete.

“Sarabha, tell us what you say you already know of The Dhamma of the Recluse Gautama, Son of the Sakyans. And if you have not learned it completely, then He will help you complete it. And, if you are indeed complete in your learning as you claim, then He will be content and happy for you!”

When this was said, the wandering ascetic Sarabha still remained silent, confused, with his head drooping, hunched over, overcome with grief, as he sat there unable to reply.

Then, seeing that the wandering ascetic Sarabha was thus sitting quietly, defeated, and unable to defend himself, The Blessed One addressed the other wandering ascetics:

“Know this, O wandering ascetics, whoever approaches to tell Me:

‘Although you claim to be Fully Awakened, you are still not Fully Awakened.’

“Then, I will carefully cross-question him, examining closely by asking for his reasons in saying so, while openly conversing together. But, when thus cross-questioned and asked for his reasons while conversing together, it is impossible that he should not find himself cornered into one of these three consequential positions, and not another. What three?

“He would either evade the question entirely by changing the topic of our conversation; or show bitter resentment, hatred, and anger; or sit silently and confused, with his head drooping; hunched over and overcome with grief, as he sits there unable to reply, just like this wandering ascetic Sarabha is now doing!

“Furthermore, O wandering ascetics, whoever approaches to tell Me:

‘Although you claim to have destroyed all your contaminants, you are still not free from the contaminants.’

“Then, I will carefully cross-question him, examining closely by asking for his reasons in saying so, while openly conversing together. But, when thus cross-questioned and asked for his reasons while conversing together, it is impossible that he should not find himself cornered into one of these three consequential positions, and not another. What three?

“He would either evade the question entirely by changing the topic of our conversation; or show bitter resentment, hatred, and anger; or sit silently and confused, with his head drooping; hunched over and overcome with grief, as he sits there unable to reply, just like this wandering ascetic Sarabha is now doing!

"And furthermore, wandering ascetics, whoever was to tell Me:

'If one were to seriously and diligently practice The Dhamma that You teach, they would find out that it still does not lead to the ending of all suffering.'

"Then, I will carefully cross-question him, examining closely by asking for his reasons in saying so, while openly conversing together. But, when thus cross-questioned and asked for the reasons while conversing together, it is impossible that he should not find himself cornered into one of these three consequential positions, and not another. What three?

"He would either evade the question entirely by changing the topic of our conversation; or show bitter resentment, hatred, and anger; or sit silently and confused, with his head drooping; hunched over and overcome with grief, as he sits there unable to reply, just like this wandering ascetic Sarabha is now doing!"

Then, soon after The Blessed One had left that gathering of wandering ascetics, having thus roared His lion's roar three times, the wandering ascetics themselves surrounded the wandering ascetic Sarabha and began rebuking and chastising him with verbal assaults, as they exclaimed:

"Sarabha, you foolish idiot, you are like a jackal aimlessly roaming in a vast woodland, thinking *'I will roar the lion's roar,'* but instead, you have simply been howling and barking like a puny jackal! *Now* it is quite clear for us what you were trying to do, Sarabha!

"For, in the absence of the Recluse Gautama, you tried to roar like a lion, pretending to outdo the Recluse Gotama. Yet, you only ended up barking and screeching as you howled like a jackal, in the *absence* of the Recluse Gautama.

"You are just like that crow wanting to sing the cuckoo's song, but you only squealed and shrieked like a parrot, Sarabha! You wanted to outdo the Recluse Gotama, but in fact, you mooed like a useless bull in a deserted cattle barn, when no one was around, while pretending you were somehow 'the alpha!'"

In just this manner, those other wandering ascetics mocked him tauntingly, as they teased and laughed at their fellow wandering ascetic, Sarabha.

65. ***Kesaputtiya (Kālāma) Sutta*** *(Discourse to the Kālamas)*

This is what I have personally heard.

At one time, while The Blessed One was touring the country of Kosala with a large Saṅgha of Bhikkhus, he entered the township of Kesaputta of the Kālamas. Then, the Kālamas of Kesaputta heard –

'The Good Recluse Gautama, son of the Sakyan clan, having gone forth from the home life into homelessness, has now entered our city of Kesaputta.'

Further, they came to learn that a great report had been spread about The Blessed Gautama, to the effect that –

'The Blessed One is an Arahant, perfectly Awakened, accomplished and endowed with true knowledge and conduct; well gone, knower of the worlds, the incomparable discipliner of those to be tamed; Teacher of Devas and humans, The Enlightened and Blessed One.

'And having realized by himself and with direct knowledge, in this world together with its Devas and humans, Māras, Brahmās, as well as the community of recluses and brahmins, He now teaches The Dhamma that is beautiful in its beginning, beautiful in its middle, and beautiful in its end; fully presenting it with its right meaning and phrasing, while clearly revealing to all The Holy Life that is utterly perfect and pure.

'Now, it surely is wonderful indeed, to be able to go and see such Arahants.'

Then, the Kālamas of Kesaputta approached The Blessed One, where some of them paid homage to Him and then sat down to one side; others exchanged friendly greetings and sat down to one side; while still others extended their clasped hands towards The Blessed One and sat down to one side; still others sat down after having announced their name and clan, while others silently sat down to one side, without greeting The Teacher, at all.

Then, the Kālamas addressed The Blessed One by asking:

"Venerable Sir, some recluses and brahmins who come passing through our town of Kesaputta, teach and explain their own views, but while denigrating, denouncing, and disparaging the views of others, which they make seem to be useless, at best. Then, other recluses and brahmins passing through our town of Kesaputta too, teach and explain their own views, but while denigrating, denouncing, and disparaging the views of others, which they make seem to be useless, at best.

"So, You see, Venerable Sir, this has been a source of much confusion and doubt for us in Kesaputta, for we find ourselves perplexed and unsure as to which recluse speaks the truth, and which one does not."

And The Blessed One replied, by saying:
"Kālamas, given what you have described, it is understandable for you to become confused, perplexed, and unsure as to which recluse speaks the truth, and which one speaks what is untrue.

"Come now, O Kālamas, do not accept a teaching simply on account of it being disseminated through an oral tradition; by lineage of teaching; by hearsay; by scriptures; by logical reasoning alone; by inferential reasoning alone; on the grounds of some authority; by the charisma or apparent competence of the speaker; or by the eloquent or entertaining nature of their words, whereby you think: *'I have to follow such a teacher because they are my 'teacher.'*

“However, Kālamas, when you carefully look at the teachings that you receive and come to know the following, for yourselves:

‘These thoughts are harmful and damaging; these thoughts are blameworthy; these thoughts are reproved and criticized by all those considered to be truly wise; once acted upon and undertaken, these thoughts would certainly <u>not</u> lead to our welfare or happiness, but instead, they will bring about more suffering, indeed.’

“Then Kālamas, on understanding and seeing the truth in this, you should quickly abandon those thoughts, right on the spot.

“Now, what do you think, Kālamas? Does greed or passionate wanting that arises in a person, really lead to his welfare and benefit, or in fact, it leads to his ruin, bringing him much harm?”

“Venerable Sir, it surely does not lead to his welfare, but simply brings him much harm, leading him to ruin.”

“Kālamas, a greedy person, with a mind obsessed with greed, destroys living beings; takes what is not given; covets and then goes to other’s wives; tells lies, and encourages others to do the same. Now, do such actions conduce to his ruin and suffering for a long time?”

“Yes of course, Venerable Sir.”

“What do you think, then Kālamas? Does the anger or hatred that arises in a person, really lead to his welfare and benefit, or in fact, it leads to his ruin, bringing him much harm?”

“Venerable Sir, it surely does not lead to his welfare, but simply brings him much harm, leading him to ruin.”

“Kālamas, an angry person, with a mind obsessed with anger or hate, destroys living beings; takes what is not given; covets and then goes to other’s wives; tells lies, and encourages others to do the same. Now, do such actions conduce to his ruin and suffering for a long time?”

“Yes of course, Venerable Sir.”

“What do you think, Kālamas?
Does the delusion that arises in a person, really lead to his welfare and benefit, or in fact, it leads to his ruin, bringing him much harm?”

“Venerable Sir, it surely does not lead to his welfare, but simply brings him much harm, leading him to ruin.”

“Kālamas, a deluded person, with a mind drenched in ignorance, destroys living beings; takes what is not given; covets and then goes to other’s wives; tells lies, and encourages others to do the same. Now, do such actions conduce to his ruin and suffering for a long time?”

“Yes of course, Venerable Sir.”

“What do you think then, O Kālamas? Would you say that such thoughts and actions are beneficial or harmful?”

“Venerable Sir, they are harmful.”

“Are they blameworthy or blameless?”

“Venerable Sir, they are blameworthy.”

“Are they reproved or praised by the wise?”

“Venerable Sir, they are reproved by the wise.”

“And how do you understand it, O Kālamas, when such thoughts and actions are undertaken, would they then lead to happiness or to further evil, bringing about more suffering?”

“Venerable Sir, as we understand it, when such actions are undertaken and committed, they lead to further evil and more suffering.”

“Thereby, O Kālamas, as I stated to you earlier:

“Come now, O Kālamas, do not accept a teaching simply on account of it being disseminated through an oral tradition; by lineage of the teaching; by hearsay; by its scriptures; by logical reasoning alone; by inferential reasoning alone; on the grounds of some authority; by the charisma or apparent competence of the speaker; or by the eloquent and entertaining nature of their words, whereby you think: *‘I have to follow such a teacher because they are my ‘teacher.’”*

“However, Kālamas, when you ponder and know for yourselves:

‘These thoughts are harmful and damaging; these thoughts are blameworthy; these thoughts are reproved and criticized by all those considered to be truly wise; once acted upon and undertaken, these thoughts would certainly <u>not</u> lead to our welfare or happiness, but instead, they will bring about more suffering, indeed.’

Then, Kālamas, you should abandon those thoughts. It was for this reason that it was thus said:

“Come Kālamas, do not accept a teaching simply on account of it being disseminated through an oral tradition; by lineage of the teaching; by hearsay; by its scriptures; by logical reasoning alone; by inferential reasoning alone; on the grounds of some authority; by the charisma or apparent competence of the speaker; or by the eloquent and entertaining nature of their words, whereby you think: *‘I have to follow such a teacher because they are my ‘teacher.’”*

“However, Kālamas, when you ponder and know for yourselves thus:

'These thoughts are wholesome; these thoughts are blameless; these thoughts are praised by all those considered to be truly wise; once acted upon and undertaken, these thoughts are conducive to our welfare, and they bring about happiness, for sure.'

Then, Kālamas, you should grow such thoughts further and live in harmony with them."

"What do you think, Kālamas? Is the arising of non-greed in a person conducive to his benefit or to his ruin?"

"Venerable Sir, it is to his benefit, and not to his ruin."

"Kālamas, a person lacking greed, not overcome by greed, with a mind not obsessed by greed, does not destroy living beings; does not take what is not given; he does not covet nor goes to other's wives; he does not tell lies; nor encourages others to engage in unwholesome behavior. Now, do such actions contribute to his benefit and happiness, for a long time?"

"Yes of course, Venerable Sir."

"What do you think Kālamas? Is the arising of non-anger in a person conducive to his benefit or to his ruin?"

"Venerable Sir, it is to his benefit, and not to his ruin."

"Kālamas, a person lacking anger, not overcome by anger, with a mind not obsessed by anger, does not destroy living beings; does not take what is not given; he does not covet nor goes to other's wives; he does not tell lies, nor encourages others to engage in unwholesome behavior. Now, do such actions contribute to his benefit and happiness, for a long time?"

"Yes of course, Venerable Sir."

"What do you think, Kālamas? Is the arising of non-delusion in a person conducive to his benefit or to his ruin?"

"Venerable Sir, it is to his benefit, and not to his ruin."

"Kālamas, a person lacking delusion, not overcome by delusion, with a mind not drenched in delusion, does not destroy living beings; does not take what is not given; he does not covet nor goes to other's wives; he does not tell lies, nor encourages others to engage in unwholesome behavior. Now, do such actions contribute to his benefit and happiness, for a long time?"

"Yes of course, Venerable Sir."

"What do you think, Kālamas? Are such thoughts and actions wholesome or unwholesome?"

"Venerable Sir, they are wholesome."

“Are they blameworthy or blameless?”

“Venerable Sir, they are blameless.”

“Are they reproved or praised by the wise?”

“Venerable Sir, they are praised by the wise.”

“And how do you understand it, when such thoughts and actions are undertaken and committed, would they conduce to benefit and happiness, or not?”

“Venerable Sir, as we understand it, when such thoughts and actions are undertaken and committed, they would conduce to benefit and happiness.”

“Thereby, Kālamas, as I stated to you earlier:

“Come now, O Kālamas, do not accept a teaching simply on account of it being disseminated through an oral tradition; by lineage of the teaching; by hearsay; by its scriptures; by logical reasoning alone; by inferential reasoning alone; on the grounds of some authority; by the charisma or apparent competence of the speaker; or by the eloquent and entertaining nature of their words, whereby you think: *‘I have to follow such a teacher because they are my ‘teacher.’”*

“However, Kālamas, when you carefully look at the teachings you receive, and come to know the following, for yourselves:

‘These thoughts are wholesome; these thoughts are blameless; these thoughts are praised by all those considered to be truly wise; once acted upon and undertaken, these thoughts are conducive to our welfare, and they bring about happiness, for sure.’

Then, Kālamas, you should grow such thoughts further and live in harmony with them.
It was for this reason that it was thus said.

a. “After all, O Kālamas, it is in this manner that the Noble Disciple – who has freed himself from covetousness, anger, and delusion; who is clearly comprehending and aware, with mindfulness firmly established – pervades one quarter direction with Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness, so too the second quarter, the third quarter, and the fourth quarter; so above, below and across, in every respect, while radiating with a heart that is fully drenched in Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness, enveloping and growing in all directions, immeasurably, and without any sense of forcefulness, resentment, compulsion, or the slightest antagonism towards anyone or anything.

b. “Further, he abides pervading one quarter direction with Universal Compassion, so too the second quarter, the third quarter, and the fourth quarter; so above, below and across, in every

respect, while radiating with a heart that is fully drenched in Universal Compassion, enveloping and growing in all directions, immeasurably, and without any sense of forcefulness, resentment, compulsion, or the slightest antagonism towards anyone or anything.

c. "Further, he abides pervading one quarter direction with Universal Altruistic Joy, so too the second quarter, the third quarter, and the fourth quarter; so above, below and across, in every respect, while radiating with a heart that is fully drenched in Universal Altruistic Joy, enveloping and growing in all directions, immeasurably, and without any sense of forcefulness, resentment, compulsion, or the slightest antagonism towards anyone or anything.

d. "Further, he abides pervading one quarter direction with Equanimity, so too the second quarter, the third quarter, and the fourth quarter; so above, below and across, in every respect, while radiating with a heart that is fully drenched in Equanimity, enveloping and growing in all directions, immeasurably, and without any sense of forcefulness, resentment, compulsion, or the slightest antagonism towards anyone or anything.

"In such a way, Kālamas, when the Noble Disciple's mind is without anger, without covetousness, faultless and unblemished, and thus purified, he here and now gains four certainties, while still alive, and in this very body.

"Here, with the first certainty, O Kālamas, he knows for sure, that –

'If there is another world, if there are results of good and evil actions, then there is a possibility that after death, I will be reborn in a good state, in heaven.'

"This, therefore, is his first certainty.

Furthermore, he reflects:

'If there isn't another world, if there are no results for good and evil actions, still, here and now, I abide without enmity, without covetousness, in purity and happiness.'

"This then is his second certainty.
And he considers –

'The evildoer does evil, yet I do not even think of any evil, which means that I have not done any evil; hence, I will not experience any results of evil.'

"This is his third certainty.

And, he reflects –

'Even if the evildoer does not experience the evil consequences of his evil actions, I still see myself residing in peace and purity in both respects, having nothing to worry about.'

"This is his fourth certainty.

"Thus, Kālamas, when the Noble Disciple's mind is without anger, without covetousness, not soiled but pure, he here and now gains these four certainties, while being alive."

"This makes so much sense, O Blessed One! This is truly amazing, O Tathāgata!

"Especially when you explain, Bhante, how the Noble Disciple's mind is without anger, without covetousness, faultless and unblemished, and thus purified, whereby he here and now gains those four certainties, with the first one being:

'If there is another world, if there are results of good and evil actions, then there is a possibility that after death, I will be reborn in a good state, in heaven.'

"Followed by his second certainty, which says:

'If there isn't another world, if there are no results for good and evil actions, still, here and now, I abide without enmity, without covetousness, in purity and happiness.'

"Then, his third certainty, which states:

'The evildoer does evil, yet I do not even think of any evil, which means that I have not done any evil; hence, I will not experience any results of evil.'

"And finally, his fourth certainty, that states:

'Even if the evildoer does not experience the evil consequences of his evil actions, I still see myself residing in peace and purity in both respects, having nothing to worry about.'

"In this way, that when the Noble Disciple's mind is without anger, without covetousness, faultless and unblemished, and thus purified, he here and now gains four certainties, while still alive, and in this very body."

Then, on hearing these words spoken to them directly by The Blessed One Himself, the Kālamas exclaimed with delight:

"Sādhu, Sādhu indeed, Bhante! This truly is Magnificent, Bhante!

"The Blessed One has made The Dhamma clear to us in *many* ways! It is as though He turned upright what had been turned upside-down, and revealed to us what was hidden; showing the way to those who were lost; holding up a lamp in the dark for those with eyesight to see.

"We go to The Blessed One for refuge, and to The Dhamma, and to The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus!

"From this day forward, Bhante, may The Blessed One kindly remember us as lay disciples of His, who have taken refuge in Him, until the end of life."

*66. **Sāḷha Sutta** (Discourse to Sāḷha)*

I have personally heard this.

At one time, the Venerable Nandaka was abiding at Sāvatthī's Eastern Park, in the monastery of Migāra's Mother.

Then Sāḷha, the grandson of Migāra, and Rohana, who was a grandson of Pekhuṇiya, both went and approached the Venerable Nandaka, and after paying homage to him, sat to one side.

Then, the Venerable Nandaka said to them:

"Come Sāḷha, do not accept a teaching simply on account of it being disseminated through an oral tradition; by lineage of the teaching; by hearsay; by its scriptures; by logical reasoning alone; by inferential reasoning alone; on the grounds of some authority; by the charisma or apparent competence of the speaker; or by the eloquent and entertaining nature of their words, whereby you think: *'I have to follow such a teacher because they are my 'teacher.'"*

"However, Sāḷha, when you ponder and know for yourselves thus:

'These thoughts are harmful and damaging; these thoughts are blameworthy; these thoughts are reproved and criticized by all those considered to be truly wise; once acted upon and undertaken, these thoughts would certainly <u>not</u> lead to our welfare or happiness, but instead, they will bring about more suffering, indeed.'

"Then, Sāḷha, you should abandon those thoughts.

"Sāḷha, what do you think? Is there such a thing as greed?"

"Yes, Venerable sir."

"Greed has the meaning of covetousness. A greedy person, with a mind obsessed with greed, destroys living beings; takes what is not given; covets and then goes to other's wives; tells lies, and encourages others to do the same. Now, do such actions conduce to his ruin and suffering for a long time?"

"Yes, Venerable sir."

“Sāḷha, what do you think? Is there such a thing as anger?”

“Yes, Venerable sir.”

“Anger has the meaning of hatred and ill will. An angry person, with a mind obsessed with ill will, destroys living beings; takes what is not given; covets and then goes to other’s wives; tells lies, and encourages others to do the same. Now, do such actions conduce to his ruin and suffering for a long time?”

“Yes, Venerable sir.”

“Sāḷha, what do you think? Is there such a thing as delusion?”

“Yes, Venerable sir.”

“Delusion has the meaning of ignorance. A deluded person, with a mind drenched in ignorance, destroys living beings; takes what is not given; covets and then goes to other’s wives; tells lies, and encourages others to do the same. Now, do such actions conduce to his ruin and suffering for a long time?”

“Yes, Venerable sir.”

“What do you think, Sāḷha? Are such thoughts and actions wholesome or unwholesome?”

“Venerable sir, they are unwholesome.”

“Are they blameworthy or blameless?”

“Venerable sir, they are blameworthy.”

“Are they reproved or praised by the wise?”

“Venerable sir, they are reproved by the wise.”

“And how do you understand it, when such actions are undertaken and committed, do they conduce to evil and suffering or not?”

“Venerable sir, as I understand it, when such actions are undertaken and committed, they conduce to evil and suffering.”

“In this way, Sāḷha, we have stated to you earlier:

‘Come Sāḷha, do not accept a teaching simply on account of it being disseminated through an oral tradition; by lineage of the teaching; by hearsay; by its scriptures; by logical reasoning alone; by inferential reasoning alone; on the grounds of some authority; by the charisma or

apparent competence of the speaker; or by the eloquent and entertaining nature of their words, whereby you think: *'I have to follow such a teacher because they are my 'teacher.'"*

"However, Sāḷha, when you ponder and know for yourselves thus:

'These thoughts are harmful and damaging; these thoughts are blameworthy; these thoughts are reproved and criticized by all those considered to be truly wise; once acted upon and undertaken, these thoughts would certainly <u>not</u> lead to our welfare or happiness, but instead, they will bring about more suffering, indeed.'

"Then, Sāḷha, you should abandon those thoughts. It was for this reason that it was thus said:

"Come 'Sāḷha, do not accept a teaching simply on account of it being disseminated through an oral tradition; by lineage of the teaching; by hearsay; by its scriptures; by logical reasoning alone; by inferential reasoning alone; on the grounds of some authority; by the charisma or apparent competence of the speaker; or by the eloquent and entertaining nature of their words, whereby you think: *'I have to follow such a teacher because they are my 'teacher.'"*

"However, Sāḷha, when you ponder and know for yourselves thus:

'These thoughts are wholesome; these thoughts are blameless; these thoughts are praised by all those considered to be truly wise; once acted upon and undertaken, these thoughts are conducive to our welfare, and they bring about happiness, for sure.'

"Then, Sāḷha, you should grow such thoughts further and live in harmony with them."

"What do you think, Sāḷha? Is the arising of non-greed in a person conducive to his benefit or to his ruin?"

"Venerable sir, it is for his benefit, and not for his ruin."

"Sāḷha, a person lacking greed, not overcome by greed, with a mind not obsessed by greed, does not destroy living beings; does not take what is not given; he does not covet nor goes to other's wives; he does not tell lies, nor encourages others to engage in unwholesome behavior. Now, do such actions conduce to his benefit and happiness for a long time?"

"Yes, Venerable sir."

"What do you think, Sāḷha? Is the arising of non-anger in a person conducive to his benefit or to his ruin?"

"Venerable sir, it is for his benefit, and not for his ruin."

"Sāḷha, a person lacking anger, not overcome by anger, with a mind not obsessed by anger, does not destroy living beings; does not take what is not given; he does not covet nor goes to other's

wives; he does not tell lies, nor encourages others to engage in unwholesome behavior. Now, do such actions conduce to his benefit and happiness for a long time?"

"Yes, Venerable sir."

"What do you think, Sāḷha? Is the arising of non-delusion in a person conducive to his benefit or to his ruin?"

"Venerable sir, it is for his benefit, and not for his ruin."

"Sāḷha, a person lacking delusion, not overcome by delusion, with a mind not drenched in delusion, does not destroy living beings; does not take what is not given; he does not covet nor goes to other's wives; he does not tell lies, nor encourages others to engage in unwholesome behavior. Now, do such actions conduce to his benefit and happiness for a long time?"

"Yes, Venerable sir."

"What do you think, Sāḷha? Are such thoughts and actions wholesome or unwholesome?"

"Venerable sir, they are wholesome."

"Are they blameworthy or blameless?"

"Venerable sir, they are blameless."

"Are they reproved or praised by the wise?"

"Venerable sir, they are praised by the wise."

"And how do you understand it, when such actions are undertaken and committed, do they conduce to benefit and happiness, or not?"

"Venerable sir, as I understand it, when such actions are undertaken and committed, they conduce to benefit and happiness, indeed."

"In this way, Sāḷha, we have stated earlier:

"Come Sāḷha, do not accept a teaching simply on account of it being disseminated through an oral tradition; by lineage of the teaching; by hearsay; by its scriptures; by logical reasoning alone; by inferential reasoning alone; on the grounds of some authority; by the charisma or apparent competence of the speaker; or by the eloquent and entertaining nature of their words, whereby you think: *'I have to follow such a teacher because they are my 'teacher.'"*

"However, Sāḷha, when you ponder and know for yourselves thus:

'These thoughts are wholesome; these thoughts are blameless; these thoughts are praised by all those considered to be truly wise; once acted upon and undertaken, these thoughts are conducive to our welfare, and they bring about happiness, for sure.'

Then, Sāḷha, you should grow such thoughts further and live in harmony with them.
It was for this reason that it was thus said.

"In this manner, Sāḷha, the Noble Disciple – who is thus free from covetousness, free from anger, free from delusion; clearly comprehending and aware, with mindfulness firmly established – pervades one quarter direction with Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness, so too the second quarter, the third quarter, and the fourth quarter; so above, below and across, in every respect, while radiating with a heart that is fully drenched in Universal Benevolent Loving Kindness, enveloping and growing in all directions, immeasurably, and without any sense of forcefulness, resentment, compulsion, or the slightest antagonism towards anyone or anything.

"Further, he abides pervading one quarter direction with Universal Compassion, so too the second quarter, the third quarter, and the fourth quarter; so above, below and across, in every respect, while radiating with a heart that is fully drenched in Universal Compassion, enveloping and growing in all directions, immeasurably, and without any sense of forcefulness, resentment, compulsion, or the slightest antagonism towards anyone or anything.

"Further, he abides pervading one quarter direction with Universal Altruistic Joy, so too the second quarter, the third quarter, and the fourth quarter; so above, below and across, in every respect, while radiating with a heart that is fully drenched in Universal Altruistic Joy, enveloping and growing in all directions, immeasurably, and without any sense of forcefulness, resentment, compulsion, or the slightest antagonism towards anyone or anything.

"Further, he abides pervading one quarter direction with Equanimity, so too the second quarter, the third quarter, and the fourth quarter; so above, below and across, in every respect, while radiating with a heart that is fully drenched in Equanimity, enveloping and growing in all directions, immeasurably, and without any sense of forcefulness, resentment, compulsion, or the slightest antagonism towards anyone or anything.

"Then, he knows and understands: *'There is this which is inferior. There is this that is superior. And there is an escape beyond this world of perceptions.'*

"When he knows and sees thus, his mind is released and liberated from the contaminant of sensual desires, from the contaminant of becoming, and from the contaminant of ignorance. When it is thus liberated, there arises in him the knowledge that birth is destroyed, indeed, the Holy Life has been fully lived, what should have been done is now done, with no more becoming to any state of being.

"He also sees and understands thus:

'Earlier, when there was greed, and because of that, what was experienced was unwholesome, but now with greed being no more, there is only wholesomeness. Earlier there was anger, and because of that, what was experienced was unwholesome, but now with anger being no more, there is only wholesomeness. Earlier there was delusion, and because of that, what was experienced was unwholesome, but now with delusion being no more, there is only wholesomeness.'

"Thus, he lives his life in the here and now, while fully quenched, contented, extinguished, and cooled, abiding even beyond the divine state of Brahmā."

67. ***Kathāvatthu Sutta*** *(Topics of Conversation)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three topics of conversation. What three?

Either a conversation is about the past, such as: *'it was so in the past.'*

Or it is a conversation about the future, such as: *'it will be so in the future.'*

Or it is a conversation about the present, such as: *'it is so at present.'*

"Bhikkhus, by the way a person engages in a conversation, it should be known whether he is in fact someone fit to have a discussion with, or not.

"Bhikkhus, when such a person is asked a question that needs a direct answer, and he fails to give the direct answer; when asked a question that needs an explanatory answer, he fails to give the explanatory answer; when asked a question that invites or needs a counter question, he fails to counter question; and when asked a question that requires for it to be put aside, and he fails to put it aside, then it should be known that this person is unfit to have a discussion with.

"But Bhikkhus, when this person is asked a question that needs a direct answer, and he gives the direct answer; when asked a question that needs an explanatory answer, he gives the explanatory answer; when asked a question that needs a counter question, he counter-questions; and when asked a question that requires for it to be put aside, and he does put it aside, then it should be known that this person is fit for engaging in a conversation with.

"Bhikkhus, by the way a person engages in a conversation, it should be known whether he is in fact someone fit to have a discussion with, or not.

"Bhikkhus, if this person is asked a question and he does not stand strongly in his position in relation to the other's; if he does not adhere to his understanding and keeps shifting his position in relation to the other's; if he does not know how to demonstrate or express his views and has no method to defend his argument; and if he does not stand firm to the truth of what he thinks is valid about his argument, then it should be known that this person is unfit for conversation.

“But Bhikkhus, if this person is asked a question and he does stand strongly in his position in relation to the other’s; if he does adhere to his understanding instead of shifting his position in relation to the other’s; if he knows how to demonstrate and express his views, while using various methods to defend his argument; and if he does stand firm to the truth of what he thinks is valid about his argument, then it should be known that this person is fit for conversation.

“Bhikkhus, by the way a person engages in a conversation, it should be known whether he is in fact someone fit to have a discussion with, or not.

“Bhikkhus, if when asked a question, this person evades the question and leads the conversation aside to irrelevant matters, or shows resentment or ill-temper, malice and mistrust, then it should be known that this person is unfit for conversation.

“But Bhikkhus, if when asked a question, this person does not evade the question and does not lead the conversation aside to irrelevant matters, nor shows resentment or ill-temper, malice or mistrust, then it should be known that this person is fit for conversation.

“Bhikkhus, by the way a person engages in a conversation, it should be known whether he is in fact someone fit to have a discussion with, or not.

“Bhikkhus, if when asked a question, this person swears, belittles, mocks, and seizes an opportunity by focusing on a slight error, then it should be known that this person is unfit for conversation.

“But Bhikkhus, if when asked a question, this person does not swear, or belittle, or mock, nor focuses on a slight error, then it should be known that this person is fit for conversation.

“Bhikkhus, by the way a person engages in a conversation, it should be known whether he is in fact someone fit to have a discussion with, or not.

“Without attentive listening, there is no foundation, but with attentive listening, there is a foundation. Therefore, the one who has such a foundation, can know things thoroughly, and by knowing things accurately, he dispels specific things and realizes specific things. He who knows thoroughly, knows to dispel specific things and to realize specific things, and thereby to experience the specific Release, which is Liberation.
“Bhikkhus, it is for this reason that a conversation takes place. And where there is consultation, there has to be the foundation of careful and attentive listening present in the individual. After all, that is what sets the person on the straight Path to the complete Liberation of the Heart, by no longer gripping onto anything.

‘While speaking with the intent to harm, being rigid in one’s opinions,
Ignoble and full to the brim with pride, lacking any virtue whatsoever,
One simply keeps looking for an opening or an opportunity to attack another,
Preparing to pounce at the slightest error that the other makes,
As one speaks harshly, rejoicing in another’s defeat,
Much like a hunter towards its prey.

But this is not how the Noble Ones converse, at all.
For, the wise person knows how to wait for the right moment to speak;
Talking only on The Dhamma, or the lives of the Noble Ones.
Thus, lacking any pride whatsoever,
They make no enemies and do not become elated;
With hearts that no longer grip or grab onto anything,
They are merciful and harmless towards those with opposing views to theirs.

Without jealousy or envy,
Basing one's speech on one's own right understanding and knowledge,
He speaks only to discuss words that are good,
While inspiring confidence and satisfying one's desire for the harmonious and good end.
This is the way Noble Ones discuss and converse,
Not engaging in anything evil or wrong,
Lacking any harsh words or intent of harm,
Thus, the wise truly speak little, sharing knowledge and spreading reconciliation.
This indeed is how the Noble Ones speak.'

68. ***Aññatitthiya (Titthiya) Sutta*** *(Those holding other views)*

"Bhikkhus, if wandering ascetics of other sects were to ask you:

'Friends, there are these three things to consider. What three? Greed, hatred, and delusion. Friends, what is the difference between these three things?'

"How would you reply or explain your position to those wandering ascetics of other sects?"

"Venerable Sir, The Blessed One is indeed our Leader and Guide, hence, all that we have learned are rooted in Him, for He indeed is the very Source of The Dhamma! Thus, we rely upon The Blessed One, Our Teacher in this beautiful Dhamma.

"It would be truly beneficial, therefore, if The Blessed One were to explain to us the meaning of these words, so that we may retain it by practicing and living accordingly."

"Then, Bhikkhus, listen carefully and attend closely to what I shall say."

"Yes, Bhante," the Bhikkhus responded.

And The Blessed One continued instructing:

"Bhikkhus, if wandering ascetics of other sects were to ask you:

'Friends, there are these three things to consider. What three? Greed, hatred, and delusion. Friends, what is the difference between these three things?'

"Then, you should reply in this manner:

'Friends, greed is a fault of lesser weight but takes a long time to fade away. Hatred is a fault of greater weight and it fades away quickly. Delusion is a fault of greater weight, and it takes a long time to fade away.'

"And if they were to ask further:

'But, friends, what is the reason for unarisen greed to arise, and the already arisen greed to develop and increase?'

"Your reply then, Bhikkhus, should be the following:

'Friends, the presence of an attractive object is the reason for unarisen greed to arise, and for the already arisen greed to develop and increase. This because, when one unwisely pays attention to an attractive object, then unarisen greed arises, whereas the already arisen greed develops further and increases.

'Therefore, friends, this is the reason for unarisen greed to arise and for arisen greed to develop and increase.'

"And if they were to ask further:

'But, friends, what is the reason for the unarisen anger or hatred to arise, and for the already arisen hatred or anger to develop and increase?'

"Then, Bhikkhus, your reply should be the following:

'Friends, the presence of a disagreeable object is the reason for unarisen anger or hatred to arise, and for the already arisen hatred or anger to develop and increase. This because, when one unwisely pays attention to a disagreeable object, then unarisen hatred or anger arises, and the already arisen hatred or anger develops further and increases.

'Therefore, friends, this is the reason for unarisen anger or hatred to arise, and for the already arisen hatred or anger to develop and increase.'

"And if they were to ask further:

'But, friends, what is the reason for unarisen delusion to arise, and for the already arisen delusion to develop and increase?'

"Your reply then, Bhikkhus, should be the following:

'Friends, the presence of unwise attention is the reason for unarisen delusion to arise, and for the already arisen delusion to develop and increase. This because, when one is unwise in his attention, then unarisen delusion arises, and the already arisen delusion develops further and increases.

'Therefore, friends, this is the reason for unarisen delusion to arise, and for the already arisen delusion to develop and increase.'

"And if they were to ask further:

'But, friends, what is the reason for the non-arising of unarisen greed, and for the arisen greed to just dissipate and fade away?'

"Your reply then, Bhikkhus, should be the following:

'Friends, the reason is the presence of an unattractive object. This because, when one wisely pays attention to an unattractive object, then unarisen greed does not arise and arisen greed is abandoned and thus dissipates and fades away.

'Therefore, friends, this is the reason for the non-arising of unarisen greed and for the arisen greed to just dissipate and fade away.'

"And if they were to ask further:

'But, friends, what is the reason for the non-arising of unarisen hatred, and for the arisen hatred to just dissipate and fade away?'

"Your reply then, Bhikkhus, should be the following:

'Friends, it is due to the heart having experienced liberation through mettā (universal benevolent loving-kindness). This because, when the heart is liberated through loving-kindness, then unarisen hatred does not arise and arisen hatred is abandoned and thus dissipates and fades away.

'Therefore, friends, this is the reason for the non-arising of unarisen hatred and for the arisen hatred to just dissipate and fade away.'

"And if they were to ask further:

'But, friends, what is the reason for the non-arising of unarisen delusion, and for the arisen delusion to just dissipate and fade away?'

"Your reply then, Bhikkhus, should be the following:

'Friends, it is due to the presence of wise radical attention (yoniso manasikāra). This because, when one wisely applies his attention, then unarisen delusion does not arise, and the arisen delusion is abandoned and thus dissipates and fades away.

'Therefore, friends, this is the reason for the non-arising of unarisen delusion and for the arisen delusion to just dissipate and fade away."

69. ***Akusalamūla Sutta*** *(Damaging & Harmful Roots)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three damaging and harmful roots. What three?

Greed is a damaging and harmful root; hatred is a damaging and harmful root; delusion is a damaging and harmful root.

a. Bhikkhus, whenever one has greed, it is a damaging and a harmful state. This because, with greed as their root, one becomes cruel, and whatever that person does, whether through body, speech, or mind, it becomes damaging and harmful, producing much detrimental consequences. And when a person is overcome by greed, the mind becomes obsessed and exhausted, as he covertly seeks to inflict suffering and discontent upon others, by imprisoning, humiliating, banishing, and killing them, thinking: *"I am powerful, and I want to add more power to myself."* Hence, all this is truly damaging and harmful, while also producing much demerit.

Thus, born from greed, originating from greed, because of greed, damaging and harmful thoughts and their evil qualities arise and accrue in the person.

b. When one is inflamed by hatred, it is a damaging and a harmful state. This because, with hatred as their root, one becomes cruel, and whatever that person does, whether through body, speech, or mind, it becomes damaging and harmful, producing much detrimental consequences. And when a person is overcome by hatred, the mind becomes obsessed and exhausted, as he covertly seeks to inflict suffering and discontent upon others, by imprisoning, humiliating, banishing, and killing them, thinking: *"I am powerful, and I want to add more power to myself."* Hence, all this is truly damaging and harmful, while also producing much demerit.

Thus, born from hatred, originating from hatred, because of hatred, damaging and harmful thoughts and their evil qualities arise and accrue in the person.

c. When one is deluded through willful ignorance, it is a damaging and a harmful state. This because, with delusion as their root, one becomes cruel, and whatever that person does, whether through body, speech, or mind, it becomes damaging and harmful, producing much detrimental consequences. And when a person is overcome by delusion, the mind becomes obsessed and exhausted, as he covertly seeks to inflict suffering and discontent upon others, by imprisoning, humiliating, banishing, and killing them, thinking: *"I am powerful, and I want to add more power to myself."* Hence, all this is damaging and harmful, while also producing much demerit.

Thus, born from delusion, originating from delusion, because of delusion, damaging and harmful thoughts and their evil qualities arise and accrue in the person.

Bhikkhus, this kind of person is known as one who does not speak at the proper time, does not tell the truth, does not speak what is essential or beneficial, as he does not talk according to either The Dhamma or The Discipline.

And Bhikkhus, why is it that this kind of person is known as one who does not speak at the proper time, does not tell the truth, does not speak what is essential and beneficial, as he does not talk according to either The Dhamma or The Discipline?

It is because, Bhikkhus, this person covertly seeks to inflict suffering and discontent upon others, by imprisoning, humiliating, banishing, and killing them, thinking: *"I am powerful, and I want to add more power to myself."*

And when confronted as to the true nature of his hidden evil intentions and actions, this person despises the one reproaching him and calling him out, instead of acknowledging the truth about his own evil behavior.

Thus, he does not come forward to tell the truth, nor arouses the intention or thought to get rid of that stain in his heart, while denying the validity of the reproach and accusation addressed to him, claiming them to be untrue.

Therefore, this kind of person is known as one who does not speak at the proper time, does not tell the truth, does not speak what is essential or beneficial, as he does not talk according either to The Dhamma or The Discipline.

To this end, Bhikkhus, a person with a mind obsessed with damaging and harmful thoughts born of greed, here and now abides in suffering, with worries, troubles, and fears throughout his life, and with the breakup of the body after death, he will not be heading anywhere else other than to bad state of rebirth, in the hell realms.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, such a person with a mind obsessed with damaging and harmful thoughts born of anger or hatred, here and now abides in suffering, with worries, troubles, and fears throughout his life, and with the breakup of the body after death, he will not be heading anywhere else other than to bad state of rebirth, in the hell realms.

And similarly, Bhikkhus, such a person with a mind obsessed with damaging and harmful thoughts born of delusion, here and now abides in suffering, with worries, troubles, and fears throughout his life, and with the breakup of the body after death, he will not be heading anywhere else other than to a bad state of rebirth, in the hell realms.

Bhikkhus, just like a Sāla or a Dhava tree or an aspen that finds itself strangled and encroached upon by three Māluvā creepers that cause its certain destruction, in the same manner, a person with a mind obsessed with damaging and harmful thoughts born of greed, here and now abides in suffering, with worries, troubles, and fears throughout his life. And with the breakup of the body

after death, he will not be heading anywhere else other than to a bad state of rebirth, in the hell realms.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, such a person with a mind obsessed with damaging and harmful thoughts born of anger or hatred, here and now abides in suffering, with worries, troubles, and fears throughout his life, and with the breakup of the body after death, he will not be heading anywhere else other than to a bad state of rebirth, in the hell realms.

And similarly, Bhikkhus, such a person with a mind obsessed with damaging and harmful thoughts born of delusion, here and now abides in suffering, with worries, troubles and fears throughout his life, and with the breakup of the body after death, he will not be heading anywhere else other than to a bad state of rebirth, in the hell realms.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, these are the three damaging and harmful roots.

However, Bhikkhus, there are also these three beneficial and helpful roots. What three?

Non-greed is a beneficial and helpful root; non-hatred is a beneficial and helpful root; and non-delusion is a beneficial and helpful root.

a. Bhikkhus, whenever one does not have greed, it is a beneficial and a helpful state. With non-greed as their root, whatever that person does, whether through body, speech, or mind, it becomes beneficial and helpful, producing much good and favorable consequences. And when a person is thus not overcome by greed, not obsessed with greed, the mind becomes light as he lives honestly and does not seek to covertly inflict suffering and discontent upon others, nor attempts to imprison, humiliate, banish, harm or kill them, thinking: *"I am powerful, and I want to add more power to myself."* All this is wholesome, producing much good and favorable results.

Thus, born from non-greed, originating from non-greed, because of non-greed, many a beneficial and helpful thoughts and their lovely qualities arise and accrue in the person.

b. Bhikkhus, whenever one does not have hatred, it is a beneficial and a helpful state. With non-hatred as their root, whatever that person does, whether through body, speech, or mind, it becomes beneficial and helpful, producing much good and favorable consequences. And when a person is thus not overcome by hatred, not obsessed with hatred, the mind becomes light, as he lives honestly and does not seek to covertly inflict suffering and discontent upon others, nor attempts to imprison, humiliate, banish, harm or kill them, thinking: *"I am powerful, and I want to add more power to myself."* All this is beneficial and helpful, producing much good and favorable results.

Thus, born from non-hatred, originating from non-hatred, because of non-hatred, many a beneficial and helpful thoughts and their lovely qualities arise and accrue in the person.

c. Bhikkhus, whenever one does not have delusion, it is a beneficial and a helpful state. With non-delusion as their root, whatever that person does, whether through body, speech, or mind, it

becomes beneficial and helpful, producing much good and favorable consequences. And when a person is thus not overcome by delusion, not obsessed with delusion, the mind becomes light, as he lives honestly and does not seek to covertly inflict suffering and discontent upon others, nor attempts to imprison, humiliate, banish, harm or kill them, thinking: *"I am powerful, and I want to add more power to myself."* All this is beneficial and helpful, producing much good and favorable results.

Thus, born from non-delusion, originating from non-delusion, because of non-delusion, many a beneficial and helpful thoughts and their lovely qualities arise and accrue in the person.

Bhikkhus, this kind of person is known as one who speaks at the proper time, tells the truth, speaks what is essential and beneficial, as he does talk according to The Dhamma and The Discipline.

And why is it, Bhikkhus, that this kind of person is known as one who speaks at the proper time, tells the truth, speaks what is essential and beneficial, as he does talk according to The Dhamma and The Discipline?

It is because he lives honestly and not seeking to covertly inflict suffering and discontent upon others, nor attempts to imprison, humiliate, banish, harm or kill them, thinking: *"I am powerful, and I want to add more power to myself."*

And when confronted as to the true nature of his acts, this person does not despise the one reproaching him and thereby acknowledges his own mistakes. Thus, he comes forward to tell the truth, arousing the thought to get rid of the blemish, welcoming the reproach and accusation, while making the effort to reveal what is to be revealed.

Therefore, this kind of person is known as one who speaks at the proper time, tells the truth, speaks what is essential and beneficial, as he talks according to The Dhamma and The Discipline.

Bhikkhus, with a mind thus immersed in beneficial and helpful thoughts born of non-greed, such a person, here and now, abides free of worries, troubles, or fears throughout his life, dwelling happily, for he has cut the root of greed, making it like a palm stump, destroying the need for any future re-becoming, whereby in this very life, he attains Nibbāna.

Bhikkhus, with a mind thus immersed in beneficial and helpful thoughts born of non-hatred, such a person, here and now, abides free of worries, troubles, or fears throughout his life, dwelling happily, for he has cut the root of hatred, making it like a palm stump, destroying the need for any future re-becoming, whereby in this very life, he attains Nibbāna.

Bhikkhus, with a mind thus immersed in beneficial and helpful thoughts born of non-delusion, such a person, here and now, abides free of worries, troubles, or fears throughout his life, dwelling happily, for he has cut the root of delusion, making it like a palm stump, destroying the need for future re-becoming, whereby in this very life, he attains Nibbāna.

Bhikkhus, imagine a Sāla or a Dhava tree or an aspen that was being suffocated and encroached upon by three Māluvā creepers causing its destruction, where a man comes along with a hoe and a basket and cuts the roots of the Māluvā creepers, digging them up from their roots, even down to their finest rootlets, and then uses an ax to cut them into finer and finer pieces, and later dries them up in the open air, then burns and turns them into ashes that get blown into the wind or thrown into a fast-flowing river.

In the same way, Bhikkhus, with a mind immersed in beneficial and helpful thoughts born of non-greed, such a person, here and now, abides free of worries, troubles, or fears throughout his life, dwelling happily, for he has cut the root of greed, making it like a palm stump, destroying the need for any future re-becoming, whereby in this very life, he attains Nibbāna.

Bhikkhus, with a mind thus immersed in beneficial and helpful thoughts born of non-hatred, such a person, here and now, abides free of worries, troubles, or fears throughout his life, dwelling happily, for he has cut the root of hatred, making it like a palm stump, destroying the need for any future re-becoming, whereby in this very life, he attains Nibbāna.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, with a mind thus immersed in beneficial and helpful thoughts born of non-delusion, such a person, here and now, abides free of worries, troubles, or fears throughout his life, dwelling happily, for he has cut the root of delusion, making it like a palm stump, destroying the need for future re-becoming, whereby in this very life, he attains Nibbāna.

Bhikkhus, these are the three beneficial and helpful roots.

70. ***Uposatha Sutta*** *(The Fortnightly Observances)*

I have personally heard this.

At one time The Blessed One was staying at the Pubba monastery, the palace of Migāra's mother in Sāvatthī. Then, on that full moon day, Visākhā, Migāra's mother, went and approached The Blessed One, and having paid homage to The Teacher, she sat down to one side.

Then, The Blessed One said this to her:

"Visākhā, why have you come during the daytime?"

And Visākhā replied by saying:

"Bhante, today being the full moon day, I am observing the eight precepts of the Uposatha."

"Visākhā, there are these three full moon Uposatha observances. What three?

"The Uposatha of the cattle herd; the Uposatha of the Niganṭhas (Jains); and the Uposatha of the Noble Ones.

a. "Now, what Visākhā, is the Uposatha observance of the cattle herd?

"Visākhā, just like the cowherder who returns the cattle in the evening to their owner and reflects thus:

'Today the cattle grazed in such a place, drank water in such a place; tomorrow the cattle will graze in such a place, and drink water in such a place.'

"In the same manner, Visākhā, someone here having observed the eight precepts of the Uposatha reflects thus:

'Today I ate such and such edibles and drank such and such nourishing drinks. Tomorrow, I will eat such and such edibles and drink such and such nourishing drinks.'

"Thus, he spends the day with a mind overcome with greed and covetousness.

"Therefore, Visākhā, this is the Uposatha observance of the cattle herd, which is not of great fruit or benefit, nor does it bring good results, as it lacks in permeating splendor.

b. "And what, Visākhā, is the Uposatha observance of the Nigaṇṭhas (Jains)?

"Visākhā, there are those ascetics called Nigaṇṭhas (the followers of Jainism), who instruct their disciples thus:

'Come! Good man, do not punish living beings up to seven hundred miles in the eastern direction; do not punish living beings up to seven hundred miles in the western direction; do not punish living beings up to seven hundred miles in the northern direction; and do not punish living beings up to seven hundred miles in the southern direction!'

"Thus, their Uposatha observance is directed selectively with sympathy towards some but not others. Further, on the Uposatha observance day, a Nigaṇṭha gives the following instruction to his disciples:

'Come! Good man. Take off all your clothes and declare: 'By doing this and removing my clothes, nowhere do I belong to anyone, nor anyone belongs to me; I have no desires for any place or thing, and I have no attachments to any place or thing!'

"Meanwhile, however, his mother and father do know him and maintain their bond with him very well, while declaring: *'this is our son,'* and he too knows them and maintains his bond with them very well, while declaring, *'this is my mother and father.'*
His wife and children also know and maintain their bond with him very well, while declaring: *'this is my husband and this is our father,'* just as he also knows and maintains his bond with them very well, while declaring: *'this is my wife and children.'*

His slaves and workmen know him and maintain their bond with him very well, while declaring as well: *'this is our master,'* just as he also knows and maintains his bond with them very well, while declaring: *'these are my slaves and workmen.'*

"Thus, at the time of Uposatha, when he is supposed to be engaged in observing the precepts, including refraining from telling lies, he speaks lies, I say. And at the end of that night, he goes back to his estate and home, while enjoying and partaking of his wealth and possessions, even before they are offered to him, and thus he takes what is not given.

"Visākhā, this is the Uposatha observance of the Nigaṇṭhas, which is not of great fruit or benefit at all, nor does it bring any good or meaningful results, as it lacks in permeating splendor.

c. "And what, Visākhā, is the Uposatha observance of The Noble Ones?

"Here, Visākhā, the Uposatha observance is seen as the methodical cleansing of the defiled heart through exertion.

"And how, Visākhā, can the Uposatha observance be a methodical cleansing of the defiled heart through exertion?

"Here, Visākhā, the Noble Disciple recollects The Tathāgata thus:

'The Blessed One is an Arahant, Perfectly Awakened, endowed with Sublime Knowledge and Supremely Pure Conduct; He indeed is The Well-Gone, The Knower of existence, The Matchless and Incomparable Tamer of those to be tamed; The Teacher of Devas and humans; The Enlightened and Blessed.'

"And while recollecting The Tathāgata thus, the Noble Disciple's mind brightens up, becoming tranquil, where joy arises and the defilements in the heart fade and are washed away, just like the dirty head hair that is methodically cleansed through careful exertion.
In the same manner, Visākhā, the defiled mind gets a methodical cleansing through exertion.

"And how, Visākhā, is the dirty head hair methodically cleansed through careful exertion?

"With the help of a good brush, soap, water and the suitable and persistent efforts of a person to wash it, the dirty head hair gets a methodical cleansing.
In the same manner, the defiled heart gets a methodical cleaning.

"So too, the Noble Disciple recollects The Tathāgata thus:

'The Blessed One is an Arahant, Perfectly Awakened, endowed with Sublime Knowledge and Supremely Pure Conduct; He indeed is The Well-Gone, The Knower of existence, The Matchless and Incomparable Tamer of those to be tamed; The Teacher of Devas and humans; The Enlightened and Blessed.'

“Thus, while recollecting The Tathāgata, the Noble Disciple’s mind brightens up, becoming tranquil, where joy arises and the defilements in the heart fade and are washed away, just like the dirty head hair that is methodically cleansed through careful exertion.

“Visākhā, this is called the Noble Disciple observing the Brahmā’s observance, as one is seen to live with Brahmā. On account of this, his heart brightens up and becomes tranquil, while joy arises and the defilements in the heart fade and are washed away.
In the same manner, Visākhā, the defiled heart gets a methodical cleansing through exertion.

“And what, Visākhā, is meant by ‘the methodical cleansing of the defiled heart through exertion’?

“Here Visākhā, the Noble Disciple recollects The Dhamma thus:
‘The Dhamma of The Blessed One is well expounded; it is directly visible here and now; immediately effective; inviting one to come and investigate for oneself; taking one straight forward, undeterred; to be understood and personally realized by the wise; each for oneself.’

“And when recollecting The Dhamma in this manner, the Noble Disciple’s mind brightens up and becomes tranquil, where joy arises and the defilements in the heart fade and are washed away, just like the dirt from the body that is methodically cleansed through careful exertion.
In the same manner, Visākhā, the defiled heart gets a methodical cleansing through exertion.

“And how, Visākhā, is the dirty body methodically cleaned through exertion?

“With a brush, soap, water and the suitable and persistent efforts of a person washing it, the dirty body gets a methodical cleansing.
In the same manner, Visākhā, the defiled heart gets a methodical cleansing.

“So too, the Noble Disciple recollects The Dhamma thus:

‘The Dhamma of The Blessed One is well expounded; it is directly visible here and now; immediately effective; inviting one to come and investigate for oneself; taking one straight forward, undeterred; to be understood and personally realized by the wise; each for oneself.’

“Thus, while recollecting The Dhamma in this manner, the Noble Disciple’s mind brightens up and becomes tranquil, where joy arises and the defilements in the heart fade and are washed away.

“Now, Visākhā, this is called the Noble Disciple who observes the Uposatha observance of The Dhamma, who lives and dwells with The Dhamma, because while reflecting on the qualities of The Dhamma, the defiled heart gets a methodical cleansing through exertion.

“Further, Visākhā, what is the methodical cleansing of the defiled heart through exertion?

“Here, Visākhā, the Noble Disciple recollects The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus thus:

'The Saṅgha of the Disciples of The Blessed One is practicing well the Good Path, which is the Threefold Training of Sīla, Samādhi, Paññā (virtuous living, mental cultivation, and development of wisdom); the Disciples of The Blessed One are practicing the Straight Path of the Threefold Training, which is the Middle Path; the Disciples of The Blessed One are practicing wisely to realize Nibbāna, in a methodical way; the Disciples of The Blessed One are practicing The Dhamma in harmony; Such are the Four Pairs of Eight Great Beings, comprised of the Eight Noble Disciples of The Blessed One; the ones to be honored and respected, deserving of hospitality, worthy of offerings; to be venerated with reverential salutation, with one's palms pressed together at the heart, for they are indeed the Incomparable Field of merit for the world.'

"When recollecting The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus thus, the Noble Disciple's mind brightens up and becomes tranquil, where joy arises and the defilements in the heart fade and are washed away, just like the dirty cloth that is cleansed through exertion.
In the same way, Visākhā, the defiled heart gets a methodical cleansing through exertion.

"And how, Visākhā, is the dirty cloth methodically cleansed through exertion?

"With water and clay, with cow dung and the suitable and persistent efforts of a person, the dirty cloth gets a methodical cleansing.
In the same manner, Visākhā, the defiled mind gets a methodical cleansing.

"So too, the Noble Disciple recollects The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus thus:

'The Saṅgha of the Disciples of The Blessed One is practicing well the Good Path, which is the Threefold Training of Sīla, Samādhi, Paññā (virtuous living, mental cultivation, and development of wisdom); the Disciples of The Blessed One are practicing the Straight Path of the Threefold Training, which is the Middle Path; the Disciples of The Blessed One are practicing wisely to realize Nibbāna, in a methodical way; the Disciples of The Blessed One are practicing The Dhamma in harmony; Such are the Four Pairs of Eight Great Beings, comprised of the Eight Noble Disciples of The Blessed One; the ones to be honored and respected, deserving of hospitality, worthy of offerings; to be venerated with reverential salutation with one's palms pressed together at the heart, for they are indeed the Incomparable Field of merit for the world.'

"When recollecting The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus thus, the Noble Disciple's mind brightens up and becomes tranquil, where joy arises and the defilements in the heart fade and are washed away.

"Visākhā, this is called the Noble Disciple who observes the Uposatha observance of The Saṅgha, who lives and dwells with The Noble Saṅgha, and in considering the qualities of The Noble and Pure Saṅgha, the defiled mind gets a methodical cleansing through exertion.

"Furthermore, Visākhā, how does the defiled mind get a methodical cleansing?

"Here, Visākhā, the Noble Disciple recollects his own virtuous behavior, which is unbroken, flawless, and spotless, for he lives a blameless life, one that is unblemished, free from greed,

with qualities that are praised by the wise as conducive to the deepening of collected stability of mind.

"And when recollecting his own pure conduct and virtues thus, the Noble Disciple's mind brightens up and becomes tranquil, where joy arises and the defilements in the heart fade and are washed away, just like a dirty mirror is cleansed and polished through exertion.
In the same manner, Visākhā, the defiled heart gets a methodical cleansing through exertion.

"And how, Visākhā, does the dirty mirror get a methodical cleansing, becoming well-polished?

"With oil, chalk, a tail brush and the suitable and persistent efforts of a person, the dirty mirror gets a methodical cleansing through exertion, becoming thus polished.
In the same manner, Visākhā, the defiled heart gets a methodical cleansing through exertion.

"So too, the Noble Disciple recollects his own virtuous behavior, which is unbroken, flawless, and spotless, for he lives a blameless life, one that is unblemished, free from greed, with qualities that are praised by the wise as conducive to the deepening of collected stability of mind.

"And when recollecting his own pure conduct and virtues thus, the Noble Disciple's mind brightens up and becomes tranquil, where joy arises and the defilements in the heart fade and are washed away.

"Therefore, Visākhā, this is called the Noble Disciple who observes the Uposatha observance of his own purity of conduct and virtue; who lives and dwells with virtuous behavior; and in considering his own true and virtuous behavior, the defiled heart gets a methodical cleansing through exertion.

"Further, Visākhā, how does the defiled mind get a methodical cleansing through exertion?

"Here, Visākhā, the Noble Disciple recollects the Devas thus:

'There are the Devas ruled by the Four Guardian Kings, the Tāvatiṁsā Devas in the company of the Thirty-Three, ruled by Lord Sakka, King of the Devas; there are the Yāma Devas, the Tusita Devas, the Nimmānaratī Devas, who delight in creation, the Paranimmita Devas, who enjoy controlling the creation of other Devas; the Devas in the company of Brahmā Gods, and there are those Devas who are even higher than those.'

"Here, the Noble Disciple reflects further:

'Just like those many Devas, I too possess strong faith, virtuous behavior, knowledge of The Dhamma, generosity, and wisdom that these heavenly beings once possessed while they were still human beings here, with the help and support of which, after death, on disappearing from here, they immediately reappeared there, in those higher realms of happiness and delight.'

"Thus, whenever the Noble Disciple recollects the faith, virtuous behavior, the knowledge of The Dhamma, along with the generosity and wisdom possessed by those Devas, and compares them

to his own, his heart immediately brightens up and becomes tranquil, where joy arises and the defilements in the heart fade and are washed away, much like impure gold or silver gets purified and cleansed.
In the same manner, Visākhā, the defiled heart gets a methodical cleansing through exertion.

"And how, Visākhā, does impure gold and silver get a methodical cleansing?

"With a red-hot burning and bellowing furnace, salt, a coating of red chalk, a tube or a pipe, pincers, and the persistent and suitable efforts of a man, the gold and silver have their dirt and impurities removed as they get purified through the methodical cleansing they receive.
In the same manner, Visākhā, the defiled heart gets a methodical cleansing through exertion.

"So too, the Noble Disciple recollects the Devas thus:

'There are the Devas ruled by the Four Guardian Kings, the Tāvatiṁsā Devas in the company of the Thirty-Three, ruled by Lord Sakka, King of the Devas; there are the Yāma Devas, the Tusita Devas, the Nimmānaratī Devas who delight in creation, the Paranimmita Devas who enjoy controlling the creation of other Devas; the Devas in the company of Brahmā Gods, and there are those Devas who are even higher than those.'

"Furthermore, the Noble Disciple reflects:

'Just like those many Devas, I too possess strong faith, virtuous behavior, knowledge of The Dhamma, generosity, and wisdom that these heavenly beings once possessed while they were still human beings here, with the help and support of which, after death, on disappearing from here, they immediately reappeared there, in those higher realms of happiness and delight.'

"Thus, whenever the Noble Disciple recollects the faith, virtuous behavior, the knowledge of The Dhamma, along with the generosity and wisdom possessed by those Devas, and compares them to his own, his heart immediately brightens up and becomes tranquil, where joy arises and the defilements in the heart fade and are washed away, much like impure gold or silver gets purified and cleansed.

"This itself, Visākhā, is called the Noble Disciple who observes the Uposatha through the observance of the Devas, while he lives alongside and in the company of the Devas.

"In the same manner, Visākhā, the defiled heart gets a methodical cleansing through exertion.

"Further, Visākhā, the Noble Disciple reflects thus:

'As long as life lasts, the Arahants refrain from taking the life of living beings, having thrown away rods, sticks and weapons; they go on living with consideration, behaving kindly towards all, with Universal Compassion for all living beings. Similarly, this day and night, I too will refrain from taking the life of living beings, while also having thrown away rods, sticks and weapons; I will go living with consideration while behaving kindly towards all, with Universal

Compassion for all living beings. By imitating the Arahants thus, may my Uposatha observance be complete.

'As long as life lasts, the Arahants refrain from taking what is not given, taking only what is given and being satisfied with that, dwelling free from covetousness or greed for the possessions of others. Similarly, this day and night, I too will refrain from taking what is not given, taking only what is given and being satisfied with that, dwelling free from covetousness or greed for the possessions of others. By imitating the Arahants thus, may my Uposatha observance be complete.

'As long as life lasts, the Arahants refrain from living the low life of engaging in sexual conduct, observing celibacy throughout, living the holy life by giving up sexual behavior completely. Similarly, this day and night, I too will refrain from living the low life of engaging in sexual conduct and will observe celibacy, living the holy life by giving up sexual behavior completely. By imitating the Arahants thus, may my Uposatha observance be complete.'

'As long as life lasts, the Arahants refrain from telling lies and using false speech, speaking only what is truth, adhering to the truth, while being trustworthy and reliable, and not deceivers of the world. Similarly, this day and night, I too will refrain from telling lies or using false speech, speaking only what is truth, adhering to the truth, while being trustworthy and reliable, and not a deceiver of the world. By imitating the Arahants thus, may my Uposatha observance be complete.'

'As long as life lasts, the Arahants refrain from taking intoxicants of any kind, whether liquor, wine, or any other mind-altering substance that causes heedlessness. Similarly, this day and night, I too will refrain from taking intoxicants of any kind, whether liquor, wine, or any other substance that causes heedlessness. By imitating the Arahants thus, may my Uposatha observance be complete.'

'As long as life lasts, the Arahants live by eating only once a day, refraining from eating at night and from taking food outside the proper time. Similarly, this day and night, I too will eat only once, refraining from eating at night and from taking food outside the proper time. By imitating the Arahants thus, may my Uposatha observance be complete.

'As long as life lasts, the Arahants refrain from dancing, singing, playing or listening to instrumental music, attending entertainments and shows, from beautifying the self with adornments, scents, anointments, bearing flowers and decorating the self with garlands. Similarly, this day and night, I too will refrain from dancing, singing, playing or listening to instrumental music, attending entertainments and shows, from beautifying the self with adornments, scents, anointments, bearing flowers and decorating the self with garlands. By imitating the Arahants thus, may my Uposatha observance be complete.'

'As long as life lasts, the Arahants refrain from using high, luxurious, and lofty beds and seats, and instead use a low seat or a couch, or make a straw mat to lie down upon. Similarly, this day and night, I too will refrain from using high, luxurious, and lofty beds and seats, and instead will use a low seat or a couch, or make a straw mat to lie down upon. By imitating the Arahants thus, may my Uposatha observance be complete.'

"Visākhā, this is the noble Uposatha observance of the full moon day, which when observed thus, it becomes of much fruit and benefit, as it brings extraordinarily good and wonderful results, with permeating splendor.

"And what, Visākhā, is the extent of the fruits, benefits, extraordinarily good and wonderful results, and the permeating splendor of such a noble Uposatha observance?

"Here, Visākhā, consider a ruler or a king presiding over these sixteen provincial states of Anga, Magadha, Kāsi, Kosala, Vajji, Malla, Ceti, Vanga, Kuru, Pancala, Maccha, Surasena, Assaka, Avanti, Gandhara, and Kamboja, with all their resources of wealth and abounding seven precious treasures. However, all this wealth would not make up *even* one-sixteenth part in comparison to thus fully observing the eight precepts during Uposatha.

"And what is the reason for this?

"Visākhā, it is because human kingship, with its pleasures and seeming magnitude, is truly but a poor trifling when compared to celestial pleasure and happiness.

a. "Thus, Visākhā, fifty years of a human's life is but a single night and a day for the Devas living in the realm of the Four Guardian Kings. Thirty of those days make up a month, and twelve of those months make up a year. Now, bear in mind that the lifespan of these Devas is made up of five hundred celestial years!

"So, it may very well happen, that a man or a woman who has fully observed the eight precepts on the full moon day of Uposatha, reappears after death into the company of the Four Guardian Devas.

"Visākhā, it was on account of this that it was said:

'Visākhā, it is because human kingship, with its pleasures and seeming magnitude, is truly but a poor trifling when compared to celestial pleasure and happiness.'

b. "Furthermore, Visākhā, a hundred years of human life is but a single night and a day for the Devas living in Tāvatiṁsā heaven, in the company of the Thirty-Three Devas in the realm of King Sakka, Ruler of the Gods. Now, thirty of those days equal a single month, and twelve of those months make up a year. A *thousand* of those celestial years makes up the life span of a Deva living in the company of the thirty-three Devas!

"So, it may very well happen, that a man or a woman who has fully observed the eight precepts on the full moon day of Uposatha, reappears after death into the Tāvatiṁsā heaven, with the company of the Thirty-Three Devas.

"Visākhā, it was on account of this that it was said:

'Visākhā, it is because human kingship, with its pleasures and seeming magnitude, is truly but a poor trifling when compared to celestial pleasure and happiness.'

c. "Visākhā, two hundred years of a human life is but a single night and a day for the Yāma Devas. Thirty of those equal a month, and twelve of those months make up a single year. Two thousand of those celestial years make up the life span of the Yāma Devas.

"So, it may very well happen, that a man or a woman who has fully observed the eight precepts on the full moon day of Uposatha, reappears after death in the company of the Yāma Devas.

"Visākhā, it was on account of this that it was said:

'Visākhā, it is because human kingship, with its pleasures and seeming magnitude, is truly but a poor trifling when compared to celestial pleasure and happiness.'

d. "Visākhā, four hundred years of human life is but a single night and a day for the Tusita Devas. Thirty of those full days make up a month, and twelve of those months make up a single year. Now, four thousand of those celestial years make up the life span of the Devas of the Tusita heaven.

"So, it may very well happen, that a man or a woman who has fully observed the eight precepts on the full moon day of Uposatha, reappears after death in the company of the Tusita Devas.

"Visākhā, it was on account of this that it was said:

'Visākhā, it is because human kingship, with its pleasures and seeming magnitude, is truly but a poor trifling when compared to celestial pleasure and happiness.'

e. "Visākhā, eight hundred years of human life is but a single night and a day for the Nimmānaratī Devas, who delight in their creations. Thirty of those equal a month, and twelve of those months make up a year. Now, eight thousand of those celestial years make up the life span of the Nimmānaratī Devas, who delight in their creations.

"So, it may very well happen, that a man or a woman who has fully observed the eight precepts on the full moon day of Uposatha, reappears after death in the company of the Nimmānaratī Devas, who delight in their creations.

"Visākhā, it was on account of this that it was said:

'Visākhā, it is because human kingship, with its pleasures and seeming magnitude, is truly but a poor trifling when compared to celestial pleasure and happiness.'

f. "Furthermore, Visākhā, sixteen hundred years of human life is but a single night and a day for the Paranimmita Devas, who delight in controlling the creations of other Devas. Thirty of those equal a month, and twelve of those months make up a single year. Now, sixteen thousand of those celestial years make up the life span of the Paranimmita Devas, who delight in controlling the creations of other Devas.

"So, it may very well happen, that a man or a woman who has fully observed the eight precepts on the full moon day of Uposatha, reappears after death in the company of the Paranimmita Devas, who delight in controlling the creations of other Devas.

"Visākhā, it was on account of this that it was said:

'Visākhā, it is because human kingship, with its pleasures and seeming magnitude, is truly but a poor trifling when compared to celestial pleasure and happiness."'

'Do not destroy life, nor take what is not given.
Do not tell lies, nor take any mind-altering intoxicants.
Lead the holy life in full, by abstaining entirely from sexual acts.
Do not eat at night, nor at untimely hours.
Do not wear flowers nor embellish yourself with fragrance or perfume.
Make your bed the floor, covering it as you like.

These are the eight precepts
For the full moon day of Uposatha,
Given by The Blessed One Himself,
Who declared the ending of suffering.

The moon and the sun shine unhindered,
Dispelling the darkness throughout the sky.
Whatever wealth is seen in life, be it pearls, gems, lapis, gold, silver or metal ore,
They are not worth even one-sixteenth part when compared
To fully observing the eight precepts on the full moon day of Uposatha.

Therefore, by engaging in blameless acts,
Men and women bring to themselves countless benefits, resulting in happiness.
Even winning a rebirth into the heavenly realms.'

AN III

Suttas 71-80

Ānanda Vagga

"The Section on the Venerable Ānanda"

71. ***Channa Sutta*** *(The Wandering Ascetic Channa)*

Once at Sāvatthī, the wandering ascetic Channa approached the Venerable Ānanda, and after exchanging friendly greetings, he sat down to one side and said:

"Friend Ānanda, we see that you teach the renouncing of greed, the renouncing of anger and the renouncing of delusion. But we also teach the renouncing of greed, the renouncing of anger, and the renouncing of delusion.

"Therefore, friend Ānanda, having seen what type of danger exactly within greed, anger, and delusion, that you teach their renouncing?"

And the Venerable Ānanda said:

a. "Friend, a greedy person, overcome and consumed by greed, ends up harming himself, harming others, and harming both, becoming mentally afflicted and overwhelmed with suffering. But, when greed is abandoned, he does not harm himself, nor others, nor both. Thus, he does not become mentally afflicted, but instead lives at ease, enjoying the soothing comfort this brings.

"Friend, a greedy person, overcome and consumed by greed, misbehaves by body, speech and mind. But, when greed is abandoned, he does not misbehave by body, speech, and mind.

"Friend, a greedy person, overcome and consumed by greed, does not know his own good; he does not know the good of another; and he does not know what is really considered to be good for both.
But, when greed is abandoned, he knows his own good as it really is; he knows the good of others as it really is; and knows the good of both, as it really is.

"Therefore, friend, to have greed itself means that the person is no longer able to see clearly; hence, greed is the lack of sight; it is blindness itself and the very absence of wisdom, as it obstructs wisdom, which is why greed truly is destructive and does *not* lead to Nibbāna.

b. "Similarly, friend, an angry person, overcome and consumed by hatred, ends up harming himself, harming others, and harming both, becoming mentally afflicted and overwhelmed with suffering.
But, when hatred is abandoned, he does not harm himself, nor others, nor both. Thus, he does not become mentally afflicted, but instead lives at ease, enjoying the soothing comfort this brings.

"Friend, an angry person, overcome and consumed by hatred, misbehaves by body, speech and mind. But, when hatred is abandoned, he does not misbehave by body, speech, and mind.

"Friend, an angry person, overcome and consumed by hatred, does not know his own good; does not know the good of another; and does not know the good of both.
But, when hatred is abandoned, he knows his own good as it really is; he knows the good of others as it really is; and knows the good of both, as it really is.

"Therefore, friend, to have hatred itself means that the person is no longer able to see clearly; hence, hatred is the lack of sight; it is blindness itself and the very absence of wisdom, as it obstructs wisdom, which is why hatred truly is destructive, for it does *not* lead to Nibbāna.

c. "Similarly, friend, a deluded person, overcome and consumed by delusion, ends up harming himself, harming others, and harming both, by becoming mentally afflicted and overwhelmed with suffering.
But, when delusion is abandoned, he does not harm himself, nor others, nor both. Thus, he does not become mentally afflicted, but instead lives at ease, while enjoying the soothing comfort this brings.

"Friend, a deluded person, overcome and consumed by delusion, misbehaves by body, speech and mind. But, when delusion is abandoned, he does not misbehave by body, speech, and mind.

"Friend, a deluded person, overcome and consumed by delusion, does not know his own good; does not know the good of another; and does not know the good of both.
But, when delusion is abandoned, he knows his own good as it really is; he knows the good of others as it really is; and knows the good of both, as it really is.

"Therefore, friend, to have delusion itself means that the person is no longer able to see clearly; hence, delusion is the lack of sight; it is blindness itself and the very absence of wisdom, as it obstructs wisdom, which is why delusion truly is destructive, for it does *not* lead to Nibbāna.

"As you see, friend, it is by seeing these dangers in greed, that I teach the renouncing of greed; it is by seeing these dangers in hatred that I teach the renouncing of hatred; and it is by seeing these dangers in delusion, that I teach the renouncing of delusion."

Then, the ascetic Channa asked a further question:

"But friend Ānanda, is there a path and a method for the renouncing of greed, hatred, and delusion?"

"Yes, there is *indeed* a Path and a Method, friend, for the renouncing of greed, hatred, and delusion."

"But friend, what is the Path and Method for the renouncing of greed, hatred, and delusion?"

"Friend, it is this same Noble Eightfold Path, that is: Right view, Right intention, Right speech, Right action, Right lifestyle, Right effort, Right mindfulness, and Right collected stability of mind."

"Excellent, friend, is the Path, and excellent is the Method for the renouncing of greed, hatred, and delusion, as it truly is necessary, friend Ānanda, in order to stay vigilant, instead of living with careless negligence!"

*72. **Ājīvaka Sutta** (The Naked Ascetics)*

At one time, the Venerable Ānanda was living at the Ghosita Monastery in Kosambi. Then, a certain householder who was a disciple of the Ājīvaka naked ascetics' sect, went and approached the Venerable Ānanda, and after paying homage to him, sat down to one side and said to the Venerable Ānanda:

"Venerable sir, how is The Dhamma well declared in the world? Who are those that are following the right method? And who are those considered to be truly 'Well-gone,' and genuinely deserving of the designation of 'Fortunate Ones'?"

"Householder, I will cross-question you on this and you may reply as it pleases you."

"Yes, Venerable Sir."

"Householder, there indeed is The Dhamma for the abandoning of greed, for the abandoning of hatred, and for the abandoning of delusion.

"But, householder, would you be able to recognize such a Dhamma as genuinely good, taught for the purpose of renouncing and thus abandoning greed, hatred, and delusion, and therefore see it as a teaching that is well-declared, or not? How do you understand it?"

"Bhante, I would consider and understand The Dhamma you just mentioned to be genuinely good, as it is taught for the purpose of renouncing and thus abandoning greed, hatred, and delusion. Therefore, I would recognize and see it as a teaching that is indeed well-declared."

Then, the Venerable Ānanda continued instructing:

“Householder, would you be able to recognize those engaged in the practice of renouncing and abandoning greed, hatred, and delusion, as those who are truly following the correct method, or not? How do you see or understand it?”

“Bhante, I would see and recognize all those engaged in the practice of renouncing and thereby abandoning greed, hatred, and delusion, as those who are following the correct method, indeed.”

“Householder, those who have renounced greed, having pulled it out with its roots, have turned it into a dead palm tree stump, so that it would not rise again. They have renounced hatred, and pulled it out with its roots, turning it into a dead palm tree stump, so that it would not rise again. And similarly, by renouncing delusion, they have pulled it out from its very roots, making it like a dead palm tree stump, so that it can never rise again.
Now, householder, in looking upon such beings, would you then see or recognize those individuals as being ‘Well-gone’ and genuinely deserving of the designation of ‘Fortunate Ones,’ or not? How would you consider or understand it?”

“Bhante, in looking upon all those beings who have indeed renounced greed, having pulled it out with its roots and made it like a dead palm tree stump, so that it would not rise again; who have renounced hatred and pulled it out with its roots, turning it into a dead palm tree stump, so that it would not rise again; and similarly, by renouncing delusion, those who have pulled it out from its very roots, making it like a dead palm tree stump, so that it can never rise again, I would see and recognize these individuals as ‘Well-gone’ and genuinely deserving of the designation of ‘Fortunate Ones’ in this world!”

And the Venerable Ānanda added, by saying:

“Well, there you go, householder! For, you have just now declared it yourself, by saying:

“Bhante, in looking upon all those beings who have indeed renounced greed, having pulled it out with its roots and made it like a dead palm tree stump, so that it would not rise again; who have renounced hatred and pulled it out with its roots, turning it into a dead palm tree stump, so that it would not rise again; and similarly, by renouncing delusion, those who have pulled it out from its very roots, making it like a dead palm tree stump, so that it can never rise again, I would see and recognize these individuals as ‘Well-gone’ and genuinely deserving of the designation of ‘Fortunate Ones’ in this world!”

“Bhante, it is simply wonderful and also delightfully surprising to see, that neither one’s own Dhamma was praised in your response, nor another’s Dhamma was disparaged or debased. But rather, The Dhamma, with its bare bones meaning, was given in the right setting, wherein the most essential teaching within it was clearly carried across and conveyed, while leaving oneself out!

“Truly, Bhante, The Dhamma that you teach is for the renouncing and abandoning of greed, for the renouncing and abandoning of hatred, and for the renouncing and abandoning of delusion; hence it most certainly is ‘Well Declared!’

"You are following the method for the renouncing and abandonment of greed; for the renouncing and abandoning of hatred; and for the renouncing and abandoning of delusion; and therefore, you are following the correct and *right* method. Your greed is abandoned, Bhante, pulled out with its roots, made like a dead palm tree stump, so that it would not rise again. Your hatred is abandoned, Bhante, pulled out with its roots, and made like a dead palm tree stump, so that it cannot rise again. And the delusion in you is abandoned, Bhante, having been pulled out with its roots, and made like a dead palm tree stump, so that it would not rise again. This is why I see and recognize you, Bhante, as one who is truly 'Well-gone' and genuinely deserving of the designation of 'Fortunate Ones' in this world!

"It is excellent, Venerable sir! It is truly magnificent, Bhante!

"The Venerable Ānanda has made The Dhamma clear to me in many ways, as though he turned upright what had been turned upside-down, revealing what was hidden, having shown the correct path to someone who was lost, just like holding up a lamp in the dark for all those with eyesight to see.

"Bhante Ānanda, I go to The Blessed One for refuge, and to The Dhamma, and to The Saṅgha of Bhikkhus. From this day forward, may the Venerable Ānanda remember me as a lay disciple who has taken refuge in The Triple Gem, until the end of life itself."

*73. **Mahānāmasakka Sutta** (Mahānāma, the Sakyan)*

At one time, The Blessed One was staying at the Nigrodha monastery, in the Sakyan city of Kapilavatthu. It was during this time, that The Blessed One had just recovered from an illness. Then, Mahānāma the Sakyan approached The Blessed One, and having paid homage to Him, sat down to one side and said to The Blessed One:

"Bhante, a long time ago, I remember The Blessed One saying: *'Knowledge comes for the one who has a collected mind, not to the who is distracted.'*

"But, Bhante, does the collected stability of mind come first and then the knowledge, or does knowledge come first, followed by the collected stability of mind?"

Then, it occurred to the Venerable Ānanda:

'The Blessed One is still recovering from his illness but the Sakyan Mahānāma is here, asking a very deep question. What if I lead the Sakyan Mahānāma aside and explain it to him?'

Then, the Venerable Ānanda held the Sakyan Mahānāma by the arm and led him away, as he said this to him:

"Mahānāma, The Blessed One has spoken on the virtuous behavior of a Noble Disciple in Training and the virtuous behavior of the one who has gone beyond the Training. He has spoken about the collected stability of mind of the Noble Disciple in Training, and the collected stability of mind of the one who has gone beyond the Training, too. He has also spoken extensively about the wisdom of a Noble Disciple in Training, and the wisdom of the one who has gone beyond the Training, as well.

a. "Now what, Mahānāma, is meant by the virtuous behavior of a Noble Disciple in Training?

"Here Mahānāma, the Bhikkhu lives a virtuous life while observing and being restrained by the Pātimokkha; he is disciplined, possessing a wholesome and beneficial conduct, shunning the possibility of even the slightest misconduct in himself. Thus, having taken on the training rules, he practices the Bhikkhu's Code of Discipline.

"This is what is meant by the virtuous behavior of the Noble Disciple in Training.

b. "And what, Mahānāma, is the collected stability of mind of a Noble Disciple in Training?

"Here, Mahānāma, overcoming the obstructive five hindrances, the Bhikkhu trains by secluding his mind from running after things that have to do with sensuality; he pulls his attention inwards and becomes quite secluded from sensual pleasures. Thus secluded from unwholesome and bad merit-making states, he enters upon and remains in the first *jhāna*, which is accompanied by thinking and planning, while experiencing a strong flood of spiritual joy and ecstasy, all resulting from such seclusion.

"Later, by stilling his thinking process and without fighting with himself, he turns his attention away from his thoughts by not engaging with them any further, and comes to experience the disappearance of both thinking and planning. In this way, he enters upon and remains in the second *jhāna*, which continues to be accompanied by a strong flood of spiritual joy and ecstasy, that are now the result of his growing and stable collectedness of heart (*samādhi*).

"Furthermore, the Bhikkhu goes deeper in his meditation by not holding on to anything, including the experience of spiritual joy, as he witnesses it beginning to vanish and cease. Thus, he abides in a state of equanimity, while being mindful and fully aware, still feeling a subtle ecstasy throughout, as he enters upon and abides in the third *jhāna*, for which reason the Noble Ones declare:

'It is such a one indeed, who is serenely mindful;
Abiding in happiness, with an ever-present sense of equanimity.'

"Going further, the Bhikkhu gives up both pleasure and pain, and having already gone beyond joy and anguish, he remains in the continuous state of purifying mindfulness, with an ever-

present sense of equanimity, as he enters upon and abides in the fourth *jhāna*, while experiencing neither pleasure nor pain, having now gone beyond both of them.

"Now, Mahānāma, this is the collected stability of mind of a Noble Disciple in Training.

c. "And what, Mahānāma, is the wisdom of a Noble Disciple in Training?

"Here Mahānāma, the Noble Disciple in Training knows as it really is: *This is suffering.*
The Noble Disciple in Training knows as it really is: *This is the cause of suffering.*
The Noble Disciple in Training knows as it really is: *This is the cessation of suffering.*
And the Noble Disciple in Training knows as it really is: *This is The Path that leads to the very ending and cessation of suffering.*

"This then, Mahānāma, is the wisdom of the Noble Disciple in Training.

"Now, Mahānāma, when the Noble Disciple in Training thus lives and behaves with virtue, becoming collected and stable in mind, while possessing wisdom, then with the destruction of the heart's contaminants, his heart is finally released through wisdom, whereby he here and now realizes, personally, on his own, and with direct knowledge, the Liberation of Heart through Wisdom.

"So, you see, Mahānāma, The Blessed One has spoken on the virtuous behavior of a Noble Disciple in Training and the virtuous behavior of the one who has gone beyond the Training. He has spoken about the collected stability of mind of the Noble Disciple in Training, and the collected stability of mind of the one who has gone beyond the Training, too. He has also spoken extensively about the wisdom of a Noble Disciple in Training, and the wisdom of the one who has gone beyond the Training, as well."

*74. **Niganṭha Sutta** (The Niganṭha – Jain Naked Ascetics)*

At one time, while the Venerable Ānanda was staying at the gabled hall in the Great Forest of Vesālī, the Licchavi Princes, Abhaya and Pandita Kumāra, went and approached the Venerable Ānanda, and after paying homage to him, they both sat down to one side.

Then, the Licchavi Prince Abhaya addressed the Venerable Ānanda, by saying:

"Bhante, Niganṭha Nāṭaputta (The Jain Mahāvīra) claims himself to be all-knowing, all-seeing, with an all-embracing knowledge and vision that is complete, while stating:

'Whether walking, standing, laying down or awake, my knowledge and vision is always established and is always present in me!'

"Furthermore, he instructs on finishing one's Kamma [*referring to the 'fruits' of past intentional actions*] done earlier in one's past, through the means of engaging in severe austerities, in order to 'break down the bridge' connecting them to those stains of kamma by canceling them out altogether, instead of starting or engaging in new actions.

"In this manner, he claims that with the very destruction of action (*kamma*), there occurs the destruction of suffering; with the destruction of suffering, the destruction of feelings; and with the destruction of feelings, the destruction of all suffering.

"Thus, he declares the ending of suffering, by claiming it to be none other than the chipping away and wearing down of these past actions and their stains, through the means of which one, here and now, becomes purified and transcended.

"Bhante, what does The Blessed One say about this?"

And the Venerable Ānanda replied, by saying:

"Abhaya, The Blessed One who knows and sees, who is in fact an actual Arahant, Perfectly Awakened, rightfully teaches these three kinds of chipping away and wearing down, the kind of wearing down and obliteration that leads to the purification of beings, for the overcoming of all sorrows, grief and lamentation; for going beyond suffering and despair, and for gaining the very knowledge and realization of Nibbāna itself.

"Now what are these three?

a. "Here, Abhaya, the Bhikkhu lives a virtuous life, while observing and being restrained by the Pātimokkha rules, becoming disciplined, possessing a wholesome and beneficial conduct, shunning the possibility of even the slightest misconduct in himself. Thus, having taken on the training rules, he practices the Bhikkhu's Code of Discipline (*Vinaya*). As such, he does not create new evil or unwholesome actions, while also working to eliminate the old evil and unwholesome actions, by having them decay, wither away, and wear down, right here and now.

"Now, this wearing down, Abhaya, is itself directly visible, inviting of inspection and fully testable, a method that is certainly applicable, leading one to progress, and therefore, is personally realized by the wise, for themselves.

b. "Further, Abhaya, by overcoming the obstructive five hindrances, the Bhikkhu trains by secluding his mind from running after things that have to do with sensuality; he pulls his attention inwards and becomes quite secluded from sensual pleasures. Thus secluded from unwholesome and bad merit-making states, he enters upon and remains in the first *jhāna*, which is accompanied by thinking and planning, while experiencing a strong flood of spiritual joy and ecstasy, all resulting from such seclusion.

"Later, by stilling his thinking process and without fighting with himself, he turns his attention away from his thoughts by not engaging with them any further, and comes to experience the disappearance of both thinking and planning. In this way, he enters upon and remains in the second *jhāna*, which continues to be accompanied by a strong flood of spiritual joy and ecstasy, that are now the result of his growing and stable collectedness of heart (*samādhi*).

"Furthermore, the Bhikkhu goes deeper in his meditation by not holding on to anything, including the experience of spiritual joy, as he witnesses it beginning to vanish and cease. Thus, he abides in a state of equanimity, while being mindful and fully aware, still feeling a subtle ecstasy throughout, as he enters upon and abides in the third *jhāna*, for which reason the Noble Ones declare:

'It is such a one indeed, who is serenely mindful;
Abiding in happiness, with an ever-present sense of equanimity.'

"Going further, the Bhikkhu gives up both pleasure and pain, and having already gone beyond joy and anguish, he remains in the continuous state of purifying mindfulness, with an ever-present sense of equanimity, as he enters upon and abides in the fourth *jhāna*, while experiencing neither pleasure nor pain, having now gone beyond both of them.

"Thus, the Bhikkhu does not create any new action (*Kamma*). Meanwhile, however, he keeps breaking the negative pattern of old kamma by no longer perpetuating such actions that he used to do in the past. Thereby, he lets those actions wear down and die out, right here and now.

"Here again, this wearing down is itself directly visible, inviting of inspection and fully testable, a method that is certainly applicable, leading one to progress, and therefore, is personally realized by the wise, for themselves.

c. "Further, Abhaya, by becoming virtuous and thus collected and settled in his mind, with the destruction of the contaminants, the Bhikkhu realizes, in this very life, with direct knowledge and by himself, the spotless liberation of mind through wisdom and dwells in that state here and now.

In this manner, he directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is suffering.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the origin of suffering.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the cessation of suffering.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the Path leading to the cessation of suffering.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'These are the contaminants (āsavas).'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the origin of the contaminants.'*
He directly knows and sees as it actually is: *'This is the cessation of the contaminants.'*
He directly sees and knows as it actually is: *'This is the Path leading to the cessation of the contaminants.'*

“And at that moment when the Bhikkhu knows and sees thus, his mind becomes fully liberated from the contaminant of sensual desire; freed from the contaminant of becoming; and from the contaminant of ignorance. And with the heart thus fully liberated and released through wisdom, he dwells in that state as he goes on living out the rest of his days.

“Throughout this process, the Bhikkhu does not engage in creating any new action; meanwhile, he keeps breaking the pattern of old evil and unwholesome *Kamma,* by no longer perpetuating such actions he had done earlier, as he lets them all wear down, wither away, and die out, here and now.

“And as stated before, this wearing down is itself directly visible, inviting of inspection and fully testable, a method that is certainly applicable, leading one to progress, and therefore, is personally realized by the wise, for themselves.

“Now, Abhaya, these are the three kinds of wearing down through purity that The Blessed One, The Arahant, who is indeed Perfectly Awakened, rightfully teaches for the purification of all beings, for the overcoming of all sorrows, grief and lamentation; for going beyond suffering and despair, and for gaining the knowledge and realization of Nibbāna itself.”

When this was said, the Licchavi Pandita Kumāra, while listening delightedly to these words spoken by the Venerable Ānanda, turned to his fellow Licchavi Abhaya, and said:

“Well, friend Abhaya, are you still *not* inspired in hearing these lovely and well-spoken words from the Venerable Ānanda?”

“My dear Friend, *how* could I possibly *not* be inspired by, and wholeheartedly appreciative for the lovely and well-spoken words of the Venerable Ānanda? For, if anyone were to sit here and listen to such lovely and well-spoken words and somehow to *not* get inspired or wholeheartedly appreciative, then their head would simply blow up into pieces, right where they sit!”

75. ***Nivesaka Sutta*** *(Encouragement)*

At one time, the Venerable Ānanda approached The Blessed One, and after paying homage to The Teacher, he sat down to one side.

Then, The Blessed One said:

“Ānanda, those for whom you have Universal Compassion, and who think they should listen to you and heed your words, whether they happen to be your friends, fellow companions, relatives, or family members, in your eagerness to help these individuals, Ānanda, you must endeavor to encourage, inspire, settle, and establish them in these three ways.

Now, what are these three?

“First, they must be encouraged, inspired, settled, and established in the unwavering confidence in The Buddha. Thus, you should help them to understand that –

‘The Blessed One is an Arahant, Perfectly Awakened, endowed with Sublime Knowledge and Supremely Pure Conduct; He is The Well-Gone, The Knower of worlds, The Incomparable Tamer of those to be tamed, The Teacher of Devas and humans, The Enlightened and Blessed.’

Secondly, they must be encouraged, inspired, settled, and established in unwavering confidence in The Dhamma, thus –

‘The Dhamma of The Blessed One is well expounded; it is directly visible here and now; immediately effective; inviting one to come and investigate for oneself; taking one straight forward, undeterred; to be understood and personally realized by the wise; each for oneself.’

Thirdly, they must be encouraged, inspired, settled, and established in unwavering confidence in the Saṅgha, thus:

‘The Saṅgha of the Disciples of The Blessed One are practicing well the Good Path, which is the Threefold Training of Sīla, Samādhi, Paññā (virtuous living, mental cultivation, and development of wisdom); the Disciples of The Blessed One are practicing the Straight Path of the Threefold Training, which is the Middle Path; the Disciples of The Blessed One are practicing wisely to realize Nibbāna, in a methodical way; the Disciples of The Blessed One are practicing the Dhamma in harmony; Such are the Four Pairs of Eight Great Beings, comprised of the Eight Noble Disciples of The Blessed One; the ones to be honored and respected, deserving of hospitality, worthy of offerings; to be venerated with reverential salutation with one’s palms pressed together at the heart, for they are indeed the Incomparable Field of merit for the world.’

“Now, Ānanda, there might come a time when some changes may occur in the characteristics of the four great elements of earth, water, fire, and air. But, Ānanda, there *cannot* come a time when some kind of a change or alteration may occur within the heart of the Noble Disciple, in his unwavering confidence in The Buddha!

“Therefore, Ānanda, there is no possibility for a Noble Disciple who possesses such unwavering confidence in The Buddha, to somehow be born in hell, or in the animal world, or in the company of ghosts. This is simply impossible to ever occur.

“Similarly, Ānanda, there might come a time when some changes may occur in the characteristics of the four great elements of earth, water, fire, and air. But, Ānanda, there *cannot* come a time when some kind of a change or alteration may occur within the heart of the Noble Disciple in his unwavering confidence in The Dhamma!

“Therefore Ānanda, there is no possibility for a Noble Disciple who possesses such unwavering confidence in The Dhamma, to somehow be born in hell, or in the animal world, or in the company of ghosts. This is simply impossible to ever occur.

“Also, Ānanda, there might come a time when some changes may occur in the characteristics of the four great elements of earth, water, fire, and air. But, Ānanda, there *cannot* come a time when some kind of a change or alteration may occur within the heart of the Noble Disciple in his unwavering confidence in the Saṅgha!

“Therefore, Ānanda, there is no possibility that a Noble Disciple who possesses such unwavering confidence in the Saṅgha, to somehow be born in hell, or in the animal world, or in the company of ghosts. This simply is impossible to ever occur.

“Therefore, Ānanda, those for whom you have Universal Compassion and who think they should listen to you and heed your words, whether they happen to be your friends, fellow companions, relatives, or family members, in your eagerness to help these individuals, Ānanda, you must endeavor to encourage, inspire, settle, and establish them in these three ways.”

76. ***Paṭhama Bhava Sutta*** *(On Becoming – Part 1)*

At one time, the Venerable Ānanda approached The Blessed One, and after paying homage to The Teacher, he sat down to one side and said to The Blessed One:

“Bhante, *‘becoming, becoming…’* it is said.

“But, Blessed Lord, in what way is there a *‘becoming’* that can be fully and thoroughly understood?”

And The Blessed One replied by instructing:

a. “Ānanda, when there is no maturation of *kamma* manifesting into the sensual realm, then would there be any kind of becoming or rebirth for a being into the sensual realms, that may be discerned at all?”

“No, Bhante.”

“Just so, Ānanda, when beings are shrouded by ignorance and bound by craving, action (*kamma*) becomes the soil, consciousness becomes the seed, and the craving becomes the moisture for the consciousness to gestate and develop into a lower state of being. Thus, renewed becoming is produced for a being in the future.

b. “Ānanda, when there is no maturation of *kamma* manifesting into the form realm, then would there be an experience of becoming or rebirth for a being into the form realms, that may be discerned?”

“No, Venerable Sir.”

"Just so, Ānanda, when beings are shrouded by ignorance and bound by craving, action (*kamma*) becomes the soil, consciousness becomes the seed, and the craving becomes the moisture for the consciousness to gestate and develop into a middle state of being. Thus, renewed becoming is produced for a being in the future.

c. "Ānanda, when there is no maturation of *kamma* manifesting into the formless realm, then would there be an experience of any becoming or rebirth for a being into the formless realms, that may be discerned?"

"No, Venerable Sir."

"Just so Ānanda, when beings are shrouded by ignorance and bound by craving, action (*kamma*) becomes the soil, consciousness becomes the seed, and the craving becomes the moisture for the consciousness to gestate and develop into a superior state of being. Thus, renewed becoming is produced for a being in the future.

"This, therefore, Ānanda, is how future becoming is produced for beings."

77. ***Dutiya Bhava Sutta*** *(On Becoming – Part 2)*

At one time, the Venerable Ānanda approached The Blessed One, and after paying homage to The Teacher, he sat down to one side and said to The Blessed One:

"Bhante, *'becoming, becoming…'* it is said.

"But, Blessed Lord, in what way is there a *'becoming'* that could to be fully and thoroughly understood?"

And The Blessed One replied by instructing:

a. "Ānanda, when there is no maturation of *kamma* manifesting into the sensual realm, then would there be any kind of becoming or rebirth for a being into the sensual realms, that may be discerned at all?"

"No, Bhante."

"Just so, Ānanda, when beings are obstructed by ignorance and fettered by craving, then their deliberate actions (*kammā*) serve as the very soil, where consciousness becomes the seed, and the craving, with its constant thirst for more (*taṇhā*), which they held in their hearts, becomes the moisture, allowing their intentions and aspirations to gestate, and thus become established and develop within one of the lower planes of existence.
Thus, renewed becoming is produced for a being, in the future.

b. "Now, Ānanda, when there is no maturation of *kamma* manifesting into the form realm, then would there be any kind of becoming or rebirth for a being into the form realms, that may be discerned at all?"

"No, Bhante."

"Just so, Ānanda, when beings are obstructed by ignorance and fettered by craving, then their deliberate actions (*kammā*) serve as the very soil, where consciousness becomes the seed, and the craving, with its constant thirst for more (*taṇhā*), which they held in their hearts, becomes the moisture, allowing their intentions and aspirations to gestate, and thus become established and develop within one of the middle planes of existence.
Thus, renewed becoming is produced for a being, in the future.

c. "Ānanda, when there is no maturation of *kamma* manifesting into the formless realm, then would there be any kind of becoming or rebirth for a being into the formless realms, that may be discerned at all?"

"No, Bhante."

"Just so, Ānanda, when beings are obstructed by ignorance and fettered by craving, then their deliberate actions (*kammā*) serve as the very soil, where consciousness becomes the seed, and the craving, with its constant thirst for more (*taṇhā*), which they held in their hearts, becomes the moisture, allowing their intentions and aspirations to gestate, and thus become established and develop within one of the higher planes of existence.
Thus, renewed becoming is produced for a being, in the future.

"This, therefore, Ānanda, is how future becoming is produced for beings."

78. ***Sīlabbata Sutta*** *(Rites & Observances of Religious Practice)*

At one time, the Venerable Ānanda approached The Blessed One, and after paying homage to The Teacher, he sat down to one side. Then, The Blessed One said to him:

"Ānanda, when looking at the various responsibilities, especially the various rites, ceremonial behaviors, observances, and lifestyle that are practiced, would you say that these somehow *do* bring about some meaningfully tangible and fruitful results, as it relates to the actual Holy Life, for the person taking part in them?"

"Not necessarily, Bhante."

"In that case, explain your answer, Ānanda."

“Bhante, when someone practices the rites, observances, and lifestyle of the Holy Life by looking at these as the essential part of the spiritual life, meanwhile, evil and unwholesome traits increase in him. Given the fact that the beneficial and wholesome traits in the individual continue to decrease, then the mere practicing of the rites, ceremonial behaviors, observances, and lifestyle are truly fruitless and utterly empty, for they are of no real benefit, at all, for the person taking part in them, as it relates to the actual Holy Life.

“However, Bhante, when evil and unwholesome thoughts continue to decrease, while the beneficial and wholesome traits in that individual increase, then practicing the rites, ceremonial behaviors, observances, and lifestyle may come to support, bringing much fruit for the person’s development in the Holy Life.”

Having replied thus, the Venerable Ānanda received the approval of The Teacher, through His silence.

“Then, knowing that The Blessed One had approved of his response, the Venerable Ānanda arose from his seat, and after paying homage to The Blessed One and circumambulating Him, he went away.

Then, soon after the Venerable Ānanda had left, The Blessed One addressed the Bhikkhus thus:

“Bhikkhus, although Ānanda is still a disciple in higher training, it is difficult to find one equal to him in wisdom.”

79. ***Gandhajāta Sutta*** *(The Fragrances)*

Once, having approached The Blessed One and after paying homage to Him, the Venerable Ānanda sat to one side and said to The Blessed One:

“Bhante, these three are the odors which permeate about and spread everywhere, while moving and being pushed here and there by the wind or the current of air, being carried in whichever direction it takes them. Thus, they cannot go against the wind. And what are these three?

“The repulsive smells; the fragrance of the heartwood; and the fragrance of flowers.

“Therefore, Bhante, these are the three smells which permeate about and spread everywhere, while moving and being pushed here and there by the wind or the current of air, being carried in whichever direction it takes them. Thus, they cannot go against the wind.

“But, Bhante, could there be an odor, a scent or a fragrance, which not only permeates about and spreads everywhere, while moving and being pushed here and there by the wind or the current of air, but *also* moves and permeates by going *against* the wind as well?”

“Ānanda, there is indeed such a fragrance, which not *only* permeates about and spreads everywhere, moving and being pushed here and there by the wind or the current of air, but *also* moves and permeates while going *against* the wind as well; a truly unique fragrance that is carried and moved *with* the wind, but *also* goes against the wind.”

“But, what Bhante, could that fragrance be? What is that fragrance which not *only* permeates about and spreads everywhere, moving and being pushed here and there by the wind or the current of air, but *also* moves and permeates while going *against* the wind, a truly unique fragrance that is carried and moved *with* the wind, but *also* goes against the wind?”

“Ānanda, think of a situation where there happens to be a man or a woman in a certain village or town, who has taken Refuge in The Buddha, The Dhamma, and The Noble Saṅgha.

“Now, being dedicated to the Path, this person develops a virtuous character, whereby he or she abstains from destroying or harming living beings; abstains from stealing or taking what is not given; does not engage in sexual misconduct of any kind; does not tell lies or speak falsehood; and does not take or consume any mind-altering or intoxicating substances, which delude the mind, seeing that they are the basis for heedlessness.

“Such a person, Ānanda, starts living with a heart that is generous, one that is without the stain of stinginess. This open-handed person becomes truly kind and benevolent, always ready to give to the needy, and devoted to charity. Then, people, recluses, and brahmins from all directions happen to discuss this individual, by speaking words of praise about him, in this manner:

‘In a certain village or town, there happens to be such and such a person, who has taken Refuge in The Buddha, The Dhamma, and The Noble Saṅgha. Being dedicated to the Path, this person has developed a virtuous character, whereby he or she abstains from destroying or harming living beings; abstains from stealing or taking what is not given; does not engage in sexual misconduct of any kind; does not tell lies or speak falsehood; and does not take or consume any mind-altering or intoxicating substances, which delude the mind, seeing that they are the basis for heedlessness. Also, that person is now living with a heart that is generous, while being free from the stain of stinginess. Therefore, this open-handed person is truly benevolent and kind, always ready to give to the needy, and devoted to charity.’

“Also, Ānanda, even the Devas in the heavens praise this person thus:

‘In a certain village or town, there happens to be such and such a person, who has taken Refuge in The Buddha, The Dhamma, and The Noble Saṅgha. Being dedicated to the Path, this person has developed a virtuous character, whereby he or she abstains from destroying or harming living beings; abstains from stealing or taking what is not given; does not engage in sexual misconduct of any kind; does not tell lies or speak falsehood; and does not take or consume any mind-altering or intoxicating substances, which delude the mind, seeing that they are the basis for heedlessness. Also, that person is now living with a heart that is generous, while being free from the stain of stinginess. Therefore, this open-handed person is truly benevolent and kind, always ready to give to the needy, and devoted to charity.’

"In fact, Ānanda, even non-human beings praise this person thus:

'In a certain village or town, there happens to be such and such a person, who has taken Refuge in The Buddha, The Dhamma, and The Noble Saṅgha. Being dedicated to the Path, this person has developed a virtuous character, whereby he or she abstains from destroying or harming living beings; abstains from stealing or taking what is not given; does not engage in sexual misconduct of any kind; does not tell lies or speak falsehood; and does not take or consume any mind-altering or intoxicating substances, which delude the mind, seeing that they are the basis for heedlessness. Also, that person is now living with a heart that is generous, while being free from the stain of stinginess. Therefore, this open-handed person is truly benevolent and kind, always ready to give to the needy, and devoted to charity.'

"Therefore, Ānanda, *this* is that unique fragrance, which not *only* permeates about and spreads everywhere, moving and being pushed here and there by the wind or the current of air, but *also* moves and permeates while going *against* the wind as well; a truly unique fragrance that is carried and moved *with* the wind, but *also* goes against the wind.

'The fragrance of the loveliest of flowers cannot go against the wind,
Neither that of the rare Sandalwood nor the Tagāra,
Not even that of Mallikā (Jasmine);
For, it is indeed only the fragrance of those great Beings
That spreads and goes even against the wind,
Permeating in all directions unobstructed, as it exudes everywhere.'

80. ***Cūḷanikā (Abhibhu) Sutta*** *(Minor World Systems)*

Once, having approached The Blessed One and after paying homage to Him, the Venerable Ānanda sat to one side and said to The Blessed One:

"Bhante, these words I have heard from The Blessed One, in His presence. It is a statement that I personally know The Blessed One has made, as well as acknowledged Himself, by saying to me:

'Ānanda, long ago, Abhibhu, a Disciple of The Buddha Sikhi, while standing in the Brahmā world, sounded his voice by letting it spread and vibrate throughout, in all directions, which was immediately heard by beings in an entire galactic system (cluster).'

"I am curious to know, Bhante, how far can the voice of The Blessed One, The Arahant, The Perfectly Awakened Buddha, vibrate and thus expand and be spread throughout, in all directions, for it to be heard immediately by others, in so many different and far off places?"

And The Blessed One said:

"Ānanda, the one you speak of happened to be the Noble Disciple of an immeasurable Tathāgata!"

Then, for a second time, the Venerable Ānanda asked:

"Bhante, these words I have heard from The Blessed One, in His presence. It is a statement that I personally know The Blessed One has made, as well as acknowledged Himself, by saying to me:

'Ānanda, long ago, Abhibhu, a Disciple of The Buddha Sikhi, while standing in the Brahmā world, sounded his voice by letting it spread and vibrate throughout, in all directions, which was immediately heard by beings in an entire galactic system (cluster).'

"I am curious to know, Bhante, how far can the voice of The Blessed One, The Arahant, The Perfectly Awakened Buddha, vibrate and thus expand and be spread throughout, in all directions, for it to be heard immediately by others, in so many different and far off places?"

Again, The Blessed One replied by saying:

"Ānanda, the one you speak of happened to be the Noble Disciple of an immeasurable Tathāgata!"

And for a third time, the Venerable Ānanda asked:

"Bhante, these words I have heard from The Blessed One, in His presence. It is a statement that I personally know The Blessed One has made, as well as acknowledged Himself, by saying to me:

'Ānanda, long ago, Abhibhu, a Disciple of The Buddha Sikhi, while standing in the Brahmā world, sounded his voice by letting it spread and vibrate throughout, in all directions, which was immediately heard by beings in an entire galactic system (cluster).'

"I am curious to know, Bhante, how far can the voice of The Blessed One, The Arahant, The Perfectly Awakened Buddha, vibrate and thus expand and be spread throughout, in all directions, for it to be heard immediately by others, in so many different and far off places?"

And The Blessed One said:

"Ānanda, have you ever heard of a Cūḷanikā (minor galaxy)?"

"Bhante, *this* is the time! *Now* happens to be the perfect occasion, O Tathāgata, for The Blessed One to speak and for all to hear. For, hearing and carefully listening to it from The Blessed One Himself, the Bhikkhus will memorize and retain it in their hearts, which will be for the benefit of the many!"

"Then, Ānanda, listen and pay close attention. I will now speak."

“Yes, Bhante!” replied the Venerable Ānanda.

And The Blessed One continued instructing:

“Ānanda, a thousand times the mass of space within which the moon and the sun illuminate in all directions with their brightness, is called Cūḷanikā or a minor galaxy (a thousand-fold world system). Here, there are to be found a thousand moons, a thousand suns, a thousand Mahā Meru mountains, a thousand Jambudīpas, a thousand Aparagoyānas, a thousand Uttarakurus, a thousand Pubbavidehas, a thousand fourfold oceans, a thousand fourfold rulers, a thousand fourfold Guardian Kings, a thousand Tāvatiṁsā heavens of the Thirty-three, a thousand Yāma heavens, a thousand heavens of Tusita, a thousand Nimmānaratī heavens of the Devas of creation, a thousand Paranimmita heavens of the Devas who control the creation of other Devas, and a thousand Brahmā worlds.

“This, Ānanda, is what is called Cūḷanikā (a minor galaxy) or a thousand-fold world system.

“Ānanda, a thousand times the size of the Cūḷanikā or the thousand-fold world system, is the million-fold world system, which still happens to be *only* a middle-sized world system, or a big galactic cluster.

“But further than that, Ānanda, is the giant cluster that is even bigger, where you have a giant galactic cluster that is a thousand times the size of the middle-sized galactic cluster, which includes more than a billion world systems within it.

“Now, Ānanda, if The Tathāgata so wishes, He can sound His voice by letting it spread and vibrate throughout, in all directions, resounding and reaching far and wide, while at the same time being immediately heard by beings in the various planes of existence, within these giant galactic clusters, containing more than a billion world systems.”

“But in what way, Bhante, could The Blessed One, if He so wishes, let His voice spread and vibrate throughout, in all directions, resounding and reaching far and wide, while at the same time being immediately heard by beings in the various planes of existence, within these giant galactic clusters, containing more than a billion world systems?”

“Here, Ānanda, The Tathāgata pervades the entire super galactic cluster of a billion world systems with His effulgent light, so that those sentient beings living in them could clearly see it. Then, The Tathāgata lets His voice resound, reaching far and wide, while being heard in all directions, throughout the billion world systems.

“It is in this manner, therefore, Ānanda, that if The Tathāgata so wishes, He can sound His voice by having it spread and vibrate throughout, in all directions, resounding and reaching far and wide, while at the same time being immediately heard by beings in the various planes of existence within these giant galactic clusters, containing more than billion world systems.”

When this was said, the Venerable Ānanda stated to The Blessed One:

“It is indeed my great fortune! I am truly fortunate that *My* Teacher possesses such unimaginable power and might!”

Then, when this was said, the Venerable Udāyī said to the Venerable Ānanda:

“Friend Ānanda, and what difference does it make to *you*, or how would it affect you, anyhow, that your Teacher possesses such unimaginable power and might?”

At this, The Blessed One said:

“Udāyī, do not say so. Do not say so!

“For, if Ānanda were to die right now, albeit while still having the stains of passion and greed in his heart for not having fully released it from greed, then because of his very faith and confidence in The Tathāgata and His unimaginable power and might, giving him that sense of comfort and a pleasant state of safety in the mind, Ānanda will be immediately reborn as the King of the Devas! A position which he would take for no less than seven times over, after his death, and even later, he will similarly rule as the sovereign King of this entire peninsula of Jambudīpa (India), for seven different lifetimes, one after the other!

“But, Udāyī, there is no need to be concerned about such things, for they will not be necessary, since Ānanda *will* attain Full Release before the end of this very life!”



AN III

Suttas 81-90

Samaṇa Vagga

"The Section on Recluses"

81a. ***Samaṇa Sutta*** *(Recluses)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three tasks for a recluse.

What are these three?

The training in the Higher Virtues; the training in the Higher Mind; and the training in the Higher Wisdom. Bhikkhus, these are the three tasks for a recluse.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, you should train thus:

"Our desire and determination will be relentless as we keenly train ourselves in the Higher Virtues, as we keenly train in order to develop and fully experience the Higher Mind, and as we keenly train ourselves to gain the Higher Wisdom."

Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must all train.

81b. ***Gadrabha Sutta*** *(A Donkey)*

Bhikkhus, while following a herd of cattle, a donkey cannot call on them by saying:

"Wait! I am one of you! I too am part of this herd!" And why is that?

It is because neither his appearance nor color is similar to those of cattle; also, his voice or calling is not like those of cattle, as well as his hoof prints are not like those of cattle. Yet, he follows after the cattle, while claiming:

"Wait! I am one of you! I too am part of this herd!"

It is the same, Bhikkhus, when a certain bhikkhu goes on following after the Noble Saṅgha of Bhikkhus, while claiming:

"I too am one of you! After all, I also am a Bhikkhu!"

Yet, the absence of fervent desire and determination in his heart for the Training, in order to fully develop in the Higher Virtues, gives him away as someone who is, in fact, totally unrelated to those who are genuine Bhikkhus, indeed!

Similarly, the absence of fervent desire and determination in his heart for the Training, in order to develop and gain the Higher Mind, gives him away as someone who is, in fact, totally unrelated to those who are genuine Bhikkhus, indeed!

Similarly, the absence of fervent desire and determination in his heart for the Training, in order to gain the Higher Wisdom, gives him away as someone who is, in fact, totally unrelated to those who are genuine Bhikkhus, indeed!

Yet, he still continues to walk behind The Noble Saṅgha of Bhikkhus, while thinking to himself:

"I too am one of you! After all, I also am a Bhikkhu!"

Therefore, Bhikkhus, you should train yourselves thus:

"Our desire and determination will be relentless as we keenly train ourselves in the Higher Virtues, as we keenly train in order to develop and fully experience the Higher Mind, and as we keenly train ourselves to gain the Higher Wisdom."

Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must all train.

82. ***Kassaka Sutta*** *(A Farmer)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three fundamental tasks that must be undertaken by a farmer. What three?

Here, Bhikkhus, a farmer must first prepare the field by ploughing and harrowing it well. Next, he has to carefully embed the seeds at the right time. Afterward, at the right time, he has to lead the water into the cultivated field by irrigating it, and then drain the field by letting the water flow out, at the appropriate time.

Bhikkhus, these are the three fundamental tasks that must be undertaken by a farmer.

Now, in the just same manner, Bhikkhus, there are these three fundamental tasks that must be undertaken by a Bhikkhu. What three?

The training in the Higher Virtues; the training in the Higher Mind; and the training in the Higher Wisdom.

Bhikkhus, these are the three fundamental tasks that must be undertaken by a Bhikkhu.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, you should all train thus:

"Our desire and determination will be relentless as we keenly train ourselves in the Higher Virtues, as we keenly train in order to develop and fully experience the Higher Mind, and as we keenly train ourselves to gain the Higher Wisdom."

Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that you must all train.

83. ***Vajjiputta Sutta*** *(Son of the Vajjis)*

This is what I personally heard.

Once, while The Blessed One was living at the gabled hall of the Great Forest, in the city of Vesālī, a certain Bhikkhu of the Vajji people went and approached The Blessed One.

Then, after paying homage to The Teacher, he sat to one side and spoke these words, while addressing The Blessed One:

"Bhante, the recital of the one hundred and fifty rules that we chant every fortnight, is truly too much for me. Therefore, Bhante, I am unfortunately unable to go through them one by one. It is also tediously dreary and tiresome for me to recite them."

And The Blessed One replied, by asking that Bhikkhu:

"But, Bhikkhu, can you train in the Three Trainings, by developing yourself in the Higher Virtues, by developing your Higher Mind, while also by training yourself in Higher Wisdom?"

"Yes, indeed, Bhante! I *am* certainly able to train in the Three Trainings, by developing myself in the Higher Virtues, by developing my Higher Mind, and also by training myself in Higher Wisdom."

"In that case, Bhikkhu, just focus on training and developing yourself in the Higher Virtues, training and developing your Higher Mind, while also training in Higher Wisdom. And as you do so, naturally passion and lust, anger, hatred, and delusion, along with willful ignoring (*avijjā*) will simply drop away and be totally relinquished in you.

"Then, as a result of you having abandoned those tendencies, it will no longer be possible for you to engage in anything evil or unwholesome, nor somehow act in a damaging or harmful manner, at all. And with their fading away, all your actions will become wholesome and beneficial, while at the same time, all unwholesome and damaging traits will be entirely removed from your behavior."

Now, as instructed by The Teacher, that Bhikkhu kept practicing and diligently training himself, as he developed himself in the Higher Virtues, training and developing in his Higher Mind, while also training in Higher Wisdom. And as expected, he gave up all his former ties to passion and lust, to anger, hatred, and delusion, along with willful ignorance.

Thus, as a result of having abandoned those tendencies, it was no longer possible for him to engage in anything evil or unwholesome, nor somehow act in a damaging or harmful manner, at all. And with their fading away, all of his actions became wholesome and beneficial, while at the same time, all unwholesome and damaging traits were entirely removed from his behavior.

84. ***Sekha Sutta*** *(The Disciple in Higher Training)*

Once, a certain Bhikkhu went and approached The Blessed One, paid homage to Him, and then sat down to one side and said:

"Bhante, I often hear the term: *'The disciple in Higher Training'… 'The disciple in Higher Training,'* being mentioned. But, Bhante, what is to be understood from that expression? How does one become a Disciple in Higher Training, Bhante?"

"Bhikkhu, when the Bhikkhu is genuinely training, then, he is considered to be in the training stage, hence, he is called a Disciple in Higher Training.

"And what exactly is it that he trains in?

"He engages in the training of the Higher Virtues; the training in the Higher Mind; and the training in Higher Wisdom.

"This, therefore, is the reason why he is called a 'Disciple in Higher Training.'

'As the disciple in Higher Training engages in training,
Maintaining his course on the direct path,
He first experiences personally the process of wearing away,
Immediately followed by the unmistakable knowledge of the journey's end.
And when thus having destroyed the fetters of becoming,
One is liberated, where the firm understanding suddenly surfaces in him, at last:
"Unshakeable is now my Release."'

85. ***Paṭhama Sikkhā Sutta*** *(Mastering the Trainings – Part 1)*

Bhikkhus, every fortnight, good sons of families who have come seeking their benefit and wellbeing, gather together in order to recite the Pātimokkha rules which number one hundred and fifty, while continuing to develop their growth within the Training.

There are, after all, these three trainings.

And what are these three?

The training in the Higher Virtues; the training in the Higher Mind; and the training in the Higher Wisdom. Bhikkhus, these are the three tasks for a recluse.

a. Here, Bhikkhus, think of a Bhikkhu who, although is well-trained and accomplished in his development of virtuous behavior, having mastered it, yet is still only moderately developed in his meditation (*samādhi*), as well as in his wisdom, wherein his understanding is relatively limited.

Now, such a practitioner might still break his minor and lesser significant training rules, and thus engage in wrong behavior. However, soon he can recover and regain his former balance.

And why is this so?

Because, while it is still quite possible for such a person to break his training rules and commit a wrongdoing, in terms of those minor and lesser rules, yet given that he is well-structured in his dedication to the rules, treating them as his core and fundamental basis, he can therefore regain his balance by continuing his work, undertaking and keeping those rules, which benefits him greatly in completing the task of the Holy Life. Thus, his firmness in virtuous behavior and his reliance on the training in the monastic rules helps him greatly.

And through diligent practice, when he is able to shatter the first three fetters, he then becomes a "Stream Winner" (someone who has entered The Stream of Dhamma), hence, no longer being subject to ever falling back into any of the lower and miserable realms. Thus, he becomes firmly established on his direct and inevitable course to Full Awakening.

b. Next, Bhikkhus, think of another Bhikkhu who, although is also well-trained and accomplished in his development of virtuous behavior, having mastered it, yet is still only moderately developed in his meditation (*samādhi*), as well as in his wisdom, wherein his understanding is relatively limited. Now, such a practitioner might still break his minor and lesser significant training rules, and thus engage in wrong behavior. However, soon he can recover and regain his former balance.

And why is this so?

Because, while it is still quite possible for such a person to break his training rules and commit a wrongdoing, in terms of those minor and lesser rules, yet given that he is well-structured in his dedication to the rules, treating them as his core and fundamental basis, he can therefore regain his balance by continuing his work, undertaking and keeping those rules, which benefits him greatly in completing the task of the Holy Life. Thus, his firmness in virtuous behavior and reliance on the training in the monastic rules helps him greatly.

And through diligent practice, having already shattered the first three fetters, he strongly weakens the defilements of lust, hatred, and delusion, and as a result, he becomes a "Once Returner," one who is bound to return back only once more, prior to attaining Full Awakening, being already firmly established on his direct and inevitable course to Nibbāna.

c. Next, Bhikkhus, think of another Bhikkhu who, although is well-trained and accomplished in his development of virtuous behavior, as well as his meditation (*samādhi*), having mastered them both, yet is still only moderately developed in his wisdom, wherein his understanding is still relatively limited. Now, such a practitioner might still break his minor and lesser significant training rules, and thus engage in wrong behavior. However, soon he can recover and regain his former balance.

And why is this so?

Because, while it is still quite possible for such a person to break his training rules and commit a wrongdoing, in terms of those minor and lesser rules, yet given that he is well-structured in his dedication to the rules, treating them as his core and fundamental basis, he can therefore regain his balance by continuing his work, undertaking and keeping those rules, which benefits him greatly in completing the task of the Holy Life. Thus, his firmness in virtuous behavior and reliance on the training in the monastic rules helps him greatly.

And through diligent practice, having already shattered all of the five lower fetters, at the end of life, which will be his very last one here in this world, at death, he is immediately reborn into The Pure Abodes, whence there is no more return, and where he will attain Full Awakening.

d. Next, Bhikkhus, think of another Bhikkhu who is well-trained and accomplished in his development of virtuous behavior, accomplished in his development in meditation (*samādhi*), and fully accomplished in his development in wisdom and understanding, having mastered them all. Now, it might so happen that such a practitioner breaks his minor and lesser significant training rules. However, soon he can recover and regain his former balance.

And why is this so?

Because, while it is still quite possible for such a person to break his training rules and commit a wrongdoing, in terms of those minor and lesser rules, yet given that he is well-structured in his dedication to the rules, treating them as his core and fundamental basis, he can therefore regain his balance by continuing his work, undertaking and keeping those rules, which benefits him

greatly, in completing the task of the Holy Life. Thus, his firmness in virtuous behavior and reliance on the training in the monastic rules helps him greatly.

Through diligent practice, he attains the Release of the Heart, that is the dustless Freedom through Wisdom, in this very life, having destroyed all the contaminants of the heart through his own effort and direct realization. And thus, he attains to the Supreme Goal of the Holy Life, whereby he dwells in that state, while living out the rest of his days.

So, Bhikkhus, it depends on the maturity of your development in the Training, whereby if you have *only* partially developed yourself in it, then your success too will be partial and limited. But those of you who become fully accomplished in your development within the Training, by mastering all its levels, then you are assured the success it certainly brings.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, I declare that your serious commitment and genuine effort with which you apply yourselves in this Training are *never* in vain.

86. ***Dutiya Sikkhā Sutta*** *(Mastering the Trainings – Part 2)*

Bhikkhus, the one hundred and fifty training rules are to be recited every two weeks. Therefore, the sons of clansmen seeking their own good must observe them.

These training rules are categorized into three training groups. What are the three?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu develops and becomes complete in his practice, as he engages in training in the Higher Virtues, training in the Higher Mind, and training in Higher Wisdom.

a. Here, a Bhikkhu, while training in virtuous behavior and accomplishing mastery in it, however, is one who only develops his collectedness of mind and wisdom to a modest level, as he breaks certain minor training rules but works diligently to abstain from doing so again.

And for what reason?

Bhikkhus, while training, I say he may end up breaking those minor training rules. However, because he is dedicated to those training rules that are fundamental to living the Holy Life, conducive to the Holy life, he remains fixed and firm in his resolve, and comes back to them.

Thus, by undertaking these training rules, he is heedful and determined in their practice, and with the complete destruction of the three fetters, he limits his rebirths among the Devas or humans for no more than seven times at the most, whereby he will put a final end to suffering.

Or, with the complete destruction of the three fetters, he goes from family to family, after being reborn in good families two or three more times at the most, putting a final end to suffering.

Or, by the complete destruction of the three fetters, he becomes a "single-seeder", as he seeks rebirth once more in the human realm, whereby he puts a final end to suffering.

Or, with the complete destruction of the three fetters, while also reducing his greed, hatred, and delusion, he becomes a "Once-Returner," coming back only once more to existence, where he will put a final end to all suffering.

b. Next, another Bhikkhu who, although is well-trained and accomplished in his development of virtuous behavior, and in his meditation (*samādhi*), having mastered them both, yet still is only moderately developed in his wisdom, wherein his understanding is relatively limited.

And for what reason?

Bhikkhus, while training, I say that at times, he may be prone to breaking those minor training rules. However, because he is dedicated to those training rules that are fundamental to living the Holy Life, conducive to the Holy life, he remains fixed and firm in his resolve, and thus comes back to them.

Thus, by undertaking these training rules, he is heedful and determined in their practice, and with the destruction of the five lower fetters binding him to the sensual world, he becomes a "Non-Returner," destined to go upstream and to only reappear in the highest of Brahma realms, in the Akaniṭṭha Pure Abodes, where he will attain Full Liberation, without ever returning from that plane of existence.

Or, through the complete destruction of the five lower fetters binding him to the sensual world, after his death in this body, he will reappear in the Akaniṭṭha Pure Abode, where he attains Final Nibbāna through exertion, by putting a final end to all suffering.

Or, by the complete destruction of the five lower fetters binding him to the sensual world, after his death at the end of this life, he would also reappear in the Pure Abodes for his next birth, where he attains Final Nibbāna but *without* any difficulty or exertion, and thus puts a final end to all suffering.

Or, by the complete destruction of the five lower fetters binding him to the sensual world, at the end of his human existence, he attains Final Nibbāna upon landing into the Pure Abodes, and thus puts a final end to all suffering.

Or, with the complete destruction of the five lower fetters binding him to the sensual world, at death, when this body has broken down, he attains Final Nibbāna during the interval of his reappearance into the Pure Abodes, thus putting a final end to all suffering.

c. Next, another Bhikkhu, while completing his training in virtuous behavior, also develops and completes his training in collected stability of mind, as well as his training in wisdom, mastering

them all. However, though there might come a time when he breaks certain minor training rules, he works diligently to abstain from doing so again.

And for what reason?

Bhikkhus, while training, I say he may still be prone to breaking those minor training rules. However, because he is dedicated to those training rules that are fundamental to living the spiritual life, conducive to the Holy life, he remains fixed and firm in his resolve.

Thus, by undertaking these training rules, he is heedful and determined in their practice, and with the destruction of the contaminants in this very life, he realizes for himself and through his own direct knowledge, the taintless Final Liberation of the Heart, and enters upon and dwells in this liberated state of mind through wisdom.

It is in this way, Bhikkhus, whereby through dedicating oneself partially, one attains partial results, and by dedicating oneself fully to the Holy Life, along with its three Higher Trainings to their perfection, one here and now attains Final Liberation.

I declare, therefore, that these training rules are not to be regarded as fruitless, at all.

*87. **Tatiya Sikkhā Sutta** (Mastering the Trainings – Part 3)*

Bhikkhus, the one hundred and fifty training rules are to be recited every two weeks. Therefore, all those sons of clansmen who come seeking their own good must observe them.

These training rules are categorized into three training groups. What are the three?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu develops and becomes complete in his practice, as he engages in training in the Higher Virtues, training in the Higher Mind, and training in Higher Wisdom, mastering them all.

Now, it might so happen that such a practitioner breaks his minor and lesser significant training rules. However, soon he can recover and regain his former balance.

And why is this so?

Because, while it is still quite possible for such a person to break his minor training rules and commit a wrongdoing, in terms of those lesser rules, yet given that he is well-structured in his dedication to the training rules, treating them as his core and fundamental basis, he can therefore regain his balance by continuing his work, undertaking and keeping those rules, which benefits him greatly in the Holy Life. Thus, his firmness in virtuous behavior and reliance on the training in the monastic rules helps him greatly.

Thus, by maintaining his diligent practice, he attains the Release of the Heart, that is the dustless Freedom through Wisdom, in this very life, having destroyed all the contaminants of the heart through his own direct realization and sincere efforts. In this manner, he attains to the Supreme Goal of the Holy Life, whereby he dwells in that state, while living out the rest of his days.

However, Bhikkhus, if the Bhikkhu is unable to realize the Release of the Heart that is the dustless Freedom through Wisdom, in this very life, then with the complete destruction of the five lower fetters binding all beings to the sensual world, at the conclusion of his human existence, he then attains Final Nibbāna during the interval of his reappearance into the Pure Abodes, at which point he puts a final end to all suffering.

But, if he does not attain in this manner by to not penetrating thus far, then, through the complete destruction of the five lower fetters which bind one to the sensual world, once this body is no more, after death, he attains Final Nibbāna upon landing in the Pure Abodes, as he puts a final end to all suffering.

However, if he is still unable to realize or attain in this manner, then, with the complete destruction of the five lower fetters binding one to the sensual world, right after this life is over, at death, he reappears into the Pure Abodes, where he attains Final Nibbāna without exertion, and thus puts a final end to all suffering.

Still however, if he is still unable to realize this, then with the complete destruction of the five lower fetters that bind all beings to the sensual world, at the conclusion of this life, upon death, he reappears in the Pure Abodes, where he attains Final Nibbāna with some effort and exertion, thus putting a final end to all suffering.

And if he is still unable to realize this, then, with the destruction of the five lower fetters that bind one to the sensual world, already being a Non-Returner himself, he is declared to be “one who goes upstream” and reappears in the highest of Brahma realms, in the Akaniṭṭha Pure Abodes, where he will attain Full Liberation, without ever returning from that world.

If, however, he is still unable to realize or attain any of these states, then, with the complete destruction of the first three fetters, thus greatly reducing his passion, hatred, and delusion, he becomes a “Once-Returner,”, whereby he will come back only once more to this world of human existence, where he will put a final end to all suffering.

But, if he is still unable to realize this, then, through the complete destruction of the three fetters, he becomes a “one-seeder,” as he seeks rebirth once more in human existence, putting a final end to suffering.

But, if he is unable to realize this, then, with the complete destruction of the three fetters, he goes from family to family, being reborn in good families two or three more times at the most, upon the completion of which, he will put a final end to suffering.

But, if he is still unable to realize this, then, with the complete destruction of the three fetters, he limits his rebirths among the Devas or humans for seven more times at the most, where he finally puts an end to suffering.

It is in this way, Bhikkhus, that by dedicating oneself partially, one attains partial results, and by dedicating yourselves fully to the Holy Life, engaging through all its trainings, you will attain Final Liberation, here and now.

Thus, I declare that your genuine efforts in the Holy Life will not be a waste, hence these training rules are not to be regarded as fruitless, at all.

88. ***Paṭhama Sikkhā Sutta*** *(The Higher Trainings – Part 1)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three higher trainings. What three?

Observing the training in the Higher virtues; the training in the Higher Mind; and the training in the Higher Wisdom.

And what, Bhikkhus, is the training in the Higher Virtues?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu becomes virtuous in his behavior while training in the Higher Virtues pertaining to the six sense bases. By undertaking these training rules, he is heedful and determined in their practice. This is called training in the Higher Virtue.

And what, Bhikkhus, is the training in the Higher Mind?

Here, Bhikkhus, by overcoming the obstructive five hindrances, while being secluded from sensual and harmful thoughts, the Bhikkhu enters upon and abides in the first *jhāna*, which is accompanied by thinking and planning, with joy and pleasure that arise from such seclusion. Later, through the disappearance of both thinking and planning, the Bhikkhu enters upon and abides in the second *jhāna*, which brings self-confidence and singleness of mind but without thinking and planning, with joy and pleasure born of the collected stability of mind. And with joy increasingly dissipating, he experiences a deepening of equanimity, where he remains mindful and fully aware, while experiencing pleasure and happiness within the body. This is the third *jhāna*, for which the Noble Ones state:

"Such a one mindfully abides in happiness, with ever-present equanimity."

Further, by giving up both pleasure and pain, and having already gone beyond joy and anguish, the Bhikkhu remains in the continuous state of purifying mindfulness, with an ever-present sense of equanimity, as he enters upon and abides in the fourth *jhāna*, while experiencing neither pleasure nor pain, having now gone beyond both.

This, therefore, is called training in the Higher Mind.

And what, Bhikkhus, is training in Higher Wisdom?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu knows and sees how suffering comes to be. He knows and sees directly, how suffering is conditioned and the manner in which its origination unfolds and comes to be. He also knows and sees directly, how the very cessation of suffering unfolds and takes place. Furthermore, he knows and sees directly, how the Path of Practice itself, when applied correctly, puts an end to suffering, thereby bringing suffering to its cessation.

Bhikkhus, this is the training in the Higher Wisdom.

These, Bhikkhus, are therefore the Three Higher Trainings.

89. ***Dutiya Sikkhā Sutta*** *(The Higher Trainings – Part 2)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three Higher Trainings. What three?

Observing the training in the Higher Virtues; the training in the Higher Mind; and the training in the Higher Wisdom.

And what, Bhikkhus, is the training in the Higher Virtues?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu lives a virtuous life while observing and being restrained by the Pātimokkha, being disciplined and possessing good conduct, aware of the slightest misconduct in himself. And having thus taken on the training rules, he practices the monk's Code of Discipline. This is called training in the Higher Virtue.

And what, Bhikkhus, is the training in the Higher Mind?

Here, Bhikkhus, by overcoming the obstructive five hindrances, while being secluded from sensual and harmful thoughts, the Bhikkhu enters upon and abides in the first *jhāna*, which is accompanied by thinking and planning, with joy and pleasure that arise from such seclusion. Later, through the disappearance of both thinking and planning, the Bhikkhu enters upon and abides in the second *jhāna*, which brings self-confidence and singleness of mind but without thinking and planning, with joy and pleasure born of the collected stability of mind. And with joy increasingly dissipating, he experiences a deepening of equanimity, where he remains mindful and fully aware, while experiencing pleasure and happiness within the body. This is the third *jhāna*, for which the Noble Ones state:

"Such a one mindfully abides in happiness, with ever-present equanimity."

Further, by giving up both pleasure and pain, and having already gone beyond joy and anguish, the Bhikkhu remains in the continuous state of purifying mindfulness, with an ever-present sense

of equanimity, as he enters upon and abides in the fourth *jhāna*, while experiencing neither pleasure nor pain, having now gone beyond both.

This, therefore, is called training in the Higher Mind.

And what, Bhikkhus, is the training in Higher Wisdom?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu knows and sees directly, how suffering comes to be. He knows and sees directly, how suffering is conditioned and the manner in which its origination unfolds and comes to be. He also knows and sees directly, how the very cessation of suffering unfolds and takes place. Furthermore, he knows and sees directly, how the Path of Practice itself, when applied correctly, puts an end to suffering, thereby bringing suffering to its cessation, as it too finally unfolds.

Bhikkhus, this is the training in the Higher Wisdom.

These, Bhikkhus, are therefore the Three Higher Trainings.

'Strong, resolute, and energized,
Maintaining consistent mindfulness,
Fully guarded in his sense faculties,
He trains himself diligently in Higher Virtue, in Higher Mind, and in Higher Wisdom.
Ever-present with his full awareness,
Wherever he finds himself, throughout all quarters;

Whether in front of his face or behind him too,
Be it above or below, whether by day or by night it may happen to be,
His collected stability of heart (samādhi) remains boundlessly available and present,
Persistently, always with him, wherever he may be.

One whose conduct and behavior has become thus purified
Is known as a Noble Disciple who is genuinely training in this Path of Practice;
Truly engaged in living and thus completing the Holy life,
And to be known as having gone beyond the Training and reached the very Goal;
An Awakened One himself,
Son of the Self-Awakened and The Perfectly Enlightened Buddha.
And through the ceasing of his consciousness,
All craving comes to a full stop and is no more,
Experiencing freedom at last from the constant thirst for more,
Like an oil lamp that's suddenly gone out.

That's how it is, after all, that very moment,
When the Heart is finally Liberated and Fully Released.'

90. ***Paṅkadhā Sutta*** *(Acknowledging a Mistake)*

At one time, The Blessed One was wandering in the country of Kosala with a large Saṅgha of Bhikkhus, as he entered the town of Paṅkadhā, where He decided to stay for some time.

It was during this time, that a Bhikkhu by the name of Kassapagotta also lived in Paṅkadhā.

While residing there, The Blessed One kept instructing, advising, encouraging, inspiring and gladdening the hearts and minds of the Bhikkhus, with a talk on the training rules.

Upon hearing The Blessed One's talk on upholding the training rules, the Bhikkhu Kassapagotta became bitter and discontented with the teachings that were being given to the Bhikkhus, as he kept thinking to himself that The Teacher was being too stringent in establishing those rules. Then, after The Blessed One had stayed in Paṅkadhā for as long as He had pleased, He set out on a journey toward Rājagaha, where He reached gradually and began living at the Gijjha Cillfs (Vulture's Peak), in Rājagaha.

Meanwhile, soon after The Blessed One had left, the Bhikkhu Kassapagotta became remorseful and regretful given his earlier thoughts, as he reflected:

'This state of affairs has not helped me one bit, for instead, I have truly lost much, wasting valuable time being bitter and discontented with the teachings The Holy One was giving us Bhikkhus, on the training rules. It surely does not benefit me or anyone else, to go on ruminating or thinking that The Teacher was being too strict and stringent with the rules, while The Blessed One kept instructing, advising, encouraging, inspiring and gladdening the hearts and minds of us Bhikkhus, with a talk on the training rules. Now, let me head out to find The Blessed One wherever He may be dwelling, and ask His forgiveness for my wrongdoing, in committing that offence!'

Then, having put his dwelling in order, the Bhikkhu Kassapagotta took his alms bowl and outer robes and headed to Rājagaha, where he eventually arrived at the Vultures' Peak. And in approaching The Blessed One, he paid homage to The Teacher, and then sat to one side and said: "Bhante, when The Blessed Lord was in the Kosalan country, living in Paṅkadhā, The Blessed One instructed, advised, encouraged, inspired and gladdened the hearts and minds of us Bhikkhus, with a talk on the training rules. But, on listening to The Blessed One's talk on upholding the rules, I became bitter and discontented with the teachings given to us, Bhikkhus, while ruminating and thinking to myself that The Teacher was being too stringent with the rules."

"Then, Bhante, after The Blessed One had left Paṅkadhā and set out on His journey toward Rājagaha, I became remorseful and regretted my actions, given my earlier thoughts, and thereby reflected to myself:

'This state of affairs has not helped me one bit, for instead, I have truly lost much, wasting valuable time being bitter and discontented with the teachings The Holy One was giving us Bhikkhus, on the training rules. It surely does not benefit me or anyone else, to go on ruminating

or thinking that The Teacher was being too strict and stringent with the rules, while The Blessed One kept instructing, advising, encouraging, inspiring and gladdening the hearts and minds of us Bhikkhus, with a talk on the training rules. Now, let me head out to find The Blessed One wherever He may be dwelling, and ask His forgiveness for my wrongdoing, in committing that offence!'

"Therefore, Bhante, I have committed an offence by my wrongdoing, for as The Blessed One was instructing, advising, encouraging, inspiring and gladdening the hearts and minds of the Bhikkhus with a talk on the training rules, I, on the other hand, while listening to The Blessed One's talk, became bitter and discontented with the teachings given to us, Bhikkhus, on the training rules, thinking to myself that The Teacher was being too stringent with so many rules.

"Blessed Lord, I was utterly foolish as it was ignorant of me and damaging, in fact, to become so bitter and discontented with my thoughts about The Blessed One being too stringent with the rules.

"Bhante, may The Blessed One please forgive me for my offence, as this wrongdoing of mine was based on foolishness and ignorance, and may this be seen as an offence that I promise never to engage in again, in the future, through maintaining wise restraint!"

And The Blessed One said:

"Indeed, Kassapa, you have committed an offence, for while I was instructing, advising, encouraging, inspiring and gladdening the hearts and minds of the Bhikkhus with a talk on the training rules, you became bitter and discontented with the teachings given to the Bhikkhus, as you were listening to My talk on upholding the rules, thinking to yourself that I, The Teacher, was being too stringent with the rules.

"However, Kassapa, since you ask for pardon while seeing your own fault in this offence, and seek to make amends according to The Dhamma, I pardon you and accept your apology, given your promise to not repeat it again, by maintaining wise restraint in the future. For, it indicates growth in The Noble One's Discipline when someone sees their own offence as an offence, and therefore seeks to make amends according to The Dhamma, while ensuring restraint in the future.

"Kassapa, there may be an elder Bhikkhu who, not liking the training himself, does not talk in praise of the training, and consequently does not encourage other Bhikkhus to follow and observe the training rules, either. Furthermore, such a Bhikkhu would not praise other Bhikkhus genuinely, truthfully, and in a timely manner, who unlike him, *do* like the training and therefore observe it carefully.

"Now, Kassapa, I do not speak in praise of such an elder Bhikkhu. And why is that?

"Because in hearing The Teacher praise such a person, other Bhikkhus would start to associate with him and consequently behave in like manner by following his example, and as a result, they

would fall into much harm and suffering, for a very long time. Hence, Kassapa, I do not speak in praise of such an elder Bhikkhu.

“Kassapa, there may be another Bhikkhu, one of a middle standing who, also not liking the training rules, does not talk in praise of the training, and consequently, does not encourage other Bhikkhus to follow or observe the training rules, either.

“Furthermore, such a Bhikkhu would not praise other Bhikkhus genuinely, truthfully, and in a timely manner, who unlike him, *do* in fact like to follow the training rules, while observing them carefully.

“Here too, Kassapa, I do not speak in praise of such a Bhikkhu of middle standing. And why is that?

“Because in hearing The Teacher praise such a person, other Bhikkhus would start to associate with him and behave in like manner by following his example, and as a result, they would fall into much harm and suffering, for a very long time. Therefore, Kassapa, I do not speak in praise of such a Bhikkhu of middle standing, either.

“Kassapa, there may be a junior Bhikkhu who, because of not liking the training himself, does not talk in praise of the training, and consequently does not encourage other Bhikkhus to follow or observe the training rules, either.

“Furthermore, such a Bhikkhu would not praise other Bhikkhus genuinely, truthfully, and in a timely manner, who unlike him, *do* in fact, like to adhere to the training rules, by observing them carefully.

“Kassapa, I do not speak in praise of such a junior Bhikkhu, either. And why is that?

“Because in hearing The Teacher praise such a person, other Bhikkhus would start to associate with him and behave in like manner by following his example, and as a result, they would fall into much harm and suffering, for a very long time. Therefore, Kassapa, I do not speak in praise of such a junior Bhikkhu either.

“But, Kassapa, *if* there may be an elder Bhikkhu who, while adhering to the training himself, speaks in praise of the training, and consequently encourages other Bhikkhus to follow and observe the training as well; and if such a Bhikkhu praises genuinely, truthfully, and in a timely manner other Bhikkhus who, like him, do like the training rules, while observing them carefully, then, Kassapa, I *do* indeed, speak in praise of such an elder Bhikkhu. And why is that?

“Because, Kassapa, in hearing The Teacher praise such a person, other Bhikkhus would start to associate with him more and behave in like manner by following his example, and as a result, they too would gain much benefit and happiness, for a very long time. Therefore, Kassapa, I *do* speak in praise of such an elder Bhikkhu.

“Furthermore, Kassapa, if there may be a Bhikkhu of middle standing who, while adhering to the training rules himself, also speaks in praise of the training, and consequently encourages other Bhikkhus to follow and observe the training; and if such a Bhikkhu praises genuinely, truthfully, and in a timely manner those other Bhikkhus who, like him, also adhere to the training rules while observing them carefully, then, Kassapa, I *do* speak in praise of such a Bhikkhu of middle standing. And why is that?

“Because in hearing The Teacher praise such a person, other Bhikkhus would start to associate with him more, and thus behave in like manner by following his example, and as a result, they too would gain much benefit and happiness, for a very long time. Therefore, Kassapa, I do speak in praise of such a Bhikkhu of middle standing.

“Further, Kassapa, if there may be a junior Bhikkhu who also adheres to the training himself and speaks in praise of the training, and consequently encourages other Bhikkhus to also follow and observe the training; and if such a Bhikkhu praises genuinely, truthfully, and in a timely manner those other Bhikkhus who, like him, also adhere to the training rules while observing them carefully, then, Kassapa, I *do* speak in praise of such a junior Bhikkhu. And why is that?

“Because in hearing The Teacher praise such a person, other Bhikkhus would start to associate with him more and behave in like manner by following his example, and as a result, they too would gain much benefit and happiness, for a very long time. Therefore, Kassapa, I do speak in praise of such a junior Bhikkhu, too.”



AN III

Suttas 91-101

Loṇakapalla Vagga

"The Section on the Salt Crystal"

91. ***Accāyika Sutta*** *(Urgent Tasks)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three urgent tasks to be undertaken by a farmer. What three?

Here, Bhikkhus, a farmer must first prepare the field by ploughing and harrowing it well. Then, he has to carefully plant the seeds at the right time. And later, at the right time, he has to lead the water into the field to irrigate it sufficiently, followed by draining the field by letting the water flow out, at the appropriate time.

Bhikkhus, a farmer must do these three things with urgency.

Bhikkhus, a farmer does not possess the kind of psychic ability, with which he could command by determining:

'Today, the seeds which I planted will start to germinate, tomorrow they will start growing, and the day after tomorrow, they will be ready for harvest!'

Yet, it so happens that with the seasonal changes taking place, at the right time, the seedlings will indeed start to germinate, grow, and bear fruit.

In the same manner, Bhikkhus, there are these three urgent tasks to be undertaken by the Bhikkhu. What three?

The undertaking of his training in Higher Virtue; the undertaking of his training in the Higher Mind; and the undertaking of his training in Higher Wisdom.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, a Bhikkhu must do these three things with urgency.

Such a Bhikkhu may not possess the kind of psychic ability, with which he could command by determining:

'Today, tomorrow, or the day after tomorrow, my mind will be liberated from the contaminants by no longer gripping or grabbing onto anything!'

Yet, as this Bhikkhu trains himself while undertaking the training in Higher Virtue, in the Higher Mind, and in Higher Wisdom, then, at the right moment, his heart becomes suddenly liberated from the contaminants (*āsavas*) by no longer gripping or grabbing onto anything.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, you should train yourselves thus:

'We will be firm in our resolve to undertake the training in Higher Virtue, the training in the Higher Mind, and the training in Higher Wisdom.'

Therefore, Bhikkhus, it is in such a manner that you must train.

92a. ***Paviveka Sutta*** *(Seclusion)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three types of seclusion practiced by the wandering ascetics of other sects. What three?

Seclusion in regards to the robes; seclusion in regards to alms food; and seclusion in regards to dwellings.

a. Here, Bhikkhus, for the wandering ascetics of other sects, seclusion as it relates to robes is seen as having to do with wearing robes made from hemp, from coarse cloth interwoven with hemp, robes made from shrouds that at one time corpses were wrapped and laid in, robes made of tree bark, antelope hide, strips of antelope hide, strips of wood and owls' wings. In addition, they wear robes made of grass, blankets made of head hair, animal hair, and horses' tail.
This is the seclusion in regards to robes, as followed by the wandering ascetics of other sects.

b. Next, Bhikkhus, for the wandering ascetics of other sects, seclusion as it relates to alms food is seen as having to do with eating only vegetables and greens, millets, raw rice, a kind of dark rice, a kind of water plant, finely broken rice, rice foam, sesame flour, grass, cow dung, roots and fruits from the forest and whatever is picked from the ground.
This is the seclusion in regards to alms food, as followed by the wandering ascetics of other sects.

c. Further, Bhikkhus, for the wandering ascetics of other sects, seclusion as it relates to dwelling is seen as having to do with living only in forests, next the roots of trees, cemeteries, forest paths, open spaces, on a heap of straw, or in a hay stack.
This is the seclusion in regards to dwelling, as followed by the wandering ascetics of other sects.

These, therefore, are the three types of seclusion followed by the wandering ascetics of other sects.

But, Bhikkhus, in This Dhamma and Discipline, there are instead these different three seclusions followed by the Bhikkhu.

And what are these three?

a. Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu lives with virtue, abandons the immoral lifestyle, and thus dwells secluded and free from a non-virtuous or immoral life.

b. The Bhikkhu is one of Right View, as he has abandoned wrong views entirely, and dwells secluded and free from wrong views.

c. The Bhikkhu is one who has destroyed the contaminants (*āsavas*), who has abandoned the contaminants, and dwells secluded and free from the contaminants.

Now Bhikkhus, when the Bhikkhu lives with virtue, having abandoned the non-virtuous and immoral lifestyle, and dwells secluded and free from it; when the Bhikkhu is of Right View, having abandoned wrong views entirely, and dwells secluded and free from wrong views; and when the Bhikkhu has destroyed the contaminants, and having abandoned the contaminants, he dwells secluded and free from them; then, he is called the Bhikkhu who has attained the highest, who has reached the very core, and in his purity, he is established in that which is *the* foremost essential.

Bhikkhus, these are the three seclusions for the Bhikkhus in This Dhamma and Discipline.

Imagine a farmer, Bhikkhus, whose field of rice has ripened successfully, where he would quickly work to harvest his crops by cutting, collecting, and carrying them away into a heap to be threshed. Then, by piling them up, he quickly crushes them, while shaking out the straw and throwing it away, along with its chaff that is allowed to get blown away. And afterwards, he would quickly carry them away to be pounded and then husked, leaving only the pure essence of the grain. In this manner, the farmer is able to attain the core, the foremost of his crops, the pure essence of whatever he has cultivated.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, when the Bhikkhu lives with virtue, having abandoned the non-virtuous and immoral lifestyle, and dwells secluded and free from it; when the Bhikkhu is of Right View, having abandoned wrong views entirely, and dwells secluded and free from wrong views; and when the Bhikkhu has destroyed the contaminants, and having abandoned the contaminants, he dwells secluded and free from them; then, he is called the Bhikkhu who has attained the highest, who has reached the very core, and in his purity, he is established in that which is *the* foremost essential.

92b. ***Sarada Sutta*** *(In Autumn)*

Bhikkhus, much like in the autumn season when there is not a single cloud in sight, and the sun rises high up in the clear sky, dispelling all the darkness as it shines and radiates its light upon everything, similarly, when the Eye of Dhamma arises in the Noble Disciple, along with the arising of Vision, the three fetters are dispelled: the view of a substantially independent personal self; skeptical doubt; and the old belief that rites, ceremonies, and rituals could somehow help one to reach the culmination of the Holy Life.

Progressing further, as the Noble Disciple perseveres in his training, he then moves beyond the fetters of covetousness and hatred.

Thus, while being secluded from sensual pleasures and protected from any negative or unwholesome states, he enters upon and abides in the first *jhāna*, which includes joy and pleasure born of seclusion, while still being accompanied by thinking and planning.

And, if it so happens that that Noble Disciple dies on that occasion, then he will have no fetters to bind him to another rebirth into this world.

93. ***Parissa Sutta*** *(Gatherings)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three types of gatherings. What three?

The foremost gathering; the divided gathering; and the harmonious gathering.

And what, Bhikkhus, is the foremost gathering?

Here, Bhikkhus, in this type of gathering, the elder Bhikkhus do not live in luxury, as they are not given to being careless nor falling behind in their spiritual practice. They focus their attention on seclusion as they put forth the effort to attain that which has not yet been attained, and to realize that which has not yet been realized.

As a result, the next generation of Bhikkhus emulates and follows their example, as they too adopt the lifestyle of not living in luxury, nor being given to carelessness or falling behind in their spiritual practice. Thus, just like their predecessors, they will also focus their attention on seclusion, while putting forth the effort to attain that which has not yet been attained, and to realize that which has not yet been realized.

Now, Bhikkhus, this is what is called the ‘foremost gathering.’

And what, Bhikkhus, is the divided gathering?

Here, Bhikkhus, in this type of gathering, the Bhikkhus quarrel and argue, being inconsiderate towards each other, disputing amongst themselves, while stabbing each other with verbal daggers.

This, Bhikkhus, is called the divided gathering.

And what, Bhikkhus, is the harmonious gathering?

Here, Bhikkhus, in this type of gathering, the Bhikkhus live in harmony, blending like milk and water, united and without any disputes amongst each other, as they dwell while looking at each other with kindly and warm eyes, abiding with caring consideration towards one another.

This, Bhikkhus, is called the harmonious gathering.

Bhikkhus, when Bhikkhus truly live in harmony, blending like milk and water, united and without any disputes amongst each other, looking at each other with kindly and warm eyes, abiding with caring consideration towards one another, then, because of this precious and lovely atmosphere, they generate much merit.

It is truly at such times, that the Bhikkhus are said to be abiding in divine company, due to the Universal Altruistic Joy vibrating within, creating yet another lovely condition and atmosphere that leads to the Release of the Heart (*Cetovimutti*).

a. Thus, in being greatly pleased, joy arises in the mind, and because of it, the body naturally becomes relaxed and at ease, experiencing the softly spreading fullness of appeasement.

b. And as the body becomes more tranquil and relaxed, there spreads a soothing and lovely feeling throughout, wherein the heart becomes quietly pleased and happy.

c. The mind thus naturally drops into silent stillness, and then, without any difficulty, it slides into *samādhi*, becoming truly collected and unified in its stability.

For, just like when large raindrops fall on the higher altitudes of the mountain, the water from all that rainfall starts sloping down into the valleys, filling up the small streams and the bigger streams and in turn accumulating into small ponds, which come to flow and gather into the larger ponds and the rivulets, which then come together and form into rivers, and later those great rivers go flowing down and pouring all the way to the seas, filling up the great ocean;

In the same manner, Bhikkhus, whenever the Bhikkhus truly live in harmony, blending like milk and water, united and without any disputes amongst each other, looking at each other with kindly and warm eyes, abiding with caring consideration towards one another, then, because of this precious and lovely atmosphere, they generate much merit.

It is truly at such times, that the Bhikkhus are said to be abiding in divine company, due to the Universal Altruistic Joy vibrating within, creating yet another lovely condition and atmosphere that leads to the Release of the Heart (*Cetovimutti*).

a. Thus, in being greatly pleased, joy arises in the mind, and because of it, the body naturally becomes relaxed and at ease, experiencing the softly spreading fullness of appeasement.

b. And as the body becomes more tranquil and relaxed, there spreads a soothing and lovely feeling throughout, wherein the heart becomes quietly pleased and happy.

c. The mind thus naturally drops into silent stillness, and then, without any difficulty, it slides into *samādhi*, becoming truly collected and unified in its stability.

These, therefore, Bhikkhus, are the three types of gatherings.

94. ***Paṭhama Ājānīya Sutta*** *(The Thoroughbred – Part 1)*

Bhikkhus, endowed with three qualities, the king's thoroughbred stallion becomes worthy of him, while also being the king's prized possession, a genuine sign of his kingship.

What are these three qualities?

Here, Bhikkhus, the king's thoroughbred stallion is endowed with beauty, power, and speed.

Endowed with these three qualities, the king's thoroughbred stallion thus becomes worthy of him, while also being the king's prized possession, a genuine sign of his kingship.

In the same manner, Bhikkhus, endowed with three qualities, the Bhikkhu becomes worthy of gifts, worthy of hospitality, worthy of offerings, and worthy of reverential salutation with clasped hands in front of one's heart, truly being the highest and unsurpassed field of merits throughout existence.

And what are these three qualities?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu is endowed with beauty, power, and speed.

And how, Bhikkhus, is the Bhikkhu endowed with 'beauty'?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu lives and behaves virtuously while observing the Pātimokkha's rules, practicing right conduct in all of his behavior. He observes the training rules, while being scrupulous, seeing fear and disgust in the slightest of faults. Thus, by undergoing such training, the Bhikkhu becomes endowed with beauty.

And how, Bhikkhus, does the Bhikkhu become powerful?

Here, Bhikkhus, with applied effort, the Bhikkhu is vigorously dedicated to his training, as he dispels any unwholesome and damaging (*akusala*) traits in himself, while developing wholesome and beneficial (*kusala*) ones instead, maintaining firm resolve by exerting himself, sustaining his heedfulness as he develops wholesome characteristics, without ever becoming deterred from the single and primary aim of the Holy Life, for which he has gone forth. It is therefore in this manner, that the Bhikkhu becomes powerful.

And how, Bhikkhus, does the Bhikkhu become endowed with speed?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu knows and sees directly, how suffering comes to be. He knows and sees directly, how suffering is conditioned and thus the manner in which its origination unfolds and comes to be. He also knows and sees directly, how the very cessation of suffering comes to be. Furthermore, he knows and sees directly, how the Path of Practice itself puts an end to grief and sorrow, thereby bringing suffering to its cessation, as it too, takes place and unfolds. In this manner, the Bhikkhu becomes endowed with speed.

Therefore, it is in this manner, Bhikkhus, that being thus endowed with these three qualities, the Bhikkhu becomes worthy of gifts, worthy of hospitality, worthy of offerings, and worthy of reverential salutation with clasped hands in front of one's heart, truly being the highest and unsurpassed field of merits throughout existence.

95. ***Dutiya Ājānīya Sutta*** *(The Thoroughbred – Part 2)*

Bhikkhus, endowed with three qualities, the king's thoroughbred stallion becomes worthy of him, while also being the king's prized possession, a genuine sign of his kingship.

Now, what are these three qualities?

Here, Bhikkhus, the king's thoroughbred stallion is endowed with beauty, power and speed.

It is because of these three qualities, that the king's thoroughbred stallion becomes worthy of him, while also being the king's prized possession, a genuine sign of his kingship.

In the same manner, Bhikkhus, endowed with three qualities, the Bhikkhu becomes worthy of gifts, worthy of hospitality, worthy of offerings, and worthy of reverential salutation with clasped hands in front of one's heart, truly being the highest and unsurpassed field of merits throughout existence.

And what are these three qualities?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu is endowed with beauty, power, and speed.

And how, Bhikkhus, is the Bhikkhu endowed with beauty?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu lives and behaves virtuously while observing the Pātimokkha's rules, practicing right conduct in all of his behavior. He observes the training rules, while being scrupulous, seeing fear and disgust in the slightest of faults. Thus, by undergoing such training, the Bhikkhu becomes endowed with beauty.

And how, Bhikkhus, does the Bhikkhu become powerful?

Here, Bhikkhus, with applied effort, the Bhikkhu is vigorously dedicated to his training, as he dispels any unwholesome and damaging (*akusala*) traits in himself, while developing wholesome and beneficial (*kusala*) ones instead, maintaining firm resolve by exerting himself, sustaining his heedfulness as he develops wholesome characteristics, without ever becoming deterred from the single and primary aim of the Holy Life, for which he has gone forth. It is therefore in this manner, that the Bhikkhu becomes powerful.

And how, Bhikkhus, does the Bhikkhu become endowed with speed?

Here, Bhikkhus, having destroyed the five lower fetters that bind one to the sensual world, the Bhikkhu transforms himself, whereby after death, he becomes one who is destined to be spontaneously reborn into the Pure Abodes, never to return from there, for he is to realize Full Awaking within that realm. It is therefore in this manner, that the Bhikkhu becomes endowed with speed.

Bhikkhus, being thus endowed with these three qualities, the Bhikkhu becomes worthy of gifts, worthy of hospitality, worthy of offerings, and worthy of reverential salutation with clasped hands in front of one's heart, truly being the highest and unsurpassed field of merits throughout existence.

*96. **Tatiya Ājānīya Sutta** (The Thoroughbred – Part 3)*

Bhikkhus, endowed with three qualities, the king's thoroughbred stallion becomes worthy of him, while also being the king's prized possession, a genuine sign of his kingship.

Now, what are these three qualities?

Here, Bhikkhus, the king's thoroughbred stallion is endowed with beauty, power, and speed.

Being thus endowed with these three qualities, the king's thoroughbred stallion becomes worthy of him, while also being the king's prized possession, a genuine sign of his kingship.

In the same manner, Bhikkhus, endowed with three qualities, the Bhikkhu becomes worthy of gifts, worthy of hospitality, worthy of offerings, and worthy of reverential salutation with clasped

hands in front of one's heart, truly being the highest and unsurpassed field of merits throughout existence.

Now, Bhikkhus, what are these three qualities?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu is endowed with beauty, power, and speed.

And how, Bhikkhus, is the Bhikkhu endowed with beauty?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu lives and behaves virtuously while observing the Pātimokkha's rules, practicing right conduct in all of his behavior. He observes the training rules, while being scrupulous, seeing fear and disgust in the slightest of faults. Thus, by undergoing such training, the Bhikkhu becomes endowed with beauty.

And how, Bhikkhus, does the Bhikkhu become powerful?

Here, Bhikkhus, with applied effort, the Bhikkhu is vigorously dedicated to his training, as he dispels any unwholesome and damaging (*akusala*) traits in himself, while developing wholesome and beneficial (*kusala*) ones instead, maintaining firm resolve by exerting himself, sustaining his heedfulness as he develops wholesome characteristics, without ever becoming deterred from the single and primary aim of the Holy Life, for which he has gone forth. It is therefore in this manner, that the Bhikkhu becomes powerful.

And how, Bhikkhus, does the Bhikkhu become endowed with speed?

Here, Bhikkhus, with the destruction of the contaminants (*āsavā*), in this very birth, the Bhikkhu realizes for himself and through his own direct knowledge, the taintless Full Release of the Heart, as he enters upon and remains in that Liberated state of Mind through Wisdom. It is in this manner, that the Bhikkhu becomes endowed with speed.

Bhikkhus, being thus endowed with these three qualities, the Bhikkhu becomes worthy of gifts, worthy of hospitality, worthy of offerings, and worthy of reverential salutation with clasped hands in front of one's heart, truly being the highest and unsurpassed field of merits throughout existence.

97. ***Potthaka Sutta*** *(A Rough Burlap Cloth)*

Bhikkhus, even though it may be new, a piece of rough burlap cloth still happens to be very coarse and ugly, uncomfortable to the touch, and therefore of little value. The same is the case when that rough burlap cloth is worn, as it continues to be ugly and coarse, uncomfortable to the touch and of little value. And when that rough burlap cloth gets old, it still remains ugly and coarse, uncomfortable to the touch and still of little value.
Therefore, it is no surprise, that a rough burlap cloth is used to clean out dirty pots, or that it even gets discarded and thrown into a heap of rubbish.

a. Bhikkhus, in the same manner, if a novice Bhikkhu is non-virtuous in his behavior, who lives an immoral life and entertains evil thoughts, I call such a person "ugly and no different than a rough burlap cloth," matching it in all its negative attributes.

The reason for this is, because those who attend to such a Bhikkhu, who associate with him, and follow his example, will end up being harmed and fall into much suffering, for a very long time.

For, he will be uncomfortable to be around, and therefore I declare, that such a person is no different than a rough burlap cloth. And when the laity offers him robes, alms food, dwellings, and medicinal requisites, such acts will *not* bear much benefit at all, and thus will be of little value or benefit to them, similar to the rough burlap cloth that is of little or no value. It is for these reasons, that I call such a person "ugly and no different than a rough burlap cloth."

b. Furthermore, Bhikkhus, if a Bhikkhu of middle standing is non-virtuous in his behavior, who lives an immoral life and entertains evil thoughts, I call such a person "ugly and no different than a rough burlap cloth," matching it in all its negative attributes.

The reason for this is, because those who attend to such a Bhikkhu, who associate with him, and follow his example, will end up being harmed and fall into much suffering, for a very long time.

For, he will be uncomfortable to be around, and therefore I declare, that such a person is no different than a rough burlap cloth. And when the laity offers him robes, alms food, dwellings, and medicinal requisites, such acts will *not* bear much benefit at all, and thus will be of little value or benefit to them, similar to the rough burlap cloth that is of little or no value. It is for these reasons, that I call such a person "ugly and no different than a rough burlap cloth."

c. Further, Bhikkhus, if a senior Bhikkhu is non-virtuous in his behavior, who lives an immoral life and entertains evil thoughts, I call such a person "ugly and no different than a rough burlap cloth," matching it in all its negative attributes.

The reason for this is, because those who attend to such a Bhikkhu, who associate with him, and follow his example, will end up being harmed and fall into much suffering, for a very long time.

For, he will be uncomfortable to be around, and therefore I declare, that such a person is no different than a rough burlap cloth. And when the laity offers him robes, alms food, dwellings, and medicinal requisites, such acts will *not* bear much benefit at all, and thus will be of little value or benefit to them, similar to the rough burlap cloth that is of little or no value. It is for these reasons, that I call such a person "ugly and no different than a rough burlap cloth."

And if such an elder or senior Bhikkhu speaks in the midst of the Saṅgha of Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhus would then tell him:

"What right do you have, a foolish and incompetent man, to think that you can actually speak?

How do you consider yourself somehow 'entitled' to even speak here?"

At this, he becomes angry and hurls insulting and harsh words at them. In response to such a wrongful act, the Saṅgha would then expel him, much like the ugly and rough burlap cloth, that is thrown away and discarded as rubbish.

98. ***Kāsikam Vattha Sutta*** *(A Fine Varanasi (Kāsi) Fabric)*

Bhikkhus, even while being new, a fine Kāsi fabric is beautiful, soft to the touch, and of great value. So too, when a fine Kāsi fabric is worn, it continues to be beautiful, soft and smooth to the touch, still being of great value. And when a fine Kāsi fabric gets old, it remains beautiful, being soft and smooth to the touch, and still of great value.

So, it is no surprise, that a fine Kāsi fabric is used to encase rare gems, often used to deck the interior of a fragrant and precious box.

a. Bhikkhus, in just the same manner, if a novice Bhikkhu is virtuous in his behavior, who lives a virtuous life and does not entertain evil thoughts, I call such a Bhikkhu "beautiful and quite similar to a fine Kāsi fabric" in his attributes.

The reason for this, is because those who attend to such a Bhikkhu, who associate with him, and follow his example, will surely be rewarded with many benefits and thus experience much happiness and wellbeing, for a very long time.

For, such a Bhikkhu will certainly be a genuine comfort to be around, and therefore I declare, that such a person is quite similar to a fine Kāsi fabric. And when the laity offers him robes, alms food, dwellings, and medicinal requisites, such acts will bear much benefit, as well as generate many merits, and be of great value, similar to the fine Kāsi fabric that is of great value. It is for these reasons, that I call such a Bhikkhu "beautiful and quite similar to a fine Kāsi fabric" in his attributes.

b. Also, Bhikkhus, in the same manner, if a Bhikkhu of middle standing is virtuous in his behavior, who lives a virtuous life and does not entertain evil thoughts, I call such a Bhikkhu "beautiful and quite similar to a fine Kāsi fabric" in his attributes.

The reason for this, is because those who attend to such a Bhikkhu, who associate with him, and follow his example, will surely be rewarded with many benefits and thus experience much happiness and wellbeing, for a very long time.

For, such a Bhikkhu will certainly be a genuine comfort to be around, and therefore I declare, that such a person is quite similar to a fine Kāsi fabric. And when the laity offers him robes, alms food, dwellings, and medicinal requisites, such acts will bear much benefit, as well as generate

many merits, and be of great value, similar to the fine Kāsi fabric that is of great value. It is for these reasons, that I call such a Bhikkhu "beautiful and quite similar to a fine Kāsi fabric" in his attributes.

c. Furthermore, Bhikkhus, in the same manner, if a senior or elder Bhikkhu is virtuous in his behavior, who lives a virtuous life and does not entertain evil thoughts, I call such a Bhikkhu "beautiful and quite similar to a fine Kāsi fabric" in his attributes.

The reason for this, is because those who attend to such a Bhikkhu, who associate with him, and follow his example, will surely be rewarded with many benefits and thus experience much happiness and wellbeing, for a very long time.

For, such a Bhikkhu will certainly be a genuine comfort to be around, and therefore I declare, that such a person is quite similar to a fine Kāsi fabric. And when the laity offers him robes, alms food, dwellings, and medicinal requisites, such acts will bear much benefit, as well as generate many merits, and be of great value, similar to the fine Kāsi fabric that is of great value. It is for these reasons, that I call such a Bhikkhu "beautiful and quite similar to a fine Kāsi fabric" in his attributes.

If such a senior or elder Bhikkhu speaks in the midst of the Saṅgha of Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhus would say to everyone else present:

"Venerable sirs, please let us all be quiet now. An elder Bhikkhu is about to speak on The Dhamma and The Discipline. Let us all pay attention and listen!"

And why is that?

It is because words that are to be spoken by such a Bhikkhu are indeed worthy of being preserved, just as fine Kāsi fabric is used to encase rare gems, often used to deck the interior of a fragrant and precious box.

It is in this manner, Bhikkhus, that you must train yourselves, by saying:

"Throughout our Training, we shall strive to be like the fine Kāsi fabric, and not like the ugly and rough burlap cloth!"

Therefore, it is in this way that you all must train yourselves.

99. ***Loṇakapalla Sutta*** *(A Salt Crystal)*

"Bhikkhus, when you hear the following statement being made:

'In whatever way a person commits an action, in accordance to that, he will experience its results.'

"You must consider, Bhikkhus, that if this was truly the case, then there would not be any possibility to live the Holy Life, since there is no apparent method to end all suffering.

"However, Bhikkhus, if on the other hand, a person says:

'With whatever intentions a man commits an action, in accordance to that, he will experience its results.'

"Then, Bhikkhus, it becomes possible to live the Holy Life, for it would mean that there surely is a clear method, a well-defined Path to end all suffering.

"Bhikkhus, take for example, a certain individual who commits a trifling wrong or evil action, which would then pull him to a rebirth in hell.

"Meanwhile, Bhikkhus, another person committing a trifling wrong or evil action of the same nature and magnitude, however, would hardly experience any negative consequences or terrible effects as its result, within this very life, let alone face any significant consequences in future lives.

"Now, what kind of a person, Bhikkhus, on committing a trifling wrong or evil action, would end up being pulled into hell, as a consequence of it?

"This, Bhikkhus, would be someone who does not live with virtue, being thus non-virtuous in his behavior, uncontrolled and unrestrained in his bodily actions, in his mental activities, and therefore one who lacks wisdom. Thus, being unrestrained and empty of any true consideration either for oneself or others, remaining mean-hearted and without any virtue in his heart, he is one who lacks integrity, hence constantly abides in suffering already, even while still alive in this body.

"It is such a person, Bhikkhus, who on committing a trifling evil or wrong action, would get pulled into a rebirth in hell, as a consequence.

"And what kind of a person, Bhikkhus, after committing a trifling evil or wrong action of the same nature and magnitude, however, would hardly experience any negative consequences or terrible effects as its result within this very life, let alone face any significant consequences in future lives?

"This, Bhikkhus, would be someone who lives with virtuous behavior, who is controlled in his bodily actions, in his mental activities, and possesses wisdom. Being thus restrained, considerate towards oneself and others, and with an immeasurable character, he is one who constantly abides in happiness.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, by committing a trifling evil or wrong action of the same nature, such a person would hardly experience any negative effects in this very life, let alone face any significant consequences because of it, in the future.

“Bhikkhus, suppose a man would put a large piece of salt crystal into a small cup of water. Now, would that cup of water become saturated with the salt crystal and its saltiness, rendering it undrinkable?

“Yes, Bhante,” those Bhikkhus replied.

“And what is the reason?”

“It is because, Bhante, the little water that is in the cup would be completely saturated with the salt crystal that dissolved in it.”

“And what if, Bhikkhus, a man was to put that same piece of salt crystal into the River Ganges. Would the water in the River Ganges be similarly saturated with the salt crystal, rendering it undrinkable?”

“No, Bhante!”

“And why is that the case?”

“It is because, Bhante, due to its size and the great mass of water it contains, the River Ganges would not be saturated at all with that salt crystal, and therefore not be rendered undrinkable.”

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, a certain individual who commits a trifling wrong or evil action, would be pulled to a rebirth in hell.

“Meanwhile, Bhikkhus, another person committing a trifling wrong or evil action of the same nature and magnitude, however, would hardly experience any negative consequences or terrible effects as its result within this very life, let alone face any significant consequences in future lives.

“Here Bhikkhus, what kind of a person, on committing a trifling wrong or evil action, would end up being pulled into hell, as a consequence of it?

“This, Bhikkhus, would be someone who does not live with virtue, being non-virtuous in his behavior, uncontrolled and unrestrained in his bodily actions, in his mental activities, and therefore one who lacks wisdom. Thus, being unrestrained and empty of any true consideration either for oneself or others, remaining mean-hearted and without any virtue in his heart, he is one who lacks integrity, hence constantly abides in suffering already, even while still alive in this body.

“It is such a person, Bhikkhus, who on committing a trifling evil or wrong action, would get pulled into a rebirth in hell, as a consequence.

“And what kind of a person, Bhikkhus, after committing a trifling evil or wrong action of the same nature and magnitude, however, would hardly experience any negative consequences or terrible effects as its result within this very life, let alone face any significant consequences in future lives?

“This, Bhikkhus, would be someone who lives with virtuous behavior, who is controlled in his bodily actions, in his mental activities, and possesses wisdom. Being thus restrained, considerate towards oneself and others, and with an immeasurable character, he is one who constantly abides in happiness.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, by committing a trifling evil or wrong action of the same nature, such a person would hardly experience any negative effects in this very life, let alone face any significant consequences because of it, in the future.

“Suppose, Bhikkhus that a certain person would go to jail for stealing half a coin, a single coin, or even a hundred coins. Meanwhile, Bhikkhus, someone else would not go to jail for stealing half a coin, a coin, or even a hundred coins.

“And what kind of a person, Bhikkhus, would go to jail for stealing half a coin, a coin, or a hundred coins?

“Here, Bhikkhus, a certain person is poor, clumsy, unimaginative, and unable to do anything with little resources: this kind of person would go to jail for stealing half a coin, a coin, or a hundred coins.

“And what kind of a person, Bhikkhus, would not go to jail for stealing half a coin, a coin, or even a hundred coins?

“Here, Bhikkhus, a certain person is wealthy, smart, and very resourceful: this kind of a person would not go to jail for stealing half a coin, a coin, or even a hundred coins.

“In the same manner, Bhikkhus, a certain individual who commits a trifling wrong or evil action, would then be pulled to a rebirth into hell.

“Meanwhile, Bhikkhus, another person committing a trifling wrong or evil action of the same nature and magnitude, however, would hardly experience any negative consequences or terrible effects as its result within this very life, let alone face any significant consequences in future lives.

“Here, Bhikkhus, what kind of a person, on committing a trifling wrong or evil action, would end up being pulled into hell, as a consequence of it?

“This, Bhikkhus, would be someone who does not live with virtue, being non-virtuous in his behavior, uncontrolled and unrestrained in his bodily actions, in his mental activities, and therefore one who lacks wisdom. Thus, being unrestrained and empty of any true consideration either for oneself or others, remaining mean-hearted and without any virtue in his heart, he is one who lacks integrity, hence constantly abides in suffering already, even while still alive in this body.

“It is such a person then, Bhikkhus, who on committing a trifling evil or wrong action, would get pulled into a rebirth in hell, as a consequence.

“And what kind of a person, Bhikkhus, after committing a trifling evil or wrong action of the same nature and magnitude, however, would hardly experience any negative consequences or terrible effects as its result within this very life, let alone face any significant consequences in future lives?

“This again, Bhikkhus, would be someone who lives with virtuous behavior, who is controlled in his bodily actions, in his mental activities, and possesses wisdom. Being thus restrained, considerate towards oneself and others, and with an immeasurable character, he is one who constantly abides in happiness.

“It is for this reason, Bhikkhus, that by committing a trifling evil action of the same nature, such a person would hardly experience any negative effects in this very life, let alone face any significant consequences because of it, in the future.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, when you hear the following statement being made:

‘In whatever way a person commits an action, in accordance to that, he will experience its results.’

“You must consider, Bhikkhus, that if this was truly the case, then there would not be any possibility to live the Holy Life, since there is no apparent method to end all suffering.

“However, Bhikkhus, if on the other hand, a person says:

‘With whatever intentions a man commits an action, in accordance to that, he will experience its results.’

“Then, Bhikkhus, it becomes possible to live the Holy Life, for it would mean that there surely is a clear method, a well-defined Path to end all suffering.

100. ***Paṁsudhovaka Sutta*** *(The Refining of Gold)*

Bhikkhus, in order to purify gold from rough impurities such as dirt, sand, pebbles, and other contaminating metal particles and stones, a master gold assayer, goldsmith, or his skilled apprentice first pours the gold dust and gold pellets on a trough, wherein the impurities are carefully washed, cleaned and shaken to be properly sifted, while he uses his fingers to pick and remove visibly large pieces of dirt and other minute impurities.

Then, when the bigger particles are removed, there still remain middle-sized impurities such as fine grit, along with coarse sand grains. Then, the master gold assayer, goldsmith, or his skilled apprentice again carefully washes the gold dust and gold pellets, by cleaning and shaking it on the trough, sifting through it until any remaining middle-sized defilements are removed.
Later, with the removal of the middle-sized impurities, with some fine dust particles and black sand grains still remaining, the master gold assayer, goldsmith, or his skilled apprentice carefully and repeatedly washes, cleaning and shaking it yet again, until the small-sized defilements are also sifted and removed, and only the gold pellets and gold dust are left.

Next, taking the raw gold dust and gold pellets, the master gold assayer, goldsmith, or his skilled apprentice, puts the raw gold into a smelting pot, and heats it under intense heat until the gold turns into liquid, meanwhile he carefully attends to it by blowing on it and periodically shaking it gently in the pot.

However, even then the gold does not yet become free from the dross and dirt, which must still be removed. For this reason, the gold in that impure state would still not possess its natural luster, nor is malleable, but instead, it remains brittle and not ready to be made into a piece of jewelry at the hands of the master goldsmith or his skilled apprentice.

However, Bhikkhus, there comes a time when as the gold assayer, goldsmith, or his skilled apprentice heats the liquid gold by continuously blowing on it, by increasing the heat and further purifying it, the liquid gold finally develops a brilliant quality to it, as all the dirt and dross are fully removed. Then, once cooled, the gold becomes lustrous and malleable, flexible and pliant, no longer brittle, thus transformed and fit to be worked with.

And now, whatever the goldsmith desires to fashion out of it, whether a girdle, earrings, or a chain for the neck, it appropriately serves that purpose.

In the same manner, Bhikkhus, as the Bhikkhu develops the mind to a higher degree, he will encounter rough and gross defilements, such as misconduct engaged by body, speech, or mind. Here, the Bhikkhu who is genuinely dedicated to the Path of Practice, will eagerly work to dispel those impurities, by overcoming, abandoning, uprooting and destroying them all.

Now, once the Bhikkhu has done this, there still remain subtle defilements in the mind as he continues to develop the mind to a higher degree. Here, while facing the impurities of sensual thoughts, hateful thoughts, those of ill-will and hurtful thoughts, such a Bhikkhu who is genuinely dedicated to the Path of Practice will eagerly work to dispel and get rid of those impurities, by overcoming, abandoning, uprooting and destroying them all.

And once the Bhikkhu has done this, there still remain in him even more subtle defilements, as he continues to develop the mind to an even higher degree.

Here, while experiencing subtle thoughts about loved ones, about one's race or nationality, or reputation or status, seeing all these as mere impurities due to one's own attachment to them, such a Bhikkhu who is genuinely dedicated to the Path of Practice will eagerly work to dispel and get rid of these, by overcoming, abandoning, uprooting and destroying them all.

Once this is done, what are left in him are then simply thoughts about The Dhamma. Thus, he ponders how he does not attain a collected state of mind that is peaceful, but instead experiences a mind that is unsteady and un-exalted, lacking tranquility and focus. But despite this, he perseveres even by force, if and when necessary, as he keeps reigning in the mind trying to suppress those subtle defilements.

In time, Bhikkhus, he experiences a collected state of mind (*samādhi*) that is peaceful, steady and exalted, while enjoying tranquility and thus becoming focused, yet without trying to force or reign in the mind to try and suppress anything. Then, to whatever lofty state the mind inclines, the Bhikkhu is able to realize and attain it with wisdom, with his direct knowledge and understanding.

At this point, if the Bhikkhu wishes:

'May I possess the various types of psychic powers, such as while being one, may I become many; by being many, may I become one again; may I appear and disappear as I please; may I move unobstructed through walls, embankments and rocks, as though passing through space; may I slip in and out of the earth beneath me as if submerging into water; may I walk on water without disturbing its surface as though its solid ground; may I sit comfortably and fly, while traveling through the skies like a bird; may I touch the Moon and the Sun with my hand; and may I wield these powers, while in this body, as far as the Brahma world.'

Then, he is able to experience and witness all these for himself, due to the mind's mastery over that specific mental sphere.

If he so desires:

'May I, with the Divine ear that is pure and goes beyond the capacity of mere human abilities, hear the sounds of both Divine and human origin, those that are far distant as well as near.'

Then, he is able to experience and witness all these for himself, due to the mind's mastery over that specific mental sphere.

And if he so desires:

'May I have the ability to penetratingly know the mental states of other beings, as well as of people; may I know and recognize a mind with lust, as a mind with lust, and a mind without lust,

as a mind with without lust; may I know and recognize a mind with hatred, as a mind with hatred, and a mind without hatred, as a mind without hatred; may I know and recognize a mind with delusion, as a mind with delusion, and a mind without delusion, as a mind without delusion; may I know and recognize a torpid mind, as a torpid mind, and a scattered mind, as a scattered mind; may I know and recognize an expansive mind, as expansive, and a narrow-range mind, as narrow-ranged; may I know and recognize a mediocre mind as mediocre, and an excellent mind, as excellent; may I know and recognize a mind that is collected into stability, as collected into stability, and an uncollected mind as uncollected; may I know and recognize a released mind as a released mind, and an unreleased mind as unreleased.'

Thus, he is able to experience and witness all of these for himself, due to the mind's mastery over that specific mental sphere.

And if he so desires:

'May I recall my innumerable previous births, such as one birth, two births, three, four, five, ten, twenty, thirty, forty, fifty births, one hundred, one thousand, one hundred thousand births, innumerable eons of world expansions, innumerable eons of world contractions, and innumerable eons of world expansions and contractions. Thus, he recalls: "Here, I was of such name, lineage, clan, with such a disposition, with such food as my nourishment, experiencing such pleasant and unpleasant feelings and with such a life span. Dying from that state, I was born there, of such name, lineage, clan, with such a disposition, with such food as my nourishment, experiencing such pleasant and unpleasant feelings and with such a life span. Dying from that state there, I was born here.'

Thus, he then begins recollecting his innumerable previous births with their specific characteristics and details, whereby he is able to experience and witness all these for himself, with direct knowledge and understanding, due to the mind's mastery over that specific mental sphere.

And if he so desires:

'May I, with the Divine eye that is pure and goes beyond the capacity of mere human abilities, see beings dying and being reborn, whether into inferior or superior births, beautiful or ugly, in good or evil states. May I know and recognize how they fare along on their respective states, according to their actions.'

Thus, he knows and recognizes:

'These beings, due to their bodily, verbal, and mental misconduct, on account of abusing the noble ones, by adhering to their wrong views, and acting on those wrong views, after death, are reborn into terrible states of misery, in the lower worlds, in hell; whereas these good beings, due to their bodily, verbal, and mental good conduct, on account of not abusing and instead honoring the noble ones, by adhering to right view, and acting on right view, after death, are reborn into sublime states of happiness, in the heavenly realms.'

In this manner, with the Divine eye that is pure and goes beyond the capacity of mere human abilities, he sees beings dying and being reborn, whether into inferior or superior births, beautiful or ugly, in good or evil states, knowing and recognizing how they all fare along on their respective states, according to their actions.

Thus, he is able to experience and witness all these for himself, due to the mind's mastery over that specific mental sphere.

And Bhikkhus, if he so desires:

'May I realize for myself, here and now, the taintless liberation of the mind through wisdom, with the release of the mind from the contaminants (āsavā). Thus, by having entered into that state, may I abide in that state.'

Thus, he is able to experience and witness all this for himself, due to the mind's mastery over that specific mental sphere.

101. ***Nimitta Sutta*** *(Hallmark)*

Bhikkhus, while developing the Higher Mind, a Bhikkhu, from time to time, should attend to these three hallmarks. What three?

From time to time, and while attending carefully, the Bhikkhu should check to see whether the mind is truly collected and unshaken in its stability, thus bearing the hallmark of *samādhi*.

The Bhikkhu should, from time to time, check to see whether the mind is light and uplifted, while supporting and infusing it with persevering energy, thus bearing the hallmark of maintaining the right and proper exertion.

And from time to time, through his continuous application of careful attention, the Bhikkhu should check to see if the mind is indeed in equanimity, thus bearing the hallmark of *upekkhā*.

Now, Bhikkhus, while developing the Higher Mind, if the Bhikkhu tries to exclusively place his focus on keeping the mind collected, to thereby maintain it unshaken in its stability, then there is the possibility, that the mind may become idle and thus lean toward laziness.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, while developing the Higher Mind, if the Bhikkhu tries to exclusively place his focus on maintaining an uplifted mind while infusing and supporting it with persevering energy, then there is the possibility, that the mind may become restless and thus lean toward excited agitation.

And, Bhikkhus, while developing the Higher Mind, if the Bhikkhu tries to exclusively place his focus on maintaining the mind in a state of equanimity, then there is the possibility, that the mind will not become collected nor properly stable enough, in order to destroy the contaminants.

However, Bhikkhus, when developing the Higher Mind, if the Bhikkhu, from time to time, and while attending carefully, checks to see whether the mind is truly collected and unshaken in its stability; if from time to time, he checks to see whether the mind is light and uplifted while supporting and infusing it with persevering energy; and if, from time to time, and through his continuous application of careful attention, the Bhikkhu checks to see if the mind is indeed in equanimity, then the mind truly becomes malleable, flexible, gentle, workable, bright, and not prone to agitation, as it organically and properly becomes collected in *samādhi*, which at this stage brings about the very destruction of the contaminants (*āsavas*).

This is similar, Bhikkhus, to the master goldsmith or his skilled apprentice who builds a furnace and fires up its mouth with the bellows, and by taking the gold with a pair of pincers, he places it in a smelting pot inside the crucible, while from time to time, blowing air on it and sprinkling it with water, as he carefully looks on, from time to time.

This because, if the master goldsmith or his skilled apprentice were to exclusively blow air on the gold within the crucible, then it is possible for it to simply spill out or burn up. And if he were to exclusively sprinkle water on it, then it is possible for it to cool down or cause the crucible to crack. If he were to exclusively keep looking at it without mixing or stirring it and doing what is necessary at specific intervals in the smelting process, then it is possible for the gold to not reach the right consistency, hence to become brittle and unworkable later, due to its rigidity.

On the other hand, if the master goldsmith or his skilled apprentice, from time to time, would go back and forth by blowing air on the gold in the furnace, sprinkling water on it as needed, and only from time to time, while carefully looking on, then the gold will become malleable, flexible, and pliant, no longer brittle, and fit to be worked with. And whatever the master goldsmith desires to fashion out of it, whether a girdle, earrings, or a chain for the neck, it would appropriately serve that purpose.

In just the same manner, Bhikkhus, while developing the Higher Mind, a Bhikkhu, from time to time, should attend to three hallmarks.

From time to time, and while attending carefully, the Bhikkhu should check to see whether the mind is truly collected and unshaken in its stability, thus bearing the hallmark of *samādhi*.

The Bhikkhu should, from time to time, check to see whether the mind is light and uplifted, while supporting and infusing it with persevering energy, thus bearing the hallmark of maintaining the right and proper exertion.

And from time to time, through his continuous application of careful attention, the Bhikkhu should check to see if the mind is indeed in equanimity, thus bearing the hallmark of *upekkhā*.

Now, Bhikkhus, while developing the Higher Mind, if the Bhikkhu tries to exclusively place his focus on keeping the mind collected, to thereby maintain it unshaken in its stability, then there is the possibility, that the mind may become idle and thus lean toward laziness.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, while developing the Higher Mind, if the Bhikkhu tries to exclusively place his focus on maintaining an uplifted mind while infusing and supporting it with persevering energy, then there is the possibility, that the mind may become restless and thus lean toward excited agitation.

And, Bhikkhus, while developing the Higher Mind, if the Bhikkhu tries to exclusively place his focus on maintaining the mind in a state of equanimity, then there is the possibility, that the mind will not become collected nor properly stable enough, in order to destroy the contaminants.

However, Bhikkhus, when developing the Higher Mind, if the Bhikkhu, from time to time, and while attending carefully, checks to see whether the mind is truly collected and unshaken in its stability; if from time to time, he checks to see whether the mind is light and uplifted while supporting and infusing it with persevering energy; and if, from time to time, and through his continuous application of careful attention, the Bhikkhu checks to see if the mind is indeed in equanimity, then the mind truly becomes malleable, flexible, gentle, workable, bright, and not prone to agitation, as it organically and properly becomes collected in *samādhi*, which at this stage brings about the very destruction of the contaminants (*āsavas*).

Thus, he directs the heart while enabling it to develop the capacity to fully understand and directly experience the inherent quality of things, and all that he desires to realize and know firsthand, whether here, there, or everywhere. That is because, at that point, the Bhikkhu would have already developed mastery over each of those specific mental spheres.

It is for this reason, Bhikkhus, that if the Bhikkhu wishes:

'May I possess the various types of psychic powers, such as while being one, may I become many; by being many, may I become one again; may I appear and disappear as I please; may I move unobstructed through walls, embankments and rocks, as though passing through space; may I slip in and out of the earth beneath me as if submerging into water; may I walk on water without disturbing its surface as though its solid ground; may I sit comfortably and fly, while traveling through the skies like a bird; may I touch the Moon and the Sun with my hand; and may I wield these powers, while in this body, as far as the Brahma world.'

Then, he is able to experience and witness all these for himself, due to the mind's mastery over that specific mental sphere.

If he so desires:

'May I, with the Divine ear that is pure and goes beyond the capacity of mere human abilities, hear the sounds of both Divine and human origin, those that are far distant as well as near.'

Then, he is able to experience and witness all these for himself, due to the mind's mastery over that specific mental sphere.

And if he so desires:

'May I have the ability to penetratingly know the mental states of other beings, as well as of people; may I know and recognize a mind with lust, as a mind with lust, and a mind without lust, as a mind with without lust; may I know and recognize a mind with hatred, as a mind with hatred, and a mind without hatred, as a mind without hatred; may I know and recognize a mind with delusion, as a mind with delusion, and a mind without delusion, as a mind without delusion; may I know and recognize a torpid mind, as a torpid mind, and a scattered mind, as a scattered mind; may I know and recognize an expansive mind, as expansive, and a narrow-range mind, as narrow-ranged; may I know and recognize a mediocre mind as mediocre, and an excellent mind, as excellent; may I know and recognize a mind that is collected into stability, as collected into stability, and an uncollected mind as uncollected; may I know and recognize a released mind as a released mind, and an unreleased mind as unreleased.'

Thus, he is able to experience and witness all of these for himself, due to the mind's mastery over that specific mental sphere.

And if he so desires:

'May I recall my innumerable previous births, such as one birth, two births, three, four, five, ten, twenty, thirty, forty, fifty births, one hundred, one thousand, one hundred thousand births, innumerable eons of world expansions, innumerable eons of world contractions, and innumerable eons of world expansions and contractions. Thus, he recalls: "Here, I was of such name, lineage, clan, with such a disposition, with such food as my nourishment, experiencing such pleasant and unpleasant feelings and with such a life span. Dying from that state, I was born there, of such name, lineage, clan, with such a disposition, with such food as my nourishment, experiencing such pleasant and unpleasant feelings and with such a life span. Dying from that state there, I was born here.'

Thus, he then begins recollecting his innumerable previous births with their specific characteristics and details, whereby he is able to experience and witness all these for himself, with direct knowledge and understanding, due to the mind's mastery over that specific mental sphere.

And if he so desires:

'May I, with the Divine eye that is pure and goes beyond the capacity of mere human abilities, see beings dying and being reborn, whether into inferior or superior births, beautiful or ugly, in good or evil states. May I know and recognize how they fare along on their respective states, according to their actions.'

Thus, he knows and recognizes:

'These beings, due to their bodily, verbal, and mental misconduct, on account of abusing the noble ones, by adhering to their wrong views, and acting on those wrong views, after death, are reborn into terrible states of misery, in the lower worlds, in hell; whereas these good beings, due to their bodily, verbal, and mental good conduct, on account of not abusing and instead honoring the noble ones, by adhering to right view, and acting on right view, after death, are reborn into sublime states of happiness, in the heavenly realms.'

In this manner, with the Divine eye that is pure and goes beyond the capacity of mere human abilities, he sees beings dying and being reborn, whether into inferior or superior births, beautiful or ugly, in good or evil states, knowing and recognizing how they all fare along on their respective states, according to their actions.

Thus, he is able to experience and witness all these for himself, due to the mind's mastery over that specific mental sphere.

And Bhikkhus, if he so desires:

'May I realize for myself, here and now, the taintless liberation of the mind through wisdom, with the release of the mind from the contaminants (āsavā). Thus, by having entered into that state, may I abide in that state.'

Thus, he is able to experience and witness all this for himself, due to the mind's mastery over that specific mental sphere.



AN III

Suttas 102-111

Sambodhi Vagga

"The Section on Awakening"

102. ***Pubbeva Sambodha Sutta*** *(Before Awakening)*

Bhikkhus, before my Awakening, while I was still a bodhisattva, intent on attaining Full Awakening, it occurred to me:

'What is the quest for satisfaction in the world; what is the danger in it; and what could be the escape from it?'

Then, it occurred to me:

"The arising of pleasure and its enjoyment, as a result of something that is experienced in the world, is itself the seeking of satisfaction in this world. The fact that nothing lasts, and that there is impermanence, suffering, in the face of ever-present change in the world, that is the danger. The obliteration of that pursuit after something, along with the desire for more, and therefore, the complete giving up and abandonment of the passion and the lusting after things, is truly the escape from the world."

Bhikkhus, until I knew as it really is: the satisfaction as the satisfaction; the danger as the danger; and the escape as the escape, I did not announce to the world, together with its Devas, Māras, Brahmās, and the community of recluses and brahmins, My rightful Awakening into the Matchless and Unsurpassed Perfect Enlightenment.

It was only *after* My rightful, Matchless, Unsurpassed and Perfect Awakening, when I knew through direct knowledge, by seeing it as it truly is, the very seeking after satisfaction as satisfaction; the danger in its pursuit as the danger; and the escape from it as the escape, that I *did* declare to the world and this entire existence, together with its Devas, Māras, Brahmās, and the community of recluses and brahmins, the fact of My Matchless and Unsurpassed Perfect Enlightenment.

Then, the unmistakable Knowledge and Vision arose in Me, and I understood, without the shadow of a doubt:

'Unshakeable is my Liberation of Heart.
This is My last birth.
There will be no more rebirths for me anywhere, anymore.'

103. ***Paṭhama Assada Sutta*** *(Seeking Satisfaction – Part 1)*

Bhikkhus, I went in search of satisfaction in the world, whatever satisfaction that could be found in the world. Then, on having found and experienced it thoroughly and to its maximum limits, I saw with wisdom how far exactly, the satisfaction in the world really extends.

Bhikkhus, I went in search of the danger in the world, whatever danger that is to be found in the world. Then, on having found and experienced it thoroughly, I saw with wisdom how far exactly, the danger in the world really extends.

Bhikkhus, I went in search of the escape from the world, whatever escape that is to be found from the world. Then, on having found and experienced it thoroughly, I saw with wisdom how far exactly, the escape from the world really extends, and where it truly leads.

Then, it occurred to me:

"The arising of pleasure and its enjoyment, as a result of something that is experienced in the world, <u>is</u> itself the seeking of satisfaction in this world. The fact that nothing lasts, and that there is impermanence, suffering, in the face of ever-present change in the world, <u>that</u> is the danger. The obliteration of that pursuit after something, along with the desire for more, and therefore, the complete giving up and abandonment of the passion and the lusting after things, <u>is</u> truly the escape from the world."

Bhikkhus, until I knew as it really is: the satisfaction as the satisfaction; the danger as the danger; and the escape as the escape, I did not announce to the world, together with its Devas, Māras, Brahmās, and the community of recluses and brahmins, My rightful Awakening into the Matchless and Unsurpassed Perfect Enlightenment.

It was only *after* My rightful, Matchless, Unsurpassed and Perfect Awakening, when I knew through direct knowledge, by seeing it as it truly is, the very seeking after satisfaction as satisfaction; the danger in its pursuit as the danger; and the escape from it as the escape, that I *did* declare to the world and this entire existence, together with its Devas, Māras, Brahmās, and the community of recluses and brahmins, the fact of My Matchless and Unsurpassed Perfect Enlightenment.

Then, the unmistakable Knowledge and Vision arose in Me, and I understood, without the shadow of a doubt:

'Unshakeable is my Liberation of Heart.
This is My last birth.

There will be no more rebirths for me anywhere, anymore.'

104. ***Dutiya Assada Sutta*** *(Seeking Satisfaction – Part 2)*

Bhikkhus, if there was no pursuit after satisfaction in the world, sentient beings would not be attached to existence. But, so long as there is the pursuit after satisfaction, then sentient beings will be attached to existence.

Bhikkhus, if there was no danger in the world, sentient beings would not become disenchanted with the world. But, since there is a danger, sentient beings become disenchanted with existence.

Bhikkhus, if there was no escape from the world, sentient beings would not be able to escape from this world. But, since there is an escape, sentient beings are able to escape from the cycles of existence.

Bhikkhus, so long as the sentient being neither knows nor understands, as it really is, the satisfaction as the satisfaction, the danger as the danger, and the escape as the escape, then he will still remain unable to free himself from this cyclical existence, stuck along with all the Devas and other humans, its Māras, Brahmās and the community of recluses and brahmins.

Thus, such a person would not be able to unshackle and release himself from the fetter, thereby remaining unable to abide with a mind free from agitation and other obstacles.

However, Bhikkhus, when the sentient being *does*, in fact, come to know and understand directly, as it really is, the satisfaction as the satisfaction, the danger as the danger, and the escape as the escape, then he can certainly free himself from this existence, along with its Devas and humans, its Māras, Brahmās and the community of recluses and brahmins.

It is therefore such a person, indeed, who is able to unshackle and thus release himself from the fetter, while continuing to live the rest of his life with a mind that is unblemished and taintless, free from all agitation and obstacles of any kind.

105. ***Samaṇa Brahmana Sutta*** *(Recluses & Brahmins)*

Bhikkhus, those who are considered to be "recluses and brahmins," yet neither know nor understand, as it really is, the satisfaction as the satisfaction, the danger as the danger, and the escape as the escape, are *not* really individuals whom I would call recluses and brahmins, at all; hence, they are *not* to be considered as those who are truly living the Holy Life.

It is because these individuals will not come to the life of recluseship, or be able to somehow live the true religious life, in this very birth; hence they will remain unable to realize, for themselves

with direct knowledge, the true Goal of the Holy Life, nor come to abide in the genuine state of nobility.

However, Bhikkhus, those other recluses and brahmins who *do* know and understand, as it really is, the satisfaction as the satisfaction, the danger as the danger, and the escape as the escape, I consider to be true recluses and brahmins who are truly living the Holy Life; hence they can certainly be recognized as recluses and brahmins.

It is because these individuals can come to the life of recluseship, and are truly living the religious life, while still alive, in this very birth; hence they will come to realize, for themselves and with direct knowledge, the true Goal of the Holy Life, while abiding in true nobility.

106. ***Ruṇṇa Sutta*** *(Lamentation)*

Bhikkhus, in The Noble One's Discipline, to engage in singing is considered the same as tearful lamenting, while dancing is seen as pure insanity.

Bhikkhus, in The Noble One's Discipline, it is considered childish to laugh too much, where one keeps showing one's teeth.

Therefore, cut the cord and give up singing and dancing altogether, and go on delighting in the beauty of The Dhamma instead, through the joyful expression of a simple smile.

107. ***Atitti Sutta*** *(Non-Satiation)*

Bhikkhus, by indulging in these three things, one does not become satiated, but instead goes on craving, and being eager for more. And what are these three?

By indulging in sleeping while taking naps often, one does not become satiated, but instead goes on craving and being eager for more.
By taking intoxicating and mind-altering substances, one does not become satiated, but instead goes on craving and being eager for more.
And by engaging in sexual intercourse, one does not become satiated, but instead goes on craving and being eager for more.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by indulging in these three things, one does not become satiated, but still craves and is eager for more.

108. ***Paṭhama Kūṭāgāre Sutta*** *(The Peaked Roof – Part 1)*

Once, the householder Anāthapiṇḍika approached The Blessed One, and after paying homage to The Teacher, he sat to one side. Then, The Blessed One said:

"Householder, when the mind is not protected, one's bodily actions are not protected, so also are one's verbal and mental actions. When bodily, verbal, and mental actions are not protected, bodily actions become all contaminated and start leaking; verbal actions become all contaminated and start leaking; and mental actions become all contaminated and start leaking. And when bodily, verbal, and mental actions become all contaminated and start leaking, then bodily actions stink and thus turn disgusting; verbal actions stink and thus turn disgusting; and mental actions stink and thus turn disgusting.
And for one with such behavior, householder, whereby he has lived a life with stinking bodily, verbal, and mental actions that have been disgusting, there can be no good death at all.

"Householder, suppose there is a gabled house that is not well thatched, leaving the peaked roof vulnerable and not protected, which will make the main beam that supports the very framework of the roof vulnerable and thus not protected, while all the walls beneath the roof will similarly be vulnerable and not protected at all.
What naturally follows then, is that the peaked roof will leak, contaminating and damaging the beam supporting the whole framework that holds everything up, including the roof itself, as well as the walls. Then, this will lead to the collapse of the peaked roof, along with the beam supporting the framework of the roof and the walls.

"In the same manner, householder, when the mind is not protected, one's bodily actions are not protected, so also are one's verbal and mental actions. When bodily, verbal, and mental actions are not protected, bodily actions become all contaminated and start leaking; verbal actions become all contaminated and start leaking; and mental actions become all contaminated and start leaking. And when bodily, verbal, and mental actions become all contaminated and start leaking, then bodily actions stink and thus turn disgusting; verbal actions stink and thus turn disgusting; and mental actions stink and thus turn disgusting.
And for one with such behavior, householder, who has lived a life with stinking bodily, verbal, and mental actions that have been disgusting, there can be no good death at all.

"But, householder, when the mind is indeed protected, then one's bodily actions are protected, as also are one's verbal and mental actions. And when bodily, verbal, and mental actions are thus protected, bodily actions do not become contaminated nor leak; verbal actions do not become contaminated nor leak; and mental actions do not become contaminated nor leak. And when bodily, verbal, and mental actions neither become contaminated nor leak, then, bodily actions do not become disgusting; verbal actions do not become disgusting; and mental actions do not become disgusting. Instead, they all become pure.
And for one with such behavior, householder, whose bodily, verbal, and mental actions are thus pure, there will be a good death.

“Householder, suppose there is a gabled house that is well thatched, where the peaked roof is well protected and strong; the beam supporting the framework of the roof is protected and strong; and the walls too are protected and sturdy.
What naturally follows, is that the peaked roof will not leak, neither contaminating nor damaging the beam supporting the framework, maintaining the integrity of the roof itself, as well as the walls beneath it. This will then lead to the sturdiness of the peaked roof, along with the beam supporting the framework of the roof and all its walls.

“In the same manner, householder, when the mind is indeed protected, then one’s bodily actions are protected, as also are one’s verbal and mental actions. And when bodily, verbal, and mental actions are thus protected, bodily actions do not become contaminated nor leak; verbal actions do not become contaminated nor leak; and mental actions do not become contaminated nor leak.
And when bodily, verbal, and mental actions neither become contaminated nor leak, then bodily actions do not become disgusting; verbal actions do not become disgusting; and mental actions do not become disgusting. Instead, they all become pure.
And for one with such behavior, householder, whose bodily, verbal, and mental actions are thus pure, there will be a good death.”

109. ***Dutiya Kūṭāgāre (Byāpanna) Sutta*** *(Peaked Roof – Part 2)*

At another time, the householder Anāthapiṇḍika approached The Blessed One, and after paying homage to The Teacher, he went and sat to one side.

Then, The Blessed One said this to him:

Householder, when the mind is distressed, one’s bodily actions are distressed, under pressure, and insecure, so also are one’s verbal and mental actions. Householder, for one with distressed and insecure bodily, verbal, and mental actions, there will not be a good death awaiting him.

Householder, suppose there is a gabled house that is not well thatched, making the peaked roof distressed, under pressure and insecure; then the beam supporting the framework of the roof is also distressed and insecure; and the walls too are similarly distressed and insecure.

In the same manner, householder, when the mind is distressed, under pressure, and insecure, so also are one’s verbal and mental actions. Householder, for one with distressed and insecure bodily, verbal, and mental actions, there will not be a good death awaiting him.

But, householder, when the mind is neither distressed nor under pressure or insecure, one’s bodily actions too are not distressed nor insecure; so also, one’s verbal and mental actions are not distressed nor insecure. Householder, for one whose bodily, verbal, and mental actions are neither distressed nor insecure, there will be a good death awaiting him.

Householder, suppose there is a gabled house that is well thatched, making the peaked roof neither distressed nor under pressure or insecure; then the beam supporting the framework of the

roof will also be neither distressed nor under pressure, or insecure; and the walls too are not going to be distressed, under pressure, or insecure, either.

In the same manner, householder, when the mind is neither distressed nor under pressure or insecure, one's bodily actions too are not distressed nor insecure; so also, one's verbal and mental actions are not distressed nor insecure. Householder, for one whose bodily, verbal, and mental actions are neither distressed nor insecure, there will be a good death awaiting him.

110. ***Paṭhama Nidāna Sutta*** *(Origination of Actions – Part 1)*

Bhikkhus, these three are the origins for the arising of actions. What three?

Wanting or greed is an origin for the arising of actions; anger or hatred is the origin for the arising of actions; delusion is the origin for the arising of actions.

Bhikkhus, whatever intentional action (*kamma*) that originates from greed, is based in greed, and arises from greed, is going to be unwholesome, damaging and thus wrong. For, sooner or later, it brings unpleasant and painful results and conduces to more harmful actions, instead of bringing about the cessation of such actions.

Bhikkhus, whatever intentional action (*kamma*) that originates from hatred, is instigated by hatred, and arises from hatred, is unwholesome, damaging and thus wrong. For, sooner or later, it brings unpleasant and painful results and conduces to more harmful actions, instead of bringing about the cessation of such actions.

Bhikkhus, whatever intentional action (*kamma*) that originates from delusion, is instigated by delusion, and arises from delusion, is unwholesome, damaging and thus wrong. For, sooner or later, it brings unpleasant and painful results and conduces to more harmful actions, instead of bringing about the cessation of such actions.

Bhikkhus, these three are therefore the origins for the arising of actions.

Furthermore, Bhikkhus, these three are the origins for the arising of actions. What three?

Being contented and no longer driven by greed in the heart, is itself an origin for the arising of actions; having genuine empathy and non-hatred towards others is the origin for the arising of actions; and being willfully discerning is the origin for the arising of actions.

Bhikkhus, whatever intentional action (*kamma*) that originates from a state of contentment and non-greed, that is based in non-greed, and arises from non-greed, is wholesome, beneficial, and thus blameless. For, sooner or later, it brings pleasant results and conduces to the eventual cessation of actions altogether, and not to their continued perpetuation.

Bhikkhus, whatever intentional action (*kamma*) that originates from genuine empathy and non-hatred towards others, that is based in non-hatred, and arises from non-hatred, is wholesome, beneficial, and blameless. For, sooner or later, it brings pleasant results and conduces to the eventual cessation of actions altogether, and not to their continued perpetuation.

Bhikkhus, whatever intentional action (*kamma*) that originates from willful discernment and non-delusion, that is based in non-delusion, and arises from non-delusion, is wholesome, beneficial, and blameless. For, sooner or later, it brings pleasant results and conduces to the eventual cessation of actions altogether, and not to their continued perpetuation.

Bhikkhus, these three are also the origins for the arising of actions.

111. ***Dutiya Nidāna Sutta*** *(Origination of Actions – Part 2)*

Bhikkhus, these three are the origins for the arising of actions. What three?

Bhikkhus, passionate interest arises on account of thoughts, that trigger the arousal of desire and wanting, related to the past.

Bhikkhus, passionate interest arises on account of thoughts, that trigger the arousal of desire and wanting, related to the future.

Bhikkhus, passionate interest arises on account of thoughts, that trigger the arousal of desire and wanting, related to the present.

a. And how, Bhikkhus, does passionate interest arise on account of thoughts, that trigger the arousal of desire and wanting, related to the past?

Here, Bhikkhus, there is thinking and planning that occurs due to the presence of perceptions and ideas, triggering the arousal of desire and wanting, related to the past. Because of the process of thinking and planning, there is the arousal of new desire. Then, due to the arisen desire, one becomes fettered and chained by those thoughts, compelling him to seek ways to satisfy them by turning them into actions.
Bhikkhus, this fetter itself is the outcome of desire that was allowed to roam free within the greedy and wanting heart, agitating it further.

In this way, Bhikkhus, passionate interest arises on account of thoughts that trigger the arousal of desire and greed related to the past.

b. And how, Bhikkhus, does passionate interest arise on account of thoughts, that trigger the arousal of desire and wanting, related to the future?

Here, Bhikkhus, there is thinking and planning that occurs due to the presence of perceptions and ideas, triggering the arousal of desire and wanting related to the future. Because of the process of thinking and planning, there is the arousal of new desire. Then, due to the arisen desire, one becomes fettered and chained by those thoughts, compelling him to seek ways to satisfy them by turning them into actions.
Bhikkhus, this fetter itself is the outcome of desire that was allowed to roam free within the greedy and wanting heart, agitating it further.

In this way Bhikkhus, passionate interest arises on account of thoughts, that trigger the arousal of desire and greed related to the future.

c. And how, Bhikkhus, does passionate interest arise on account of thoughts, that trigger the arousal of desire and greed, related to the present?

Here, Bhikkhus, there is thinking and planning that occurs due to the presence of perceptions and ideas, triggering the arousal of desire and wanting, related to the present. Because of the process of thinking and pondering, there is the arousal of new desire. Then, due to the arisen desire, one becomes fettered and chained by those thoughts, compelling him to seek ways to satisfy them by turning them into actions.
Bhikkhus, this fetter itself is the outcome of desire that was allowed to roam free within the greedy and wanting heart, agitating it further.

In this way, Bhikkhus, passionate interest arises on account of thoughts, that trigger the arousal of desire and greed related to the present.

On the other hand, Bhikkhus, there are these other three origins for the arising of actions. What three?

Here, Bhikkhus, passionate interest does not arise on account of thoughts that might have triggered or aroused desire and wanting, pertaining to the past.

Passionate interest does not arise on account of thoughts that might have triggered or aroused desire and wanting, related to things of the future.

Similarly, passionate interest does not arise on account of thoughts that might have triggered or aroused desire and wanting, pertaining to the present.

a. And how, Bhikkhus, does passionate interest not arise on account of thoughts that might have triggered or aroused desire and wanting, pertaining to things of the past?

Bhikkhus, knowing the future outcome of thoughts, which might trigger or arouse desire and wanting pertaining to things of the past, one should therefore avoid them, abstain from hankering for them, and instead penetratingly see this through careful discernment.

Thus, passionate interest does not arise on account of thoughts that might have triggered or aroused desire and wanting, pertaining to things of the past.

b. And how, Bhikkhus, does passionate interest not arise on account of thoughts that might have triggered or aroused desire and wanting, pertaining to the future?

Bhikkhus, knowing the future outcome of thoughts, which might trigger or arouse desire and wanting pertaining to things of the future, one should therefore avoid them, abstain from hankering for them, and instead penetratingly see this through careful discernment.

Thus, passionate interest does not arise on account of thoughts, that might have triggered or aroused desire and wanting pertaining to the future.

c. And how, Bhikkhus, does passionate interest not arise on account of thoughts, that might have triggered or aroused desire and wanting, pertaining to the present?

Bhikkhus, knowing the outcome of thoughts, which might trigger or arouse desire and wanting pertaining to things of the present, one should therefore avoid them, abstain from hankering for them, and instead penetratingly see this through careful discernment.

Thus, passionate interest does not arise on account of thoughts, that might have triggered or aroused desire and wanting pertaining to the present.

Bhikkhus, these three are also the origins for the arising of actions.



AN III

Suttas 112-121

Āpāyika Vagga

"The Section on the Miserable Realms"

112. ***Āpāyika Sutta*** *(Miserable Realms)*

Bhikkhus, without abandoning three things, one will find oneself reborn into the miserable realms, in the hells.

Now, what are these three?

While expected to live a celibate Holy Life, one engages in sexual acts and lies about it.

Someone slanders another who is truly celibate and indeed lives the Holy Life, thus falsely accusing them of non-celibacy.

Another firmly believes in and upholds the view that "nothing is wrong with indulging in sensual pleasures," and thus goes on running after and indulging in them.

Bhikkhus, without abandoning these three things, one will find oneself reborn into the miserable realms, in the hells.

113. ***Dullabha Sutta*** *(Rare)*

Bhikkhus, the arising of three individuals is rare in the world. What three?

The arising of The Tathāgata, who is an Arahant and Perfectly Awakened, is truly rare in the entire existence.

A person who teaches The True Dhamma and Discipline declared by The Tathāgata, is really, quite rare in existence.

A grateful person, who also freely expresses one's thankfulness and appreciation, is indeed, so rare in existence.

Bhikkhus, the arising of these three individuals is quite rare in the world.

*114. **Appameyya** (Immeasurable)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three types of persons living in existence. What three?

The one easily measured; the one measured with difficulty; and the one who is truly immeasurable.

And what type of person, Bhikkhus, is the easily measured one?

Here, Bhikkhus, a certain person is excitable, muddled in the mind, puffed up and vain, conceited and arrogant, while being easily distractable and restless; someone who is forgetful, engaging in loose talk while also lacking clear comprehension, being confused, lacking awareness and with uncontrolled mental faculties. Bhikkhus, such a person is easily measured.

And what type of person, Bhikkhus, is measured with difficulty?

Here, Bhikkhus, a certain person is not excitable, not muddled in the mind, nor puffed up or vain, neither conceited nor arrogant; someone who is not forgetful and does not engage in loose talk; who has mindfulness and clear comprehension established; someone who is aware, with controlled mental faculties and a mind that is collected and stable. Bhikkhus, such a person is measured with difficulty.

And what type of person, Bhikkhus, is the one who is truly immeasurable?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu is an Arahant, with contaminants fully destroyed.
Bhikkhus, such a person is truly immeasurable.

Bhikkhus, these are the three types of persons living in the world.

*115. **Āneñja Sutta** (Immovable States)*

Bhikkhus, these three persons are known to exist in the world. What three?

a. Here, Bhikkhus, a certain person, having overcome all perceptions and memories that have to do with form, having transcended the perception of sensory impingement or compactness, and gone beyond the confines of the physical world and of tangibility, along with the disappearance of perceptions dealing with sensory reflexive contact; and by no longer paying any attention to the multiplicity of unending perceptions, instead, remains fully aware of how "space is infinitely boundless," as he enters upon and abides in the dimension of 'Boundless Infinity of Space.'

But, on attaining that state, he becomes attached to it, craving for it to last, as he strives after it while looking for satisfaction in it. Thus, becoming infatuated and making much of it, without falling away from it, after death, he is reborn in the company of Devas within the realm of boundless space, who have a life span of twenty thousand world cycles or eons (*kappas*).

Now, in the case of an ordinary person, having lived and completed that life span by using up the merits of his divine birth, once his time expires there, he then goes to hell, or to the animal realm, or reappears among the afflicted and miserable ghosts.

In contrast, however, the disciples of The Blessed One, having also reappeared into that same realm of boundless space, and once having completed their life span in that divine realm, they attain final Nibbāna within that very same existence, before expiring and dying in that realm.

Bhikkhus, this is the difference and distinction that exists between the future rebirth destination of the instructed Noble Disciple, and that of the ordinary person.

b. Next, Bhikkhus, by having completely transcended and gone beyond the perception of space being infinitely boundless, and by experiencing and being fully aware of how "consciousness is boundlessly infinite," he enters upon and abides in the dimension of 'Boundless infinity of Consciousness.'

But, on attaining that state, he becomes attached to it, craving for it to last, as he strives after it while looking for satisfaction in it. Thus, on becoming infatuated and making much of it, without falling away from it, after death, he is reborn in the company of Devas within the realm of boundlessness of consciousness, who have a life span of forty thousand world cycles or eons (*kappas*).

Now, in the case of an ordinary person, having lived and completed that life span by using up the merits of his divine birth, once his time expires there, he then goes to hell, or to the animal realm, or reappears among the afflicted and miserable ghosts.

In contrast, however, the disciples of The Blessed One, having also reappeared into that same realm of boundless consciousness, and once having completed their life span in that divine realm, they attain final Nibbāna within that very same existence, before expiring and dying in that realm.

Bhikkhus, this is yet another difference and distinction that exists between the future rebirth destination of the instructed Noble Disciple, and that of the ordinary person.

c. Also, Bhikkhus, by having completely transcended and gone beyond the perception of consciousness being infinitely boundless, and by experiencing and being fully aware of how "there is only nothingness," he enters upon and abides in the dimension of 'Nothingness.'

But, on attaining that state, he becomes attached to it, craving for it to last, as he strives after it while looking for satisfaction in it. Thus, on becoming infatuated and making much of it, without falling away from it, after death, he is reborn in the company of Devas within the realm of nothingness, who have a life span of sixty thousand world cycles or eons (*kappas*).

Now, in the case of an ordinary person, having lived and completed that life span by using up the merits of his divine birth, once his time expires there, he then goes to hell, or to the animal realm, or reappears among the afflicted and miserable ghosts.

In contrast, however, the disciples of The Blessed One, having also reappeared into that same realm of nothingness, and once having completed their life span in that divine realm, they attain final Nibbāna within that very same existence, before expiring and dying in that realm.

Bhikkhus, this is yet another difference and distinction that exists between the future rebirth destination of the instructed Noble Disciple, and that of the ordinary person.

Bhikkhus, these are the three persons known to exist in the world.

116. ***Vipatti Sampadā Sutta*** *(Failures and Successes)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three failures. What three?

Failure in virtuous behavior; failing to develop the mind; and failure in rectifying one's view.

And what, Bhikkhus, is failure in virtuous behavior?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone destroys living beings, takes what is not freely given, engages in sexual misconduct, tells lies, slanders, uses harsh and mean words meant to hurt and cause injury and suffering, and engages in frivolous speech by using idle chatter.

This, Bhikkhus, is failure in virtuous behavior.

And what, Bhikkhus, is failing to develop the mind?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone has a mind that is full of desires, while also being mean and avaricious, having no consideration for others and their wellbeing.

This, Bhikkhus, is failing to develop the mind.

And what, Bhikkhus, is failing to rectify one's view?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone holds on to wrong views, while functioning with the wrong understanding, thus:

'There is no point in giving, making offerings, or sacrificing anything, since there are no benefits or good results for what is generously given, as well as in making offerings or sacrifices. Similarly, there are no results for good and evil actions; there is no 'this existence' nor a life

beyond it; there is no mother, no father; there are no spontaneously reborn beings; there are no recluses or brahmins with upright behavior and proper conduct, with solid and reliably good character, who having come to the correct path and method, by realizing for themselves this world and the other, confidently and through their own personal experience, teach and declare it to others.'

Bhikkhus, this is failing to rectify the view.

Bhikkhus, as a result of failure in virtuous behavior, when their body breaks down, after death, those sentient beings are reborn into the miserable lower realms, in the hells.

Similarly, as a result of failing to develop the mind, when their body breaks down, after death, those sentient beings are reborn into the miserable lower realms, in the hells.

And also, as a result of failing to rectify and correct their view, when their body breaks down, after death, those sentient beings are reborn into the miserable lower realms, in the hells.

Bhikkhus, these are the three failures.

In contrast, Bhikkhus, there are these three successful accomplishments. What three?

Success in virtuous behavior; success in developing the mind; and success in rectifying the view.

And what, Bhikkhus, is success in virtuous behavior?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone does not destroy nor harms living beings; does not take what is not freely given; does not engage in sexual misconduct; does not tell lies; does not slander; does not use harsh or mean words meant to harm or cause suffering; and does not talk frivolously nor uses idle chatter.

This, Bhikkhus, is success in virtuous behavior.

And what, Bhikkhus, is success in developing the mind?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone has a mind that does not covet what others have, nor is obsessed with desires or hatred, remaining considerate of others and their wellbeing.

This, Bhikkhus, is success in developing the mind.

And what, Bhikkhus, is success in rectifying the view?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone holds the Right View, while functioning with the right understanding, thus:

'There is indeed much value in giving, making offerings, and sacrificing things, as there are surely benefits and good results for what is generously given, as well as in the offerings and sacrifices made. Similarly, there are results for good and evil actions; there is this existence and a life beyond; there is mother and father; there are indeed spontaneously reborn beings; there are recluses or brahmins with upright behavior and proper conduct, with solid and reliably good character, who having come to the correct path and method, through realizing for themselves this world and the other, confidently and through their own personal experience, teach and declare it to others.'

Bhikkhus, this is success in rectifying the view.

Now, Bhikkhus, as a result of success in virtuous behavior, after death, those sentient beings are reborn in good destinations, in the higher realms, in the heavenly abodes.

Similarly, as a result of success in developing the mind, after death, those sentient beings are reborn in good destinations, in the higher realms, in the heavenly abodes.

So also, as a result of success in rectifying and having corrected their view, after death, those sentient beings are reborn in good destinations, in the higher realms, in the heavenly abodes.

Bhikkhus, these are the three successful accomplishments.

117. ***Apaṇṇaka Sutta*** *(With Certainty)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three failures. What three?

Failure in virtuous behavior; failing to develop the mind; and failure in rectifying one's view.

And what, Bhikkhus, is failure in virtuous behavior?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone destroys living beings, takes what is not freely given, engages in sexual misconduct, tells lies, slanders, uses harsh and mean words meant to hurt and cause injury and suffering, and engages in frivolous speech by using idle chatter.

This, Bhikkhus, is failure in virtuous behavior.

And what, Bhikkhus, is failing to develop the mind?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone has a mind that is full of desires, while also being mean and avaricious, having no consideration for others and their wellbeing.

This, Bhikkhus, is failing to develop the mind.

And what, Bhikkhus, is failing to rectify one's view?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone holds on to wrong views, while functioning with the wrong understanding, thus:

'There is no point in giving, making offerings, or sacrificing anything, since there are no benefits or good results for what is generously given, as well as in making offerings or sacrifices. Similarly, there are no results for good and evil actions; there is no 'this existence' nor a life beyond it; there is no mother, no father; there are no spontaneously reborn beings; there are no recluses or brahmins with upright behavior and proper conduct, with solid and reliably good character, who having come to the correct path and method, by realizing for themselves this world and the other, confidently and through their own personal experience, teach and declare it to others.'

Bhikkhus, this is failing to rectify the view.

Bhikkhus, as a result of failure in virtuous behavior, when their body breaks down, after death, those sentient beings are reborn into the miserable lower realms, in the hells.

Similarly, as a result of failing to develop the mind, when their body breaks down, after death, those sentient beings are reborn into the miserable lower realms, in the hells.

And also, as a result of failing to rectify and correct their view, when their body breaks down, after death, those sentient beings are reborn into the miserable lower realms, in the hells.

Bhikkhus, similar to a situation where a dice is tossed, no matter where it lands, it always ends up firmly on its base, so too is the case when, as a result of failure in virtuous behavior, after death, sentient beings are reborn into the miserable lower realms, in the hells.

Similarly, as a result of failing to develop the mind, when their body breaks down, after death, those sentient beings are reborn into the miserable lower realms, in the hells.

And also, as a result of failing to rectify and correct their view, when their body breaks down, after death, those sentient beings are reborn into the miserable lower realms, in the hells.

Bhikkhus, these are the three failures.

On the other hand, Bhikkhus, there are these three successful accomplishments. What three?

Success in virtuous behavior; success in developing the mind; and success in rectifying the view.

And what, Bhikkhus, is success in virtuous behavior?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone does not destroy nor harms living beings; does not take what is not freely given; does not engage in sexual misconduct; does not tell lies; does not slander; does not use harsh or mean words meant to harm or cause suffering; and does not talk frivolously nor uses idle chatter.

This, Bhikkhus, is success in virtuous behavior.

And what, Bhikkhus, is success in developing the mind?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone has a mind that does not covet what others have, nor is obsessed with desires or hatred, remaining considerate of others and their wellbeing.

This, Bhikkhus, is success in developing the mind.

And what, Bhikkhus, is success in rectifying the view?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone holds the Right View, while functioning with the right understanding, thus:

'There is indeed much value in giving, making offerings, and sacrificing things, as there are surely benefits and good results for what is generously given, as well as in the offerings and sacrifices made. Similarly, there are results for good and evil actions; there is this existence and a life beyond; there is mother and father; there are indeed spontaneously reborn beings; there are recluses or brahmins with upright behavior and proper conduct, with solid and reliably good character, who having come to the correct path and method, through realizing for themselves this world and the other, confidently and through their own personal experience, teach and declare it to others.'

Bhikkhus, this is success in rectifying the view.

Now, Bhikkhus, as a result of success in virtuous behavior, after death, those sentient beings are reborn in good destinations, in the higher realms, in the heavenly abodes.

Similarly, as a result of success in developing the mind, after death, those sentient beings are reborn in good destinations, in the higher realms, in the heavenly abodes.

So also, as a result of success in rectifying and having corrected their view, after death, those sentient beings are reborn in good destinations, in the higher realms, in the heavenly abodes.

Bhikkhus, much like a dice when it gets tossed, no matter where it lands, it always ends up firmly on its base, so too, as a result of success in virtuous behavior, after death, sentient beings are reborn in good destinations, in the higher realms, in the heavenly abodes.

Similarly, as a result of success in developing the mind, after death, those sentient beings are reborn in good destinations, in the higher realms, in the heavenly abodes.

So also, as a result of success in rectifying the view, after death, those sentient beings are reborn in good destinations, in the higher realms, in the heavenly abodes.

Bhikkhus, these are the three moral accomplishments.

118. ***Kammanta Sutta*** *(Activity)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three failures. What three?

Failing in activity; failing in livelihood; and failing to rectify the view.

And what, Bhikkhus, is 'failing in activity?'

Here, Bhikkhus, someone destroys living beings, takes what is not freely given, engages in sexual misconduct, tells lies, slanders, uses harsh and mean words meant to hurt and cause injury and suffering, and engages in frivolous speech by using idle chatter.

This, Bhikkhus, is what is meant by 'failing in activity'.

And what, Bhikkhus, is 'failing in livelihood?'

Here, Bhikkhus, someone makes a living through wrong means of securing his livelihood and gaining support.

This, Bhikkhus, is what is meant by 'failing in livelihood'.

And what, Bhikkhus, is 'failing to rectify the view?'

Here, Bhikkhus, someone holds onto wrong views, while functioning with the wrong and convoluted ways of understanding, seeing life thus:

'There is no point in giving, making offerings, or sacrificing anything, since there are no benefits or good results for what is generously given, as well as in making offerings or sacrifices.

Similarly, there are no results for good and evil actions; there is no 'this existence' nor a life beyond it; there is no mother, no father; there are no spontaneously reborn beings; there are no recluses or brahmins with upright behavior and proper conduct, with solid and reliably good character, who having come to the correct path and method, by realizing for themselves this world and the other, confidently and through their own personal experience, teach and declare it to others.'

Bhikkhus, this is failing to rectify the view.

Now, Bhikkhus, these are the three failures.

On the other hand, Bhikkhus, there are these three successes. What three?

Success in activity; success in gaining a livelihood; and success in rectifying the view.

And what, Bhikkhus, is 'success in activity?'

Here, Bhikkhus, someone does not destroy nor harms living beings; does not take what is not freely given; does not engage in sexual misconduct; does not tell lies; does not slander; does not use harsh or mean words meant to harm or cause suffering; and does not talk frivolously nor uses idle chatter.

This, Bhikkhus is what is meant by 'success in activity'.

And what, Bhikkhus, is 'success in gaining a livelihood'?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone does not engage in wrong means of securing his livelihood, and instead, earns his living through the right means of making a living by gaining support, in order to live.

This, Bhikkhus, is 'success in gaining a livelihood'.

And what, Bhikkhus, is 'success in rectifying the view'?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone holds the Right View, while functioning with the right understanding, thus:

'There is indeed much value in giving, making offerings, and sacrificing things, as there are surely benefits and good results for what is generously given, as well as in the offerings and sacrifices made. Similarly, there are results for good and evil actions; there is this existence and a life beyond; there is mother and father; there are indeed spontaneously reborn beings; there are recluses or brahmins with upright behavior and proper conduct, with solid and reliably good

character, who having come to the correct path and method, through realizing for themselves this world and the other, confidently and through their own personal experience, teach and declare it to others.'

Bhikkhus, this is 'success in rectifying the view'.

These, therefore, Bhikkhus, are the three successes.

119. ***Paṭhama Soceyya Sutta*** *(On Purity – Part 1)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three purities. What three?

Bodily purity; purity through speech; and purity of thought.

And what, Bhikkhus, is bodily purity?

Here, Bhikkhus, a certain person abstains from destroying and harming living beings, abstains from taking what is not freely given, and abstains from engaging in sexual misconduct.

This is bodily purity.

And what, Bhikkhus, is verbal purity or purity through speech?

Here, Bhikkhus, the person abstains from telling lies, from slandering, from using harsh or mean words, and from talking frivolously or using idle chatter.

Bhikkhus, this is purity through speech.

And what, Bhikkhus is mental purity or purity through thought?

Here, Bhikkhus, a person does not possess covetousness or hatred in his heart, and lives with the Right View.

Bhikkhus, this is mental purity or purity through thought.

These, Bhikkhus, are the three purities.

120. ***Dutiya Soceyya Sutta*** *(On Purity – Part 2)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three purities. What three?

Bodily purity; verbal purity; and mental purity.

Now, Bhikkhus, what is bodily purity?

Here, Bhikkhus, a certain person abstains from destroying or harming living beings, abstains from taking what is not freely given, and abstains from engaging in sexual misconduct.

This is bodily purity.

And what, Bhikkhus, is verbal purity?

Here, Bhikkhus, a certain person abstains from telling lies, from slandering, from using harsh or mean words, and from talking frivolously or using idle chatter.

Bhikkhus, this is verbal purity.

And what, Bhikkhus, is mental purity?

Here, Bhikkhus, when there is the slightest sensual desire, the Bhikkhu knows, *'there is sensual desire in me,'* and when there isn't even the slightest sensual desire in him, the Bhikkhu knows, *'there isn't the slightest sensual desire in me.'* The Bhikkhu also knows how the non-arisen sensual desire arises; how arisen sensual desire is relinquished; and how the relinquished sensual desire would not arise again.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, when there is the slightest anger, the Bhikkhu knows, *'there is anger in me,'* and when there isn't even the slightest anger in him, the Bhikkhu knows, *'there isn't the slightest anger in me.'* The Bhikkhu also knows how the non-arisen anger arises; how arisen anger is relinquished; and how the relinquished anger would not arise again.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, when there are sloth and torpor in him, the Bhikkhu knows, '*there are sloth and torpor in me,'* and when there isn't even the slightest sloth or torpor in him, the Bhikkhu knows, *'there isn't the slightest sloth or torpor in me.*' The Bhikkhu also knows how the non-arisen sloth and torpor arise; how arisen sloth and torpor are relinquished; and how the relinquished sloth and torpor would not arise again.

Similarly, Bhikkhus, when there is agitation or worry in him, the Bhikkhu knows, *'there is agitation or worry in me,'* and when there isn't even the slightest agitation or worry in him, the Bhikkhu knows, *'there isn't the slightest agitation or worry in me.'* The Bhikkhu also knows how

the non-arisen agitation or worry arises; how arisen agitation or worry is relinquished; and how the relinquished agitation or worry would not arise again.

Also, Bhikkhus, when there is the slightest doubt, the Bhikkhu knows, *'there is doubt in me,'* and when there isn't even the slightest doubt in him, the Bhikkhu knows, *'there isn't the slightest doubt in me.'* The Bhikkhu also knows how the non-arisen doubt arises; how arisen doubt is relinquished; and how the relinquished doubt would not arise again.

These, Bhikkhus, are the three purities.

'Living in purity with body, speech, and mind,
One stands without any contaminants left in the heart.
No wonder it is of Him they speak, by declaring:
"A Pure One indeed, he is;
Truly accomplished in his purity;
The One who has washed all evil away."

121. ***Moneyya Sutta*** *(Wise Perfection)*

Bhikkhus, these three are the wise perfections. What three?

Wise perfection in body, speech, and mind.

Now what, Bhikkhus, is wise bodily perfection?

Here, Bhikkhus, a certain person abstains from destroying and harming living beings, from taking what is not freely given, and from engaging in sexual misconduct.

This is wise bodily perfection.

And what, Bhikkhus, is wise verbal perfection?

Here, Bhikkhus, a certain person abstains from telling lies, from slandering, from using harsh or mean words, and from talking frivolously or using idle chatter.

Bhikkhus, this is wise verbal perfection.

And what, Bhikkhus, is wise mental perfection?

Here, Bhikkhus, through the destruction of the contaminants (*āsavas*) and by his own direct knowledge, the Bhikkhu realizes in this very birth, the taintless Release of the Heart, becoming liberated through wisdom, as he enters upon and dwells in it.

This, Bhikkhus, is wise mental perfection.

Bhikkhus, these are the three wise perfections.

'The Sage is developed in body, speech, and mind
Thus, he now stands with contaminants of the heart all destroyed.
No wonder it is of Him they speak, by declaring:
"A Wise One indeed, he is;
Truly accomplished in his sagacity;
The One who has relinquished all things."



AN III

Suttas 122-131

Kusinārā Vagga

"The Section on Kusinārā"

122. ***Kusinārā Sutta*** *(At Kusinārā)*

Once, The Blessed One was living in Kusinārā, within a stretch of forest in Baliharaṇa. There, The Blessed One addressed the Bhikkhus and said:

a. Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu lives while relying on a certain village or town. Then, a householder or his son approaches him and invites the Bhikkhu for the next day's meal. If the Bhikkhu wishes so, he accepts the invitation. The next morning, after putting on his robes and taking his bowl and outer robe, the Bhikkhu goes and approaches the home of that householder or the householder's son. Then, he sits on the prepared seat, and the householder or his son serves the Bhikkhu nourishing food and drinks, with his own hands.

1. Then, it occurs to the Bhikkhu:

'It is indeed good, that this householder (or his son) has served me nourishing and delicious food and drinks, with his own hands.'

2. He then starts to ponder further:

'It would be really great, if this same householder (or his son) serves me nourishing and delicious food and drinks of a similar nature, with his own hands, again in the future as well.'

3. Thus, in accepting that meal offering, he becomes a slave to it, dwelling and fixating on it with greedy delight, without seeing the danger and therefore being unable to make use of it, in order to escape *from* it. What follows is that he gets lost in sensual thoughts, thoughts of ill will, and even harmful thoughts, all triggered by the alms food he received.

Now, Bhikkhus, I say that to give gifts or make offerings to such a Bhikkhu is not of much benefit, at all. And what is the reason for this?

It is because that careless Bhikkhu lives negligently.

b. Next, Bhikkhus, another Bhikkhu lives while also relying on a certain village or town. Then, a householder or his son approaches him and invites the Bhikkhu for the next day's meal. If the

Bhikkhu wishes so, he accepts the invitation. The next morning, after putting on his robes and taking his bowl and outer robe, the Bhikkhu goes and approaches the home of that householder or the householder's son. Then, he sits on the prepared seat, and the householder or his son serves the Bhikkhu nourishing food and drinks, with his own hands.

1. Now, with this Bhikkhu, the following thought does not even occur to him, as in:

'It is indeed good, that this householder (or his son) has served me nourishing and delicious food and drinks, with his own hands.'

2. Nor does he go on pondering further:

'It would be really great, if this same householder (or his son) serves me nourishing and delicious food and drinks of a similar nature, with his own hands, again in the future as well.'

3. Thus, in accepting that meal offering, he does not become a slave to it, nor dwells or is fixated on it with greedy delight, and instead, he clearly sees the danger in it and therefore is able to make use of it, in order to escape *from* it. What follows is that he reflects on the special quality of renunciation, while valuing its many benefits, along with thoughts of good will, empathetic and considerate thoughts of non-harm that arise in him, triggered by the alms food that he received.

Now, Bhikkhus, I say that to give gifts or make offerings to such a Bhikkhu is of much merit and benefit, indeed. And what is the reason for this?

It is because that considerate and mindful Bhikkhu is living diligently.

123. ***Bhaṇḍana Sutta*** *(Quarrelling)*

Bhikkhus, wherever Bhikkhus quarrel, fight and viciously argue, throwing verbal daggers at each other, I always find that place displeasing and undeserving to turn My attention to, let alone to spend any time there. Thus, I conclude:

'Indeed, these venerable ones have given up three things, and instead have taken up these other three things.'

And what are the three things they have given up?

They have really given up thoughts of renunciation; thoughts of good-will towards each other; and thoughts of consideration or the ability to remain empathetic. These are the three things they have given up.

And what are those three things, which they have taken up instead?

Thoughts of sensual lust; thoughts of ill will; and thoughts of harming or being apathetic towards each other. These are the three things they have instead taken up and immersed themselves in.

Thus, Bhikkhus, wherever Bhikkhus quarrel, fight and viciously argue, throwing verbal daggers at each other, I always find that place displeasing and undeserving to turn My attention to, let alone to spend any time there. Thus, I conclude:

'Indeed, these venerable ones have given up three things, and instead have taken up these other three things.'

On the other hand, Bhikkhus, wherever Bhikkhus are united, delighting in each other's company, and living harmoniously together without disputing, blending like milk and water, as they look at each other with kindly and considerate eyes, I find that place quite pleasing to turn My attention to, which is why I go and spend my time there.

Thus, in thinking about them, I conclude:

'Indeed, these venerable ones have given up three things, while taking up and cultivating these other three things.'

And what three things have they given up?

Thoughts of sensual lust; thoughts of ill will; and thoughts of harming or being apathetic towards each other. These are the three things they have given up.

And what three things have they taken up instead?

Non-sensual thoughts; thoughts of good-will; and considerate or empathetic thoughts of non-harm towards each other. These are the three things they have taken up and cultivated.

Thus, Bhikkhus, wherever Bhikkhus are united, delighting in each other's company, and living harmoniously together without disputing, blending like milk and water, as they look at each other with kindly and considerate eyes, I find that place quite pleasing to turn My attention to, which is why I go and spend my time there.

And, in thinking about them, I conclude:

'Indeed, these venerable ones have given up three things, while taking up and cultivating these other three things.'

124. ***Gotamaka Cetiya Sutta*** *(At the Gotamaka Shrine)*

At one time, while The Blessed One was living in Vesālī by the Gotamaka shrine, He addressed the Bhikkhus thus:

“Bhikkhus!”

“Yes, Bhante!” They replied.

And The Blessed One continued instructing –

“Bhikkhus, I teach The Dhamma through direct understanding, and not without first having experienced and understood it directly!

“I teach The Dhamma with its foundations, and not without its foundations.

“I teach The Dhamma that remedies and heals; I do not teach it without its healing and remedial effects.

“Now, because I teach The Dhamma through My direct understanding, and not without first having experienced and understood it directly; because I teach The Dhamma with its foundations, and not without its foundations; and because I teach The Dhamma that remedies and heals, and I do not teach it without its healing and remedial effects, you must seriously apply yourselves by following My dissemination and instruction to you, and thus intently practice it.

“This in itself, should be sufficient for you to rejoice and happily declare:

‘The Blessed One is indeed Perfectly Awakened!
The Dhamma is well proclaimed and beautifully explained by The Blessed One!
The Saṅgha of The Blessed One has truly come to the Right Path, and as such, is Practicing The Path correctly!”

This is what The Blessed One said, and those Bhikkhus were joyously delighted in The Blessed One’s words.

Now, as this discourse was taking place, the entire thousand-fold galaxy vibrated and shook in unison.

125. ***Bharaṇḍu Kālāma Sutta*** *(The Kālāma Bharaṇḍu)*

Once, The Blessed One was touring the country of Kosala, when he arrived to the City of Kapilavatthu.

On hearing that The Blessed One had arrived in Kapilavatthu, The Sakyan Mahānāma rushed to see Him as he paid homage to The Teacher, and then stood to one side. The Blessed One then said to the Sakyan Mahānāma:

"Mahānāma, find me a suitable dwelling for my night's rest in Kapilavatthu."

Then, the Sakyan Mahānāma set off speedily, as he wandered looking everywhere in Kapilavatthu, trying to find a suitable resting place for The Blessed One to spend the night. But, not being successful in this, he returned to The Blessed One and reported:

"Bhante, in Kapilavatthu there is no suitable dwelling place for The Blessed One to spend the night. However, Lord, there is the monastery of Bharaṇḍu, the one from Kālāma, who was The Blessed One's former student. Perhaps, The Blessed One may agree to take His rest there for the night?"

"Then, go there, Mahānāma, and prepare a resting mat for me."

And the Sakyan Mahānāma got up, and went straight to the monastery of Bharaṇḍu the Kālāman, as he prepared a resting place for The Blessed One, and after placing water for washing the feet, he returned to The Blessed One and informed Him:

"Blessed One, the resting mat is made and prepared, and the water is placed for washing the feet. Let The Blessed One go, whenever it is convenient for Him."

Then, The Blessed One went to Bharaṇḍu the Kālāman's monastery, and after having washed His feet, He went and sat on His ready-made mat.

Then, it occurred to the Sakyan Mahānāma:

'This is not the appropriate time to associate with The Blessed One, for He is now tired. I will come by in the morning, as I visit Him tomorrow.'

Thus, by paying homage to The Blessed One and circumambulating The Teacher, Mahānāma then went on his way.

The next morning, the Sakyan Mahānāma approached The Blessed One, paid homage to Him and then sat to one side.

And The Blessed One said this to him:

"Mahānāma, there are these three kinds of teachers found in the world. What three?

“Here, Mahānāma, a certain teacher explains and prescribes a thorough understanding of what exactly sensual pleasures are, but he neither explains much about their relationships to forms and feelings, nor their connection to each other.

“Then, there is another teacher, Mahānāma, who does elucidate and provide a clear explanation of both sensual pleasures and forms, but not of feelings, nor of their connection to each other.

“Still another teacher, Mahānāma, teaches and provides a clear explanation of sensual pleasures, of forms, and of feelings, as well as their relationships and connection to each other.

“These, Mahānāma, are the three teachers found in the world.

“Now, what do you think, Mahānāma? Would you say that the goal and outcome of these three teachers happen to be the same, or different?”

When this was said, Bharaṇḍu the Kālāman prompted the Sakyan Mahānāma, by telling him:

“Mahānāma, *say* that they are all the same!”

But The Blessed One intervened, by correcting Him quickly:

“No, Mahānāma, you must understand them to be quite different, in fact, and *not* the same!”

But, for the second time, Bharaṇḍu the Kālāman urged the Sakyan Mahānāma to answer The Blessed One’s question thus, by telling him again:

“Mahānāma, *say* that they are all the same!”

But The Blessed One again corrected Him:

“*No*, Mahānāma, you must understand them to be quite different, in fact, and *not* the same!”

Then, for the third time, Bharaṇḍu the Kālāman pressed the Sakyan Mahānāma, while insisting on his reply:

“Mahānāma, *say* that they are all the same!”

But for the third time, The Blessed One corrected Him, by saying:

“No, Mahānāma, you must understand them to be quite different, in fact, and *not* the same, at all!”

Then, it occurred to Bharaṇḍu the Kālāman:

‘I have been contradicted up to the third time by The Blessed One, and in the presence of this highly influential Mahānāma, the ruler of the Sakyans. I think it is best that I just leave Kapilavatthu altogether.’

Then, Bharaṇḍu the Kālāman left Kapilavatthu for good, and never returned.

*126. **Hatthaka Sutta** (Hatthaka the Young Deva)*

At one time, The Blessed One was living in Sāvatthī, at the monastery offered by Anāthapiṇḍika, in Jeta’s Grove.

Then, when the night was far spent, Hatthaka the young Deva approached The Blessed One, as he illuminated the whole of Jeta’s Grove, while thinking to himself:

‘Unlike before, when in approaching My Teacher, I used to get on my knees, now I will have to stand by touching the ground with my feet, while venerating My Beloved Teacher, The Blessed One!’

But, in doing so, he suddenly found himself sinking into the ground beneath him, much like hot oil or ghee would start to sink when poured on sand.

In the same manner, Hatthaka the young Deva, while trying to stand before The Blessed One, found himself sinking and could not stand upright, having lost his balance.

Then, The Blessed One instructed Hatthaka:

“Create a denser and more solid version of your body, Hatthaka!”

“Yes, Lord!” said Hatthaka, as he did just as instructed by The Blessed One, and created a grosser bodily form of himself, with which he was able to stand and pay homage to The Blessed One, and then went and stood to one side.

Then, The Blessed One said to him:

“Hatthaka, do you still recall those teachings that you learned in your life, while a human being?”

“Blessed Lord, I *do* indeed, still recall those teachings that I learned in my life while a human being, as well as those teachings from even earlier times, which I could not recall at all, while I was still in human form, but now they are all coming back to me!

“In fact, Blessed Lord, just as The Blessed One now lives while being surrounded by Bhikkhus, Bhikkhunis, male and female lay disciples, kings, kings’ ministers, and all those from different sects, along with their disciples, who come to listen and learn The Dhamma;

“In the same manner, Blessed Lord, I am often crowded by other Devas, who come to me from near and far, all eager to listen to The Dhamma from this Hatthaka, now the young Deva!

“This because, O Blessed Lord, I died while not being satisfied and thirsty for more, in regards to these three things. What three?

“Blessed Lord, I passed away while not being satisfied, because I was thirsty for more, to come and see The Blessed One.

“Blessed Lord, I passed away while not being satisfied, because I was thirsty for more, to come and listen to the True Dhamma.

“Blessed One, I passed away while not being satisfied, because I was thirsty for more, as I wanted to come to serve and cater to the needs of The Noble Saṅgha.

“Thus, Blessed One, I died while not being satisfied and thirsty for more, in regards to these three things.

‘I could never get enough of these three:
Seeing The Blessed One,
Listening to the True Dhamma, and
Attending to The Noble Saṅgha and its needs.

While training in Higher Virtue,
I was still attached to The Dhamma.
As a result of which, Blessed Lord,
In passing away and dying,
I, Hatthaka reappeared in Aviha’s Pure Abode
For, I had not yet given up even these beloved three.’”

127. ***Kaṭuviya Sutta*** *(On Defiling)*

At one time, The Blessed One was staying in the deer park at Isipatana, in Varanasi.

Then, when it was morning, having dressed and taking His alms bowl and outer robes, The Blessed One entered Varanasi for His daily alms.

While walking on His alms round, He saw a certain Bhikkhu who had also gone for his alms round, but instead of tending to collecting his meal for the day, the Bhikkhu was skulking near a fig tree, where cattle were being kept bound.

The Blessed One saw how this Bhikkhu's mind was restless and unhappy, internally dissatisfied, and being given to bitter resentment for being a Bhikkhu, who instead kept entertaining himself by gratifying his senses with external sights and sounds.

Thus, The Blessed One saw that this was a Bhikkhu, who lacked both mindfulness and clear comprehension, with a mind that was muddled and uncollected, completely at the mercy of his uncontrolled mental faculties.

Witnessing the Bhikkhu's state of disarray, The Blessed One said:

"Bhikkhu, O Bhikkhu, do not defile yourself! When you defile yourself as such, you give off an evil stench, making it impossible for flies not to follow or settle on you, attracted to your terribly nasty stench!"

The startled Bhikkhu, on being advised by The Blessed One in this manner, quickly became remorseful and resolutely reengaged in his efforts.

Then, later in the day, having returned from the alms round and eaten His meal, The Blessed One addressed the Bhikkhus, by saying:

"Bhikkhus, this morning, after having dressed and taken my alms bowl and outer robes, I entered Varanasi for the alms round.

"While walking for alms, I saw a certain Bhikkhu also going for alms, who had stopped near a fig tree, where some cattle were being kept bound.

"Then, I saw how this Bhikkhu's mind was restless and unhappy, internally dissatisfied, and being given to bitter resentment for being a Bhikkhu, who instead kept entertaining himself by gratifying his senses with external sights and sounds.

"Thus, I saw that this was a Bhikkhu, who lacked both mindfulness and clear comprehension, with a mind that was muddled and uncollected, completely at the mercy of his uncontrolled mental faculties.

"Witnessing him in that state, I said:

“Bhikkhu, O Bhikkhu, do not defile yourself! When you defile yourself as such, you give off an evil stench, making it impossible for flies not to follow or settle on you, attracted to your terribly nasty stench!”

On being advised by Me in this manner, the startled Bhikkhu quickly became remorseful, and resolutely reengaged in his efforts.

When this was said, a certain Bhikkhu asked a question:

“Bhante, what is meant here by the term ‘defiling;’ what is ‘the evil stench;’ and what are the ‘flies’?”

And The Blessed One replied by instructing:

“Bhikkhu, ‘the defiling’ mentioned here is one’s covetousness for what others have; the ‘evil stench’ is aversion and hatred one keeps in his heart; and the ‘flies’ are one’s evil and damaging thoughts.

“Therefore, when the Bhikkhu defiles himself as such, he inevitably ends up giving off an evil stench, making it impossible for flies not to follow or settle on him, attracted to his nasty and terrible stench.”

‘When the eyes and ears are left unprotected,
And the mental faculties run amok,
The flies of evil thoughts will multiply and abound.
The defiled Bhikkhu, thus giving off an evil stench,
Far from Nibbāna he remains,
Living only in suffering, that remains his only lot.

Whether in the village or forest,
Not able to taste the fruits of inner peace,
The fool leads on, followed by the flies.
But he who is of virtuous behavior,
Enjoying the fruits of peaceful wisdom,
Lives tranquil and sleeps happily,
Having destroyed all those flies, and all that they bring.’

128. ***Paṭhama Anuruddha Sutta*** *(The Venerable Anuruddha – Part 1)*

At one time, the Venerable Anuruddha approached The Blessed One, and after paying homage to The Teacher, he sat down to one side and said:

“Bhante, with the Divine Eye, which is purified and far surpasses that of a human, I see that at the breakup of the physical body, after their death here, most women are immediately reborn into the lower states of being, into the miserable and bad states, landing as they do in the hells.

“Blessed Lord, as a consequence of what mental tendencies is it, that at the breakup of their physical bodies, after death, most women are being reborn into the lower states of being, into the miserable and bad states, landing as they do in the hells?”

And The Blessed One said:

“Anuruddha, when a woman has these three mental tendencies, at the breakup of the physical body, after death, she finds herself reborn into the lower states of being, into the miserable and bad states, landing as she does in the hells.

“And what are these three?

“Here, Anuruddha, during the early part of their day, women live while being overcome by a heart that is self-obsessed, with a strong sense of stinginess.
Then, during the middle part of their day, they live overcome by jealous thoughts and envy of others.
And during the final part of their day, they live with a mind that is flooded by sexual desire, drenched in sensual and lustful fantasies.

“Anuruddha, as a consequence of these three mental tendencies, at the breakup of the physical body, after death, most women find themselves reborn into the lower states of being, into the miserable and bad states, landing as they do in the hells.”

129. ***Dutiya Anuruddha Sutta*** *(The Venerable Anuruddha – Part 2)*

Once, the Venerable Anuruddha approached the Venerable Sāriputta, and after exchanging friendly greetings with him, he sat to one side and said to the Venerable Sāriputta:

“Friend Sāriputta, with the Divine Eye, which is purified and far surpasses that of a human, I see clearly the thousand-fold world systems and galaxies.

“I also know that my energy is strong and not slacking, at all. In addition, I see that my mindfulness is firmly established while remaining un-fluttered. So, I do experience the body being tranquil and without any disturbances. Furthermore, my one-pointed mind is brought to a perfect state of collected stability (*samādhi*).

“But for some reason, friend, my heart is not yet released from the contaminants (*āsavas*); hence, it still remains quite shackled and thus unreleased from no longer gripping onto anything.”

Then, the Venerable Sāriputta said:

“Friend Anuruddha, when you reflect thus:

‘With the Divine Eye, which is purified and far surpasses that of a human, I see clearly the thousand-fold world systems and galaxies.’

“Well, this itself shows that conceit is still strongly present in you.

“And when you reflect thus, friend Anuruddha, by saying:

‘I also know that my energy is strong and not slacking, at all. In addition, I see that my mindfulness is firmly established while remaining un-fluttered. So, I do experience the body being tranquil and without any disturbances. Furthermore, my one-pointed mind is brought to a perfect state of collected stability (samādhi).’

“This shows that there is still quite a bit of restlessness in you.

“And when, friend Anuruddha, you ruminate while thinking:

‘But for some reason, friend, my heart is not yet released from the contaminants (āsavas); hence, it still remains quite shackled and thus unreleased from no longer gripping onto anything.’

“Well, this shows that worry and remorse are therefore still haunting you.

“So, it would be best, friend Anuruddha, if you could just push aside and shun all these three negative mental states, altogether. And by no longer paying any attention to these three, just have your focus be with, settled upon, and seeing *nothing* other than ‘that which is undying’ (*Amatāya dhātuyā*) within the heart.”

Then, after some time had passed, the Venerable Anuruddha abandoned, pushed aside, and shunned those three negative mental states altogether. And by no longer paying any attention to those three, as advised by his friend, the Venerable Sāriputta, he kept on resolutely practicing while having his focus be with, settled upon, and seeing *nothing* other than ‘that which is undying’ (*Amatāya dhātuyā*) within the heart.”

Thus, by staying resolute and through persistent effort, as he kept training on this Path, the Venerable Anuruddha, while striving alone and secluded from the crowds, with his careful heedfulness and diligence, before long, was able to realize for himself and through his own efforts, the very Goal of the Holy Life, for the attainment of which good sons of families rightfully leave the household life and become homeless, seeking that noble end of the holy life.

It was in this same manner, that the Venerable Anuruddha also realized for himself and through his own efforts, in this very birth, the Release of the Heart, that is indeed True Freedom through Wisdom, as he too entered upon and dwelled in it.

Thus, the Venerable Anuruddha thoroughly understood, by knowing directly for himself, and with certainty unparalleled, that:

'Birth is now finally destroyed,
The Holy Life has been fully lived.
What had to be done, is now done and complete.
There is no more coming back to any state of being.'

In this way, the Venerable Anuruddha became one of The Arahants.

130. ***Paṭicchanna Sutta*** *(Covered & Exposed)*

Bhikkhus, these three things thrive and increase in their value when covered, but not so, when exposed.

Now, what are these three?

Women become more treasured, increasing in their worth when covered and kept mysteriously hidden, but not so, when exposed.
Brahmanical hymns and mantras increase in their importance and are more treasured when covered and hidden, but not so when exposed.
Wrong views increase and thrive, while getting covertly perpetuated when covered, but not so, when exposed for what they truly are.

These are the three things that thrive and increase in their value when covered, and not when they are exposed.

On the other hand, Bhikkhus, these other three things shine brighter when exposed, but not so when covered and hidden from sight.

And what are these three?

Bhikkhus, the moon shines brighter when exposed, but not when it is covered.
The sun shines brighter when exposed, but not so, when it is covered.
And The Dhamma and Discipline declared by The Tathāgata shine brighter when exposed and made visible, but not so, when they are covered.

Bhikkhus, these are the three things that shine brighter when exposed, but not so when covered and hidden from sight.

131. ***Lekha Sutta*** *(Carved in Stone)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three types of people living in the world. What three?

The person who is like a line chiseled and carved into a solid rock; the person who is like a line drawn on sand; and the person who is like a line written on the surface of water.

And who, Bhikkhus, is that person who is like a line chiseled and carved into a solid rock?

Here, Bhikkhus, a person often gets angry, and this anger of his stays with him for a very long time. Much like the line chiseled and carved onto a rock that does not get erased quickly either by water or the wind, similarly, this irritable person often gets angry, whereby his anger stays with him for a very long time.

Bhikkhus, this is the person who is like a line chiseled and carved into a rock.

And who, Bhikkhus, is that person who is like a line drawn on sand?

Here, Bhikkhus, a person often gets angry, but unlike the previous one, his anger does not stay with him for a very long time. Much like the line drawn on sand that gets erased quickly by either water or the wind, similarly, this irritable person often gets angry, but his anger does not stay with him for long, for it dissipates with time.

Bhikkhus, this is the person who is like that line drawn on sand.

And who, Bhikkhus, is the person who is like a line that is written on the surface of water?

Here, Bhikkhus, even while spoken to with harsh, disagreeable, or rough words meant to injure and hurt him, such a person still does not get angry, but instead remains kind and on friendly terms with those same individuals, thinking little of the matter, much like the line written on the surface of water.
Similarly with this person, who even while spoken to with harsh, disagreeable, or rough words that are meant to injure and hurt him, he does not get angry, and instead remains kind and on friendly terms with those same individuals, thinking little of the matter.

Bhikkhus, this is the person who is like a line that is written on the surface of water.

Bhikkhus, these are the three types of people living in the world.

AN III

Suttas 132-141

Yodhājīva Vagga

"The Section on the Warrior"

132. ***Yodhājīva Sutta*** *(The Warrior)*

Bhikkhus, endowed with three qualities, the warrior becomes worthy of the king, supported by the king, and regarded as his royal accompaniment. What three?

Here, Bhikkhus, the warrior is a superb marksman with perfect timing; able to shoot from afar; and skilled at cutting into half a large body, with a single slice of his sword.
Bhikkhus, endowed with these three qualities, the warrior becomes worthy of the king, supported by the king, and regarded as his royal accompaniment.

In the same way, Bhikkhus, endowed with three qualities, the Bhikkhu becomes worthy of offerings, worthy of hospitality, worthy of gifts, worthy of reverential salutation with clasped palms, the incomparable field of merit for the entire existence.

And what are these three?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu is able to hit his target from afar; is a superb marksman with perfect timing; and skilled at cutting into half a large body, with a single slice.

And how, Bhikkhus, is the Bhikkhu able to hit his target from afar?

Here, Bhikkhus, whatever kind of matter or form he may witness or experience, whether related to the past, future, or present, be it internal or external, gross or subtle, of an inferior or superior quality, whether far or near, the Bhikkhu sees all this as it truly is, and with the necessary wisdom, thus:

'This is not mine. This is not a part of me. This is not myself.'

Whatever kind of feeling he may experience, whether related to the past, future, or present, be it internal or external, gross or subtle, of an inferior or superior quality, whether far or near, the Bhikkhu sees all this as it truly is, and with the necessary wisdom, thus:

'This is not mine. This is not a part of me. This is not myself.'

Whatever kind of perceptions or memories he may experience, whether related to the past, future, or present, be it internal or external, gross or subtle, of an inferior or superior quality, whether far or near, the Bhikkhu sees all this as it truly is, and with the necessary wisdom, thus:

'This is not mine. This is not a part of me. This is not myself.'

Whatever kind of habitual drives (*saṅkhārā*) he may experience, whether related to the past, future, or present, be it internal or external, gross or subtle, of an inferior or superior quality, whether far or near, the Bhikkhu sees all this as it truly is, and with the necessary wisdom, thus:

'This is not mine. This is not a part of me. This is not myself.'

Whatever kind of sense awareness or consciousness he may experience, whether related to the past, future, or present, be it internal or external, gross or subtle, of an inferior or superior quality, whether far or near, the Bhikkhu sees all this as it truly is, and with the necessary wisdom, thus:

'This is not mine. This is not a part of me. This is not myself.'

Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that the Bhikkhu is able to hit his target from afar.

And how, Bhikkhus, is the Bhikkhu a superb marksman with perfect timing?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu knows as it truly is:

'This is suffering; this is the origin of suffering; this is its cessation; this is The Path to the cessation of suffering.'

Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that the Bhikkhu is a superb marksman with perfect timing.

And how, Bhikkhus, is the Bhikkhu skilled at cutting into half a large body, with a single slice?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu cuts through a great mass of ignorance.

Bhikkhus, it is in this manner that the Bhikkhu is skilled at cutting into half a large body, with a single slice.

Bhikkhus, endowed with these three qualities, the Bhikkhu becomes worthy of offerings, worthy of hospitality, worthy of gifts, worthy of reverential salutation with clasped palms, the incomparable field of merit for the entire existence.

133. ***Parisā Sutta*** *(Gatherings)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three types of gatherings. What three?

The gathering that engages in flattery and vain talk; the gathering that engages in critiquing, blaming, and interrogating others; and the gathering that engages only when there is a threat present.

Bhikkhus, these are the three types of gatherings.

134. ***Mittā Sutta*** *(The Friend)*

Bhikkhus, you need to associate with a friend who possesses these three qualities. What three?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu gives away something that is difficult to give; he does something that is difficult to do; and he forgives what is difficult to forgive.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, associate with those who possess these three qualities.

135. ***Uppādā Sutta*** *(Arising)*

Bhikkhus, whether The Tathāgatas arise or not, the Law of Dhamma continues on its course, persisting with its enduring stability, asserting how *'all conditioned things are impermanent.'*
This, The Tathāgatas have completely awakened to and pierced through, as they directly realized, understood and fully mastered it.
It is therefore for this reason, that The Tathāgatas declared, preached, established, explained, and made clear how *'all conditioned things are impermanent.'*

Bhikkhus, whether The Tathāgatas arise or not, the Law of Dhamma continues on its course, persisting with its enduring stability, asserting how *'all conditioned things are suffering.'*
This, The Tathāgatas completely awaken to and pierce through, as they realize, understand and fully master it.
It is therefore for this reason, that The Tathāgatas declare, preach, establish, explain, and make clear how *'all conditioned things are suffering.'*

Bhikkhus, whether The Tathāgatas arise or not, the Law of Dhamma continues on its course, persisting with its enduring stability, asserting how *'all conditioned things are essence-less and without any substantiality.'*
This, The Tathāgatas will completely awaken to and pierce through, as they realize, understand and fully master it.

It is therefore for this reason, that The Tathāgatas will declare, preach, establish, explain, and make clear how *'all conditioned things are essence-less and without any substantiality.'*

136. ***Kesakambala Sutta*** *(The Blanket of Head-hair)*

Bhikkhus, what they call a "cloth," which is nothing but weaving of head hair that is collected and then turned into a blanket, is undeniably the least efficient of all materials, lacking any insulation whatsoever, keeping one cold and not warm in the cold season, and hot and not cool in the hot season. In addition, any blanket made of head-hair is unappealing, unhygienic, foul-smelling, and does not have a comforting texture to it, at all.

Bhikkhus, in the same way, it should be declared that of the numerous doctrines of various contemporary recluses, Makkhali's (Gosāla) view is indeed the worst.

For, Bhikkhus, that idiot Makkhali holds the wrong view and keeps instructing those around him that:

'There is no action being committed; there is nothing that is done; and there is no effort to be applied.'

But Bhikkhus, The Blessed Ones in the past, who became Arahants and Perfectly Self-Awakened, have all taught the truth, that there *is* indeed intentional action (*kamma*) being committed; therefore, there is action that is done, and certainly, effort is to be applied.

However, this idiot Makkhali contradicts all The Tathāgatas, with his own insane and foolish view, by declaring:

'There is no action being committed; there is nothing that is done; and there is no effort to be applied.'

Furthermore, Bhikkhus, The Blessed Ones in the future, who will become Arahants and Perfectly Self-Awakened as well, will also teach the truth, that there *is* indeed intentional action (*kamma*) being committed; therefore, there is action that is done, and certainly, effort is to be applied.

However, this idiot Makkhali contradicts all Those Tathāgatas of the future as well, with his own insane and foolish view, by declaring:

'There is no action being committed; there is nothing that is done; and there is no effort to be applied.'

And now too, Bhikkhus, when I am The Tathāgata, The Blessed One, The Arahant and The Perfectly Self-Awakened One of this age, I also teach the truth, that there *is* indeed intentional action (*kamma*) being committed; therefore, there is action that is done, and certainly, effort is to be applied.

However, this idiot Makkhali contradicts all The Tathāgatas, with his own insane and foolish view, by declaring:

'There is no action being committed; there is nothing that is done; and there is no effort to be applied.'

Bhikkhus, much like a net laid out at the mouth of a river that traps and keeps ensnaring many fish, truly leading to their harm, suffering, and disaster, in the same way, this idiot Makkhali's net of wrong views is enticing and trapping many sentient beings, truly leading to their terrible harm, suffering, and disaster.

137. ***Sampadā Sutta*** *(Attainments)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three attainments. What three?

The attainment of faith, the attainment of virtuous behavior, and the attainment of wisdom.

Bhikkhus, these are the three attainments.

138. ***Vuddhi Sutta*** *(Development)*

Bhikkhus, there are these three developments. What three?

The development in faith and confidence, the development in virtuous behavior, and the development in wisdom.

Bhikkhus, these are the three developments.

139. ***Assakhaḷuṅka Sutta*** *(Wild Colts)*

"Bhikkhus, I will teach you about the three types of wild colts, and their similarity to the three types of stubborn people, who are like wild colts themselves. Now, listen and attend carefully."

"Yes, Bhante!" The Bhikkhus replied.

And The Blessed One continued instructing:

"And what, Bhikkhus, are the three types of wild colts?"

“Here, Bhikkhus, a certain wild colt possesses speed, but lacks both the beauty and the necessary correct proportions.
Another type of wild colt, Bhikkhus, possesses both speed and beauty, but lacks the necessary correct proportions.
Yet another wild colt, Bhikkhus, possesses speed, beauty, and the necessary correct proportions.

“Bhikkhus, these are the three types of wild colts.

“And what, Bhikkhus, are the three types of stubborn people, who are like wild colts?

“Here, Bhikkhus, a certain type of stubborn person, being like a wild colt, possesses speed, but lacks both the beauty and the necessary correct proportions.
Another type of stubborn person, Bhikkhus, possesses both speed and beauty, but lacks the necessary correct proportions.
Yet another stubborn person, Bhikkhus, possesses speed, beauty, and the necessary correct proportions.

a. “And who, Bhikkhus, is the type of stubborn person who, being like a wild colt, possesses speed, but lacks both the beauty and the necessary correct proportions?

“Here, Bhikkhus, a certain Bhikkhu knows and understands as it really is:

‘This is suffering; this is the cause of suffering; this is the ending of suffering; and this is the Path leading to the ending of all suffering.’

“Bhikkhus, I say that this is his speed.

“However, if a deeper question on The Dhamma or The Discipline is to be asked of him, he becomes bewildered and angry, unable to answer. Bhikkhus, I say that this is his lack of beauty.

“Also, such a Bhikkhu does not obtain robes, alms food, shelter, as well as the necessary medicinal requisites whenever he falls sick. Bhikkhus, I say that this is his lack of necessary correct proportions.

“Bhikkhus, this is the type of stubborn person who, being like a wild colt, possesses speed, but lacks both the beauty and the necessary correct proportions.

b. “And who, Bhikkhus, is the type of stubborn person who, just like a wild colt, possesses speed and beauty, but lacks the necessary correct proportions?

“Here, Bhikkhus, a certain Bhikkhu knows as it really is:

'This is suffering; this is the cause of suffering; this is the ending of suffering; and this is the Path leading to the ending of all suffering.'

Bhikkhus, I say that this is his speed.

"And if a deeper question on The Dhamma or The Discipline is to be asked of him, he neither becomes bewildered nor gets angry, and is able to answer. Bhikkhus, I say that this is his beauty.

"Yet, he does not obtain robes, alms food, shelter, and other medicinal requisites when fallen ill. Bhikkhus, I say that this is his lack of necessary correct proportions.

"Bhikkhus, this is the type of stubborn person who, just like a wild colt, possesses speed and beauty, but lacks the necessary correct proportions.

c. "And who, Bhikkhus, is the type of stubborn person who, just like a wild colt, possesses speed, beauty, *and* the necessary correct proportions?

"Here, Bhikkhus, a certain Bhikkhu knows as it really is:

'This is suffering; this is the cause of suffering; this is the ending of suffering; and this is the Path leading to the ending of all suffering.'

"Bhikkhus, I say that this is his speed.

"And, if a deeper question on The Dhamma or The Discipline is to be asked of him, he does not become bewildered nor gets angry, and is able to answer. Bhikkhus, I say that this is his beauty.

"Also, he easily obtains robes, alms food, shelter, and other medicinal requisites when fallen ill. Bhikkhus, I say that this is him possessing the necessary correct proportions.

"Bhikkhus, this is the type of stubborn person who, being like a wild colt, possesses speed, beauty, and the necessary correct proportions.

"Bhikkhus, these are the three types of stubborn people, who are like wild colts."

140. ***Assaparassa Sutta*** *(Stallions)*

"Bhikkhus, I will teach you about the three types of stallions and their similarity to the three types of people, who are like stallions themselves. Now, listen and attend carefully."

"Yes, Bhante!" The Bhikkhus replied.

And The Blessed One continued instructing:

“And what, Bhikkhus, are the three types of stallions?

“Here, Bhikkhus, a certain stallion possesses speed, but lacks both the beauty and the necessary correct proportions.
Another type of stallion, Bhikkhus, possesses both speed and beauty, but lacks all the necessary correct proportions.
Yet another stallion, Bhikkhus, possesses speed, beauty, and the necessary correct proportions.

“Bhikkhus, these are the three types of stallions.

“And what, Bhikkhus, are the three types of people, who are like stallions?

“Here, Bhikkhus, a certain type of person, being like a stallion, possesses speed but lacks both the beauty and the necessary correct proportions.
Another type of person, Bhikkhus, possesses both speed and beauty, but lacks the necessary correct proportions.
Yet another person, Bhikkhus, possesses speed, beauty, and the necessary correct proportions.

a. “And who, Bhikkhus, is the type of person who, just like a stallion, possesses speed but lacks both the beauty and the necessary correct proportions?

“Here, Bhikkhus, on having eliminated the five lower fetters binding him to the sensual world, a certain Bhikkhu is reborn into The Pure Abodes, where he will attain Full Liberation, without ever returning or falling from that world.

“But, if a deeper question on The Dhamma and The Discipline is to be asked of him, he becomes bewildered and angry, unable to answer. Bhikkhus, I say that this is his lack of beauty.

“Also, he does not obtain robes, alms food, shelter, and other medicinal requisites when fallen ill. Bhikkhus, I say that this is his lack of necessary correct proportions.

“Bhikkhus, this is the type of person who, just like a stallion, possesses speed but lacks both the beauty and the necessary correct proportions.

b. “And who, Bhikkhus, is the type of person who, just like a stallion, possesses speed and beauty, but lacks the necessary correct proportions?

“Here, Bhikkhus, on having eliminated the five lower fetters binding him to the sensual world, a certain Bhikkhu is reborn into The Pure Abodes, where he will attain Full Liberation, without ever returning or falling from that world.

“Bhikkhus, I say that this is his speed.

“And, if a deeper question on The Dhamma and The Discipline is to be asked of him, he neither becomes bewildered nor gets angry, and is able to answer. Bhikkhus, I say that this is his beauty.

“But he does not obtain robes, alms food, shelter, and other medicinal requisites when fallen ill. Bhikkhus, I say that this is his lack of correct proportions.

“Bhikkhus, this is the type of person who, just like a stallion, possesses speed and beauty, but lacks the necessary correct proportions.

c. “And who, Bhikkhus, is the type of person who, just like a stallion, possesses speed, beauty, and the necessary correct proportions?

“Here, Bhikkhus, on having eliminated the five lower fetters binding him to the sensual world, a certain Bhikkhu is reborn into The Pure Abodes, where he will attain Full Liberation, without ever returning or falling from that world.

“And, if a deeper question on The Dhamma and The Discipline is to be asked of him, he neither becomes bewildered nor gets angry, and is able to answer. Bhikkhus, I say that this is his beauty.

“Also, he easily obtains robes, alms food, shelter, and medicinal requisites when fallen ill. Bhikkhus, I say that this is him possessing the necessary correct proportions.

“Bhikkhus, this is the type of person who, just like a stallion, possesses speed, beauty, and the necessary correct proportions.

“Bhikkhus, these are the three types of people who are like stallions.”

*141. **Assājānīya Sutta** (Thoroughbreds)*

“Bhikkhus, I will instruct you on the three excellent thoroughbred horses, and their similarity to the three excellent thoroughbreds among people.

“Now, listen and attend carefully to what I shall say.”

“Yes, Bhante!” The Bhikkhus replied.

And The Blessed One continued speaking:

“And what, Bhikkhus, are the three excellent thoroughbred horses?

“Here, Bhikkhus, a certain excellent thoroughbred is endowed with speed, but lacks both the beauty and the necessary correct proportions.
Another type of an excellent thoroughbred, Bhikkhus, possesses both speed and beauty, but lacks all the necessary correct proportions.
Yet another excellent thoroughbred, Bhikkhus, possesses speed, beauty, and the necessary correct proportions.

“These are the three excellent thoroughbred horses, Bhikkhus.

“And who, Bhikkhus, are the three excellent thoroughbred people?

“Here, Bhikkhus, a certain type of person, like an excellent thoroughbred, possesses speed, but lacks both the beauty and the necessary correct proportions.
Another type of an excellent thoroughbred person, Bhikkhus, possesses both speed and beauty, but lacks the necessary correct proportions.
Yet another excellent thoroughbred person, Bhikkhus, possesses speed, beauty, and the necessary correct proportions.

a. “And how, Bhikkhus, is an excellent thoroughbred of a person endowed with speed, but lacks both the beauty and the necessary correct proportions?

“Here, Bhikkhus, through the destruction of the contaminants and by his own direct knowledge, the Bhikkhu realizes in this very birth, the taintless Release of the Heart, liberating himself through his direct wisdom, and thereby enters into and abides in it.

“This, Bhikkhus, I say is his speed.

“But if a deep question on The Dhamma and The Discipline is asked of him, he becomes bewildered and is unable to answer.

“Bhikkhus, I say that this is his lack in beauty.

“Also, he does not easily obtain his robes, alms food, shelter, and other provisions, as well as faces difficulties in receiving the medicinal requisites, if and when he becomes sick.

“Bhikkhus, I say that this is his lack in the necessary correct proportions.

“This, Bhikkhus, is the excellent thoroughbred of a person, who possesses speed, but lacks both beauty and the necessary correct proportions.

b. “And how, Bhikkhus, does an excellent thoroughbred of a person possess both speed and beauty, but lacks the necessary correct proportions?

“Here, Bhikkhus, through the destruction of the contaminants and by his own direct knowledge, the Bhikkhu realizes in this very birth, the taintless Release of the Heart, liberating himself through his direct wisdom, and thereby enters into and abides in it.

“This, Bhikkhus, I say is his speed.

“And if a deep question on The Dhamma and The Discipline is asked of him, he does not become bewildered and is able to answer.

“Bhikkhus, I say that this is his beauty.

“But he does not easily obtain his robes, alms food, shelter, and other provisions, as well as faces difficulties in receiving the medicinal requisites, if and when he becomes sick.

“Bhikkhus, I say that this is his lack in the necessary correct proportions.

“This, Bhikkhus, is the excellent thoroughbred of a person, who possesses both speed and beauty, but lacks the necessary correct proportions.

c. “And how, Bhikkhus, is an excellent thoroughbred of a person endowed with speed, beauty, and the necessary correct proportions?

“Here, Bhikkhus, through the destruction of the contaminants and by his own direct knowledge, the Bhikkhu realizes in this very birth, the taintless Release of the Heart, liberating himself through his direct wisdom, and thereby enters into and abides in it.

“This, Bhikkhus, I say is his speed.

“And if a deep question on The Dhamma and The Discipline is asked of him, he does not become bewildered and is able to answer.

“Bhikkhus, I say that this is his beauty.

“Also, he easily obtains robes, alms food, shelter, and other provisions, as well as all the medicinal requisites, if and when he becomes sick.

“Bhikkhus, I say that this is him possessing the necessary correct proportions.

“Bhikkhus, this is the thoroughbred of a person who, like an excellent thoroughbred horse, possesses speed, beauty, and the necessary correct proportions.

“These, Bhikkhus, are the three types of excellent thoroughbred people.”

*142. **Paṭhama Moranivāpa Sutta** (The Peacock Sanctuary – Part 1)*

Once, while The Blessed One was living at the wandering ascetics' monastery of Moranivāpa, where peacocks used to roam, near the city of Rājagaha, He addressed the Bhikkhus by saying:

"Bhikkhus!"

"Yes, Bhante!" The Bhikkhus replied.

And The Blessed One continued speaking:

"Bhikkhus, endowed with three qualities, the Bhikkhu reaches the highest point, the complete ending of suffering, the ultimate goal of the Holy Life, becoming thus the Chief among both Devas and humans.

"And what are those three qualities?

"The first is the fulfillment of virtue throughout his behavior, which means he has completed The Training, and now stands beyond it.

"The second is the fulfillment of the collected stability of heart (*samādhi*), indicating that he has completed The Training, and now stands beyond it.

"The third, Bhikkhus, is the fulfillment of wisdom, which means he has completed The Training, and now stands beyond it.

"Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three qualities, the Bhikkhu reaches the highest point, the complete ending of suffering, the ultimate goal of the Holy Life, becoming thus the Chief among both Devas and humans."

*143. **Dutiya Moranivāpa Sutta** (The Peacock Sanctuary – Part 2)*

At one time, The Blessed One was living at the wandering ascetics' monastery of Moranivāpa, where peacocks used to roam, near the city of Rājagaha.

There, The Blessed One addressed the Bhikkhus, by saying:

"Bhikkhus!"

"Yes, Bhante!" The Bhikkhus replied.

And The Blessed One continued speaking:

“Bhikkhus, endowed with three qualities, the Bhikkhu comes to the highest point, the complete ending of suffering, reaching the ultimate goal of the Holy Life, becoming thus the Chief among both Devas and humans.

“And what are those three qualities?

“One is the extraordinary ability to wield psychic powers.
The other is the extraordinary ability to read the thoughts and intentions of others.
And the third is the extraordinary ability to give instructions.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three qualities, the Bhikkhu comes to the highest point, the complete ending of suffering, reaching the ultimate goal of the Holy Life, becoming thus the Chief among both Devas and humans.”

*144. **Tatiya Moranivāpa Sutta** (The Peacock Sanctuary – Part 3)*

Once, The Blessed One was living at the wandering ascetics’ monastery of Moranivāpa, where peacocks used to roam, near the city of Rājagaha.

While there, He turned to the Bhikkhus and said:

“Bhikkhus!”

“Yes, Bhante!” The Bhikkhus replied.

And The Blessed One continued instructing:

“Bhikkhus, endowed with three qualities, the Bhikkhu comes to the highest point, the complete ending of suffering, reaching the ultimate goal of the Holy Life, becoming thus the Chief among both Devas and humans.

“And what are those three qualities?

“Right View; Right Knowledge; and Right Liberation.

“Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three qualities, the Bhikkhu comes to the highest point, the complete ending of suffering, reaching the ultimate goal of the Holy Life, becoming thus the Chief among both Devas and humans.”

AN III

Suttas 145-154

Maṅgala Vagga

"The Section on the Great Fortune"

145. ***Akusala Sutta*** *(Damaging & Harmful)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three qualities, one lands in hell as if deposited there. And what are these three qualities?

Damaging and harmful physical actions; damaging and harmful speech; and damaging and harmful thoughts.

Bhikkhus, while possessing these three qualities, one lands in hell as if deposited there.

Bhikkhus, by possessing three other qualities, one lands in heaven as if deposited there. And what are these three qualities?

Beneficial and constructive physical actions; beneficial and constructive speech; and beneficial and constructive thoughts.

Bhikkhus, while possessing these three qualities, one lands in heaven as if deposited there.

146. ***Sāvajja Sutta*** *(Blamable)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three qualities, one lands in hell as if dragged and dropped there. What are these three qualities?

Engaging in blamable physical actions; engaging in blamable speech and communication; and engaging in blamable thinking.

Bhikkhus, by possessing these three qualities, one lands in hell as if dragged and dropped there.

On the other hand, Bhikkhus, by possessing three other qualities, one lands in heaven as though deposited there. What are these three qualities?

Engaging in blameless physical actions; engaging in blameless speech and communication; and engaging in blameless thinking.

Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three qualities, one lands in heaven as if deposited there.

*147. **Visama Sutta** (Disharmonious)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three qualities, one lands in hell as though dragged and dropped there. What are these three qualities?

Bodily actions that bring disharmony; speech that brings disharmony; thoughts and mental actions that bring disharmony.

Bhikkhus, by possessing these three qualities, one lands in hell as though dragged and dropped there.

But, Bhikkhus, by possessing three other qualities, one lands in heaven as though deposited there. What are these three qualities?

Bodily actions that bring harmony; speech that brings harmony; thoughts and mental actions that bring harmony.

Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three qualities, one lands in heaven as though deposited there.

*148. **Asuci Sutta** (Impure)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three qualities, one lands in hell as if dragged and dropped there. What are these three qualities?

Impure bodily actions; impure speech and verbal actions; impure thoughts and mental actions.

Bhikkhus, by possessing these three qualities, one lands in hell as if dragged and dropped there.

But Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three qualities, one lands in heaven as if deposited there. And what are these three qualities?

Bodily actions that are pure; speech that is pure; and thoughts that are pure.

Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three qualities, one lands in heaven as if deposited there.

*149. **Paṭhama Khata Sutta** (Dug Up & Undone – Part 1)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three qualities, the ignorant fool digs himself up from his very roots and destroys himself. As a result, he becomes blameworthy and is reproached by the wise, while also generating for himself much demerit.

And what are these three qualities?

Damaging and harmful bodily actions; damaging and harmful speech and communication; and damaging and harmful thoughts.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing three qualities, the ignorant fool digs himself up from his very roots and destroys himself. As a result, he becomes blameworthy and is reproached by the wise, while also generating much demerit.

But Bhikkhus, by possessing three other qualities, the wise and learned Superior Person does not uproot nor destroy himself. As a result, he remains blameless and is, in fact, praised by the wise, generating much merit.

And what are these three qualities?

Beneficial and constructive bodily actions; beneficial and constructive speech and verbal actions; and beneficial and constructive thoughts.

Bhikkhus, by possessing these three qualities, the wise and learned Superior Person does not uproot nor destroy himself. As a result, he remains blameless and is, in fact, praised by the wise, while generating much merit.

*150. **Dutiya Khata Sutta** (Dug Up & Undone – Part 2)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three qualities, the ignorant fool digs himself up from his very roots and destroys himself. As a result, he becomes blameworthy and is reproached by the wise, while also generating for himself much demerit.

And what are these three qualities?

Engaging in blamable bodily actions; engaging in blamable speech and verbal actions; and engaging in blamable thoughts.

Bhikkhus, by possessing these three qualities, the ignorant fool digs himself up from his roots and destroys himself. As a result, he becomes blameworthy, and is reproached by the wise, while also generating for himself much demerit.

However, Bhikkhus, by possessing three other qualities, the wise and learned Superior Person does not uproot nor destroy himself. As a result, he remains blameless throughout and, in fact, is praised by the wise, while generating for himself much merit.

And what are these three qualities?

Engaging in blameless bodily actions; engaging in blameless speech and verbal actions; and engaging in blameless thoughts.

Bhikkhus, by possessing three other qualities, the wise and learned Superior Person does not uproot nor destroy himself. As a result, he remains blameless throughout and, in fact, is praised by the wise, generating for himself much merit.

151. ***Tatiya Khata Sutta*** *(Dug Up & Undone – Part 3)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three qualities, the ignorant fool digs himself up from his very roots and destroys himself. As a result, he becomes blameworthy and gets reproached by the wise, while also generating much demerit for himself.

And what are these three qualities?

Engaging in physical actions that bring about disharmony and chaos; engaging in speech or communication that brings about disharmony and chaos; and engaging in thoughts that bring about disharmony and chaos.

Bhikkhus, by possessing three qualities, the ignorant fool digs himself up from his very roots and destroys himself. As a result, he becomes blameworthy and gets reproached by the wise, while also generating much demerit for himself.

But Bhikkhus, by possessing three other qualities, the wise and learned Superior Person does not uproot nor destroy himself. As a result, he remains blameless and is praised by the wise, while also generating much merit for himself. Now, what are these three qualities?

Engaging in harmonious physical actions; engaging in harmonious communication and speech; and engaging in harmonious thoughts.

Bhikkhus, by possessing three other qualities, the wise and learned Superior Person does not uproot nor destroy himself. As a result, he remains blameless and is praised by the wise, while also generating much merit for himself.

152. ***Catuttha Khata Sutta*** *(Dug Up & Undone – Part 4)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three qualities, the ignorant fool digs himself up from his very foundation and destroys himself. As a result, he becomes blameworthy and is thus reproached by the wise, while also generating much demerit for himself.

And what are these three qualities?

Engaging in defiled and impure bodily actions; engaging in defiled and impure verbal actions and speech; and engaging in defiled and impure mental actions or thoughts.

Bhikkhus, by possessing these three qualities, the ignorant fool becomes blameworthy and is thus reproached by the wise, while also generating much demerit for himself.

However, Bhikkhus, by possessing three other qualities, the wise and learned Superior Person does not uproot nor destroy himself. As a result, he remains blameless and is thus praised by the wise, while generating much merit for himself.

And what are these three qualities?

Engaging in pure bodily actions; engaging in pure verbal actions and speech; and engaging in pure mental actions.

Bhikkhus, by possessing these three other qualities, the wise and learned Superior Person does not uproot nor destroy himself. And as a result, he remains blameless and is thus praised by the wise, while generating much merit for himself.

153. ***Vandanā Sutta*** *(Homage)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three ways to pay homage. What three?

One pays homage through one's bodily actions.

One pays homage through his communication and in the way he speaks.

And one pays homage through his mental actions, in the way he thinks and ponders, while engaging in thought.

Bhikkhus, these are the three ways to pay homage.

154. ***Pubbaṇha Sutta*** *(At the Crack of Dawn)*

Bhikkhus, all those sentient beings who engage in good bodily actions, in good speech and verbal actions, and in good thought and mental actions at the crack of dawn, will already start experiencing and having genuine happiness, even at the crack of dawn.

All those sentient beings who engage in good bodily actions, in good verbal actions, and in good mental actions at noon time, will start experiencing genuine happiness even from midday.

All those sentient beings who engage in good bodily actions, in good verbal actions, and in good mental actions while the sun is already setting at the end of the day, will start experiencing genuine happiness even from the moment the sun begins to set.

'At the auspicious time,
Rising joyfully with the radiant light at the crack of dawn,
Greeting with a grateful smile,
Applying oneself fully and leading the Holy Life;
With each moment being the right moment,
Making the most of this precious life, in all its phases.

Dedicating himself to pure and wholesome actions;
Behaving in bodily actions, that are virtuous and pure;
In his communication and speech, remaining virtuous and pure,
And behaving in thought and all that is contemplated,
In ways that are truly virtuous and pure.

'In this manner doing what is upright
While also gaining the countless benefits it brings,
He easily attains to the lofty aims,
While growing in The Buddha's Dispensation,
Experiencing safety, joy and happiness, along with all his relatives too.'

AN III

Suttas 155-156

Paṭipadā Vagga

"The Section on The Path of Practice"

155. ***Paṭhama Paṭipadā Sutta*** *(Modes of Practice – Part 1)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three methods of practice. What three?

The pleasurable and sensually indulgent method of practice; the scorching method of practice that wastes the person away; and the method that is declared The Practice of the Middle Path.

a. And what, Bhikkhus, is the pleasurable and sensually indulgent method?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone holds on to the wrong view, exclaiming: *'There is nothing wrong in seeking pleasure or indulging in sensual pleasures,'* as he falls for the bait of sensual pleasures, while seeking their gratification, endlessly.

This, Bhikkhus, is the pleasurable and sensually indulgent method of practice.

b. And what, Bhikkhus, is the scorching method of practice that wastes the person away?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone lives without wearing any clothes, rejecting proper conventions of behavior within society; licks his hands, slurps his food loudly; does not invite nor accept invitations from anyone, neither offering a meal himself, nor accepting what is brought to him. He does not accept a special preparation, or an invitation to a meal. He does not accept a serving of food from a pot, from a cooking vessel, or a stick, or even pushed towards him on a broom. He does not accept food from two individuals who are eating, from a woman bearing a child, from a breast-feeding woman, from a woman living with a man, from a place where she is supported, or from a place where flies and dogs gather. He does not accept fish, meat, intoxicating drinks, brewed drinks and gruel.

Furthermore, he supports himself by going to a single house for food, to two houses, three houses, four houses, five houses, six houses or seven houses. Or he supports himself with what is brought from a single house with one morsel of food, from two houses and two morsels, from three houses and three morsels, from four houses and four morsels, from five houses and five morsels, from six houses and six morsels, from seven houses and seven morsels.

He supports himself by eating once a day, once every two days, once every three days, and as such, up to once every two weeks.

While eating, he takes vegetables, millet, raw rice, dark rice, moss, finely broken rice, rice foam, sesame flour, grass, cow dung, roots and fruits from the forest, and whatever is picked from the ground. He wears robes made of hemp, robes made of coarse cloth interwoven with hemp, robes made of rags, robes made from tree barks or *kusa* grass, from antelope hide, from strips of antelope hide, from strips of wood, and from owl's wings. He wears robes made of grass, from blankets made of head hair and blankets made of horse's tail.

He pursues the practice of pulling out his head hair and beard; continuously standing as penance while rejecting seats, or maintaining a squatting position at all times.
He tortures himself by wearing thorns and sleeping on a bed of sharp thorns. He continuously practices bathing for an extended period, up to three times per day, as well as in the evenings. Thus, he exposes himself and his body to various kinds of torture.

This, Bhikkhus, is the scorching method of practice that wastes the person away.

c. And what, Bhikkhus, is the method that is declared The Practice of the Middle Path?

Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu abides while being anchored within the body, staying with and observing the body as it moves through its many transitions, changes, interactions and positions, while remaining steadfast and mindful, clearly comprehending and fully aware, as he constantly keeps removing any thoughts of craving or resentment that may arise in the heart, towards the world and its conditions.

Similarly, the Bhikkhu abides while closely staying with feelings, and observing their shifting and ever-changing states, as they occur, while he remains steadfast and mindful, clearly comprehending and fully aware, as he constantly keeps removing any thoughts of craving or resentment that may arise in the heart, towards the world and its conditions.

Similarly, the Bhikkhu abides reflecting on the quality of the mind within the mind, and its ever-changing states, staying with and observing whatever is occurring in the mind, while remaining steadfast and mindful, clearly comprehending and fully aware, as he constantly keeps removing any thoughts of craving or resentment that may arise in the heart, towards the world and its conditions.

Likewise, the Bhikkhu abides reflecting on the various phenomena and their relationships (*dhammas*) as they arise and shift, staying with and observing the various mind objects as they occur, while remaining steadfast and mindful, clearly comprehending and fully aware of them, as he constantly keeps removing any thoughts of craving or resentment that may arise in the heart, towards the world and its conditions.

Bhikkhus, this is the method that is declared "The Practice of the Middle Path."

Therefore, Bhikkhus, these are the three methods of practice.

156. ***Dutiya Paṭipadā Sutta*** *(Modes of Practice – Part 2)*

Bhikkhus, these are the three methods of practice. What three?

The pleasurable and sensually indulgent method of practice; the scorching method of practice that wastes the person away; and the method that is declared The Practice of the Middle Path.

a. And what, Bhikkhus, is the pleasurable and sensually indulgent method?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone holds on to the wrong view, exclaiming: *'There is nothing wrong in seeking pleasure or indulging in sensual pleasures,'* as he falls for the bait of sensual pleasures, while seeking their gratification, endlessly.

This, Bhikkhus, is the pleasurable and sensually indulgent method of practice.

b. And what, Bhikkhus, is the scorching method of practice that wastes the person away?

Here, Bhikkhus, someone lives without wearing any clothes, rejecting proper conventions of behavior within society; licks his hands, slurps his food loudly; does not invite nor accept invitations from anyone, neither offering a meal himself, nor accepting what is brought to him. He does not accept a special preparation, or an invitation to a meal. He does not accept a serving of food from a pot, from a cooking vessel, or a stick, or even pushed towards him on a broom. He does not accept food from two individuals who are eating, from a woman bearing a child, from a breast-feeding woman, from a woman living with a man, from a place where she is supported, or from a place where flies and dogs gather. He does not accept fish, meat, intoxicating drinks, brewed drinks and gruel.

Furthermore, he supports himself by going to a single house for food, to two houses, three houses, four houses, five houses, six houses or seven houses. Or he supports himself with what is brought from a single house with one morsel of food, from two houses and two morsels, from three houses and three morsels, from four houses and four morsels, from five houses and five morsels, from six houses and six morsels, from seven houses and seven morsels.
He supports himself by eating once a day, once every two days, once every three days, and as such, up to once every two weeks.

While eating, he takes vegetables, millet, raw rice, dark rice, moss, finely broken rice, rice foam, sesame flour, grass, cow dung, roots and fruits from the forest, and whatever is picked from the ground. He wears robes made of hemp, robes made of coarse cloth interwoven with hemp, robes made of rags, robes made from tree barks or *kusa* grass, from antelope hide, from strips of

antelope hide, from strips of wood, and from owl's wings. He wears robes made of grass, from blankets made of head hair and blankets made of horse's tail.

He pursues the practice of pulling out his head hair and beard; continuously standing as penance while rejecting seats, or maintaining a squatting position at all times.
He tortures himself by wearing thorns and sleeping on a bed of sharp thorns. He continuously practices bathing for an extended period, up to three times per day, as well as in the evenings. Thus, he exposes himself and his body to various kinds of torture.

This, Bhikkhus, is the scorching method of practice that wastes the person away.

c. And what, Bhikkhus, is the method that is declared "The Practice of the Middle Path?"

1. Here, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu generates within himself the exceptional fervency so that no evil and damaging qualities may arise in him. To this end, he ardently strives and puts forth dedicated effort, zeal, determination, and unremitting energy, so that evil and damaging qualities do not arise in him.

Similarly, the Bhikkhu generates within himself the exceptional fervency so as to eliminate and totally obliterate any evil or damaging qualities that may have already arisen in him. To this end, he ardently strives and puts forth dedicated effort, zeal, determination, and unremitting energy, so that the evil and damaging qualities that may have already arisen in him are immediately thrown out and given up.

Similarly, the Bhikkhu generates within himself the exceptional fervency so that beneficial and constructive qualities receive their spark and thus arise in him. To this end, he ardently strives and puts forth dedicated effort, zeal, determination, and unremitting energy, so that beneficial and constructive qualities do arise in him.

Similarly, the Bhikkhu generates within himself the exceptional fervency so that the beneficial and constructive qualities that have already arisen in him, continue to grow. To this end, he ardently strives and puts forth dedicated effort, zeal, determination, and unremitting energy so that the beneficial and constructive qualities that have already arisen in him, become further cultivated and continue to develop.

2. Furthermore, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu strives by building and cultivating the foundation for success and psychic power by fanning and directing the *saṅkhāra* of fervent interest for developing in his practice, through the deepening of his *samādhi*, which grows as a result of being impelled by that fervor, accompanied by active endeavor and the necessary exertion.

Next, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu strives by building and cultivating the foundation for success and psychic power by fanning and directing the *saṅkhāra* for persevering energy, through the deepening of his *samādhi*, which grows as a result of being impelled by that energy, accompanied by active endeavor and the necessary exertion.

Also, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu strives by building and cultivating the foundation for success and psychic power by fanning and directing the *saṅkhāra* for intuitive awareness, through the deepening of his *samādhi*, which grows as a result of being impelled by his directed heart, accompanied by active endeavor and the necessary exertion.

Also, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu strives by building and cultivating the foundation for success and psychic power by fanning and directing the *saṅkhāra* for examination, through the deepening of his *samādhi*, which grows as a result of being impelled by that investigative capacity, accompanied by active endeavor and the necessary exertion.

3. Furthermore, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu applies himself by cultivating the spiritual faculty of faith and trust in his heart. He applies himself by cultivating the spiritual faculty of persevering effort. He applies himself by cultivating the spiritual faculty of mindfulness. He applies himself by cultivating the spiritual faculty of collected stability of the heart. He applies himself by cultivating the spiritual faculty of wisdom.

4. Next, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu applies himself by cultivating the spiritual power of faith and trust in his heart. He applies himself by cultivating the spiritual power of persevering effort. He applies himself by cultivating the spiritual power of mindfulness. He applies himself by cultivating the spiritual power of collected stability of the heart. He applies himself by cultivating the spiritual power of wisdom.

5. Next, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu applies himself by cultivating the Awakening Factor of mindfulness. He applies himself by cultivating the Awakening Factor of investigation of states. He applies himself by cultivating the Awakening Factor of persevering effort. He applies himself by cultivating the Awakening Factor of spiritual joy. He applies himself by cultivating the Awakening Factor of tranquility of mind. He applies himself by cultivating the Awakening Factor of collected stability of the heart. He applies himself by cultivating the Awakening Factor of equanimity.

6. Next, Bhikkhus, the Bhikkhu applies himself by cultivating Right View and Understanding. He applies himself by cultivating Right Thinking and Intentions. He applies himself by cultivating Right Speech in his Communication. He applies himself by cultivating Right Action throughout his behavior. He applies himself by cultivating Right Livelihood. He applies himself by cultivating Right Effort. He applies himself by cultivating Right Mindfulness. He applies himself by cultivating Right Concentration.

This, therefore, Bhikkhus, is the method that is declared “The Practice of the Middle Path.”

Bhikkhus, these then comprise the three methods of practice.



AN III

Suttas 157-166

Kammapatha Peyyāla

"Abbreviated Section on the Courses of Action"

157. ***Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta*** *(Deposited into Hell – Part 1)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three things, one is reborn into hell as if brought and deposited there. Now, what are these three?

First is when one destroys and kills living beings.
Second is when one incites and spurs others to destroy and kill living beings.
And thirdly, it is when one justifies and approves of the harming, destruction, and the killing of living beings.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three things, one is reborn into hell as if brought and deposited there.

However, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn into heaven as if brought and deposited there. And what are these three?

First is when one abstains from destroying or killing living beings.
Second is when one encourages others to abstain from destroying or killing living beings.
And third is when one rejects and disapproves of the harming, destruction, and the killing of living beings.

Thus, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn into heaven as if brought and deposited there.

158. ***Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta*** *(Deposited into Hell – Part 2)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three things, one is reborn in hell as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One steals and takes what is not given.
One incites others to steal and take what is not given.

And one approves of stealing and justifies the taking of what is not given.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three things, one is reborn in hell as if brought and deposited there.

However, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven as if brought and deposited there.

What three?

One abstains from stealing or taking what is not given.
One encourages others to abstain from stealing or taking what is not given.
And one disapproves of stealing or taking what is not given.

Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven as if brought and deposited there.

*159. **Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta** (Deposited into Hell – Part 3)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three things, one is reborn in hell as if brought and deposited there.
What three?

One engages in sexual misconduct.
One incites others to engage in sexual misconduct.
And one approves of and justifies the engaging in sexual misconduct.

Thus, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three things, one is reborn in hell as if brought and deposited there.

But, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One abstains from engaging in sexual misconduct.
One encourages others to abstain from engaging in sexual misconduct.
And one totally rejects and disapproves of engaging in sexual misconduct.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven as if brought and deposited there.

*160. **Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta** (Deposited into Hell – Part 4)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three things, one is reborn in hell as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One speaks falsely and lies; one incites others to speak falsely and to lie; and one justifies and approves of others speaking falsely and lying.

However, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One abstains from speaking falsely or lying; one encourages others to abstain from speaking falsely or lying; and one disapproves of others speaking falsely or lying.

*161. **Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta** (Deposited into Hell – Part 5)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three things, one is reborn in hell, as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One slanders; one incites others to slander; and one justifies and approves of slandering.

But Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven, as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One abstains from slandering; one encourages others to abstain from slandering; and one disapproves of slandering.

*162. **Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta** (Deposited into Hell – Part 6)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three things, one is reborn in hell, as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One uses mean and harsh words.
One incites others to use mean and harsh words.
And one justifies and approves the use of mean and harsh words.

Thus, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three things, one is reborn in hell, as if brought and deposited there.

But, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven, as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One abstains from using mean and harsh words.
One encourages others to abstain from using mean and harsh words.
And one disapproves of the use of mean and harsh words.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven, as if brought and deposited there.

*163. **Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta** (Deposited into Hell – Part 7)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three things, one is reborn in hell, as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One uses idle chatter by talking frivolously.
One incites others to use idle chatter by talking frivolously.
And one justifies and approves the use of idle chatter and frivolous talking.

Thus, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three things, one is reborn in hell, as if brought and deposited there.

However, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven, as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One abstains from using idle chatter by not talking frivolously.
One abstains from inciting others to use idle chatter while also discouraging frivolous talk.
And one disapproves of the use of idle chatter by talking frivolously.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven, as if brought and deposited there.

*164. **Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta** (Deposited into Hell – Part 8)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three things, one is reborn in hell, as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One covets and is full of longing.
One incites others to covet and to be full of longing.
And one justifies and approves of possessing a coveting nature and being full of longing.

Thus, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three things, one is reborn in hell, as if brought and deposited there.

However, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven, as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One abstains from coveting and is without longing.
One encourages others to abstain from coveting or to be full of longing.
And one disapproves of possessing a coveting nature and being full of longing.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven, as if brought and deposited there.

*165. **Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta** (Deposited into Hell – Part 9)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three things, one is reborn in hell, as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One becomes angry and hateful.
One incites others to become angry and hateful.
And one justifies and approves of having an angry and hateful nature.

Thus, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three things, one is reborn in hell, as if brought and deposited there.

However, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven, as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One abstains from becoming angry or hateful.
One encourages others to abstain from becoming angry or hateful.
And one disapproves of having an angry and hateful nature.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three other things, one is reborn in heaven, as if brought and deposited there.

*166. **Nikkhitto Niraye Sutta** (Deposited into Hell – Part 10)*

Bhikkhus, by possessing three things, one is reborn in hell, as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One has and holds on to wrong views.
One incites others to develop and hold on to wrong views.
And one justifies and approves of having and holding on to wrong views.

Thus, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three things, one is reborn in hell, as if brought and deposited there.

However, Bhikkhus, by possessing these other three things, one is reborn in heaven, as if brought and deposited there. What three?

One has and holds on to the Right View.
One encourages others to rectify their view and thus gain the Right View.
And one approves of having the Right View.

Therefore, Bhikkhus, by possessing these three other things, one is reborn in heaven, as if brought and deposited there.



AN III

Suttas 167-352

Rāga Peyyāla Vagga

"The Section on Abbreviated Repetitions, Starting with Passion"

167 - 352.

a. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **passion**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **passion**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **passion**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **passion**, these three things should be developed.

b. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **hatred**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **hatred**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **hatred**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **hatred**, these three things should be developed.

c. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **delusion**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **delusion**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **delusion**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **delusion**, these three things should be developed.

d. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **anger**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **anger**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **anger**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **anger**, these three things should be developed.

e. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **denigration**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **denigration**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **denigration**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **denigration**, these three things should be developed.

f. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **malicious nature**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **malicious nature**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **malicious nature**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **malicious nature**, these three things should be developed.

g. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **jealousy**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.

Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **jealousy**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **jealousy**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **jealousy**, these three things should be developed.

h. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **self-absorption**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **self-absorption**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **self-absorption**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **self-absorption**, these three things should be developed.

i. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **hypocrisy**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **hypocrisy**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **hypocrisy**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **hypocrisy**, these three things should be developed.

j. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **envy**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **envy**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **envy**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **envy**, these three things should be developed.

k. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **stubbornness**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **stubbornness**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **stubbornness**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **stubbornness**, these three things should be developed.

l. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **self-entitlement** or **impetuosity**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **self-entitlement** or **impetuosity**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **self-entitlement** or **impetuosity**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **self-entitlement** or **impetuosity**, these three things should be developed.

m. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **stinginess**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **stinginess**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **stinginess**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **stinginess**, these three things should be developed.

n. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **conceit**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **conceit**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **conceit**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **conceit**, these three things should be developed.

o. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **intoxication**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **intoxication**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **intoxication**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **intoxication**, these three things should be developed.

p. Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **negligence**, three things should be developed. What three?

The collectedness of mind through emptiness; the collectedness of mind through sign-less-ness; and the collectedness of mind through desire-less-ness.
Bhikkhus, to thoroughly and directly know **negligence**, these three should be developed.

Bhikkhus, for the complete understanding of **negligence**, its exhaustion, dispelling, destruction, fading away, disenchantment, cessation, and giving up of **negligence**, these three things should be developed.

This is what The Blessed One said.

The Bhikkhus were utterly delighted and gladdened by listening to The Blessed One's words.

(Here ends The Book of the Threes)



Sādhu Sādhu Sādhu

Translated by Bhikkhu Candana

Copyright © Bhikkhu Candana 2020, 2026

a final note

As this volume comes to a close, the words of The Blessed One and the Noble Disciples continue to echo beyond the page.

The Dhamma does not end where a book ends. It truly lives whenever and wherever it is reflected upon, practiced, and realized.

This work has been prepared with a single guiding intention: that The Teachings be preserved and made available in a way that allows their voice to come through clearly, directly, and without unnecessary interruptions, let alone any obstructions.

The Dhamma has always been something to be heard, contemplated, and lived – *not* merely studied. For this reason, the effort throughout this project has been to keep the presentation as faithful, transparent, and uninterrupted as possible, so that readers may encounter The Blessed One's Teachings in their own immediacy and depth.

The *Aṅguttara Nikāya*, with its practical and graduated structure, speaks intimately to the conditions of human life. Its teachings touch the struggles, responsibilities, relationships, and aspirations shared by people in every era. Preserving such guidance is not an academic task alone, but a living service to beings who seek clarity, peace, and Liberation.

Whatever goodness may have arisen through the preparation of this volume is not held as personal possession. It is offered in gratitude to the many individuals whose quiet generosity and support have made this work possible, and it is shared with all who turn toward The Dhamma with sincerity. May the merit extend outward without measure.

May these volumes travel far, as they meet (and "be greeted" by) all those who are ready for them…

